



Partly sunny 73/50 • Tomorrow: Plenty of sun 66/48

Democracy Dies in Darkness

MONDAY, OCTOBER 5, 2026 • \$4

Taking the L in London



DAVID J. PHILLIP/AP

Third-string quarterback Athan Kaliakmanis throws under pressure for the Commanders in Sunday's 30-13 loss to the Indianapolis Colts. Kaliakmanis stepped in after Marcus Mariota suffered a knee injury. **Story, C1**

States seek help with security for midterms

MORE FOREIGN MEDDLING IS EXPECTED

Administration isn't doing enough, local officials say

BY JOSHUA YANG AND WARREN P. STROBEL

U.S. intelligence agencies are monitoring schemes by Russia and other adversaries to meddle in the midterm elections, but countering those threats has been complicated by the Trump administration's slashing of the federal government's election security infrastructure, officials say.

The spy agencies assess that Russia, as it has in past years, will use digital disinformation to sow distrust in the 2026 midterm results and foment societal divisions, according to lawmakers and other officials. U.S. intelligence, however, has detected no signs that foreign adversaries are able to interfere directly with voting machines or vote counts.

With the midterms less than five weeks away, state elections officials responsible for administering them are decrying what they say is a dearth of information on such threats and other support from Washington.

"We're in the dark when it

comes to any sort of intelligence" on foreign adversaries, said Utah's Republican Lt. Gov. Deidre Henderson. "We're not being informed if there are problems."

President Donald Trump's administration has halted intelligence briefings, trainings, systems testing and other resources for states, according to the state officials and former federal election security officials. Only in recent days have federal agencies begun offering briefings to states, and it is unclear if any have taken place.

The Cybersecurity and Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA), a key election security agency under the Department of Homeland Security, laid off nearly one-third of its staff in early 2025.

Trump has yet to appoint a director for the CISA — though there have been three acting directors — leaving states in "a holding pattern," said Idaho Secretary of State Phil McGrane, a Republican.

SEE ELECTION ON A9

A region's grape farmers watch livelihoods wither

Falling demand for juice has left Lake Erie growers with fruit they can't sell

BY TIM CRAIG

NORTH EAST, PA. — Mark Terrell knows when it's time to harvest because the air starts to smell like a freshly opened jar of grape jelly.

That's usually when Terrell drives his harvesting tractor through his 200-acre vineyard on the shores of Lake Erie, shaking millions of concord grapes from the vines to be processed into juice.

But after a juice company abruptly canceled its contract with Terrell and about 125 other grape farmers in northwest Pennsylvania and western New York, Terrell's farm vehicles remain parked.

"It's stressful because I've put everything I had into this," Terrell said as he scanned his 120,000 grapevines. "Now, it's dying on the vine."

After months of frantically trying to find a new buyer, Terrell and other farmers in one of the nation's most abundant fruit-growing regions are preparing to let their grapes fall to the ground. The crisis threatens to reshape local economies in two states as grape farmers come to

SEE GRAPES ON A16

D.C.'s tour guides are losing business

City's reputation, landscape have been changed under Trump

BY JOE HEIM

Photographer E. David Luria has spent almost every day of the past 27 years working with clients of his Washington Photo Safari business to help them see and capture D.C. in its most beautiful light.

He teaches them how to frame breathtaking sunrises from the steps of the Lincoln Memorial, capture sweeping vistas of the National Mall from the top of the Washington Monument and shoot the elegant north face of the White House from Lafayette

Square.

"I'm probably the guy who knows more about taking pictures in D.C. than anyone else in town," Luria, 90, said with a laugh while sitting in a coffee shop near the White House on a recent rainy afternoon.

Luria, who has shepherded tens of thousands of clients over the years, was hopeful his business might get a boost in 2026 as Washington celebrated America's 250th anniversary. Instead, it has mostly been a bust.

And it isn't just Luria feeling the pain. Tour guides across the District say their business has cratered this year, in some cases as much as 70 percent as a number of Washington's iconic sites are closed, under construction or awaiting repairs. Adding to the downturn, guides say, is that many tourists, particularly in-

ternational visitors, are angered by President Donald Trump's attacks on longtime allies, the imposition of hard-hitting tariffs, and the administration's visa and immigration policies.

"People just aren't coming," said Luria, a D.C. resident for 56 years, who estimates his bookings are down about 50 percent from last year. "They just don't want to put up with it."

He keeps a running list of must-sees that have become hard-to-sees or don't-want-to-sees: The empty and fenced-off Reflecting Pool, most of Lafayette Square, the White House's no longer standing East Wing (and the \$900 million ballroom being built to replace it), the shuttered Kennedy Center and swaths of the National Mall.

It's a bit like visiting London

SEE D.C. TOUR GUIDES ON A10

ELECTION 2026

In Senate bid, Cooper avoids extremes

He touts centrist record in N.C. and is Democrats' best hope to flip a seat

BY PRAVEENA SOMASUNDARAM

WILSON, N.C. — John Ashe thought of the acres of tobacco that once sprawled across his hometown as he delivered a sobering message about where those farms stand today.

They had already dwindled in size and number, but tariffs and the Iran war were making things worse. The prices of the fuel and fertilizer he needs were doubling, sometimes tripling.

"It's killing everybody, not just farms, but everybody," Ashe, a fourth-generation tobacco farmer, said on a recent day in eastern North Carolina.

He laid out those realities as his rationale for supporting the Senate campaign of Roy Cooper, the state's former governor and a man he thought would make running the farm easier. Ashe, 58, wasn't sure how many of the neighbors in his conservative patch of the state would agree.

But he thought Cooper had a good shot, given his political success as a Democrat in what Ashe called a "funny state," which in recent decades has embraced Democrats as governors but most often shunned them in races for the U.S. Senate and president.

"It amazes me that he's done

SEE COOPER ON A8

Midterms: Record number of Native Americans are running. **A3**

Should Big Oil pay for climate change's fallout?

Boulder, Colorado, case before the Supreme Court will help decide

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL

MEEKER, COLO. — Kathleen Kelley's family long had close ties to the oil industry, but the wildfire that swept over the ridge that framed her rolling 2,000-acre ranch in the Rockies prompted a reckoning.

The Lee Fire in August 2025 was so massive that Kelley said it looked like a "giant, slow-motion" tornado of flame.

It roared in amid a relentless drought that has stretched over two decades. Kelley's late father, who lived through the Dust Bowl, said he had seen nothing like it. A stream that watered her

400 cattle turned to dust. Kelley, a fourth-generation rancher, was forced to sell her cows.

The sound of the fire ripping through the desiccated brush was like a "jet engine breaking down," Kelley said. All told, 98 percent of her ranch was scorched. In one spot, all that stood was a single tree surrounded by acres of blackened earth.

"In that moment, you look at it and say, 'Is this the future? Is this what we are stuck with everywhere?'" Kelley said.

To Kelley, there was a clear culprit pushing her way of life to the brink: climate change. Kelley's uncle had worked for Chevron and her family once had plans to drill on the ranch, but the Lee Fire marked a tipping point for her.

SEE SCOTUS ON A6

Key cases: Six things to watch in Supreme Court's new term. **A7**



KELSEY BRUNNER/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Kathleen Kelley backed a novel type of lawsuit targeting some of the world's biggest oil companies.

IN THE NEWS

Concerns on campus How ketamine, kratom and other recreational drugs are changing Cornell University and other schools. **A2**

Richard Ables's legacy A funeral director who guided generations of Washingtonians through the ritual of burying loved ones was no less meticulous about his own passing. **C8**

THE NATION **Four top U.S. officials** were named to the president's "Super Intelligence Force." **A4** **A couple** accused of killing their son-in-law had battled with him over gender identity. **A4**

THE WORLD **A U.S. Marine** was arrested on suspicion of robbing and killing a woman in Tokyo. **A12** **Russian strikes** on Kyiv's bridges aim to make Ukraine's capital unlivable by winter. **A12**

THE ECONOMY **Rising interest rates** could be good for seniors' savings, but they can hit them unexpectedly in other ways. **A13** **Changing your** approach to work is crucial to achieving the goal of early retirement if you don't have enough savings. **A13**

STYLE **"East of Eden"** is a tale of familial legacy. Zoe Kazan confronted her own to tell the story in a new Netflix series. **B1**

SPORTS **The Baltimore Ravens** lost star quarterback Lamar Jackson, then ground out a win over the Tennessee Titans. **C1**

THE REGION **National Guard** members have been congregating outside D.C. schools in recent weeks, stoking tensions. **C8**

HEALTH & SCIENCE **"Long flu"** can harm the lungs and other organs, including the brain, but you can reduce your risk.

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MATT ROURKE/AP

Students walk across the campus of Cornell University in Ithaca, New York, on Thursday. Ketamine, kratom and other drugs are changing Cornell and other schools.

What the Cornell case says about drug use at colleges

Calls for drug-testing strips, medications to reverse overdoses

BY SUSAN SVRLUGA

On Oct. 17, 2024, a Cornell University sophomore who was worried about drug use at fraternity parties suggested to the school's student government that all student housing should be supplied with medication for opioid overdoses, date-rape drug testing kits, and an easy means of testing whether drugs were laced with fentanyl or xylazine.

The next day, according to court documents, a student in Cornell's Chi Phi fraternity overdosed on ketamine, a dissociative hallucinogenic anesthetic better known as Special K or key.

And the following night at a party at Chi Phi, a 20-year-old woman took ketamine in the midst of what she would later allege in a lawsuit was a gang rape that extended into the early-morning hours of Oct. 20. Numerous people consumed ketamine, according to court documents, snorting it off a key or off of the woman's naked body.

The lawsuit filed last month against multiple defendants, including Cornell and seven men, touched off a nationwide firestorm of outraged reactions. One of the issues that surfaced in the case, as well as in other high-profile incidents in recent weeks, is the availability and recreational use of dangerous drugs on college campuses.

While alcohol use has caused problems at universities for decades, and cannabis is the most commonly used drug on campuses, experts said students now have access to a variety of far more potent, fast-evolving and potentially deadly drugs — without knowing whether something they bought illegally or right at their gas station contains dangerous unknown compounds.

Besides ketamine and fentanyl, the drugs spurring widespread concern on campuses this semester include kratom, an herbal product which can be purchased in stores in some states, cyclochlorphine, which is estimated to be about 10 times more potent than fentanyl, and

xylazine, a veterinary tranquilizer. Cyclochlorphine and xylazine are sometimes added to other drugs unbeknownst to users, experts said.

Some of the newer drugs are very different from those of previous generations, said Mary Hoban, chief research officer of the American College Health Association: "They'll kill you at a single use."

And young people, whose brains are still developing, often feel invincible, said Bernadine Waller, an assistant professor in psychiatry at Columbia University Irving Medical Center. "They're not thinking anything could go wrong."

Two students were found dead last month at the University of Mississippi, one on campus and one at a house off campus, just one hour apart.

The causes of the deaths have not yet been determined.

But the county narcotics unit said both men had packages of kratom-like pills. Officials took the opportunity to warn people through a press release not to use kratom, which is derived from the leaves of a tropical tree that is a stimulant at low doses and opiate-like sedative in higher doses. It is legal in many states, including parts of Mississippi — although the city and county where the school is have bans in place.

There are also synthetic versions of kratom.

Agents with Lafayette County Metro Narcotics went to a vape shop in the college town where they said one of the students bought kratom-related pills, seized THC- and kratom-related products and other substances, and arrested two men working at the shop. They were charged with possession of Schedule 1 controlled substances with intent to distribute, and also charged on a criminal complaint by federal prosecutors Thursday in suspected connection to the death of one of the Ole Miss students.

The narcotics officials warned last week that manufactured, concentrated or chemically altered kratom products are different than botanical kratom. And the pills that were found in both cases contained an alarming ingredient — one of three synthetic opioids that the U.S. Drug Enforcement Administration recently determined present an imminent hazard to public safety.

The developments, narcotics officials wrote in a press release last week, raise important questions about how emerging synthetic substances are identified, regulated and prosecuted. They called on Mississippi lawmakers to take action to help keep people safe.

Kratom derivatives like MGPI, MGM-15 and MGM-16 have been referred to as "gas station heroin," a statement released last week from U.S. Attorney Scott F. Leary for the Northern District of Mississippi noted, and can be significantly more potent than morphine, with high risk of addiction, overdose and death.

In 2025, poison control centers received 3,434 kratom-related exposure reports, a marked surge from the year before and an increase of 1,200 percent in the last decade.

"There has never been a more dangerous time to be a young person in American society," Mississippi Gov. Tate Reeves (R) said in a statement after news of the deaths of the two students, just 18 and 20 years old.

Students around the country are warning their classmates that they may be unknowingly consuming a lesser-known substance while getting high on other drugs.

Fraternities and sororities at Ole Miss, and other campuses including Michigan State University, warned students on social media and in other ways about the new threat posed by cyclochlorphine, a powerful synthetic opioid that has caused overdose deaths.

And while several students at various campuses said they have seen some students carry and routinely use fentanyl test strips — inexpensive ways to check drugs for the potentially deadly substance — those tests don't indicate the presence of cyclochlorphine.

Because cyclochlorphine can be far more potent than fentanyl, some of the warnings sent to students urged people to keep naloxone on them at all times, and carry at least two doses when possible — since one may not be enough to counter the drug.

Naloxone is a medicine that can rapidly reverse an opioid overdose.

Ole Miss, like a small but growing number of campuses, has vending machines with free

Narcan, the nasal spray that quickly administers naloxone so that students have quick access to potentially lifesaving supplies. It is also available in student housing at some campuses, which according to the American College Health Association, is increasingly common.

A local paper, the Oxford Eagle, reported last month that a Narcan vending machine in downtown Oxford, Mississippi, installed less than two months earlier had been used nearly 800 times.

Ole Miss also has a wellness center, named after a student who died of an overdose, that offers services including Narcan training and substance abuse recovery communities.

Several students at Ole Miss said people on campus are grieving and frightened by the recent deaths, which came just after a festive weekend when the football team beat rival Louisiana State University in an ESPN College Game Day event that broke records for crowds at a school known for its huge tailgating culture.

Nadia Shah, a senior linguistics major from Tennessee, mentioned how much people were partying that weekend. "But I would hope that after all this has happened students here will take more precaution," in what kind of substances they're ingesting, she said, "because you'll never know what exactly what you're smoking or what you're drinking."

Allyson Harlos, a pharmacy student from Mississippi, said she grew up in a "drug-heavy" town, so hearing about the deaths was more sad than shocking to her; she has long been aware of the risks of substances like fentanyl.

Since she got to college, she has always carried Narcan, she said.

"I'll be honest," she said. "I don't think anyone's really gonna change their ways about this. ... Maybe a couple more people will carry Narcan, maybe a couple more people will do things a bit more safely. But all in all, Ole Miss is one of the top-10 party schools in the world — or at least in the U.S. — and nothing's ever gonna change that."

It's always going to be dangerous, and people are always going to do irresponsible, dangerous things, she said, because "in the moment they're fun."

In 2024, Cornell student Davian Gekman started to worry about safety at his fraternity because there was no way to know whether people had taken drugs before they showed up at a party, or what was in the drugs if they had. One of the frat's members went and got some Narcan to have on hand, just in case. That's when Gekman, a member of the student assembly, began to think that all student housing should have Narcan and ways to test drugs to make sure they weren't laced.

Soon after he introduced the resolution, the student government agreed to recommend making Narcan available as well as date-rape drug testing kits and test strips that could test for fentanyl and xylazine. Xylazine is sometimes added to other drugs, and its effects can't be reversed with overdose reversal medications.

In addition to free Narcan and testing strips in vending machines, Cornell provides Narcan training for students, faculty and staff, university spokesperson Rebecca Valli said.

The school strengthened its focus on alcohol and other drugs while implementing a presidential task force on campus sexual assault, formed in 2025, including adding in-person education about communication and consent. The school also offers drug and alcohol prevention programs, including by-request education sessions focused on reducing high-risk substance use, Valli said.

On Saturday, Cornell President Michael I. Kotlikoff promised an external review of its handling of the rape allegations, and said the school would not wait for the review to act. "Where we see opportunities to strengthen prevention and education, student support, mental health and substance use resources, investigative processes or coordination among our university offices, we will act," he said in a video message to the campus community.

Gekman said he was appreciative that there was agreement from student leaders in 2024 about implementing precautions around drug use.

"We didn't wait for something to happen," he said. "We took action right away."

Dylan Thomas in Oxford, Mississippi, contributed to this report.

Cornell president acknowledges anger and sadness at school

BY SUSAN SVRLUGA

Cornell University President Michael Kotlikoff said Saturday that allegations of a 2024 gang rape raised "heartbreaking and troubling" issues and pledged to hire an outside law firm to review all aspects of Cornell's handling of the matter.

Kotlikoff, in a video message, acknowledged anger and sadness among students, faculty and parents and said it was crucial to foster a culture where sexual assault is excusable.

Kotlikoff also said he backed New York Gov. Kathy Hochul's (D) decision to appoint a special

prosecutor to lead a reopened criminal investigation.

A Cornell student, identified in court documents as "Jane Doe," has filed a civil lawsuit alleging that she was sexually assaulted and raped by seven members of Cornell's Chi Phi fraternity in October 2024 in Ithaca, New York.

Hochul has criticized a county district attorney's office and Cornell University police for their handling of the allegations.

"What happened to Jane Doe in 2024 is deeply disturbing and will weigh heavily on our community for years to come," Kotlikoff said.

likoff said.

"It raises heartbreaking and troubling issues about sexual assault, dehumanization and aspects of party culture, alcohol and drug use," he added.

He said the university was "committed to investigating and finding the answers our community deserves."

The allegations in the lawsuit sparked outrage at the district attorney and the Ivy League university, and renewed attention to the problem of sexual assault on college campuses.

Doe reported what had happened to campus police on Nov. 8, 2024, according to the com-

plaint.

Tompkins County District Attorney Matthew Van Houten declined to pursue criminal charges at the time. Van Houten has defended that decision, saying there was "insufficient evidence" to pursue charges when his office reviewed the case in 2024.

The Xi chapter of Chi Phi and seven students were placed on temporary suspension on Nov. 8, 2024, the day Doe went to campus police, according to Doe's civil complaint.

The fraternity chapter was closed and remains barred from campus.

The university said in a statement this past week that it conducted a thorough Title IX investigation over several months and issued a range of sanctions, including suspensions and expulsions.

Kotlikoff said in his video message that the university must do everything it can to prevent what happened to Jane Doe from happening to another student.

"This is a defining moment in Cornell's history," Kotlikoff said. "We must lead the way. We owe it to Jane Doe and to survivors of assault to get this right, and we must keep each other safe."

THE NATION



Former interior secretary Deb Haaland is running for governor in New Mexico. She was the first Native American to serve as a Cabinet secretary, a post she held during the Biden administration.

Record number of Native Americans in midterm races

At least 355 ran or are running as candidates for office this year

BY MARIANA ALFARO

A Native American woman has never held a governorship, or a seat in the U.S. Senate.

That could change this year, if former interior secretary Deb Haaland wins the governor's race in New Mexico, and if either former congresswoman Mary Peltola (D-Alaska) or Minnesota Lt. Gov. Peggy Flanagan (D) win their Senate bids.

Haaland, Peltola and Flanagan are part of a historically large class of at least 355 Native American and Indigenous candidates who ran or are running in local, state and federal primary and general elections this year. Many are running as Democrats, though there are some Republicans as well, including incumbent Oklahoma Reps. Tom Cole and Josh Brecheen at the federal level.

The previous high came in 2024, when at least 263 Native candidates ran for elected office, according to numbers maintained by Advance Native Political Leadership, a national Native American-led organization that aims to increase the number of elected Native and Indigenous lawmakers, and Indian Country Today.

"My goal has always been to ensure more Native Americans have the opportunity to lead," Haaland wrote in an email to The Washington Post.

"Now I see more Native people running, winning, and leading in their communities, and I support them every step of the way."

Gabriel Sanchez, a senior fellow in at the Brookings Institution and a founding member of the University of New Mexico's Native American Budget and Policy Institute, said tribal sovereignty and protection of tribal lands have likely spurred candidates to run this year — and often rank among Native American voters' top concerns in polling.

"Native Americans are not as partisan as other Americans, and oftentimes they make their voting decision not based on their party but on which candidate they perceive is going to be in the best interest of their tribe," he said.

Sanchez noted that many Native Americans view running for office through a similar lens,

and that the uptick this year likely stems from concern that the system isn't working for Native communities.

"It's not a coincidence. I think the rise in interest among Native Americans to run for office in the first place is a result of all that context," he said.

Many Native and Indigenous organizers say the recent increase in Native candidacies is thanks to a shift in how their communities view public service that began in 2018 when Haaland, a member of the Laguna Pueblo tribe, and Rep. Sharice Davids (D-Kansas), a member of the Ho-Chunk nation, became the first Native American women elected to Congress.

That shift only accelerated when Haaland became the first Native American to serve as a Cabinet secretary, as interior secretary during the Biden administration, said Jordan James Harvill, the senior director of national programs at the ANPL.

He added that Native American and Indigenous folks were lining up to watch her confirmation hearings, sharing memes and talking openly about more Native representation at the federal level.

"Native people have some of the lowest trust in government of any group in the country," Harvill said, in part due to a long history of broken treaties, forced assimilation, relocations and removals. "To be able to see ourselves in office — and believe that there was an impact — changed something fundamentally."

While figures like Haaland, Davids and Peltola provided inspiration, organizers and Native experts say the rising numbers of Native and Indigenous candidates also come from years of organizing and outreach.

Haaland — who polls show leading the New Mexico gubernatorial race — first came to politics through organizing. She writes in her memoir that she once registered 400 tribal members to vote in one weekend, and that she organized for then-presidential candidate Barack Obama in New Mexico before running for office herself.

"You have to show up in Native communities and have face to face conversations to encourage people to register to vote," Haaland said in her emailed statement. "It takes an investment of time and resources dedicated to outreach."

To grow the candidate pool, the ANPL began recruiting potential candidates in 2021. Harvill said over a thousand Native and Indigenous individuals



Former congresswoman Mary Peltola (D) is running for U.S. Senate in Alaska.



Former Navajo president Jonathan Nez is running to represent Arizona's 2nd Congressional District.

have applied to a program that recruits and trains members to run for office, and Flanagan credited the initiative with making real change.

"Programs like the Native American Leadership Program, which grew into Advance Native Political Leadership, are training people to run and win," Flanagan said in an email to The Post. "The more people see someone like them doing it, the more step up. But real obstacles remain, especially in fundraising and building support."

The ANPL also partners with voter organizations to help tribal members sign up to vote and ensure that their registrations are valid amid ongoing efforts to purge noncitizens from voter rolls.

One of these groups is Arizona Native Vote, founded by Jaynie Parrish, a citizen of the Navajo Nation who has spent the past year helping tribal members confirm that they are properly registered to vote. Arizona rules require that voters show proof of citizenship

to receive a full ballot, making voting access harder for tribal members who lack a passport or birth certificates, who may have documents with inconsistent names or dates, or who live hours away from their closest registration center.

"It's crazy that we have to talk to them and be like, 'I'm sorry, we have to verify citizenship,'" she said. "This is a barrier."

Parrish is working in a congressional district that features a Native American leader — former Navajo president Jonathan

Nez, a Democrat — who is challenging incumbent Rep. Elijah Crane (R). The Arizona district is largely rural, and larger than the state of Pennsylvania, which organizers say makes it harder to register voters and encourage them to show up to the polls.

While the Cook Political Report currently rates the race as "Likely Republican," Nez is counting on the mobilization of Native voters, who make up 20 percent of the district's population, to flip the seat, as well as the participation of independent voters, who make up 30 percent of registered voters in the district. (There is some overlap between the groups — about a quarter of Native voters nationwide identify as independent.) Nez lost to Crane by nine points in 2024, but outperformed Democratic presidential candidate Kamala Harris by six points.

Nez, who grew up on a ranch without running water or electricity in Navajo Nation, said there are still many infrastructure deficiencies in tribal communities in his district — including major water access problems.

And, mirroring the concerns of voters across the country, Native residents say the rising cost of food and gas has further strained already tight budgets, Nez said.

"My opponent has voted six times to continue to support the war in Iran when he knows the people in this country are feeling it in their wallets and their purse," Nez said.

Ben Petersen, a spokesperson for the National Republican Congressional Committee, said Nez has misdiagnosed the issues of most concern to people in the district.

"Eli Crane is a warrior. What voters in AZ-02 take issue with is Nez's past support for Hillary Clinton, Barack Obama, Joe Biden and Kamala Harris," Petersen said. Spokespeople for Crane's campaign did not respond to a request for comment.

Some candidates running this year say they hope to lay a foundation for future Native candidates, and that regardless of the outcome, they hope that in decades to come, a large pool of Native candidates will be unremarkable.

"I want my daughter, and other young Native women and girls to see this as normal and possible for them," Flanagan wrote via email. "Native people couldn't even vote in this country until 1924, about a hundred years ago. Now we have a chance to be at the table."

In-laws charged in death of New York Times engineer

Years of family strife preceded the shooting, according to court records

BY HANNAH KNOWLES AND PAUL DUGGAN

DUBLIN, CALIF. — In reams of documents in family court, the couple traded terrible allegations in an acrid divorce battle with one inarguable fact: They had long been living a domestic nightmare.

Jonathan McKinsey claimed that his wife of 15 years, Candice Jang, exercised “complete control” over him and once bullied him into eating a dead cockroach. He said that Jang’s mother ridiculed him for being transgender and blamed him when one of their small sons went through a phase of trying on girls’ clothes.

Jang claimed that McKinsey fractured a vertebra in her spine and severely struck one of the boys.

Their rancorous court fight came to an abrupt end Sept. 26 when McKinsey, director of engineering for the New York Times games department, was gunned down midafternoon in the parking lot of a playground where he spent visitation time with his three young children.

On Thursday, Jang’s parents peered through courtroom glass from the defendants’ dock — charged with murder.

“Tiny, frail, elderly people,” as one of their lawyers put it, they stood side by side, listening through earpieces to Chinese-language interpreters.

Prosecutors in this affluent suburb east of Oakland portrayed a calculated, brazen homicide. Shili Chen and Shouyong Zhang are accused of “lying in wait” for McKinsey before shooting him multiple times.

Curtis L. Briggs, the court-appointed attorney for Chen, described the couple to reporters as “two elderly grandparents who love each other very much.” Briggs said his client will plead not guilty. The public defenders office representing Zhang de-

clined to comment.

Authorities haven’t publicly cited a motive. Jang, 46, has not been implicated in the shooting.

In Alameda County Superior Court, hundreds of pages of documents filed by McKinsey and his wife, including mutual complaints of domestic violence, paint a bleak picture of family dissolution.

Jang said her mother, who helped watch the children, experienced “emotional abuse” from McKinsey, while McKinsey said his mother-in-law attacked his gender identity.

In 2023, when his and Jang’s then-4-year-old son “went through a phase where he wanted to wear [his sister’s] dresses,” Chen “continuously called [the son] a monster, a ‘disgusting queer’ and ‘a pervert’ because of this,” McKinsey told a judge in writing. He said his mother-in-law “called me the same names. She blamed me for [the boy] wanting to wear his sister’s dresses.”

In 2010, when McKinsey was receiving gender transition care, “Candice’s father physically assaulted me by punching me in the chest while I was still recovering from my double mastectomy surgery,” he said in a court filing late last year.

Jang and McKinsey’s relationship was turbulent from the start.

In the two years after they met in 2008, McKinsey tried twice to commit suicide, according to court documents. Jang said the attempts came after she tried to end the relationship. McKinsey said Jang told him he should kill himself because “no one would want to be with someone as ‘f-ed up and transgender’” as him.

Their arguing quickly grew violent, by both of their accounts. Jang said McKinsey grabbed her arm during a disagreement and caused her to hit her back on the corner of a coffee table, fracturing a vertebra. He also threatened to kill her and her parents, she wrote in court documents.

McKinsey accused Jang of outlandish cruelty. During one argument, he alleged, she hit him in the head with a frying pan and threatened to keep going unless he ate a dead cockroach she



Shili Chen and Shouyong Zhang are accused of “lying in wait” for their son-in-law Jonathan McKinsey before shooting him multiple times on Sept. 26. The elderly couple was arraigned last week.

found on the ground. He said he ate the bug to make her stop. He also accused her of almost killing their cat by trapping it in a bucket of water as punishment.

He said Jang grew jealous, at one point falsely accusing him of having an affair and hitting him in the head with a mirror. When he grabbed the mirror to stop her, it broke, cutting a nerve and tendon in his thumb, he said.

Still, they stayed together. In 2014, McKinsey — then a graduate student at the University of California at Berkeley — got pregnant.

But the baby lived less than an hour, McKinsey recounted in court documents — a loss he would later blame on Jang making him move heavy boxes during their move to San Jose.

They argued constantly.

“I hope you drop dead,” Jang said McKinsey told her in 2020.

“I hope you die,” Jang allegedly told McKinsey in another dispute.

Then, last October, Jang said McKinsey hit one of their sons while the kids were fighting

over Lego blocks, leaving a large bruise the shape of a handprint. McKinsey was charged with corporal injury to a child and endangering another child’s health after a police deputy found him alone in the home without supervision.

Soon, Jang got a temporary restraining order against her husband that ordered him to move out of their Dublin townhouse and gave her sole custody of their children — then 2, 4 and 6.

McKinsey responded with his own request for a restraining order. He also asked for a divorce.

“I truly believe that [Jang] would hurt or even kill them if she believed there was any possibility of me having the children in my custody and care,” he wrote in his filing.

McKinsey spent his last nine months fighting in court for more time with his children, limited at first to just one hour of supervised visitation each week. He told the court about his months of “Parenting Without Violence” classes and quoted from the supervisory reports documenting

his time with the kids.

“Several visits included the children telling dad they loved him, asking him to carry or hold them,” one report read. McKinsey underlined the words for emphasis.

The two misdemeanor charges against McKinsey were still pending when he was shot in the parking lot of Dublin Sports Grounds. He was found lying behind an open car trunk, according to video shared with the San Francisco Chronicle and witnesses, who said the shooters calmly walked away.

Bystanders pointed out the assailants to a patrol sergeant as they were leaving the parking lot in a black Honda Civic, according to an affidavit described by the Chronicle.

Police said they apprehended Jang’s parents within minutes, Chen at the wheel and carrying a gun, the affidavit says. A search of the vehicle turned up a second gun.

Authorities have released little information about the killing, and the defendants’ case files are

sealed.

Under California law, “lying in wait” is a “special circumstance” in a first-degree murder case, making the crime punishable by life in prison without parole. Chen and Zhang, both charged with that offense, are being held without bail.

Outside the courthouse Thursday, Briggs, the court-appointed attorney for Chen, said court documents suggest to him that McKinsey was “extremely rageful” and “could not control his temper.”

“So we are mostly focused on the full context of who Mr. McKinsey was,” Briggs said, “and what he was doing to act out these acts of violence and essentially rain hell on his family for years.”

“Are you blaming the victim?” a reporter asked.

“Not yet,” the attorney replied, but “that may be what happens.”

McKinsey confided about his child-custody fight with members of the church he began attending in recent years.

Eventually, he enlisted some of his fellow congregants to provide supervision when he spent time with his daughter and sons.

Bette Felton was among those he asked, and she was happy to do it.

In an interview, she recalled sitting with a book by a playground at Dublin Sports Grounds, looking up every so often as McKinsey chased after his children. With three little ones to look after, she recalled, “he was really running around.”

She knew him as a “gentle” person, as a church volunteer whom she and her husband peppered with questions about the Times’s games, which they loved playing.

“I never once heard him talk with any animosity about anybody,” Felton said. “It was just how much he wanted to see his kids.”

Now she thinks of those kids playing in the park and what they face.

“That’s what hurts your heart more than anything,” Felton said. “Those dear children.”

Razzan Nakhlawi in Washington contributed to this report.



President Donald Trump speaks alongside Elon Musk and other tech CEOs and administration officials Sept. 29 outside the White House.

Trump launches the ‘Super Intelligence Force’

Group will coordinate the federal government’s response to AI matters

BY CAT ZAKRZEWSKI

President Donald Trump announced Sunday that he would name four top administration officials to a “Super Intelligence Force” that will coordinate the federal government’s response to artificial intelligence.

Director of National Intelligence Jay Clayton, Federal Trade Commission Chairman Andrew Ferguson, Office of Personnel Management Director Scott Kuper and Emil Michael, undersecretary of war for research and engineering, will lead the task force, Trump said. The task force is expected to coordinate the government’s engagement with various stakeholders in a growing debate over the risks of AI, including consumers, public interest groups, tech companies and infrastructure providers.

“The Super Intelligence Force is tasked with coordinating the effort of the Federal Govern-

ment to ensure that America continues to lead the World in Super Intelligence, which many say is bigger than the Industrial Revolution, and the Internet, and will protect the interests, and improve the lives, of all Americans,” Trump wrote Sunday morning on Truth Social.

The task force is one of the most significant steps the administration has taken to respond to Americans’ anxiety about the rapid development of AI. Trump has largely brushed aside fears about the technology and portrayed it as an engine of financial prosperity, even as some industry leaders warn that AI is advancing too quickly and call for a slowdown in development.

Trump announced plans last month for an “AI Force,” sparking broad confusion because he compared it to the Space Force, a branch of the military that was created in his first term. He has since sought to rebrand AI as “super intelligence,” signing an executive order that directed federal agencies to change the name of the technology in government documents.

The leaders of the task force represent different interests of

the administration, following turf wars over how the government should craft its response to AI.

Clayton was named to the task force after U.S. intelligence agencies sought a larger role in evaluating AI models, given the advanced cybersecurity threats posed by Anthropic’s Mythos and other new models. These models are more effective than humans at identifying vulnerabilities in software, creating widespread concerns that they could be abused by even inexperienced hackers to launch complex attacks on energy grids, banks and government agencies.

Ferguson chairs the federal agency that has functioned as the government’s de facto tech regulator for decades, and the FTC recently launched a broad investigation into the safety of the systems developed by Anthropic and OpenAI, the maker of ChatGPT. (The Washington Post has a content partnership with OpenAI). The probe could provide backing for the administration’s claims that existing laws provide sufficient guardrails for AI systems.

Kuper, former managing partner of the venture capital firm

Andreessen Horowitz, has deep personal ties and experience within the investment community funding AI development. Many venture capitalists, including former Trump AI czar David Sacks, have resisted tech leaders’ calls to slow down AI development, arguing that the United States needs to forge ahead to remain competitive with China.

Michael has led the Pentagon’s efforts to transform the military with emerging technologies, amid fierce debate about AI use in warfare. Michael, who was Uber’s No. 2 executive in the 2010s, has repeatedly resisted increasing regulation of AI companies.

Clayton, Ferguson and Kuper were among the attendees at a lunch the White House hosted Tuesday with top tech leaders, including Amazon founder and Washington Post owner Jeff Bezos. After the lunch, Trump said the industry should police itself. The leaders of Google, Anthropic, Meta, Nvidia, xAI and OpenAI signed what Trump called a “morally binding” accord in which they committed to develop internal controls for their systems and submit to external audits.



Christa Pike was convicted for her role in a 1995 murder. A two-dose injection of pentobarbital failed to kill her on Wednesday.

Pike remains in critical condition, on ventilator

Injection last week was year’s second botched execution in Tennessee

BY VIOLET JIRA

Christa Pike, who was sentenced to death in Tennessee for her role in a brutal 1995 murder, remains in critical condition several days after she was hospitalized following a botched execution, her attorney said Sunday.

Stephen Ferrell told CNN that his client is still on a ventilator as doctors continue trying to clear two doses of pentobarbital, the lethal injections she survived, from her system.

Ferrell said that he has not seen Pike and that she has not spoken as far as he is aware.

Lawyers for Pike said Friday that she had been placed on a ventilator and was unconscious.

Pike was convicted for her role in the 1995 murder of Colleen Slemmer. Pike and two other teens — her boyfriend and another girl — lured Slemmer into the woods in Knoxville, where

they tortured and killed her.

Pike, who was 18 at the time of the murder, has been imprisoned for more than 30 years and would have been the first woman executed in Tennessee in more than 200 years.

The two-dose injection administered to Pike on Wednesday was the second botched execution in Tennessee this year. Frank Strada, commissioner of the state’s Department of Correction, resigned last week and is expected to step down this month.

State officials have not said how they intend to proceed, though Tennessee Gov. Bill Lee has halted executions for the remainder of the year. Ferrell told CNN on Sunday that the governor should commute Pike’s death sentence to a life sentence “at the very least.”

“I think one of the main things that will leave this up in the air for a while is the fact that we don’t know what the prognosis is, as in, the long-term prognosis,” he said. “If she recovers, she may not fully recover, and there may be issues about her competence. I mean, we just don’t know any of this.”

Amid standoff, Trump reveals Cotton’s phone number

President, senator are at odds over daylight saving time legislation

BY DAN DIAMOND

President Donald Trump on Saturday urged the Senate to immediately pass legislation to enact year-round daylight saving time, giving out the personal cellphone number of the bill’s chief critic — Sen. Tom Cotton (R-Arkansas) — in a dramatic attempt to ramp up pressure.

“Everyone in Arkansas, a State I love, and won 3 times, the last by by 34 points, tell Tom to, GET IT DONE!” Trump wrote on Truth Social, sharing Cotton’s number.

Trump also posted a letter from PGA Tour CEO Brian Rupp calling for passage of the Sunshine Protection Act, saying that shifting sunset later in the day would be a boon for golfers. The president followed up with subsequent posts further criticizing Cotton and saying that he discussed the topic during his Saturday afternoon visit to Trump National Golf Club.

“A table full of very distinguished people just told me that they HATE, immediately after a mandatory time change, going home at night – and it’s DARK,” Trump wrote, contending that the legislation would improve public safety.

Trump, an avid golfer, has spent nearly two years campaigning to end the nation’s clock changes, and the House passed the Sunshine Protection Act in July. But the bill has been stalled in the Senate, with no obvious path toward passage, and senators are not expected to return to Washington until after November’s midterm elections.

Cotton, often a staunch Trump supporter, vowed last year that he would “always oppose” efforts for year-round daylight saving time. He reiterated his opposition Saturday.

“No one likes changing the clock, me included, but Congress has enacted permanent Daylight Savings Time multiple times be-



GERALD HERBERT/AP

President Donald Trump on Saturday urged the Senate to immediately pass legislation to enact year-round daylight saving time.

fore and repealed it each time once Americans experienced absurdly late sunrises in the winter,” Cotton wrote on X. “Arkansans don’t want their kids going to school in the pitch dark, and I’ll always put Arkansas first.”

Asked about Trump’s criticism, Cotton’s office referred to the senator’s post.

A phone call to the number shared by Trump went straight to voicemail, with a recorded message saying that the mailbox was full. The number has been previously linked to Cotton in a publicly accessible database of phone records.

Trump has repeatedly criticized the long-standing practice of shifting the clocks forward one hour in the spring and shift-

ing them back one hour in the fall, calling it unnecessary and frustrating. But he said last year that he had discovered — like so many politicians before him — that making a change to daylight saving time was a “50-50 issue” with unclear political prospects.

“This should be the easiest one of all ... but a lot of people like it one way, a lot of people like it the other way, it’s very even,” the president said in March 2025.

Trump also advanced a novel theory Saturday: that shifting the clocks would deter crime.

“It’s even been proven to be better in stopping CRIME, something of which I have done an Historic job because, CRIM-

INALS DON’T LIKE WORKING IN THE LIGHT,” Trump wrote on Truth Social.

Most Americans do want to end the nation’s clock changes — but cannot agree on what should replace them.

Just 12 percent of Americans favored the current system as of October 2025, according to an Associated Press-NORC poll. But 47 percent opposed it, and the remainder said they were neither opposed or in favor.

But there’s little consensus on what to adopt instead. Fifty-six percent of Americans said they would prefer year-round daylight saving time, with more light in the evening and less in the morning, while 42 percent wanted year-round standard

time, with more light in the morning and less at night, the AP-NORC poll found.

The Sunshine Protection Act would stop the annual practice of “springing forward” and “falling back” by placing most of the country permanently on daylight saving time, with an exemption for the few places that are on year-round standard time and already don’t change their clocks.

The legislation has been championed in both the House and Senate by bipartisan members disproportionately from Southern and coastal states, who argue it would allow Americans to enjoy more outdoor afternoon and evening activities during the winter. It also has drawn

support from golf course operators, who say the extra hour of daylight in the evenings would notably boost their business.

“This bipartisan legislation represents a popular, common-sense reform and would benefit Americans by protecting precious daylight during the evening, when people are most likely to be awake and active,” according to a White House statement on the House version of the bill.

The legislation would allow states to opt out of permanent daylight saving time and remain on year-round standard time if they make the change before the legislation takes effect.

Medical groups and lawmakers who represent Midwestern states have criticized the Sunshine Protection Act, saying that year-round daylight would be unhealthy and lead to inappropriately late sunrises in many parts of the country. In cities such as Detroit and Indianapolis, the sun would rise after 9 a.m. in the middle of the winter.

The American Academy of Sleep Medicine and other medical groups have said that year-round daylight saving time does not align with humans’ natural circadian rhythms and that year-round standard time would be preferable.

Cotton and other lawmakers have also warned that a similar year-round daylight saving time plan in the 1970s swiftly backfired.

Trump has repeatedly shared personal information about other politicians in fits of pique, such as giving out Sen. Lindsey Graham’s cellphone number as the two men competed for the 2016 Republican nomination for president.

At Graham’s funeral this year, Trump admitted that he was wrong to share the senator’s number.

“I did something that I shouldn’t have done. I shared his personal cellphone number with ... millions of people,” Trump said. “But it was Lindsey who had the last laugh because while I blew up his phone, all for one day, we became great friends and Lindsey did not stop calling me for the next 10 years.”

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A showdown over Big Oil and climate change lands at the Supreme Court

SCOTUS FROM A1

Kelley, 71, decided to back a novel type of lawsuit targeting some of the world's biggest oil companies over climate change. The Supreme Court will take it up Monday as the first case of its new term.

The city and county of Boulder are seeking damages from ExxonMobil and Canada's Suncor Energy, alleging they intentionally misled the public for decades about the impact of climate change and the role fossil fuels play in global warming.

The companies deny any wrongdoing, saying Boulder is using Colorado state courts to pursue climate policy that is rightly in the purview of the federal government and Congress. They say the Supreme Court should toss out the suit.

The case is the first test of roughly 60 similar suits brought by cities, counties and states. Many are hoping they will be the environmental equivalent of the landmark litigation against tobacco companies and drug-makers that produced billions in damages over smoking and opioids.

At their heart, the suits begin to try to answer a vexing question that only grows more urgent with each new wildfire, flood and hurricane: Who should pay for the effects of global warming?

Answering that question requires grappling with complexities far more daunting than anything in those earlier rounds of litigation over tobacco or opioids, including whether it is even possible to tease out the role of climate change in any particular wildfire or weather event and assign responsibility to a particular industry.

Paul Chinowsky, a University of Colorado at Boulder professor who produced a report on the costs of climate change locally, said no city, county or even state is going to be able to foot the burden for global warming alone.

"Boulder just happens to be on the forefront," Chinowsky said. "But they are representative of literally hundreds and hundreds of cities across the country that are experiencing the same thing and trying to figure out the same question."

A new front for climate change

Tucked against soaring Rocky Mountain peaks, the landlocked city and county of Boulder might not seem like a major front in the battle over global warming.

The affluent area that is home to the University of Colorado's flagship campus does not contend with sea-level rise or hurricanes, but in 2021 the Marshall Fire destroyed more than 1,000 homes and caused about \$2 billion worth of damage.

The lawsuit against the oil companies had already been filed, but the destruction dramatically illustrated the rising stakes of climate change in the area. The lawsuit lists wildfire, drought, health impacts and infrastructure damage among the impacts of global warming.

All 25 of the largest or most destructive wildfires in Colorado's history — including the Marshall and Lee fires — have occurred in the last quarter-century, according to the state. Studies have shown climate change has made wildfires more frequent and larger.

The "megadrought" that has gripped the Southwest since 2000 has shriveled the Colorado River by two-thirds and pushed reservoirs to record lows, prompting drastic cuts to three states and warnings a source of water for more than 40 million is close to collapse.

Climate scientists have said the state may be witnessing a new normal.

Chinowsky's report estimated it could cost Boulder city and county \$96 million to \$157 million to mitigate some of the effects of global warming through 2050.

That includes big projects like hardening homes against wildfires and finding new sources of water, but also myriad smaller things such as fixing more potholes on roads, combating growing infestations of pine beetles and operating more cooling centers.

Boulder is not alone. Dozens of cities, states and tribes are seeking damages from major oil companies as the world warms. Vermont, San Francisco, New York, Honolulu and D.C. are among them.

Many of the suits rest on claims that oil companies privately pursued studies that showed oil and gas use was contributing to global warming, but downplayed such science publicly.

The allegations rely on internal reports and memos from oil companies that have been made



Kathleen Kelley stands in what used to be a stream that watered her 400 cattle in Meeker, Colorado. It turned to dust in August 2025.



Suncor Energy's oil refinery, pictured in Commerce City, Colorado. A lawsuit is targeting some of the world's biggest oil companies.

public in recent years.

The Boulder suit claims as early as the 1950s the American Petroleum Institute (API), the oil industry trade group, began research on the effects of burning fossil fuels. Both ExxonMobil and Suncor are members.

The efforts culminated in a 1968 report that said carbon dioxide was rising in the atmosphere and burning fossil fuels was likely the main driver. It found that "there seems to be no doubt that the potential damage to our environment could be severe."

Even more dire warnings followed. An API task force con-

cluded in 1980 that climate change could effectively "halt" world economic growth by 2025, according to the lawsuit. The lawsuit says Exxon recognized it would cost billions to adapt to climate change.

Despite the studies, the API and oil companies spent millions on advertising and public relations to discredit climate change research or cast doubt on the effects of global warming, according to the lawsuit.

Mobil, a precursor to Exxon-Mobil, ran an ad in the New York Times in 1997, saying "we still don't know what role man-made greenhouse gases might play in

warming the planet." Another Exxon ad in 2000 called climate science "unsettled."

Boulder city and county officials declined to comment, but Mayor Aaron Brockett (D) said in a statement in February the case is about making amends for the alleged deception.

"Local communities are living with the mounting costs of climate change," Brockett said. "The Supreme Court should affirm Colorado's right to hold these companies accountable for the harm they have caused."

The oil companies dismiss allegations they misled the public about global warming. They ar-

gue the Boulder suit and others are part of a coordinated campaign by environmentalists to impose a carbon tax on the oil industry.

The Supreme Court case will not test Boulder's allegations of a cover-up of climate change impacts, but rather whether the case can go forward in Colorado state court or should be tossed out.

Colorado's Supreme Court ruled last year Boulder's suit could continue, before the oil companies appealed to the Supreme Court.

The oil companies did not offer comment, but say in fil-

ings Boulder's state claims are preempted by federal law. They argue greenhouse gas emissions are inherently a federal issue under the Constitution because the pollution crosses state lines.

Allowing the case to go forward would open the floodgates to thousands of similar suits and potentially billions in damages that could bankrupt the oil industry and could wreak havoc with federal policy, the companies say.

"In these cases, state and local governments are attempting to assert control over the Nation's energy policies by holding energy companies liable for worldwide conduct in ways that starkly conflict with our constitutional structure, as well as the policies and priorities of the federal government," the companies wrote in a filing.

Supreme Court Justice Samuel A. Alito Jr. recused himself from the case in September. He did not offer a rationale, but environmentalists and court watchdog groups urged him to step aside because he owned stock in two oil companies that are not part of the case.

The Trump administration has sided with ExxonMobil and Suncor, arguing in a friend-of-the-court brief the Colorado Supreme Court's decision was "manifestly wrong on a question of vast nationwide significance."

President Donald Trump has referred to global warming as "a hoax." He has eased rules on oil and gas drilling.

Eight counties in northwest Colorado, whose economies rely on oil and gas, also want Boulder's suit thrown out. They include Rio Blanco, where Kelley lives, and Mesa counties.

Cody Davis, a Mesa County commissioner, said he was skeptical you could pin legal responsibility for the issues Boulder is facing on one actor that is part of a global problem with myriad sources. Even if you could, it would ultimately be counties like his that would pay the price.

"Rural Colorado is driven heavily by energy production, so the impact of a lawsuit like this is going to economically depress rural Colorado while hardly having an impact on Boulder," Davis said.

Fleeing the flames

The panicked call from Kelley's nephew came on Aug. 3, 2025. Kelley was incredulous when he told her to evacuate soon after the Lee Fire was sparked by lightning. He had worked incident teams on other major fires.

"I said, 'Kyle, it's 18 miles away what's the big deal? We'll be fine,'" Kelley recalls saying. "He said, 'We've never seen a fire burn downhill the way this one has. ... You gotta go.'"

Kelley said she was used to the wildfires of the past that typically burned a handful of acres before rain extinguished the flames, but the Lee Fire was different.

Fed by 40 mph winds, record drought and exceptionally dry air — the kind one fire expert said was typically seen in the Mojave Desert — it exploded.

The ash came first, falling gently like snow on the ranch, Kelley said. Then the flames appeared in the hills nearby. "It was like somebody had taken a saber ... and cut open the crust of the Earth," Kelley said. "Every piece of hell was pouring out."

Kelley and her husband gathered up three horses, three cats, two dogs and a bearded dragon lizard named El Guapo and fled.

When they finally returned several days later, the couple found the flames had leveled buildings and fences. Neighbors lost cattle to the blaze.

The fire had swept over her home, but it was largely spared because it was constructed of concrete. Still, there was about \$1.5 million worth of damage to the ranch.

Kelley has spent down her retirement savings to rebuild. She hopes to plant grasses that will suck more carbon dioxide out of the atmosphere to help combat climate change. She'd like to eventually bring back cattle.

But the future remains uncertain. Even if Boulder prevails in its lawsuit, she wouldn't directly benefit. But she said it was important to file a friend-of-the-court brief in the case to highlight the plight of ranchers.

On a recent day, she stood at the center of her ranch, amid acres of grassland as a thunderstorm flashed in the distance. She pointed to a large truck tire she once used as a trough to water cows. It was bone dry.

Scientists said the dry spell was the Southwest's worst in 1,200 years.

"I'm terrified for next summer," Kelley said of the drought. "It's not just me that's going to be out of business. It's going to be multiple ranchers."



Homes have been rebuilt in Superior, Colorado, after the Marshall Fire in 2021, which destroyed more than 1,000 homes.

Six things to watch in the Supreme Court’s new term

Cases involving religion, elections, immigration are likely to take the spotlight

BY JULIAN MARK
AND JUSTIN JOUVENAL

The Supreme Court kicks off a new term Monday that could significantly shift the law on guns, religion and immigration. The court may take up additional cases involving a range of controversial policies by President Donald Trump. And it could load up on other big constitutional issues, such as a Texas law that requires the Ten Commandments to be posted in public school classrooms. Also be on the lookout for potential retirements by Republican-appointed justices, and for a push by Democratic lawmakers to implement changes to the Supreme Court. Both may depend on how the midterms shake out. Oyez, oyez, oyez. Here's what you should know as the new term begins.

1. Trump’s immigration policies face more tests

Last week the justices agreed to review two major Trump immigration policies in cases that could turn into blockbusters. One involves the legality of sending noncitizens to “third countries” where they are not citizens — a policy the court has allowed to continue as it decides the case. The second centers on Trump’s mandatory detention policy for immigrants awaiting removal proceedings. Both have been critical to Trump’s sweeping immigration crackdown. Other Trump policies that could land on the docket: the president’s ban on transgender people serving in the military and the administration’s maneuvers to install loyalists to U.S. attorneys offices while bypassing the Senate confirmation process. The legality of Trump’s newest round of tariffs and his renewed push to limit birthright citizenship could also return to the high court.



During its new term, the Supreme Court could take up cases involving a range of controversial Trump administration policies.

2. The court could become enmeshed in the midterms

The stakes are high for November’s midterm elections, which will determine control of the House and Senate. Voters will decide races at the ballot box, but the Supreme Court could play a notable role, too. The Supreme Court has already decided a flurry of cases related to voting and the election in the run-up to November, some dealing with the Trump administration’s aggressive efforts to restrict voting. Given Trump’s penchant for claiming voter fraud, it’s a good bet that challenges will roll in as the ballots are counted, particularly in closely contested elections. Democratic attorneys general in about 20 states have already

been war-gaming on how to respond if federal agents are sent to polling places or voters are blocked from voting. Any fights could go up to the Supreme Court. **3. Another landmark test on guns** The Supreme Court in recent years has transformed few areas of law as much as gun rights. This term brings the next major chapter in that fight: whether states can ban AR-15-style semi-automatic rifles. The fight is significant legally, but also culturally. The AR-15 has become a symbol of Second Amendment rights for some gun enthusiasts, and a target for those who want stricter gun controls because that type of firearm has been used in so

many mass killings. The Supreme Court will weigh restrictions on semiautomatic rifles in Illinois and Connecticut, which are being challenged by gun owners and gun rights groups. The Connecticut law was passed in the wake of the 2012 mass shooting at Sandy Hook Elementary, where a gunman killed 20 children and six school staff members. In recent terms, the conservative majority has greatly loosened restrictions on firearms, most notably in a 2022 case that struck down a New York law requiring a license to carry a firearm in public. That decision, *New York State Pistol and Rifle Association, Inc. v. Bruen*, found that any gun restrictions must have roots in the nation’s history and traditions.

4. The expansion — and limits — of religious rights The justices have accepted multiple cases for this term brought by religious groups. One has attracted particular attention: *St. Mary Catholic Parish v. Roy*. It involves a Catholic preschool in Colorado that says it is being unfairly excluded from a state prekindergarten program because it does not admit children of gay and transgender parents. The high court led by Chief Justice John G. Roberts Jr. has generally ruled in favor of religious plaintiffs in such cases, and experts say *St. Mary* has a good chance of winning. The court is also widely expected to take up a case involving a Texas law that requires all public school classrooms to display the Ten Commandments. The case challenges a more than 50-year-old precedent holding that such displays of religious content in public schools violate the separation of church and state.

5. Will a justice retire? It can’t be ruled out.

Rumors swirled for months earlier this year that Samuel A. Alito Jr. might retire, before the conservative justice knocked down the talk in an interview with the *Wall Street Journal* in August. Still, speculation could soon flare again. With the midterm elections in November, Democrats have an opportunity to take control of the Senate, which must confirm any nominee to the high court. If Democrats triumph, that means Trump’s last opportunity to get a nominee through a Republican-controlled Senate will be during the lame-duck period between November and January. A Republican shellacking in November could put pressure on Alito, 76, or Clarence Thomas, 78, the other older conservative, to step aside for a younger nominee. Many court watchers do not expect Thomas to retire because he has a chance to become the longest-serving justice in the history of the court if he remains on the bench through May 2028. So all eyes will be on Alito.

6. A push to overhaul the Supreme Court

Democrats have pledged to overhaul the high court should they take control of Congress. They have already introduced a slew of proposals, including imposing term limits on the justices, increasing the number seats on the bench from nine to 13, and creating an enforceable code of ethics. Those efforts might still be a long shot unless the filibuster is eliminated. Otherwise, any proposal would require 60 votes in the Senate, which is highly unlikely. Still, the efforts reflect record dissatisfaction with the high court — especially among liberals — and Democrats have said any proposal is fair game.

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Cooper is running against history in North Carolina as he seeks a Senate seat

COOPER FROM A1

so well,” said Ashe, a Democrat who has occasionally voted for a Republican.

It has been nearly 20 years since North Carolina sent a Democrat to the Senate. Only one Democrat — Barack Obama in 2008 — has carried the state in a presidential race since 1980.

This year, Cooper has turned his first federal bid into Democrats’ best chance to flip a Senate seat. Polls have consistently shown him leading his opponent, Republican Michael Whatley, most recently by double digits. The gap between Cooper and Whatley has led Republicans to both publicly and privately admit that North Carolina may be slipping out of their grasp.

To get to this point, Cooper has pulled from the traditional playbook for a Democrat running in a battleground state. The Tar Heel State mixes urban and suburban centers that have drawn out-of-state residents for technology and banking jobs with more conservative rural areas dependent on agriculture.

Cooper summarizes his political résumé as a moderate willing to work with Republicans on anything that would help North Carolinians. He talks frequently about his time leading the state with a GOP-controlled legislature, which at times had Republican supermajorities that could override his vetoes.

Some Democrats in other Senate battlegrounds are veering to the left to bring in the voters fed up with the middle-of-the-road stance that Cooper preaches. Across Ohio, Maine and Michigan, candidates are calling American politics “rigged,” pitching progressive policies such as Medicare-for-all and distancing themselves from the Democratic establishment.

But Cooper isn’t budging from the approach he has stuck with throughout his political career.

“I’m not a socialist, and I’m not a right-wing Republican, okay,” Cooper said Friday at a campaign stop with Ashe and other tobacco farmers. “But I’ll work with anybody to try to make stuff cost less.”

The former two-term governor has steeped his campaign in that slogan — “make stuff cost less” — as he has toured North Carolina to hammer the Trump administration over high prices.

DJ Griffin, a spokesperson for Whatley, cast Cooper’s centrist approach as bluffing. He pointed to the former governor’s vetoes of anti-trans legislation and bills that would have required North Carolina sheriffs to cooperate with federal immigration agents and help them detain local inmates.

“While he says he’s a moderate, he wants to work with the socialists,” Griffin said.

Of President Donald Trump, Cooper tells voters he could “work with this president when I need to but stand up to him when I need to, as well.”

If elected, Cooper would represent North Carolina alongside Sen. Ted Budd (R). He praised the possibility of North Carolina being among the few states with senators from both parties.

“People are getting tired of this ultra-partisanship that we are seeing across the country,” Cooper told reporters in Wilson. “If we can elect more people who understand that achieving consensus can be a good thing, I think that’s positive.”

On the campaign trail, Cooper spotlights working with one particular group as evidence of his craftsmanship: Republicans opposed to expanding Medicaid.

North Carolina lawmakers fought over the program for more than 10 years before agreeing to expand it during Cooper’s second term as governor. He tells voters about bringing together leaders from across the state and the political divide to pass the legislation, which enrolled hundreds of thousands of low-income residents into Medicaid.

“It took too long, but I finally got that legislature to come around and do it,” Cooper said at a stop on his affordability tour in Elizabeth City, in the swing Pasquotank County.

Some Republican lawmakers had not expected that the Medicaid negotiations would be successful, given the years of political wrangling.

State Sen. Phil Berger (R), who leads his chamber, said at the time that if anyone had predicted that outcome a decade before, “I would have tried to figure out what planet you had come from.”

As she listened to Cooper talk about Medicaid during the Elizabeth City event, Mary Jackson could see why it had a leading role in his campaign pitch.

At least where she lives, in nearby Weeksville, Cooper can’t afford to alienate voters, said



President Donald Trump listens as Republican Senate candidate Michael Whatley speaks during a rally in Gastonia, North Carolina, on Sept. 16.



Former Democratic Gov. Roy Cooper is running in a state that for decades has more often preferred Republicans for federal office.

Jackson, a 68-year-old retired teacher and Democrat. She knew many of her neighbors cast red ballots, but she also believed people who grew the corn, soybeans and potatoes that dot the farmland around her were struggling. If Cooper kept his centrist approach and reached out to them, as he had in his gubernatorial bids, he’d have better odds, she thought.

“It’s not his first rodeo,” Jackson said.

But she was wary of polls showing Cooper with a large lead, especially as she sees television ads attacking him while she watches football with her husband. To Jackson, her state’s races always felt as if they came down to the wire.

“It always tightens up,” Jack-

son said.

Republicans attack Cooper on crime

Cooper’s record on crime has been Republicans’ biggest talking point against him.

Whatley, former chairman of the Republican National Committee, and his allies have tried to pierce Cooper’s image as a moderate by saying he was soft

on crime while in elected office.

In mid-September, while stumping for Whatley during a rally in Gastonia, Trump called Cooper “the man who made North Carolina the talk of the country” for its “violent crime.” Republicans have poured millions of dollars into ads accusing Cooper of being lax on public safety, including one that falsely blamed him for a murder that

happened in South Carolina.

Cooper’s campaign has pushed back by citing his record prosecuting criminals while he was the state’s attorney general. He also ran campaign ads saying that he stood up to Democrats on criminal justice policy. One public safety ad this cycle noted that Cooper “bucked his party to oppose defunding the police, worked with Republicans to strengthen bail laws and partnered with President Trump to crack down on fentanyl.”

For months, Whatley has campaigned on a close alignment with Trump and his conservative agenda, a contrast to Cooper’s emphasis on crossing the aisle.

Trump handpicked Whatley, who has been a close ally to the president since his 2016 cam-

paign, to run for Senate. Whatley, who also chaired the state GOP for years, has not distanced himself from the party or its unpopular president.

In Gastonia, Whatley joined Trump onstage halfway through the hour-long rally, effusively praising his administration and declaring, “I am still with that guy.”

Whatley’s allegiance to Trump, who carried North Carolina three times, may not be as beneficial as it once was, given the president’s low approval ratings. As anxiety over the race brewed, at least two Republican groups have pulled their ad spending.

Still, Whatley’s campaign is sticking beside the president. Griffin, Whatley’s spokesperson, said the candidate had talked with Republicans in Washington and felt “confident that we’re going to have the money” to reach voters across the state in the final few weeks.

Cooper not taking a win for granted

Many in politics are treating a Cooper win as all but assured. But he’s urging voters and prospective donors not to assume that.

Late last month in Elizabeth City, Cooper warned that Republicans could “catch up at the end” by winning over undecided voters. He urged supporters to help him canvass. He told the three dozen people gathered there to tell other voters that Whatley was a longtime Washington insider who walked closely with Trump.

The next day in Raleigh, Cooper began his remarks with an apology for the continuing barrage of fundraising texts and emails, which he was signed up for, too.

“My back pocket is constantly buzzing with me asking myself for money,” he joked.

“We love it!” someone shouted back.

Throughout the evening, the Raleigh crowd broke into chants of his name, “Roy! Roy! Roy!” Supporters waved white and blue campaign signs and mini North Carolina flags.

In that atmosphere, tucked in a deeply blue pocket of the state, it was easy to feel good about Cooper’s odds, said Bev Orozco, a 63-year-old Democrat.

She had a lot on her mind that she wanted Cooper to tackle if he was elected. For starters, she worried about the cost of her health insurance premiums, which doubled when the enhanced Affordable Care Act subsidies expired this year.

But she stopped herself from getting her hopes up too high, saying she knew her state and noting how it often falls short of turning blue.

“It’s so hard to know,” Orozco said.



An Atlanta poll worker talks to a voter on Election Day in 2020. As midterms near, state elections officials are decrying what they say is a dearth of information on threats and other support from Washington.

With threats to midterms, states say Trump administration isn’t doing enough

ELECTION FROM A1

The Trump administration also shuttered the Foreign Malign Influence Center, a U.S. intelligence body that monitored adversaries’ disinformation campaigns and threats to American democracy.

And Trump in July fired two Democratic members of the bipartisan Election Assistance Commission, which helps states conduct secure and accurate elections. The remaining commissioner, a Republican, resigned. The commission is now permitted to carry out only certain limited tasks with a skeleton staff.

Trump has repeatedly, and falsely, cast doubt on the accuracy of U.S. elections, claiming without evidence that he, not Joe Biden, won the 2020 contest. He personally tried to intervene in the 2020 Georgia recount, and his proxies filed dozens of legal challenges to the election results, almost all of which failed. In his second term, Trump has encouraged aides to search for evidence of election fraud.

Trump has made no secret of his desire to shape the course of the 2026 elections, widely seen as a referendum on his second term thus far. He and his administration have threatened to assert federal control over the state-run elections, pushed largely baseless claims of voter fraud and tried to restrict mail-in voting. In September, he told supporters to “try and cheat like hell, like they do,” referring to his years-long unsubstantiated assertions of voter fraud that tilts elections in favor of Democrats.

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In a televised July speech, Trump asserted that China interfered in the 2020 presidential campaign and alleged “shocking” vulnerabilities in U.S. election machinery. The China intelligence is not supported by U.S. intelligence assessments made public previously or by documents the White House declassified in connection with Trump’s speech.

A U.S. intelligence report shared with Congress in recent weeks by the Office of the Director of National Intelligence assesses there is little likelihood that a foreign actor will interfere directly with the 2026 vote counts, people familiar with the document say.

“The intelligence community has long assessed that no adversary has interfered or attempted to interfere with election infrastructure or vote counting, and I see no evidence to suggest any deviation from that finding,” Rep. Jim Himes of Connecticut, ranking Democrat on the House Intelligence Committee, said af-



Election workers prepare mail-in ballots for tallying at the Los Angeles County Ballot Processing.

ter the panel received a classified briefing in mid-September.

The National Intelligence Council, a top-level analytic group under the ODNI, assessed that Russia is the most active adversary, using digital tools to sow dissent and undermine confidence in election integrity. China is targeting individual races where U.S. policy toward Beijing is an issue, rather than intervening on a wide scale, those familiar with the reports say. The report also identifies activity by Iran, but not on the scale of Russia or China.

The NIC report says that U.S. adversaries are increasingly using artificial intelligence to create and spread online misinformation and disinformation campaigns. The New York Times first reported on the spy agencies’ assessments.

Geoff Hale, a former CISA election security official, said that while states are responsible for conducting their own elec-

tions, federal officials have the resources to identify security threats from foreign actors. Hale pointed to an Alaska case in 2020 in which Iranian agents accessed voter data, sent emails posing as the pro-Trump Proud Boys group and threatened them if they did not vote for Trump.

“The federal apparatus was able to, in a matter of hours, turn this around and go, ‘this is Iranian activity,’” he said. “As CISA has waned in their connectivity with the election community, seeing that threat picture is not available to anyone anymore.”

“CISA is implementing the newly updated and released election infrastructure security plan outlining available no-cost voluntary services — including threat information sharing, technical expertise, vulnerability scanning, and other risk-mitigation support,” a CISA spokesperson said in response to questions sent by The Washington Post. “CISA is committed to supporting state

and local election officials to protect election infrastructure and safeguard our democracy.”

Hale said that the Trump administration’s election security cuts come as the midterms could see uniquely challenging AI-powered threats. “Seeing how aggressive [the Iranians] have been in past election cycles under better terms makes you wonder how aggressive they’ll be amid genuine conflict,” he said, referring to the U.S. war with Iran.

Federal funding for states to bolster election security declined from \$55 million in 2024 to \$15 million in 2025, though funding rose again to \$45 million this year.

Some state officials downplayed the absence of federal support, saying they have been able to replace many of the resources with private-sector funding and direct coordination between states.

“We really take [seriously] creating our own partnerships, and

those are not typically with the federal government,” said West Virginia’s Republican secretary of state, Kris Warner. “I don’t know that we need a tight relationship with the federal government.”

Other state officials — including Republicans — say that the greatest threat to the midterm elections is not from malevolent foreign actors.

“The threats that we’re getting now are mostly from our own government,” Henderson, the Republican Utah lieutenant governor, said. “The way elections are being handled by the federal government right now is dangerous, disruptive and in bad faith.”

Henderson pointed to the Justice Department’s attempts to compel state officials to turn over voter rolls and Trump’s blaming of state officials for cyberattacks on their water systems.

Multiple Republican state election officials said they have plans in place if Immigration and Cus-

toms Enforcement agents show up at polling sites, a scenario Homeland Secretary Markwayne Mullin refused to rule out during a congressional hearing in June. Mullin later said ICE would only be deployed to counter “specific threats” or enforce warrants.

With the midterms barely a month away, the Trump administration has taken a handful of steps on election security.

The National Security Agency, which intercepts and decodes electronic communications, only recently reconstituted its Election Security Group.

In a memo last month, Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth directed U.S. Cyber Command and military intelligence to deter foreign interference in elections.

On Sept. 24, CISA released its Election Infrastructure Security Plan for the midterms, pledging to hold training exercises, risk assessments and threat briefings for states. The plan also included hiring new election security advisers, a team of CISA officials who directly liaise with state authorities, after the previous group of advisers were ousted at the beginning of Trump’s second term.

“The best parts of this plan are still too late to be useful,” Hale said. “Ballots are live in every state.”

“While CISA claims to be changing course and offering to help state and local governments with election security, this report does not do that,” Sen. Alex Padilla (D-California) said in a Sept. 25 statement.

In an August call between CISA officials and state elections officials, Acting Director Nick Andersen said the agency could not do much for state officials before Election Day, according to Arizona Secretary of State Adrian Fontes, a Democrat and a participant on the call.

“[CISA’s] focus was on 2028,” Fontes said. “And they basically admitted that ... we were too far along in the election season to rebuild any of what we had for the 2026 cycle.”

Other officials echoed the same frustration with the federal government.

“The trust has been so breached with ... the federal government and election officials that I don’t even know if they started offering help [that] I would trust it at this point,” Henderson said.

Patrick Marley contributed to this report.

‘People just aren’t coming’: D.C.’s tour guides grapple with changing landscape

D.C. TOUR GUIDES FROM A1

and finding Buckingham Palace blocked from view, Big Ben hidden behind scaffolding and London Bridge falling down.

The District’s core, guides say, is also marred by the long stretches of chain-link fence that line the Potomac River, surround construction sites and section off portions of the Mall that are under repair.

“The biggest complaint we hear from visitors is we can’t get our pictures without fences,” said Camden Arciniega, who has been guiding visitors around D.C. for almost two decades and is the co-owner of DC by Foot Tours. Knowing how to navigate the District and get tourists from one spot to the next with a minimum of hassle is a point of pride for Arciniega, 42, but this year has been particularly challenging. She has had to tell numerous visitors who wanted a group shot taken in front of the White House that they were out of luck.

One of DC by Foot’s most popular tours is “White House at Night: Secrets, Scandals and Legends.” But that tour has been shelved indefinitely because most of the sites are inaccessible, Arciniega said. Attendance at other tours her business offers, she said, has also suffered.

“Our Capitol Hill tours used to be twice a day, Tuesday through Saturday,” she said. “Now they’re offered just four times a week and are rarely full.”

White House spokeswoman Lauren Bis rejected assertions by tour guides that the shutting down of key sites on or near the Mall has negatively impacted their business.

“This is a completely false narrative,” she wrote in an emailed response to a request for comment. “President Trump has transformed our nation’s capital from a crime-ridden city into a safe and beautiful haven for residents and visitors alike by removing violent criminals from the streets, cleaning up the parks, and making long-overdue renovations to public lands.”

The White House pointed to the repairs and cleaning done by the administration at dozens of fountains and memorials across Washington. It also noted the installation or refurbishing of more than 1,100 park benches, the installation of 134 rat-resistant trash cans and the removal of 154 homeless encampments.

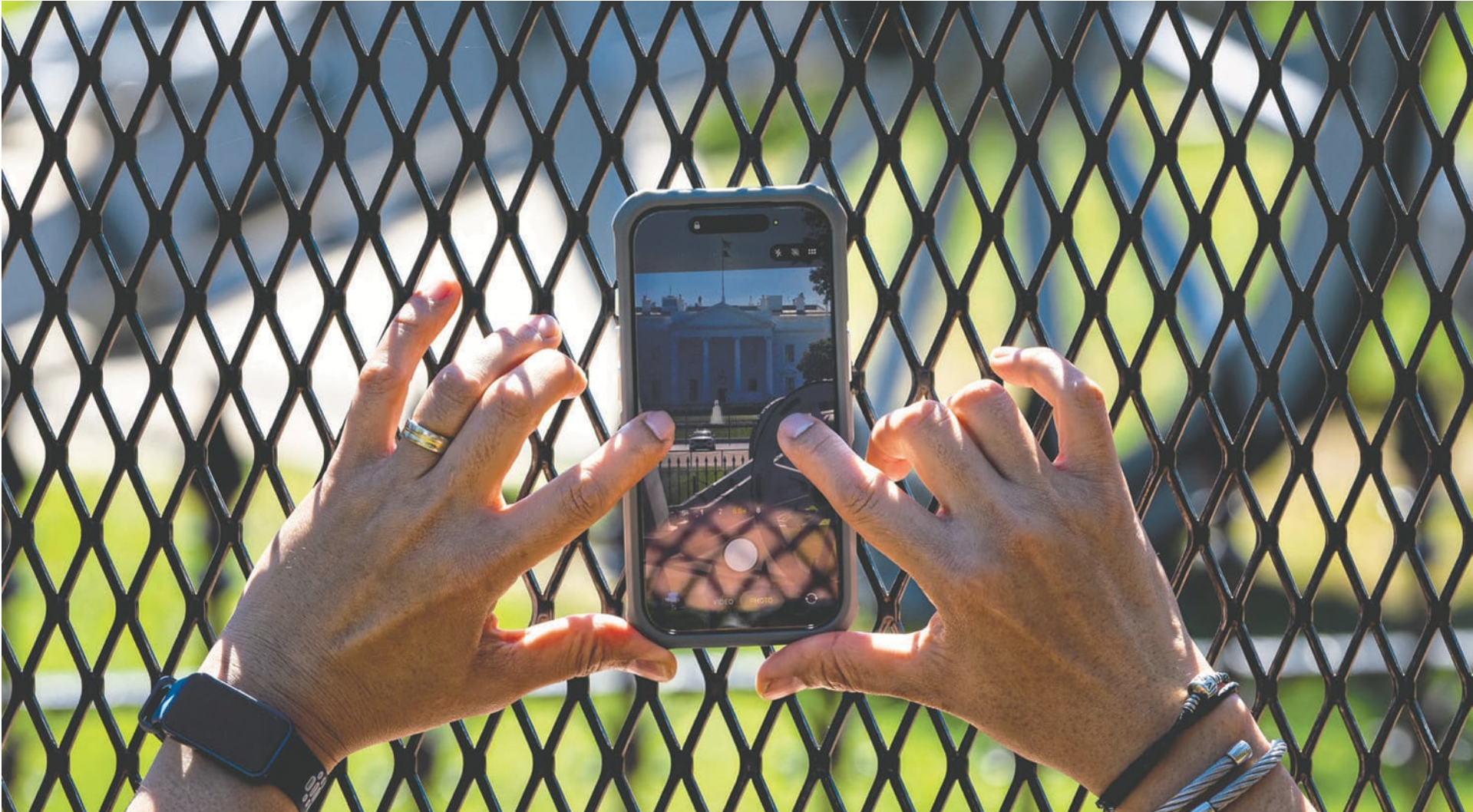
Carolyn Crouch, a tour guide who founded Washington Walks in 1999, said this year has been the worst for her company outside of the pandemic in 2020. Revenue is down 70 percent for July and August and about 50 percent for the rest of the year, she said. “We are on track to conclude 2026 with a loss.”

Visitors are dismayed by the lengthy closures, incomplete repairs and fencing that blight so many locations, said Crouch, 63. But she and other tour guides in the city say politics and anger at the president is another part of the tourist disappearance equation.

“The current administration has not only created lots of obstructed views and made the National Mall look in some places like a work in progress, it has also made our city’s brand toxic,” she said. “And our experience is that people seem to be voting with their feet and not traveling to Washington, D.C.”

Arciniega says the drop-off in the number of international visitors has been especially notable. Her company typically hosts a large number of corporate and school groups from Canada, but that traffic has evaporated. Overall, the number of her company’s international clients has dropped more than 50 percent, she said.

“I do feel that a lot of international guests are not coming



Richard Parrilla, a visitor from the Philippines, attempts to take a picture of the White House through a fence in Lafayette Square on Thursday.



A man peeks over the fencing at the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool on Thursday. The pool is one of a host of D.C.’s landmarks that have become hard to see.

for political reasons and visa reasons and, you know, fear of deportation,” Arciniega said.

More than 27.2 million total visitors came to D.C. in 2025, up slightly over 2024, according to Destination DC, the nonprofit organization responsible for marketing the District to tourists and convention planners. But the number of international visitors in 2025 declined by 4 percent.

The White House rebutted claims that tourism to the District had been adversely impacted by the president’s policies toward immigrants or his treatment of countries that have

long been U.S. allies.

“The President’s efforts along with his historic freedom 250 events including the UFC fight, Independence Day celebration, and the Grand Prix attracted a record number of Americans and foreign tourists across the globe,” Bis said in her email.

Destination DC said that it does not yet have updated information for 2026 but that the trend for domestic visitors is positive, driven in large part by attendance at events celebrating America’s 250th anniversary.

The organization says it does not have trend information specifically for international

visitors to D.C. But according to Destination DC’s data partner, Tourism Economics, overall international travel to the U.S. is weaker than anticipated and was down nearly 6 percent through August.

The firm estimates the United States “will forgo \$39.6 billion in inbound travel spending across 2025 and 2026 relative to what would have occurred if the country had maintained its 2024 share of global international travel spending.”

Rauf Shakir, co-owner of USA Guided Tours, has lived in Washington for 26 years. Two years ago, his company was tak-

ing 80,000 to 90,000 visitors a year on tours through D.C. Those numbers started dropping last year and have continued to plummet. Revenue is down 65 to 75 percent from two years ago, he said.

Shakir, 45, said the closing of some sites and limited access to others is partly responsible for the drop in visitors, but he attributes most of it to international tourists no longer wanting to come to the United States.

“Everything that happened with immigration and countries being put on lists by the administration really hurt us,” he said. “The other issue is the images

people were seeing of the National Guard on the streets. I think that discouraged a lot of people from coming to D.C.”

“It has been hands down our worst year,” he said. And, he added, it’s not just business that’s being lost.

“When you’re giving a tour to people from all over the world and all walks of life, this may be the only time they visit your city,” he said. “You get an opportunity to showcase the city you love, and that becomes a core memory for that person.”



Visitors walk along the fencing between Lafayette Square and the White House on Thursday.



Fencing surrounds the Reflecting Pool, which is undergoing a troubled renovation, on Thursday.

THE WORLD



DAN KITWOOD/GETTY IMAGES

The final mast of the SS Richard Montgomery is removed on Wednesday. The ship hit a sandbar, flooded and sank in the mouth of the River Thames in late summer 1944, a few months after D-Day.

World War II U.S. shipwreck is time bomb near London

Military cargo ship was laden with munitions that could still detonate

BY WILLIAM BOOTH

SHEERNESS, ENGLAND — In the mouth of the River Thames, just downstream from London, a team of elite marine salvors has been busy trying to stabilize one of the world’s most dangerous shipwrecks.

The SS Richard Montgomery, a U.S. military cargo ship, dragged anchor, broke its back on a sandbar, flooded and sank in late summer 1944, a few months after D-Day, with 1,500 tons of explosives still in the holds.

The Monty, as the locals call the ship, has been disintegrating, slowly but surely, on the shallow seafloor for the last 82 years.

Though a precise manifest is elusive, there are still thousands of World War II munitions inside the Montgomery’s broken hull, including 2,000-pound blockbusters, fragmentation bombs, white phosphorus smoke ordnance and crates of pressure fuzes.

Old bombs, even underwater, can still detonate under the right conditions, and one thing certain about the Monty is that its conditions constantly change in the fast-moving tides and shifting sands of the estuary.

“It’s not just the explosives on the wreck that we’re worried about,” said Nolan Conway, who is leading the salvage operation from a high-tech Dutch barge that sits, ever so gently, alongside the wreck.

“It’s the stuff around the barge that we want to be careful about,” Conway said. “Things

could create a sympathetic detonation at the wreck.”

The wreck has stood for all these years as a kind of war memorial, its three masts visible above the waterline, and clearly marked on nautical charts. You can see it from land. Tour operators take day-trippers out to circle it. Local communities remember the sacrifices — the bravery and the terror — of the earlier generations.

The wreck serves as a reminder, too, that the lethal detritus of war often lingers on, whether those ships and bombs are sunk off seaside towns on the English coast or in the Persian Gulf.

The Montgomery is a time capsule and a potential time bomb. And, after much delay, the British government decided that it was time to do something to prevent a catastrophic collapse of the ship’s degrading steel hull.

On a recent afternoon, Conway, the project leader for Resolve Marine, a company based out of Fort Lauderdale, Florida, was aboard a launch vessel that shuttles crew out to the barge.

His team members are masters of disaster. A recent assignment had them dealing with a fire in a torpedo room of a submarine operated by the Indian navy. In 2024, they were hired to disentangle the container ship that struck the Francis Scott Key Bridge in Baltimore Harbor. They routinely deal with groundings, capsizes, cargo losses, spills and fires.

The trip from the dock to the wreck takes just 20 minutes.

A first impression? How crowded the scene. The wreck lies a couple of miles from shore and just a few hundred meters from active shipping lanes. Thousands of vessels pass by each year, including bulk freighters, container ships, tugboats, liquefied natural gas car-

riers and cruise ships bound for London, plus many fishing craft and pleasure boats.

The wreck is marked by buoys denoting an off-limits exclusion zone. The masts were the remains of the derrick cranes that once were used to load and unload its lethal cargo.

The British government initiated the \$12 million project to remove the three masts after experts concluded the steel structures might collapse onto the decomposing decks below — and that could be very bad.

Asked if the work on the Montgomery was dangerous, Conway explained how carefully they approached their task — the extensive surveys using radar, magnetometers and sonar to form a deep understanding of the wreck and seafloor around it, which is littered with UXO and PXO, terms of art for unexploded ordnance and potential unexploded ordnance.

Over the years, the wreck has collected additional dangers. The seafloor around it is dotted with half-buried objects, possibly defensive mines and anti-aircraft ordnance left by the British navy, and unexploded offensive mines and bombs dropped by the Germans.

To put it very simply, the salvors really don’t want to bump into anything.

A shock wave could set off an explosion, which could be lethal to a diver, or could spark a larger conflagration.

Though some British government assessments remain classified, experts with the Royal Military College of Science estimated in 1970 that a “top event” — meaning essentially the worst case, in which the whole cargo goes kaboom! — could produce a blast of water and debris 3,000 meters high and set off a five-meter tsunami-style wave that could threaten local towns

and industry, including nearby oil and gas facilities.

The British government, in its reports, has calculated the risk of a top event as “remote.”

Remote, however, does not mean unfathomable, let alone completely safe.

In 1967, salvors attempted to stabilize munitions inside the wreck of another American-built ship, the SS Kielce, that was being used by the Polish navy, which had sunk soon after the war near the English port of Folkestone.

Using mines, the salvors

The wreck serves as a reminder, too, that the lethal detritus of war often lingers on, whether those ships and bombs are sunk off seaside towns on the English coast or in the Persian Gulf.

somehow ignited the hold, sparking an explosion equaling a 4.5-magnitude earthquake.

“If the Montgomery were typical salvage job, we would simply rig to the mast, cut the mast using traditional techniques and pull it free — simple and done,” Conway said. “But because of the sensitive nature of the wreck, we went with special tools.”

Those special tools include a barge that dropped three legs into the silty sand to position itself in place, just inches above the waterline and inches from

the wreck. Divers enter the water one at a time, careful not to step onto the fragile deck below.

“Visibility is measured in inches,” said Jeff Cornish, one of the divers. “We work by feel.”

To cut the mast, the salvors deployed a diamond wire saw, “because it produces lower vibrations, with a lower potential for something to go wrong,” Conway said.

“We don’t do anything that would upset our mothers,” he added, meaning they plan to come home from work.

The Montgomery was a Liberty ship, designed for convoy duty in the North Atlantic. It was built at the U.S. Navy’s direction by the St. John’s River Shipbuilding Co. in Jacksonville, Florida, and took on its last load of high explosives at Hog Island, today the site of Philadelphia International Airport.

After surviving the ocean crossing and German U-boats, the ship was destined for an American air base in newly liberated Cherbourg, France. The Montgomery arrived at what became its grave in late August 1944, two months after the Allied landing on the beaches of Normandy.

People in nearby towns — and those following a live stream online — watched as the masts were removed this past week.

The cut masts, covered in rust and sea growth, now lie aboard the salvage barge. They were in surprisingly robust shape. But the structures around them were not. Some of the steel could be knocked apart with a single bang by a hand scrapper. “It’s paper thin,” Conway said.

David Alexander, an emeritus professor of emergency planning at University College London, has studied the wreck and its cargo.

“It is a rare case,” Alexander told The Washington Post. In a

research paper, he wrote that the Montgomery “exemplified a very visible, alarming risk, but one which cannot be analyzed with any degree of sophistication and accuracy because there are simply not enough reliable, accurate data.”

“It’s impossible to say with any certainty what the explosion risk is,” he said, but that the risk is far from zero.

Alexander worried aloud that the wreck lies close to active shipping, that windsurfers have been recorded in the exclusion zone, that divers probably have sneaked out to the site and in years past, fishermen were photographed on the wreck at low tides.

Locals have reported seeing strange lights on the water above the wreck at night, probably phosphorous munitions that shook loose from their crates and ignited on the surface, he said.

In a debate in the House of Lords, and in the London newspapers, fears also have been raised that terrorists or saboteurs, using drones or simple explosives, could target the wreck.

But removing 1,500 tons of explosives might require emptying out local towns or building seawall defenses just in case. So far, the British government appears satisfied that cutting down the masts — and watching and waiting — are enough.

The masts are now headed to a nearby museum and conservatory at the Historic Dockyard in Chatham, where the structures will be restored and displayed to the public, and the story of the Monty will continue.

“There’s a lot of interest in that ship,” said Paul Barnard, deputy CEO of Chatham Historic Dockyard Trust. “A lot of history, and lore, and speculation, and to be honest, rumor, about what could happen next.”

Israel orders security review of foreign civil flights after co-pilot attack

BY SAMMY WESTFALL

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has called for a thorough review of “all aspects” of security of foreign civil flights to Israel, in the wake of the attack on a flight bound for Tel Aviv on Wednesday.

Netanyahu instructed the head of the National Security Council, Shmuel Ben Ezra, to appoint an examiner to conduct the review, Netanyahu’s office said Sunday on X.

A co-pilot of a flight traveling from Dubai to Tel Aviv allegedly attacked his fellow pilot with a crash ax and put the plane and its roughly 180 passengers into a sharp descent.

The captain managed to open the cockpit door, enabling passengers and crew members to take control of the plane and make an emergency landing in Saudi Arabia, passengers said.

The suspected attacker on FlyDubai Flight 1073 has been identified as Omani national

Hamam al-Hammami, according to Yossi Avraham Shelley, Israel’s ambassador to the United Arab Emirates.

Netanyahu said last week that the co-pilot was “suicidal” and “underwent Islamic radical indoctrination.”

Netanyahu said Friday that Israel was investigating “whether he was sent, and whoever sent him will pay a very heavy price.”

A person familiar with the matter told The Washington

Post that al-Hammami had specifically been blocked from flying planes for Oman Air because of his radical views.

The person, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss an ongoing investigation, said that the co-pilot had been placed in a desk job because of these views and that he had then resigned.

The person did not give details about those views, and it was not immediately clear whether FlyDubai or the Emi-

rati government, which did not immediately respond to requests for comment, were aware of this.

Officials from Israel’s Transportation Ministry on Saturday appeared to place the blame on FlyDubai and security in the UAE, telling reporters in a call that they should have conducted background checks on the pilot, and that a pilot from Oman — which does not have diplomatic relations with Israel — should not have been allowed

to fly a plane to Tel Aviv.

On Tuesday, before the attack, Netanyahu issued a video warning from the Tel Nof air base that there might be an attack against Israel ahead of elections in late October.

“We have indications that, ahead of the elections, our enemies will try to attack us. ... I send you this message: Do not mess with us, not now and not ever. Our long arm will reach you anywhere, at any time,” he said in the video statement.



People sunbathe Thursday in Kyiv along the Dnipro River near a bridge that was targeted in a Russian drone attack earlier in the day. Russia has been striking multiple bridges in recent days.

Russian attacks on bridges aim to make Kyiv unlivable

BY FRANCESCA EBEL

KYIV — A Russian drone hit Kyiv’s North Bridge on Saturday morning — the fifth strike within three days on bridges in the Ukrainian capital, which is split down its center by the wide Dnieper River.

Eight bridges connect Kyiv’s left and right banks, and they are relied on by millions of residents to navigate the city. The bridges serve vehicles and pedestrians, as well as subway, railroad and freight trains.

The recent effort by Russia to disable or destroy the bridges is part of an intensifying campaign against civilian targets.

Kyiv Mayor Vitali Klitschko, posting on Telegram, said Saturday that two people had been injured in the attack on the North Bridge and that the tram network running across the bridge had been damaged. As of noon, car traffic had resumed across the bridge.

On Thursday and Friday, several drones crashed into Kyiv’s South Bridge, which has been closed since the strikes. The capital was paralyzed with traffic Friday night as a result of the bridge’s closure. Some people crossed the bridge by foot, abandoning their cars and walking 20 minutes to the other side.

Olya, who spoke on the condition that she be identified only by her first name to protect her privacy, was on Kyiv’s river beach below the South Bridge at the time of Thursday’s attack.

“When it hit, the flames went two meters up. It was horrible, I feel like we almost died,” she told The Washington Post.

Like most Kyiv residents, Olya said she felt trapped between the constant danger and anxiety



Attacks on Ukrainian infrastructure have brought traffic chaos to the capital. Kyiv’s left and right banks are connected by eight bridges.

and was striving for a normal routine. Dressed in a bikini and wearing diamond earrings, she said the strike had not deterred her from getting a tan: “The sun is shining today!”

But a sense of normalcy is becoming difficult to maintain for residents of Ukraine’s big

cities. Following the attacks, Kyiv’s Defense Council has held emergency crisis meetings and implemented public transport rerouting. New ferry routes are reportedly under consideration.

According to intelligence intercepted by Kyiv, Russian President Vladimir Putin has

instructed Russia’s military leaders to abandon the rules of war and has ordered an increase on strikes on civilian targets in Kyiv, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky told the Financial Times on Thursday.

“He said there are no rules now,” Zelensky said, speaking in-

side the bomb shelter of a school that had been hit by a Russian jet-powered drone that morning. Around 100 schoolchildren had been in the shelter at the moment of impact. Zelensky said Moscow was gearing up to intensify attacks on Ukraine’s biggest cities, to isolate, disrupt and

freeze them as winter sets in.

Zelensky’s comments echoed a report in the New York Times that Ukraine’s energy minister, Denys Shmyhal, recently briefed European counterparts on an intercepted Russian plan to use as many as 1,000 missiles, drones and bombs against Ukraine’s energy infrastructure. The targets include electrical substations, hydroelectric and thermal power plants, and boiler houses.

Analysts have warned that Russia has plans to target municipal water and sewage systems, in an bid to break “life-support systems of cities.”

“Ruining the livability of cities is actually a planning factor in some of their strategies. A desired effect and force multiplier is also chaos and displacement of civilians,” wrote Dara Massicot, a senior fellow at the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace, whose research focuses on Russian military strategy and defense issues. “The Russians have very specific target set guidelines and calculations on how to induce pain and humanitarian disasters to reach a military end.”

Out enjoying the last few sunlit days as the city’s leaves begin to turn, Kyiv residents are clearly feeling the relentlessness of Russia’s attacks. Many said they are concerned that the winter freeze and darkness they are readying for may hit earlier than anticipated.

“The capital is in a very dramatic situation. And it’s no longer possible to pretend that we can live now as we do in peacetime,” said Mayor Klitschko on Friday. “The enemy is tearing Kyiv apart.”

Anastacia Galouchka contributed to this report.

U.S. Marine is accused of killing woman in Japan

BY CHIE TANAKA
AND AOIFE WALSH

TOKYO — A U.S. Marine has been arrested on suspicion of killing and robbing a Japanese woman in Okinawa, officials say, prompting Tokyo to lodge a protest with the United States on Sunday.

Devin Jacob Ballard, 20, is accused of killing Anna Yagi, 39, in a hotel Saturday, police told Japan’s public broadcaster, NHK. Ballard has denied the allegations, a spokesman said.

The III Marine Expeditionary Force, based in Okinawa, said it was cooperating with authorities “in response to allegations of serious criminal actions.”

“The Marine Corps takes these allegations very seriously and ex-

pects every Marine to adhere to the highest standards of behavior. The Marine is in custody of local authorities while investigations proceed,” it added.

Surveillance footage showed a man entering the hotel with a woman and later leaving with her belongings, NHK reported.

Yagi was pronounced dead at the scene, police said, and some of her belongings were found abandoned near the hotel. Police did not respond to a request for comment Sunday. Japan’s defense minister, Shinjiro Koizumi, said the arrested Marine is a lance corporal.

In a statement on X, Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi called the incident “extremely brutal and heinous.” She said her

government has “lodged a strong protest with the U.S. side, while firmly demanding maximum cooperation with the investigation, strict discipline among U.S. military personnel, and thorough measures to prevent the recurrence of such incidents and accidents.”

In a statement issued to local media, the victim’s brother said his family is “devastated by the loss of our family member.”

The incident reignites long-standing tensions over the U.S. military’s presence on the southern island, which hosts over half of the more than 50,000 U.S. military personnel stationed in Japan and has the largest U.S. air base in the Asia-Pacific.

Officials have repeatedly

raised concerns about hosting U.S. troops, particularly over crime, alcohol consumption and environmental contamination. The 1995 rape of an Okinawan schoolgirl by three American servicemen prompted mass protests on the island.

Genta Kojia, Okinawa’s governor, said on X that the incident “delivered a profound shock to the prefectural residents who are forced to live side by side with military bases, giving rise to new anxieties.”

The U.S. Embassy in Tokyo said an investigation was underway “to clarify the facts.”

“The United States Government continues to cooperate closely with the Government of Japan and local authorities,” it



The Futenma base, where Japan’s public broadcaster said the U.S. Marine accused in the slaying was stationed.

said on X.

George Glass, the U.S. ambassador to Japan, said he has spoken with the country’s Foreign

Ministry, “offering our sincere condolences and pledging full cooperation as the investigation continues.”

ECONOMY & BUSINESS



GRETA RYBUS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

An exercise class at a senior center in New Hampshire. Rising interest rates are good for savers, but many seniors may not realize that they can lead to higher Medicare premiums, among other things.

Higher interest rates could be trouble for some retirees

Although good news for savers, increases can also bite in unexpected ways

BY JOHN CSISZAR

An era of higher interest rates — with the 30-year U.S. Treasury bond reaching 5.609 percent, its highest yield since 2002 — generally is good news for savers, as banks may increase payouts on savings accounts or newly issued certificates of deposit. But many seniors may not realize that rising rates could hit them in other ways, including higher Medicare premiums or reduced health-insurance subsidies. Some Social Security beneficiaries may also face a surprise tax bill.

Here are three ways rising

interest rates might unexpectedly zing seniors, and what to do about it.

1. Higher interest income can raise Medicare premiums

One potential land mine is Medicare's income-related monthly adjustment amount (IRMAA). Beneficiaries with a modified adjusted gross income that exceeds certain limits face a surcharge on both Medicare Part B (the core part of Medicare) and Part D (prescription) premiums.

Medicare generally has a two-year lookback period, so additional interest earned in 2026 could affect premiums in 2028. For 2026, the limit of \$218,000 for joint filers (or \$109,000 for single filers) is applied to 2024 income.

Medicare beneficiaries exceeding this limit by even a single dollar could see premiums rise.

Joint filers enrolled in Medicare Parts B and D, for example, could each end up paying \$284.10 per month for Part B instead of the standard \$202.90, plus a \$14.50 monthly Part D surcharge. That translates to an additional annual payment of \$2,296.80 for the couple.

When interest income rises, the tax burden on retirees can become worse, even for those who don't realize it. Joshua Mangoubi, a chartered financial analyst and founder and chief investment officer of Considerate Capital, said that interest earned in a taxable CD, for example, counts as income even when the account owner leaves it untouched. "Whether you spend the interest or leave it in your account does not matter," he said.

2. More Social Security benefits may become taxable

The formula the IRS uses to determine the taxability of Social Security benefits can also be affected by higher interest rates. "Combined income" for Social Security purposes generally includes adjusted gross income, tax-exempt interest and half of Social Security benefits.

"If you earn \$40,000 in Social Security, \$20,000 of that counts," said Brian Seymour, a certified financial planner and founder of Prosperitage Wealth. Tax-exempt municipal-bond interest is also included in the calculation, he said. "It is one of the only places in the tax code where tax-exempt income still works against you."

Singles with more than \$34,000 in combined income could face taxation on as much as 85 percent of their Social Security benefits. The same is true for joint filers with combined income in excess of \$44,000.

Consider a single individual with \$40,000 in Social Security income and \$14,000 in other income. An additional \$1,000 of interest would raise combined income to \$35,000 and cause another \$850 of Social Security benefits to become taxable, per the IRS formula.

3. Affordable Care Act subsidies may have to be repaid

Early retirees with coverage through the ACA, or Obamacare, may receive subsidies based on their expected income for the year. If their actual income is higher, they may have received too much help with their premiums. "There is no cap on repayment in 2026; they may have to pay it all back," Mangoubi said.

Rising income from higher interest rates can help retirees deal with day-to-day costs, but there

may be a price to pay in the form of increased costs elsewhere. To avoid surprises, it's a good idea for retirees to review their year-to-date interest and projected modified adjusted gross income before year-end.

"Don't think about making less income. Think about coordinating your income," Mangoubi said. For example, someone expecting \$4,000 more in CD interest might take \$4,000 less from a fully taxable traditional IRA, he said, provided it is not a required distribution. "Try to stay below these lines when it makes sense."

Marketplace customers can also update their projected income when it changes. Working with a tax professional can be a good way to calculate the effects before the additional income produces a surprise premium or tax bill.

Early retirement is a possibility even if you haven't accumulated a fortune

BY MAURIE BACKMAN

The United States doesn't have an official retirement age. Non-retirees expect to end their careers at age 66, on average, according to Gallup, whereas current retirees had an average retirement age of 61.

But a 2024 YouGov survey found that 59 percent of working Americans would like to retire early, and 40 percent are confident they'll be able to do so.

With enough savings, early retirement may be possible. But if you want an early retirement and haven't accumulated a fortune, changing your approach to work could help you attain that goal.

Working in some capacity eases the financial brunt

Retiring fully at a young age means becoming completely reliant on your savings and investments to fund your lifestyle. A shift toward a different type of work or work schedule could help preserve those assets while helping you feel retired to a large degree.

"You can leave a 50-hour-per-week career without leaving work behind entirely," says Julian Morris, founder and principal at Concierge Wealth Management in Boston. "Many of my clients choose to gradually downshift their hours, which can be healthier than a hard stop. This could include consulting, teaching, mentoring, seasonal work or an



2021 PHOTO BY JOE RAEDLE/GETTY IMAGES

Dave Bayer takes a water aerobics class at a retirement community in Pompano Beach, Florida. Fifty-nine percent of working Americans would like to retire early, a 2024 YouGov survey found.

encore career completely unrelated to their previous job."

Adam Spiegelman, wealth adviser at Spiegelman Wealth Management in Alamo, California, says even modest part-time income could make a big difference when you're trying to stretch a nest egg an extra 10 years.

"If you earn \$40,000 a year from consulting or a passion project, that's \$40,000 you don't

have to pull from your portfolio," he says. "At a 4 percent withdrawal rate [which financial planners commonly recommend as a baseline], you'd need about \$1 million saved to produce the same income."

But part-time income doesn't just give you extra money to spend. Spiegelman says part-time earnings could be a lifeline if a market crash hits soon after

you retire.

Portfolios recover from downturns if their underlying shares eventually increase in price. If you're forced to sell more shares early in retirement to fund your lifestyle, you'll have fewer left to participate in that eventual recovery.

Plus, Spiegelman says, early retirement can be more expensive than planned when you con-

sider the cost of bridging the gap until Medicare starts at 65.

"Some part-time jobs come with benefits," he says. "If yours doesn't, keeping your income in a moderate range may help you qualify for subsidized coverage on the [Affordable Care Act] marketplace."

Work could keep you connected and engaged

It's easy to look at early retirement as a math problem to solve. Part-time work can help make the numbers work, but Morris says there's another aspect to look at.

"Work gives people more than income. It can provide routine, social interaction, intellectual stimulation, status, purpose and a sense of accomplishment," he says.

Morris says it's particularly important for early retirees to replace these things intentionally. That could entail a combination of volunteering, hobbies, or social activities and clubs on top of a part-time or consulting role.

"If you're retiring at 55, you may be creating 30 or 40 years of life without the built-in structure that work provided for you. So your relationships matter enormously. And your community matters, too," he says.

That's another reason Morris recommends an encore career chosen for meaning and not just money. You don't have to be bothered by lower compensation, he says, because you have

more flexibility to choose work that you enjoy but that didn't pay well enough to pursue full-time during your earlier years.

Planning your early glide path

If you're considering downshifting rather than stopping work entirely, start by calculating your annual income needs. Make sure to calculate health insurance costs if you'll be giving up subsidized coverage.

Next, ensure you have savings to access penalty-free. Traditional IRA and 401(k) plans generally impose a 10 percent penalty on withdrawals taken before age 59½. If you're separating from your employer the calendar year you turn 55 or later, that company's 401(k) balance may be available to you penalty-free before age 59½.

From there, research part-time work opportunities or an encore career based on your interests and skills. Figure out how much income allows you to cover your costs partially without pressuring your savings too much.

Finally, outline how you'll fill your days meaningfully if you'll be working only part-time or shifting to remote consulting work that offers little social interaction. Once you've crafted a plan, you may find that an early retirement that incorporates work in some shape or form allows you to free up time and do something rewarding without taking on undue financial risk.

OPINION

The Washington Post

AN INDEPENDENT NEWSPAPER



A drone view shows a Suncor Energy refinery in Ontario, Canada, on Sept. 2.

CARLOS OSORIO/REUTERS

EDITORIALS

The Supreme Court takes up climate change — and much more

THE SUPREME COURT will start a new term Monday by hearing arguments in *Suncor Energy v. Boulder County*, a case that has the potential to bankrupt every major oil and gas company if the justices don't close the floodgates.

The city and county of Boulder, Colorado, sued Suncor and ExxonMobil under a state law in 2018, arguing that their energy production released carbon emissions, which contributed to global climate change, which intensified weather-related harms, which created millions in local damages. The Colorado Supreme Court let these specious claims proceed.

Dozens of similar suits have subsequently been filed by localities across America, seeking billions in damages. A former member of the Boulder legal team, David Bookbinder, admitted last year that the goal of these cases is to impose a "carbon tax" through juries because Congress won't pass one. If even a few suits succeed, "all these companies declare bankruptcy," Bookbinder said. Too bad for anyone who drives a gas car or heats their home with fossil fuels.

While Boulder's theory of liability seems far-fetched, the issue before the court on Monday is different: whether federal law allows Colorado law to penalize companies for contributing to climate change. The decision could address a core question about federalism: To what extent can blue and red states impose their will on one another?

One issue is whether federal law preempts the Colorado law Boulder is suing under. The companies argue that interstate emissions regulation is an inherently federal task. The Environmental Protection Agency has set rules under the Clean Air Act of 1970, and if Colorado seeks to do the same, it would interfere with federal authority.

A 2011 Supreme Court decision provides strong support for these arguments. States and New York City sued energy companies under federal law for contributing to climate change. But the court decided this was a job for the EPA. Writing for an 8-0 majority in *American Electric Power Co., Inc. v. Connecticut*, Justice Ruth Bader Ginsburg said, "Congress delegated to EPA the decision whether and how to regulate carbon-dioxide emissions from power plants."

A ruling on similar grounds now would prevent future attempts to regulate emissions through state courts. But this case is also an opportunity for the high court to address the growing problem of states seeking to regulate beyond their borders.

Boulder's suit would allow Colorado to penalize a company for conduct outside of its borders. Every plant and refinery — and, for that matter, every car or cow that produces emissions — could theoretically be subject to the state law. As the dissent at the state Supreme Court put it, "That just can't be right."

The structure of the Constitution doesn't allow this. When states ratified the founding document, they kept "all the rights of sovereignty which they before had" and which were not given to the federal government, as Alexander Hamilton wrote in Federalist No. 32. How can Tennessee retain its sovereignty if Colorado is permitted to regulate its power plants?

The justices may choose to punt the case back to lower courts on procedural grounds. That became more of a possibility after Justice Samuel A. Alito Jr. recused himself last week. He didn't offer a reason, in line with court tradition, but climate activist groups had pointed to his individual stock holdings in energy companies such as ConocoPhillips, which is not a party in the case. A 4-4 split would let the suit move forward.

The American intuition that states function well as laboratories of democracy depends on protection from horizontal power grabs by other states. And citizens' faith in our constitutional system requires the power to vote out lawmakers. But Boulder's effort would circumvent Congress and let a Colorado jury make law for 49 other states.

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The evidence on anti-free-market price controls has not changed

PRICE CONTROLS have had a stench about them since the 1970s, when they were implemented on a wide scale and found wanting. Yet politicians across the political spectrum have been proposing price controls, and recent polling shows large majorities of voters support price caps on prescription drugs, credit card interest rates and child care.

Has the evidence on price controls changed? Let's take a spin around the world and see how they've been working lately.

In May, Kyrgyzstan imposed price controls on fuel. Gas stations reported shortages. The government repealed the price cap on gasoline in July.

In Bangladesh earlier this year, some drivers waited in line up to 14 hours for price-controlled fuel. As soon as the government allowed prices to rise, the lines in Dhaka, the crowded capital, shortened by two-thirds. Lines elsewhere disappeared entirely.

TotalEnergies, the French oil giant, announced it would voluntarily cap fuel prices at its gas stations in March. In early April, the great majority of gas stations in France had no shortages. Of the 900 that did, 700 belonged to TotalEnergies.

Also in France, universities in April capped meal prices at one euro for all students. The actual cost averages eight



GABRIEL BOUYS/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Motorists wait in line to fill up their cars at a TotalEnergies petrol station in Beziers, France, on Oct. 1.

euros. The surge in students using cafeterias now means there is often nowhere to sit, and unions threatened to strike over the big increase in work. Some students have said that the long lines make it impossible to eat between classes.

Catalonia, in northeastern Spain, imposed sweeping rent controls in 2024. What followed was a decline in rental agreements. As of March, the supply of rental housing had declined by 23 percent.

The Netherlands announced plans in

April to relax a rent control law from July 2024 because the supply of rentals was falling. In the months after that law took effect, the number of homes offered for rent fell by 44 percent.

A government report in Scotland published in March found that planned build-to-rent housing projects were canceled after rent controls took effect there. Investment in build-to-rent housing moved to England instead. A Scottish housing federation found that the rent controls had reduced investment in mid-market rentals.

In May, the Philippines capped prices for imported rice. A shortage didn't result, but only because most rice sellers didn't comply. Some kept selling imported rice but changed the label to say it was domestic.

Hungary capped pork prices for customers in 2022. Economic research published in September found that the price control mostly transferred the higher cost of pork leg from customers to retailers. That means grocery stores probably raised prices or cut service on other goods to offset their inability to charge the market price for pork.

Price controls are still doing what they always do: destroy investment, encourage lawbreaking and cause shortages. Politicians would be wise to remember that voters' opinions might change, but the laws of economics don't.

This dementia research shows why the NIH matters

I was pleased to be mentioned in the Sept. 26 news article "Scientists seek clues as dementia patients near death get lucid." It noted that the 2019 article I co-authored explored the possibility that some behavioral recovery may happen even with brain changes that are thought to be irreversible. This article was the result of a workshop held at the National Institutes of Health and is thanks to Basil Eldadah, who was then with the National Institute on Aging.

The article is a reminder of the value that the NIH has brought to the world. For a relatively modest investment, Americans benefit from the dedicated scientists and staff discovering new treatments and answers to critical health questions. I personally benefited from the NIH through training grants when I was an early-career researcher and again more recently as a policy fellow, enabling me to study the science of brain aging.

For those less familiar with the NIH, this article was a reminder that many of the cutting-edge treatments for diseases and the most transformational medicines are made possible largely because of the dedication of scientists and research funding provided by the agency.

Through grassroots initiatives such as the Bethesda Declaration — a letter detailing concerns with the Trump administration's changes to the NIH — I learned that NIH productivity is at risk of disruption due to recent policy changes. The initial letter was signed by hundreds of scientists and staff members at the agency last year and garnered the support of more than 30,000 additional external signers.

I continue to be in awe of the amazing science and treatments that emerge from the dedication of those working for and funded by the NIH.

Lori Frank, Kensington

"unlike ants ... the human mind shows us at our best in its capacity to imagine peace." Realistically, however, we need to consciously and actively promote and practice peace as if it were an inherited imperative. The consequences of its absence, on a large scale, are unimaginable.

John Mason, Silver Spring

Free speech isn't always polite

Regarding Conor Fitzpatrick's Oct. 1 op-ed, "Why 'Let's go, Brandon' is worth a legal fight":

The Supreme Court held in *Cohen v. California* (1971) that the expression "F--- the Draft" in a public courthouse constituted constitutionally protected speech. Writing for the majority, Justice John Harlan elaborated: "Much linguistic expression serves a dual communicative function: it conveys not only ideas capable of relatively precise, detached explication, but otherwise inexpressible emotions as well. In fact, words are often chosen as much for their emotive as their cognitive force. We cannot sanction the view that the Constitution, while solicitous of the cognitive content of individual speech, has little or no regard for that emotive function which, practically speaking, may often be the more important element of the overall message sought to be communicated."

Public schools should train students for adulthood. Speech should not be limited to what is fit for nunneries or monasteries.

Bruce Fein, Washington
The writer served as associate deputy attorney general under President Ronald Reagan.

How to keep college affordable

Regarding the Sept. 20 Business article "A crash course on college finances":

Selecting affordable education made college possible for both me and my son. My parents told me their college plan for me was: "You're going to college and you're paying for it." I started my education at community college and then commuted to a local urban university while living with my parents. I worked to pay for school as I went. Finally, I went to Stanford University, which was paid for by my employer.

My son received a small inheritance from his grandmother when he was 13. His mom invested that money, and after he turned 18, he began to invest his money on his own. That was a financial education in and of itself.

My son lived with us and commuted to a local university, and he was able to cover all his college expenses from his investments and summer jobs. Unlike many of his peers, he didn't have student loan debt. That allowed him to purchase a nice home in our neighborhood with his own money at the age of 29.

The lesson I'd pass on to prospective students is to choose an affordable college and keep expenses low. To their parents, I'd tell them to keep their children motivated.

Mark Rupersburg, Grosse Pointe Woods, Michigan

OPINION

How to rein in the chaos of college sports

BY NICK SABAN AND E. GORDON GEE

Saturdays once again belong to college football. Stadiums are full, rivalries have reignited, and grills are being fired up in parking lots across the country. Yet behind the tailgates and thrill of “College GameDay,” the system supporting college athletics is coming apart. College sports has changed more in the past five years than in the previous 50. A dizzying maze of court decisions, conflicting state laws, an out-of-control transfer portal, and the rapid rise of name, image and likeness compensation (NIL) have produced a system with no national rules. The current dynamic has led to growing financial pressure on schools and uncertainty for athletes, coaches and administrators.

Between the two of us, we have spent more than a century in college athletics. One of us has led some of America’s most respected universities — Brown, Colorado, Ohio State, Vanderbilt and West Virginia. The other spent decades coaching at the highest level of college football, watching some young men become professional athletes but many more become doctors, businessmen, lawyers and public servants.

We have stood on opposite sidelines and rooted for different teams. But we are united today because we know what is at stake if college sports continues down the current path.

Sens. Ted Cruz (R-Texas) and Maria Cantwell (D-Washington) just accomplished something rare in D.C. They crafted comprehensive, bipartisan legislation that addresses a real crisis and built an impressively broad consensus around it — two equally mountainous tasks that reflect how Congress was intended to operate.

Last week, the Senate passed the Protect College Sports Act, which establishes a national framework for the new era of college sports. Now the House must finish the job.

The central question is no longer whether college athletes should be compensated. They rightfully can be, and this legislation preserves their ability to earn legitimate NIL income. The harder question now is how college sports will accommodate this new marketplace while maintaining scholarships, roster spots, nonrevenue sports, women’s programs and the educational mission that distinguishes college athletics from professional sports.

No single law can solve the problems facing college sports, but this one would create a better path forward.

For starters, it would restore order to the transfer portal. The bill would allow student-athletes to move schools once without penalty. Subsequent transfers generally require them to sit out for a year, with important exceptions — such as if there is a coaching change or the athlete is sexually abused or harassed. That matters for roster stability, but it matters more for academics. It’s already difficult to complete a college degree while playing a sport. It’s nearly impossible to get a real education when moving across as many as four schools in four years.

This legislation would also create national standards for NIL agreements and the agents who negotiate them. It would protect a student-athlete’s ability to earn unlimited legitimate NIL income, but would draw a line between those deals and compensation intended primarily to recruit or retain players. The bill would also require agents



BRIAN BAHR/GETTY IMAGES

Oklahoma State Cowboys football players and fans celebrate a win over the Oregon Ducks on Sept. 12.

to register, cap their fees and give athletes power against bad actors.

These protections are critical for athletes navigating a marketplace that did not exist a few years ago. But at the same time, college sports is about much more than the most marketable players. It is also about the swimmer who trains before sunrise. The wrestler whose scholarship makes college possible. The gymnast, the runner, the softball player, the volleyball player and the hundreds of thousands of other student-athletes whose sports rarely make headlines but whose lives are changed by the chance to compete while earning a degree.

This legislation would safeguard those opportunities by protecting scholarships and roster thresholds so that programs are preserved rather than quietly cut. It would also prevent athletic scholarships from being revoked because of injury, athletic performance or roster-management decisions.

Additionally, it would address an economic problem college sports can no longer ignore. Athletic department deficits have grown into the millions, with 94 percent of Division I programs spending more than they generate as of 2024. The bill would give schools and conferences a voluntary option to pool media rights and negotiate them collectively, without altering conferences or traditions.

For schools that do participate, existing media contracts would be protected and revenue would

be distributed according to value. This is not diluting the strong to prop up the weak. Every school would earn more than it could under the current model, and that prosperity could turn into more scholarships and more sports.

Reasonable people can disagree with the details, and debate has made this bill stronger. But there comes a moment when leadership requires moving forward.

President Donald Trump charted the way, bringing Congress and college sports leaders to the table and demanding action. More than a century ago, President Theodore Roosevelt built a similar coalition, and the crisis of that era gave rise to the NCAA.

Congress rarely gets the opportunity to strengthen a vital American institution with bipartisan legislation. This is one of those moments.

The Senate seized the opportunity. The House should do the same and send the Protect College Sports Act to the president’s desk without delay. Not for universities, and not for coaches, but for young people whose futures will be shaped by college sports.

Nick Saban was a college football coach for 28 seasons. He was inducted into the College Football Hall of Fame in 2025. E. Gordon Gee was a university president for 45 years at five different universities.

RAMESH PONNURU

Voters aren’t buying Trump’s ‘strong’ economy

The Trump economy is strong,” wrote White House science-and-tech adviser David Sachs this week. He got the numbers right. New data showed that growth accelerated faster than expected in the second quarter. Inflation came in below expectations. Job creation, Sachs said, was solid. Since he wrote, the government reported that the unemployment rate is 4.2 percent, lower than the average in any of the last eight decades. Yet the public still hates this economy.

In a poll of likely U.S. voters, those who rate the economy as “poor” or “only fair” outnumber those who call it “good” or “excellent” by roughly 3 to 1. Liz Peek, writing for FoxNews.com, blames the low spirits on Republican communications failures and “the incessant negativity of the Trump-hating media.”

There’s a simpler explanation: Prices are too high and still rising too fast. Real wages have thus been falling. Add in that President Donald Trump has instituted some policies that raise prices, has signaled in many other ways that lowering prices is not a top priority for him and has repeatedly dismissed cost-of-living concerns, and it’s not at all surprising that voters are unhappy.

Nor is it surprising that the Republican attempts to sell this economic record, or deflect blame for it, are falling flat. The rising stock market is good news, but wages matter more than stocks for most households. Unemployment is low, but outside of severe recessions, there are more voters who buy meat than have trouble finding or keeping a job. The record-low poverty rate is great news, but the vast majority of voters aren’t poor, either.

Inflation, per the most recent reading, is at 3.4 percent. From the 1970s through the 1990s, Americans would have welcomed that as low. The context today is different. The public got used to low inflation from 2009 to 2020, when the average rate was roughly 1.6 percent. Prices then rocketed higher, especially during the first half of President Joe Biden’s term. Inflation moderated in the second half but still stayed higher than what had become normal.

That level of inflation has persisted and so has public dissatisfaction with high and rising prices. While it’s true, then, that inflation is well below its 2022 peak, that isn’t the yardstick most relevant to voters. They seem instead to be judging the president against the promises he made in his 2024 campaign, when he said that inflation was still too high and that he would bring prices down.

Wages haven’t been keeping up. Republicans brag about last month’s Census report, which shows that real median incomes have hit a record high. But that report covers 2025. Using data from the Bureau of Labor Statistics, my American Enterprise Institute colleague Michael Strain estimates that the average real wage hit a peak in November



SCOTT OLSON/GETTY IMAGES

A grocery store in Chicago on Sept. 10.

last year and has fallen since.

Yet even that estimate understates the economic pain that matters politically. The official inflation rate measures only the price of goods and services rather than the price of borrowing to finance them. The interest-rate effect nevertheless registers as inflation to most people.

The frustration Republicans feel over the politics of the economy resembles what Democrats felt during the Biden administration. They, too, cited a lot of positive statistics and concocted theories about why voters weren’t appreciating how well the economy was performing. The latter overlooked the two statistics that mattered most: the inflation rate and inflation-adjusted wages.

An even closer parallel is how Republicans thought about the economy in 2006. Then, as now, they were going into a Republican president’s second midterm with majorities in both chambers of Congress. Then, as now, voters were reacting

against corruption, an unpopular war and high gas prices. Republicans pointed to several positive indicators, including a low unemployment rate and a respectable level of economic growth. My friend Larry Kudlow, an economic commentator, called the boom “the greatest story never told,” a label he is using again this year.

Yet for most people, it didn’t feel like a boom: Their paychecks didn’t go as far as they had five years earlier. The president lost popularity, and Republicans lost the House and the Senate.

It may be that the voters are being unfair to Trump and his party. The excessive inflation we’re experiencing isn’t, for the most part, their fault. But that’s also true of the excessive inflation we went through when Biden was president, which did a lot to get Trump elected. (In both cases, the Federal Reserve deserves more of the blame.) Voters’ unhappiness with the economy has a rational basis, and nobody said politics is fair.

MEGAN MCARDLE

Cornell raises an uncomfortable question about consent

There is no question that something terrible happened at a Cornell University fraternity in 2024. The question is what. Was it a brutal gang rape? Or was it something messier and more complicated, a sexual encounter that was unwise but nonetheless consensual?

What facts we have are not enough to distinguish between the two possibilities.

A Cornell student, identified as “Jane Doe” in a lawsuit filed in September against the university, seven members of the Chi Phi fraternity and others, says she was the victim of a gang rape at the fraternity house while she was intoxicated. According to the lawsuit and a 2024 police statement, the brothers treated her abominably, posting a disgusting message about her to a group chat.

What we cannot ascertain — and may never be able to — is whether she was too intoxicated to be able to consent. So we are now fighting over this as we have fought over so many accusations over the last few decades — the Duke University rape hoax, the allegations that Christine Blasey Ford made against Brett M. Kavanaugh during his Supreme Court confirmation hearings, and the endless horrors unearthed by #MeToo. But why? Why is it so hard to agree on something that seems, to both sides, as though it ought to be obvious?

One answer is that sex between people who know each other is hard to adjudicate from outside, especially when one or both parties have been drinking or using drugs, thereby lowering their inhibitions, impairing their judgment and blurring their memories. Another is that different people can genuinely view an encounter differently, especially in hindsight, after regret has set in.

But I’d argue the reason these fights are so fraught is mostly that we are trying to believe too many contradictory things.

We want sex to be simple and sexual assault to be simply unthinkable. We want there to be bright lines that obviously shouldn’t be crossed so we can shout “Jaccuse” at anyone who does.

But we want to proclaim that men and women are fundamentally the same, aside from socialization. We want to declare that anything goes, as long as both parties have consented. And then we want to set 18-year-olds free to live out this liberation theology.

The result is predictably disastrous. We demand that young people with poor judgment respect boundaries, and then we refuse to establish any.

I know the retort that will spring to many readers’ minds: Consent *is* a clear boundary. It is certainly a boundary, and sometimes it is clear. If you force yourself on someone who is screaming and pushing you away or who is trembling on the edge of unconsciousness, that person must be left alone. If you do not, we can and should put you in jail.

But we keep fighting because consent is often

Trying to shoehorn contradictory impulses into the weak framework of consent is not workable.

not clear — at least not in a way that is coherent with our doctrines of utter sexual liberation and complete equality between the sexes.

When two people who are both extremely drunk have sex — as I believe may sometimes happen — did they rape each other? Or was the woman obviously the victim?

Many people instinctively treat such an encounter as one in which the woman is the victim and the man the predator. After the Obama administration issued informal guidance in 2011, effectively instructing colleges to make more of an effort to discipline sexual assault, including relaxing standards for due process, many colleges acted on that intuition. Though the rules were ostensibly gender neutral, Emily Yoffe noted in the Atlantic that “it is clear that the Obama administration rightly viewed campus assault overwhelmingly as something male students do to female ones.”

That’s a defensible stance if you believe that women are not, in fact, the same as men — that when sober and possessing their full good judgment, women are generally less likely to want casual sex and much more likely to suffer from it. But that intuition could not be named explicitly, because that would have violated too many other shibboleths and called the “anything goes” doctrine into question.

Given the facts we now have, it is possible to believe that Jane Doe assented to an encounter that she later bitterly regretted when the story became known around campus. It is also possible to believe something criminal happened. But most of us do know that whether or not she said yes, Jane Doe was treated in a way no woman should. We think those fraternity brothers should have known better.

They should have. What they did was, at a minimum, a shameful violation. But if we want boys and men to know that — deep enough in their bones that they will remember the lesson even while drinking and snorting ketamine — we need to communicate something different from “anything goes, as long as everyone says yes.” We need to say something about the differences between men and women.

We’re not willing to do that, so instead we are trying to shoehorn our contradictory impulses into the weak framework of consent. No one in their right mind would consent to sex that would traumatize and shame them. Jane Doe was traumatized and shamed. Ergo, it was rape.

This is not a workable way to determine criminal liability. As the frequency of such incidents shows, it is not a workable cultural script, either. But it seems we are determined to stick to it, rather than admitting that there’s something wrong with many of our other ideas about men and women, and the kinds of things they are likely to want.

‘Dying on the vine’: How a farmer ended up with tons of unwanted grapes

GRAPES FROM A1

terms with shifting consumer behavior, including sharp declines in fruit juice and wine consumption.

“If we don’t get demand back up, there is a chance we have to start taking [the vineyards] out,” said Anna-Marie Labowski, a grape farmer and a Pennsylvania Farm Bureau board member. “Some farmers are already putting their land up for sale.”

Terrell has about 1,600 tons of product — at least 200 million individual grapes — that will soon rot. Farmers are scrambling to limit the waste. Some are considering inviting the public to pick their own grapes, though they stress that residents won’t be able to help them eat their way out of this.

“Even if 50 people came here and handpicked grapes, they might get rid of one ton or two tons,” Terrell said. “That is still way short of the scale at which these concord grapes are being produced.”

Grape farmers across the world are experiencing similar problems. Both wine and fruit juice sales have declined dramatically in recent years, a trend driven by healthier habits including consuming less sugar. Some farmers in California are ripping out their vineyards as they search for new crops. Others are selling their land to developers.

The troubles around Lake Erie, the nation’s second-largest grape-growing region behind California, started this spring when Refresco, a Netherlands-based beverage company, canceled its contract with farmers.

Farmers said they were blindsided by the decision after they’d spent tens of thousands of dollars to prune and fertilize their vines over the winter.

“Everything came screeching to a halt,” said Terrell, who was forced to lay off two of his farmhands.

Antonella Sacconi, Refresco’s communications manager, said the cancellations followed “a comprehensive assessment” of “current inventory levels, market demand and long-term supply needs.”

“We deeply value the relationships we have built with our growers, many of whom we have partnered with for more than two decades, and we recognize the significance of this change for them and their local communities,” Sacconi said. “This decision is the result of sustained grape market challenges and supply imbalances that we do not expect will recover in the foreseeable future.”

The company said concord grape juice sales have declined by 30 percent over the past decade.

Besides being livid with Refresco, grape farmers are divided over who is to blame for their faltering industry.

Several Pennsylvania farmers say the decline in grape juice sales began after first lady Michelle Obama began her campaign to fight childhood obesity, which led some parents and school systems to limit juice products.

But juice, jelly and wine sales subsequently spiked during the pandemic, causing some farmers to expand their vineyards. Juice and wine sales then rapidly started declining as schools reopened and parents returned to work, leading to oversupply.

Near the Canadian border, farmers had hoped some of the surplus could be sold abroad. But that has been complicated by President Donald Trump’s tariff policies, farmers and industry experts said.

“This has been building,” said Russell Redding, Pennsylvania’s agriculture secretary, who added that grape farmers are now being forced to ask what else they can do if demand does not rebound.

There are about 500 grape farms between Erie, Pennsylvania, and Buffalo. The first vineyards in North East, where Terrell lives, were planted by immigrant families around 1850, according to local historians.

Grapes flourish here because Lake Erie’s relatively warm waters help fend off frost in the fall. In spring, the icy lake plays the opposite role by chilling the air so grape buds don’t open too early. The region’s sandy and gravelly soil, left behind after the Ice Age, helps anchor the vines.

North East’s roughly 10,000 residents consider the concord grape to be a major part of their identity. A sign in the municipal building states North East is “a grape place on a great lake” and the high school’s mascot is a grape picker.

“This has always been a place where people have found a way to sell their grapes,” said Tom



Mark Terrell tends his vineyard in North East, Pennsylvania, on Sept. 29. Terrell has about 1,600 tons of product — at least 200 million individual grapes — that will soon rot.



The flatbed truck Terrell uses to bring his grapes to the processing center sits idle at his vineyard. Both wine and fruit juice sales have declined dramatically in recent years.

Allessie, a retired mechanic who at times has worked at vineyards in the area. “We need to do more to sell people on the benefits of grape juice.”

For now, the economic blow of Refresco’s canceled contracts is softened because another major grape buyer, Welch’s, has kept its contract with farmers and maintains a manufacturing plant in town.

But some farmers fear Welch’s could eventually cut back, too, which they said would further stress vineyard owners facing rising diesel, fertilizer and labor costs.

“People are not drinking as much juice ... so I don’t think it’s sustainable,” said David Maynard, 83, a second-generation Pennsylvanian grape farmer who sells his crop to Welch’s. “But what else are you going to do with your grapes?”

Pennsylvania and New York officials have tried to protect the industry. In July, Pennsylvania Gov. Josh Shapiro (D) announced the state would spend \$500,000 to buy 350 tons of grapes from about a dozen growers, including Terrell. The grapes will be turned into juice concentrate and given to food banks.

Though they appreciate the help, Terrell and other growers said the state plan — which amounts to about 40 tons per grower — is just a tiny percentage of their overall crop.

Meanwhile, Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer (D-New York) and members of his state’s delegation announced in August that the U.S. Department of Agriculture had agreed to purchase \$20 million in surplus concord grape juice supply.

But buying existing juice



Terrell drives his daughter, Emilliana, and their dog, Rusty, through his vineyard.

doesn’t address the grapes that are about to die on farmers’ vines this fall, said Sam Valone, 67, who produces about 400 tons of grapes annually and lost his contract with Refresco.

Aude Watrelot, an assistant professor of food science and nutrition at Iowa State University, said grape growers realize they

need to find other uses for their crop. Researchers are studying whether grapes or grape waste could be used for compost, animal feed or even as an ingredient in meat products, she said.

Redding, the state agriculture secretary, agrees that farmers are going to have “to get creative about where do they put their

grapes in terms of flavors and ingredients.”

“You have to find out what parts of that product are as valuable as the fruit itself,” said Redding, comparing it to innovations that took place in the milk industry about 15 years ago.

Terrell said he’s constantly agonizing over how he can salvage

his crop.

He grew up around grapes in western New York, where he worked at his cousin’s vineyard.

After leaving graduate school and moving to the Erie region, Terrell bought his farm for about \$1 million in 2012 and spent another \$500,000 on a 16,000-pound grape harvester and other equipment.

He said he typically turned a profit despite an annual \$100,000 mortgage payment and other bills. Two years ago, Terrell noted, Refresco was paying him \$430 a ton for grapes.

Terrell said finding an alternative use for his concord grapes poses a challenge because they have a relatively short shelf life. Once picked, he said, they should be processed within eight hours.

He worries that switching to another crop would not be practical. First, he’d have to pay someone to remove the grapevines. There aren’t a lot of crops that thrive in the region’s rocky soil as grapes do.

And selling his land in a region where the population continues to get smaller and older could prove difficult.

Terrell, who has a 2-year-old daughter and 2-week-old son, said he’ll try to cover this year’s mortgage payment with his savings. But another lost harvest could leave his family in financial ruin.

“You are just watching money and a way of life fall to the ground,” he said.

There is still one solution, Terrell said as his redtick coonhound, Rusty, pranced among the vines alongside him.

“This problem would go away if people would just buy a jug of grape juice.”



Zoe Kazan, showrunner for the Netflix limited-series adaptation of “East of Eden,” at the Library of Congress on Sept. 17.

CRAIG HUDSON/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Here’s the latest word in dating: Read books

BY ETHAN BECK

Jordan Lindsey, a 31-year-old who works at a youth development nonprofit, tries to read in the morning — before work or, occasionally, on the D.C. Metro. It’s nice to go slow. Poetry is reserved for when he’s best able to focus. And Lindsey typically buys his books as opposed to taking them out from the library or borrowing them, since there’s no use in rushing through Toni Morrison’s oeuvre or “Martyr!” by Kaveh Akbar, a novel that seemingly all of Lindsey’s friends finished before he could. Reading often brings up childhood nostalgia for Lindsey. He

SEE READERS ON B2

Her grandfather directed ‘East of Eden.’ It’s her turn.

Zoe Kazan tackles the Steinbeck magnum opus, seven decades after Elia Kazan did

BY THOMAS FLOYD

Zoe Kazan can only marvel at the treasures laid before her. ¶ As the screenwriter and actress visits the Library of Congress on this mid-September afternoon, two weeks before her limited-series adaptation of John Steinbeck’s “East of Eden” hits Netflix, the curators have assembled a wealth of artifacts for Kazan to peruse. ¶ The original Time magazine review of “East of Eden” catches Kazan’s eye, both for its ruthless dismantling of Steinbeck’s 1952 magnum opus and its pointed headline: “Gentlemen & Sluts.” “Wow, they really came for it!” she says with a laugh. “We should make T-shirts.” Sifting through production stills from the 1955 film adaptation — directed by her grandfather Elia Kazan — Kazan sweetly swoons over an image of actress Lois Smith, whom she would appear with off-Broadway a half-century later.

SEE KAZAN ON B3

Q&A

Growth, not trends, motivates Quavo now

BY JONATHAN LANDRUM JR.
Associated Press

LOS ANGELES — Quavo has spent much of his career setting trends. These days, he’s more focused on what will last. The Grammy-nominated rapper is moving forward with fatherhood, healing and a sense of purpose. Now a father to a daughter, he says that growth is at the heart of his new album “QRÖMELIFE,” which was released Friday. The 14-track offering is executive produced by Pharrell Williams, who Quavo says helped him tune out the noise and re-

SEE Q&A ON B2



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Dating app users are swiping left on prospective partners who aren't readers

READERS FROM B1

once was able to shut out the world, put his head in a book and blindly follow his mom around. One of Lindsey's favorite poets, Charles Simic, wrote about how reading evoked a similar state of possibility: "Angels and gods huddled/ In dark unopened books."

Lindsey, like many young adults, has incorporated his love for literature into his love life. A partner who cares about reading is "one of those underlying things I look for," Lindsey said. "It's a sign sometimes of how someone's intellect works and what they're open to, how they see the world."

There's nothing new about perusing the bookshelf of a potential mate, placing a personal ad in the New York Review of Books or fantasizing about a rom-com situation where passion ignites at a bookstore. But a partner who regularly reads has renewed appeal, especially as attention spans dwindle and only 32 percent of Americans read five or more books in 2025, according to polling from YouGov. The pickings might seem slim: Just this week, influencer Alix Earle said that she hasn't read a book since Dr. Seuss.

Bookstores have capitalized on the eros in the air with speed-dating and singles events. One new app is testing how language can help predict compatibility, following in the footsteps of specialized dating apps for anti-vaxxers, vegans and conservatives. (There's plenty of fish, even in a smaller sea, it seems.) And since literary culture has acquired a pervasiveness via celebrity book clubs and BookTok recommendations, it doesn't seem like the affair between reading and dating will slow down anytime soon.

Several adults in their 20s and 30s told The Washington Post in interviews that they've sought out romantic relationships with



MATT WEINBERGER

Readme, a dating app that hopes to pair bookworms through a 25-question quiz, launched last month.

fellow bibliophiles for any number of reasons: A reader might have a curious streak or a strong grasp on how to communicate, while remaining amenable to different perspectives.

"Something about the active involvement of reading is very special, even challenging," Lindsey said, "because it requires a certain level of patience and openness."

Readme, which launched in early September, is a dating app that hopes to pair bookworms through a 25-question quiz that accounts for taste, styles of communication and more. The app, which was dreamed up by Co-Star founder Banu Guler and

creative consultant Emily Segal, doesn't just ask for your favorite books. Users are organized into 12 archetypes — such as the Universal Valentine and Former Gifted Kid — before being matched with other readaholics.

"We wanted to avoid a situation where you were performatively curating a bunch of books and using that to signal who you are," Segal said. No need for thirst traps with "All About Love" or profile photos with "My Year of Rest and Relaxation" in the background.

Segal said a "good number" of dates have happened already because of Readme, while several readers who The Post spoke

with expressed curiosity about the app. (She declined to share the number of active users.) Russ Marshalek, 44, set up a Readme account a few weeks ago and has already spoken with several people about "Exit Party," Emily St. John Mandel's new novel that takes place after the collapse of the United States.

"It gives you a starting point: Being on this app, you automatically know that if you match with somebody, you can start talking," Marshalek said, noting that it's a relief compared with standard dating apps. "It makes it a lot more fun. The other apps can kind of be sort of terrifying."

The transactional culture

of those apps is what that Segal and Guler wanted to avoid with Readme. But being seen as a reader on Hinge or Bumble "gives you some street cred," said Nidhi Mandadi, a 27-year-old supply chain analyst who lives in Washington. "You come off a little bit smarter."

A fan of Elena Ferrante's Neapolitan quartet who typically reads upward of 20 books a year, Mandadi went through a phase where she only wanted to date voracious readers. "It meant that they were offline," Mandadi said. "That's very important because I don't want someone that's plugged into their phone all the time."

Finding romance with someone who's unplugged is one of the primary reasons book lovers search for other book lovers. It's also why Nat Esten, 40, believes that singles events at Book Club Bar, a small chain of shops in New York that he co-owns, have been so successful.

"So many of us are trying to push back against the constant serotonin reward of just scrolling and watching videos and constantly being entertained and living in a passive state of always consuming media," Esten said.

He's somewhat of an expert at offline connection: In 2011, Esten met his wife Erin in a book club where they fought over Dave Eggers's "A Heartbreaking Work of Staggering Genius." Fast-forward to 2019, and the couple opened Book Club Bar together.

Several individuals said that dating events at bookstores seemed to help ease anxiety around approaching strangers. Zach Yang, a 38-year-old who worked as a software engineer at Microsoft, wanted to figure out how to get polite, quiet individuals to talk with each other at events. So, he founded Asaya, an app that plans mix-and-mingles at bookstores and uses profiles made in advance to match attendees.

"I've definitely been to other things where it feels like you're at some middle school dance," said Yang. "This feels more like, 'We are coming to somewhere where we already have some common ground.'"

Ralph Tedeschi, who owns Turn the Page Bookshop in Williamsburg, Virginia, said that a couple dropped by the store to tell him they'd met at a speed-dating event there. Now, they're planning on getting married, which Tedeschi thought would be great publicity for the store's events: "See, our speed dating works."

The fuss around dating readers isn't just at evenings planned exclusively for singles. Lost City Books, a fixture of Washington's Adams Morgan neighborhood, doesn't offer speed-dating events. But it's clear to Jonny Teklit, the shop's 28-year-old events director, that romances have bloomed between the bookshelves. "So many first dates happen at the bookstore," he said.

Teklit added that he's seen people buy a stack of books for their dates and bond over shared favorite authors. The Lost City staff has even kicked around the idea of a missed connections board.

"Reading widely exposes you to the breadth of human emotion, human experience," Teklit said. "It allows you to build connections, understand others, understand yourself." All of which is helpful, he believes, in building a lasting relationship.

Sabrina Moorero, a 25-year-old who works at Washington's East City Bookshop and studies library science, hesitates when asked if she would date someone who doesn't read. It's not a non-negotiable. But for Moorero, a future partner would have to provide a level of romance straight from a novel.

"I've read happily ever afters," Moorero said. In books, "I have seen true love, and I won't accept anything less now."

Q&A

Quavo shifts his focus to fatherhood, healing and a sense of purpose

Q&A FROM B1

turn to the melodic instincts that made him a defining voice with the rap group Migos.

The album features appearances from Justin Timberlake, Tyler, The Creator, A\$AP Rocky, Future and Lil Baby.

It also reunites Quavo with Offset after the two repaired their relationship following a public falling out in 2022 and grew closer in the years since the death of Quavo's nephew and fellow Migos member Takeoff.

"QRÔMELIFE" arrives as Quavo and Takeoff's 2022 "Hotel Lobby" performance fuels a flood of AI-generated videos featuring everyone from Barack and Michelle Obama and Spider-Man to soccer stars Erling Haaland and Jude Bellingham — even dogs and cats.

In an interview with the Associated Press, Quavo spoke about the meaning behind "QRÔMELIFE," how Pharrell helped him tune out the algorithm, the viral resurgence of "Hotel Lobby" and a new Migos project.

Remarks have been edited for brevity.

What does "QRÔMELIFE" mean to you? What does that actually look like as a lifestyle?

When it comes to a lifestyle, it's a way of life. When you get up, got to go to work every day, and something happened in your life, but you still have to go hit that nine-to-five, you come in grome.

That's your grome state.

I feel like God put you through those states to make you grome. It's in your chromosomes. ... Everybody go through ups and downs, but what's gonna make you come out strong? What's gonna make you come out grome?

You talked about becoming a father changing "the motive to the mission." How has fatherhood changed you?

You got mouths to feed. You got little people of yours that look up to you. What you gonna do to add or take away from what you didn't learn from your parents, or what you didn't have?

For instance, I didn't have a dad. So me being a father, it's important to me because my dad died when I was four ... I just want to be there the whole step of the way.

What did Pharrell bring out of you while making this album?

Just to challenge my versatility. The "Stir Fry" Quavo, the "Congratulations" Quavo, the "Apeshit" Quavo.

You master that with one of the greatest producers of all time. ... Sometimes the student passes the mentor. But in this case, it's still light-years. I gotta catch up to him from a business standpoint.

"Hotel Lobby" has become this huge AI phenomenon. Did you ever imagine you and Takeoff standing in that orange room, sharing one microphone, would become this viral moment four years later?

I just look at it as God. Losing (Takeoff), I just know that he's in a better place. And then coming through it at a time like this, the week before I'm rolling out my album. ... Then this hit.

It just let me know like, "Bro, I'm here. I'm here with you. I got you."

The viralness of it made me feel like it was something bigger than just a click of a button or internet sensation. Everybody just started doing it, man. From the corporate of the corporate down to the streets.

I'm proud of it. I thank you for keeping my brother and his name alive.

Some fans love the videos. Others feel uncomfortable seeing AI manipulate Takeoff's image after his death. Where is the line for you between celebrating his legacy and going too far?

You can't control it. I can't spend all day trying to find someone that got a phone in their hand or sitting behind a desk. It don't help me mentally. Don't help me emotionally.

When I see it, I just say, "All right," and go by it. You just got to be strong to be able to look at stuff and move on.

You've talked about eventually doing one final Migos project. What would another Migos album mean to you now?

It means the world to me. Obviously, we miss one, and it won't be the same without him.

I've been honored to be his uncle since the age of 3. So just having that relationship with him and knowing how he move and think, I kind of feel like he's



CHRIS PIZZELLO/AP

Quavo says growth is at the heart of the album "QRÔMELIFE," which was released Friday.

in my body.

I talk to him about it. Be like, "I don't want to do it if you ain't got the vision for it."

I know I can take the music that he got and get the Migos album ready. It just depends on how we want to honor the legacy. Because I want this music to benefit us and the estate.

When you and Offset work on Migos music now, how do you make something that still feels like all three of you?

We're cooking right now, and the chemistry is always gonna be there. We always learned to do four, five, six songs dolo and bring them to each other. But right now, we're just dumping the bags and seeing what we can put together.

Has the work you've done through the Rocket Foundation helped you process your own grief?

It helped me just realize that this could happen to anyone. You would feel some type of way, but you don't feel it till it hit home.

And when it hit home, I thought when it got to me everybody is gonna stop. But it still kept going.

You can go into a hole and not do nothing, or you can stand up and try to change and do something.

Seeing other families go through what I go through, I feel like I'm turning into this superhero to be a therapist to a family where I need a therapist.

My girlfriend wrote a book about her cheating ex. My cheating ex is upset.



Carolyn Hax

Adapted from an online discussion.

Dear Carolyn: My marriage ended three years ago because my wife cheated on me and left me for that guy. The

whole experience was devastating, but after wallowing for months, I spent time in therapy, worked on myself and carried on. My ex and I have reached a good place and co-parent our son well. We are not friends, but we are friendly.

Now, I am in love with a beautiful, smart, funny woman whom I've been dating for six months. Because of her, I am happier than I've been since before my marriage ended. She was also cheated on, and we bonded over that experience.

She wrote and published a book about it. My ex Googled her name and read the book and told me she's not happy about the relationship. The book is very brutal about cheaters. My ex says she's worried about what my girlfriend will eventually say to our son about cheaters and about her. I promised I won't let that happen, but my ex says my girlfriend is bitter and toxic and I should steer clear.

I read the book for myself and it's very funny, but she doesn't pull any punches about her hatred and disdain for her ex and all cheaters. Her ex was mean and insulting all through the divorce, so it's understandable. They don't have kids so she's free to hate him all she wants.

Could that book be a sign of toxicity, or is it a great method of coping?

— Happier Than ...

Happier Than ... : Guess what. Your ex-wife doesn't get to decide whom you date.

She doesn't even get an opinion, not even as the amicable co-parent of your children. Unless someone you're dating does or says something that either causes harm to your kids, or presents a credible risk of imminent harm or long-term damage (I think that covers it) — in which case your ex would have standing to speak up.

Your ex probably told herself that's what she was doing, but, nice try. She extrapolated and then projected from opinions expressed in a book and used that as a way to deflect. You were almost too kind just in your willingness to answer her concern — so her proper next



ILLUSTRATION BY NICK GALIFIANAKIS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

move was to drop it, not drop a "should" on you.

Cuz, sorry, ex's complaint that she's uncomfortable with your girlfriend for writing a book about cheaters because ex is a cheater herself does not pass the laugh test. Unless "laugh test" is literally that it makes a deadline-pressured advice columnist laugh out loud at her keyboard, in which case it passes with flying colors so now I'm confusing myself.

Of course she's not happy. You can say this to her, assuming there's more to be said, which there may not be. "Of course you're not happy after reading the book. I wouldn't expect you to be."

But then you can say: "I am not dating her, though, as some kind of hired assassin to kill your standing with our kids." Because you're not, right? You're dating her because she is her own person and you like her a lot and you like yourself with her.

So: "I am dating her because I like her. She and her ex are not the two of us. You and I are our own people and have our own history and have made our own peace."

Then: "If she can't respect that, then of course that will be a problem I have with her, on my own. I won't need support from an external conscience."

End of conversation, no negotiating. As for whether the book is toxicity or coping: It could be either. Or both. Her book could be a snapshot in time, maybe since superseded or outgrown, and possibly even part performance. Or it could be a place

she remains mired and that you soon leave behind.

You have chosen the high road as your kid's co-parent, so if you and your girlfriend are going to reach Month 7, then you must establish that she's willing and able to support that choice 100 percent. No margin for error.

Again — YOU find this out. You don't preemptively walk away because your ex claimed veto power and you're feeling pressured to grant it.

It takes only one person to blow up a good co-parenting relationship, so if she so chooses, your ex could do as much harm as any anti-cheating author-girlfriend could.

But handing over your agency at the first whiff of a threat is not the answer. Putting your kids first is the answer. Once you do that, the rest is trusting your judgment — and calmly insisting your ex do the same.

Re: Ex: Do note the irony that your ex didn't ask for your approval to cheat on you and leave you for the man she's with now. You may want to remind her of that fact if things get rough.

— Anonymous

Anonymous: I know. The laugh test is now the are-you-serious test. "Always cheat with good stepparent material."

Write to Carolyn Hax at tellme@washpost.com. Get her newsletter delivered to your inbox each morning at wapo.st/gethax.

Join the discussion live at noon Fridays at washingtonpost.com/livechats.

‘East of Eden’ is a tale of familial legacy. To tell it, Kazan confronted her own.

KAZAN FROM B1

But it's the sight of a weathered red slipcase — slightly sundyed, bent at the corners — that leads the 43-year-old to exclaim “I know what this is!” and to promptly unleash waterworks. Kazan owns an “East of Eden” first edition, but the original box has long proved elusive — until this moment. Kazan's eyes well up. Her voice cracks. Running her fingers along the 74-year-old cardboard, she cradles the delicate case.

“I love that,” she says. “It's so beautiful.”

Such is Kazan's connection to “East of Eden.” When Netflix announced two years ago that she had been tapped to oversee this latest iteration, she took to social media with a telling acknowledgment: “This has been the work of my last four years and, in some ways, my life.”

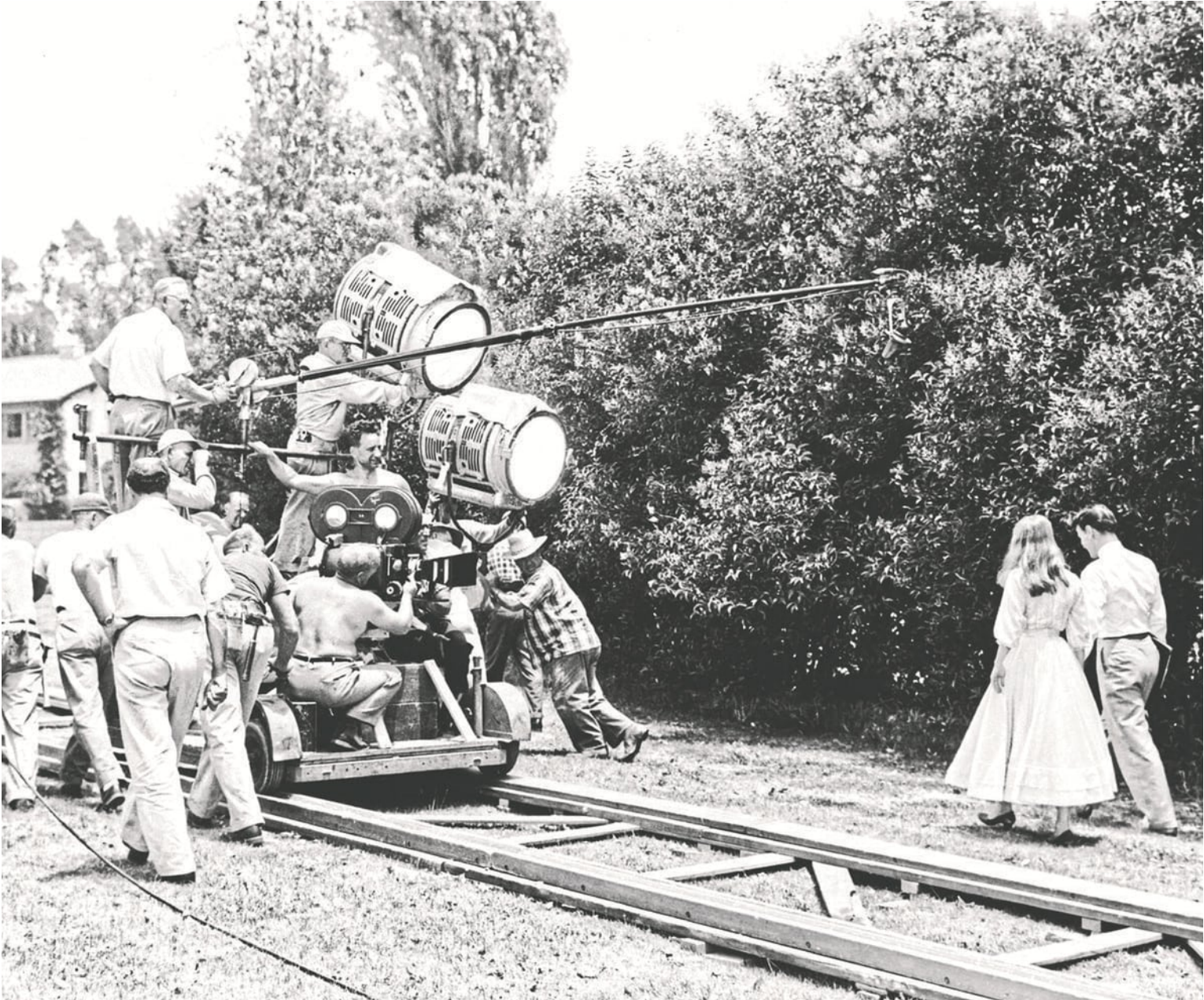
Kazan, who proudly says that her first word was “book,” has long been a literary creature. She made her screenwriting debut with 2012's “Ruby Sparks,” in which she played a love interest magically manifested by a struggling novelist (played by her real-life partner, Paul Dano). Kazan and Dano then collaborated on the screenplay for the contemplative 2018 drama “Wildlife,” adapted from Richard Ford's novel.

Kazan was 15 when she first read “East of Eden.” She was captivated not just by the magnetic characters — the naively idealistic Adam Trask, the callous, complicated Cathy Ames, the approval-craving Cal Trask — but also Steinbeck's authorial intent. The Los Angeles-raised daughter of screenwriters Rob-in Swicord and Nicholas Kazan, she also felt a kinship to the account of East Coast transplants in California's Salinas Valley.

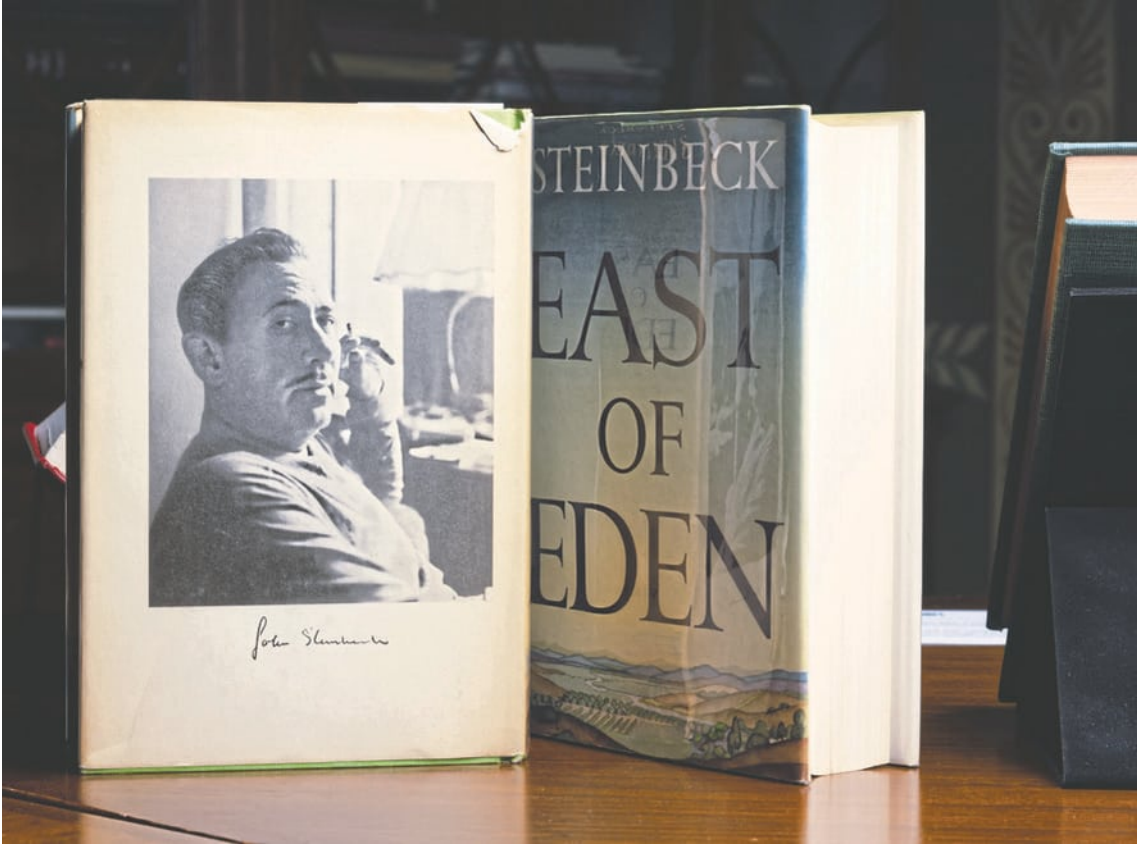
At that point, Kazan had never seen her grandfather's film — the James Dean classic that earned four Oscar nominations — or discussed Steinbeck's intergenerational epic with him. (Elia Kazan died in 2003, when she was 20.) So when her agent reached out two decades later about shepherding a new version to the screen, Kazan seized the opportunity without giving much thought to the legacy she would naturally confront. But as she considered the groundswell of pertinent themes — familial approval, individual agency, the weight of inheritance — Kazan realized there was no avoiding the thorny conversation.

“There's the nature-versus-nurture thing of: Was I drawn to this book because I was the kind of person who was already thinking about inheritance and breaking cycles?” Kazan says. “My first reaction to all of that baggage was, ‘But my love for this book is separate from my grandfather's relationship to it.’ But then I think there's some other, more mature part of my brain that's, like, ‘Yes, that can all be true — and then also there's this very strange tie between me and this material.’”

The result, a seven-part series that started streaming



Kazan's grandfather directed the 1955 film adaptation of “East of Eden” that starred James Dean and earned four Oscar nominations.



A first edition of John Steinbeck's “East of Eden” at the Library of Congress.

Thursday, is a significant feat. Although the film tackled only the final portion of Steinbeck's sprawling Cain and Abel allegory, Kazan adapted it all — tracking the parallel stories of Adam (played by Christopher Abbott) and Cathy (Florence Pugh) and

their sons (Joseph Zada and Joe Anders) from 1862 to 1918. Characters excised from the film — such as Adam's brooding half brother, Charles (Mike Faist), and the code-switching philosopher Lee (Hoon Lee) — are richly depicted here. And the

concept of timshel, a Hebrew word meaning “thou mayest,” is restored as “East of Eden's” ideological core.

“Zoe was interested in the dirty, murky parts that make us all human,” Pugh says. “She wanted to make it feel like these

people were real, and living in a real time.”

Kazan, who wrote every episode and shared show-running duties with Jeb Stuart (“Die Hard”), had her work cut out turning Steinbeck's leisurely, lyrical tome into a propulsive on-screen story. One example: The series' opening scene, when a bloodied Cathy crawls onto Adam and Charles's porch, occurs more than 100 pages into the novel — after Steinbeck takes his time reveling in Californian scene setting and time-hopping reflection.

“I have nothing but love for my king, John Steinbeck, but I do think that the novel has quite a slow start,” Kazan says. “For a novel, that can be a beautiful thing. ... As a dramatist, your job is very different.”

As Kazan points out, Adam — the ostensible protagonist — is a largely passive character defined by his choice *not* to move on after his wife, Cathy, walks out. So she focused on Pugh's Cathy, the character long seen as the novel's cruel antagonist, as the show's “engine of plot.”

“She wasn't wanting to create another simple female villain,” Pugh says. “She wanted to create something deeper and more meaningful than that, and allow for Cathy to be all sorts of things — not just one thing. She's not just evil. She's not just bad. She's not just a monster. We're showing a whole lifetime of Cathy.”

Unpacking Steinbeck's view of Cathy can be unwieldy. In a letter to a family friend, he described her as a “total representative of Satan.” The “East of Eden” narrator flatly calls Cathy a “monster.” Yet that omniscient figure later muses that “it is easy to say she was bad, but there is little meaning unless we know why.” When Kazan combed through the letters Steinbeck wrote to his editor, she saw an author with evolving empathy for his novel's purported villain.

“I do think at a deep, deep level, Steinbeck was a humanist and was trying to get us to look at ourselves and think about ourselves,” Kazan says. “I think sometimes that humanist impulse in the book comes out beautifully and fully in complex ways, and sometimes I think that the kind of misogyny and racism of a mid-century White male viewpoint overrides his intention toward humanism.”

That said, Kazan doesn't shy away from Cathy's despicable deeds. The character can be cold and calculated, violent and vindictive. She's certainly not a feminist, in Kazan's mind. But this “East of Eden” also reveals Cathy as a survivor driven to desperate measures by patriarchal malice. Her unresolved traumas linger. Her mental health issues go untreated. Her concerns aren't heard. Thus, we witness — through Kazan's nuanced writing and Pugh's tortured performance — not a diabolical rise, but a tragic descent.

“Zoe gave me so much confidence in myself and in understanding my worth,” Pugh says. “I'm probably not damaged after shooting it because I had Zoe alongside me, helping me figure out who this woman is and joining in all of the pains that this woman goes through.”

Although Kazan is best known as an actress — her eclectic credits include “Revolutionary Road,” “It's Complicated,” “Olive Kitteridge,” “The Big Sick” and “She Said” — she hasn't performed since a Broadway revival of “Doubt” nearly three years ago. Recently hired by Netflix to tackle another imposing text, Larry McMurtry's 1985 novel “Lonesome Dove,” Kazan can't say when she'll return to the screen or the stage.

Also, as a mother of two, she's pickier about her projects nowadays. “I would love to act more,” she says. “It just really has to be worth my time.”

In other words: Kazan likes to approach her work as a choice, rather than an edict. *Timshel*. That's what led her, after all, to wrestle with her lineage on “East of Eden.”

“I don't want my family's relationship to this material to supersede the actual characters,” she says. “At the same time, it's my deep desire that anyone encountering my show will then walk away thinking about their families and their own relationships to the things that they are trying to change or break free from.”

“So, in that way, it is right and good that I should be asking myself those questions.”

Men are being frank with me on dating apps, and it's making me uncomfortable

Asking Eric
R. ERIC THOMAS

end up fed up and then I do not pursue the apps and therefore do not date for a while.

In the last couple years, I have joined the apps again. I know I am an open-minded person. However, recently the men who I have reached out to and have started communication with will immediately, for example, after one day of messaging back and forth, start informing me what they like to do to women and/or what they like to do to them sexually.

That would be fine in a week or two and/or after a couple dates but within 24 hours of messaging, I feel dumbfounded and feel maybe I need to be a little more lenient and open-minded

in this area.

I just think it's too much too soon. I know it has always been said that men think of sex a lot more than women, however, I just find it surprising that at their ages, their mind is still approaching the topic so soon. Please advise if I am overreacting.

— Dating Dilemma

Dating: You are not overreacting at all. For some people, these kinds of conversations early in a dating app conversation would be no problem. But they do pose a problem for you and that's important. You don't have to change your ways or engage in conversations that make you uncomfortable.

If you encounter a man who does this and you decide you want to give him another chance, you can always tell him, “this line of conversation has gotten too intimate for now.

Can we reset?” Ideally, he would recognize where he went wrong and course correct.

But the fact that these men are jumping right to sex talk without any indication on your end that's welcome indicates they just might not be matches. There are a lot of fish in the sea. It might stress you less to just unmatch and move on to someone else or even look into apps that place a few more steps between matching and conversation.

Dear Eric: My husband is one of three brothers and a sister. Their mother died when they were young. When their dad passed the youngest brother professed the need for us all to stay in touch.

This brother and his wife live 15 minutes from the other brothers, but they never reach out. They attend some family gatherings but never suggest

a get-together or even call to check in.

When their sister passed away there were two memorials. They attended the first one but ghosted everyone for the second one. Emails and text messages were sent in advance. The messages were “read.” My husband even called his brother that day with no answer. No call back.

Recently we decided to get together for lunch. We texted them and again the message was “read” but we got no response.

We had to learn of a death in the wife's family by reading it in the local newspaper and of her hospitalization from her social media post. I understand privacy when you're sick, but a brief message would have been appreciated. Instead, we see a social media post saying, “as most of you know I spent my birthday in the hospital ...”

I'm offended by their disrespect for the family. My feelings

are hurt for their sister and her kids.

The brothers brush it off so why am I upset? Am I unjustified?

— Sensitive Sister-in-Law

Sister-in-Law: You're part of this family, too, so you're not totally off base. But it does seem that your husband and his brothers have reached a point of accepting their youngest sibling's style of communication and ability to show up (or lack thereof).

There may be other reasons for this behavior on his part, rooted in his background. Or your husband and his brothers simply may not put as much stock in family connectedness.

All of that is fine for them. But if it bothers you, it's worth working through. There isn't a way for the brother to go back and attend the second memorial, so while your feelings are

hurt on behalf of the sister's kids, it may be best to redirect your energies to showing up for them wherever they are in their grieving process.

Think about what you want from this brother and his wife. An apology? A change in behavior? And then consider, based on past instances, whether this is something they're likely to provide.

You may be justified in being upset, and you could say something to them if you want. But your time may be better spent cultivating relationships with the people who do show up for the rest of the family.

Send questions to R. Eric Thomas at eric@askingeric.com or P.O. Box 22474, Philadelphia, PA 19110. Follow him on Instagram and sign up for his weekly newsletter at erictthomas.com.

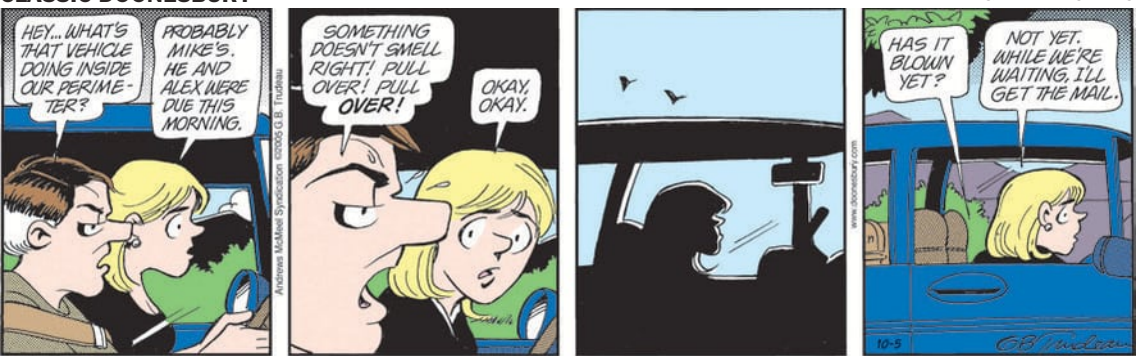
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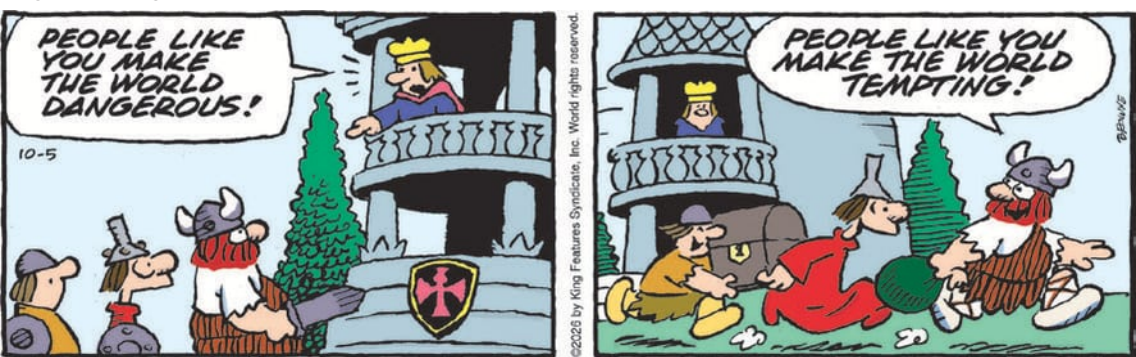
RHYMES WITH ORANGE



LIO



HAGAR THE HORRIBLE



BLONDIE



BREWSTER ROCKIT: SPACE GUY!



PEARLS BEFORE SWINE



PICKLES



AGNES



WUMO



CRABGRASS



MARK TRAIL



MOTHER GOOSE & GRIMM



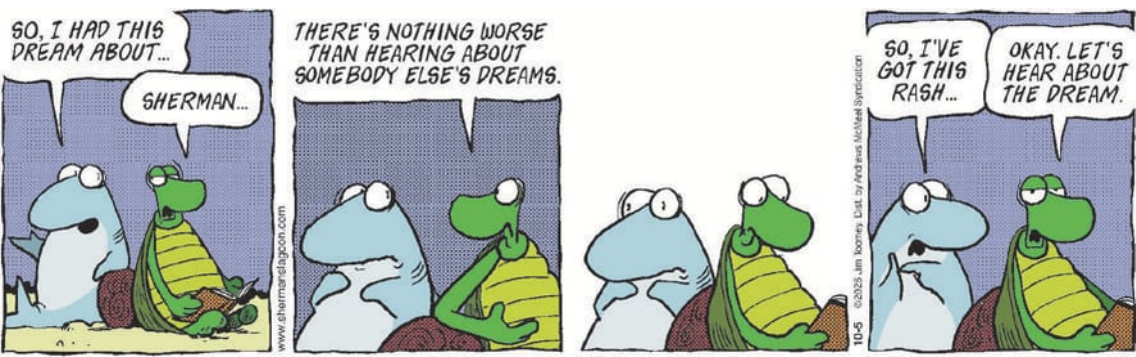
BALDO



SALLY FORTH



SHERMAN'S LAGOON



CURTIS



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PATRICK McDONNELL

ZITS

JERRY SCOTT & JIM BORGMAN

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STEENZ

JUDGE PARKER

FRANCESCO MARCIULIANO & MIKE MANLEY

FRAZZ

JEFF MALLETT

SIX CHIX

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GARFIELD

JIM DAVIS

BARNEY AND CLYDE

WEINGARTENS & CLARK

DUSTIN

STEVE KELLEY & JEFF PARKER

FLASH GORDON

DAN SCHKADE

PRICKLY CITY

MARSHALL RAMSEY

LOOSE PARTS

DAVE BLAZEK

NON SEQUITUR

WILEY

BABY BLUES

RICK KIRKMAN & JERRY SCOTT

WALLACE THE BRAVE

WILL HENRY

SPEED BUMP

DAVE COVERLY

DENNIS THE MENACE

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BILL HOLBROOK

BEETLE BAILEY

GREG, BRIAN & NEAL WALKER

FAMILY CIRCUS

BIL KEANE

REPLY ALL LITE

DONNA A. LEWIS

10-5

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“Daddy, is this the birthday when we go on Social Security or the next one?”

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10-5

10/5/26	7:00	7:30	8:00	8:30	9:00	9:30	10:00	10:30	11:00
4.1 WRC (NBC)	• NBCNe..	• News4..	• The Voice				• Line of Fire		• NEWS..
4.2 WRC (IND)	King	King	King	King	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	George
5.1 WTTG (Fox)	• Fox 5	• TMZ	• Name That Tune	• The Weakest Link	• Fox 5 at 10		• Fox 5 at 10		• Fox 5
7.1 WJLA (ABC)	• Wheel	• Jeopardy!	• R.J. Decker	• R.J. Decker	• R.J. Decker		• R.J. Decker		• News
9.1 WUSA (CBS)	• Inside	• ET	• FBI (SP)	• CIA (SP)	• Harlan (SP)		• 9 News		
14.1 WFDC (UNI)	• Rosa		• Sabor a ti, entre hi	• Tierra de amor y	• Corazón de oro		• Noticias		
20.1 WDCA (MNTV)	• Family	• Family	• Fox 5 News	• Fox 5 Live Zone	• Chicago P.D.		• Chicago Fire		• Chicago
22.1 WMPT (PBS)	• Direct	• Chesap..	• Antiques Roadshow	• Antiques Roadshow	• Antiques Roadshow		• Independent Lens		
26.1 WETA (PBS)	• PBS News Hour		• Antiques Roadshow	• Sig. Dish WETAAr..	• Independent Lens		• Independent Lens		
32.1 WHUT (PBS)	• White	• Chip In	• Workin' In The	• Legacy Series	• Here	• Decades	• BBCNe..		
50.1 WDCW (CW)	• Sheldon	• Friends	• Private Eyes (P)	• Law (SP)	• DC News Now		• Seinfeld		
66.1 WPXW (ION)	• Chicago P.D.		• Chicago P.D.	• Chicago P.D.	• Chicago P.D.		• Chicago		
A&E	Live PD: Great.		Live PD: Great.	• Live PD: Great.	• Live PD: Great.		• Live PD: Great.		LivePD
AMC	(5:45) Movie: I Know What You Did Last S...		Movie: Final Destination stalks the survivors of a doomed airliner.	★★ (2000) Death stalks the survivors of a doomed airliner.	★★ (2003) Movie: Final Destination 2		★★ (2003)		
Animal Planet	Last Frontier		Last Frontier	Last Frontier	Last Frontier		Alaska		
BET	To Be Announced		The Equalizer	Diarra From Detroit	Love You to Death		Martin		
Bravo	Below Deck Mediterranean		Below Deck Mediterranean	(:15) Still Flipping Out	(:15) Watch ..	(:45) The Real Housewives			
Cartoon Network	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy		Rick Morty
CNN	E. B. OutFront (Live)		Cooper 360 (Live)	The Source (Live)	CNN News. (Live)		Laura		
Comedy Central	The Office	The Office	The Office	The Office	Office	Office	DailyShow		
Discovery	Contraband: Seized		Contraband: Seized	Behind Bars	Behind Bars		120 Hours		
Disney	Big City	Big City	Phineas	Phineas	Vampirina	Phineas	Kiff		Ladybug
E!	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men		Dolly Part
ESPN	(6:00) Monday Night Countdown (Live)		Kickoff (Live) (:15) NFL Football Saints (Live)	NFL Football Atlanta Falcons at New Orleans Saints (Live)			Monday		
ESPN2	SportsCenter		Kickoff (Live) (:15) NFL Football Atlanta Falcons at New Orleans Saints (Live)	Monday Night Football with Peyton and Eli: Atlanta Falcons at New Orleans Saints (Live)			Monday		
Food Network	BeatBobby	Halloween	Baking Championship	Halloween Baking	SweetDe..	SweetDe..	Halloween		
Fox News	Ingraham (Live)		Jesse Watters (Live)	Hannity (Live)	Gutfeld!		Fox News		
Freeform	(5:30) Movie: Ghostbusters II (1989)		Movie: Ghostbusters II (1989)	★★ (2016) Four women battle mischievous ghosts in New York.			The 700 Club		
FX	(6:00) Movie: Mission: Impossible (2018)		Impossible: Fallout	Sunny	Movie: Uncharted	★★ (2022) Two treasure hunters try to recover a lost fortune.			
Hallmark	(6:00) Movie: Autumn in the Vineyard (2016)		Movie: Roadhouse Romance (2021) Sparks fly between a lieutenant and a TV director.	Golden Girls	Golden Girls	Golden Girls			
Hallmark M&M	(6:00) Movie: Flower Shop Mystery: Mum'...		The Cases of Mystery Lane	Murder, She Wrote		Murder ...			
HBO	(:20) Last Week To.		Lanterns	Youth	Movie: Mission: Impossible	★★ (1996) (P)			
HGTV	Botched Homes		Botched Homes	Hunters	Hunters	Hunters	House		
History	History's-Mysteries		History's-Mysteries	History's-Mysteries	(:05) NCIS	(:05) NCIS	Mysteries		
Lifetime	NCIS		NCIS	NCIS	(:05) NCIS	(:05) NCIS			
MASN	Sports	She's	2025 Perfect		Bensinger	Carolina	Pulse/P..		
Monumental	NHL Hockey			DC	Hometown	Wizards Classics			
MSNBC	The Weeknight (Live)		All in with Chr. (Live)	The Rachel (Live)	Last Word (Live)		The 11th		
MTV	Ridiculous	Ridiculous	Ridiculous	Ridiculous	Ridiculous	Ridiculous	Ridiculous		
Nat'l Geographic	Construction Fails		Construction Fails	Construction Fails	Construction Fails		Big Bang		Big Bang
Nickelodeon	Movie: The Addams Family	★★ (2019)	Cuomo	On Balance	Katie Pavlich	JesseWeb			
NWSN	Vargas Report		Movie: Miss Congeniality	★★ (2000) A clumsy FBI agent goes undercover at a beauty pageant.	To Be Announced				
Paramount	(6:00) Movie: Legally Blonde	★★ (2001)	Movie: Molly's Game	★★★ (2017)	MobLand	Movie: The Equalizer 2	★★ (2018)		
Paramount+Sho	(6:30) Movie: Ghostbusters	★★ (2016) Four women battle mischievous ghosts in New York.			Movie: Halloween	★★ (2018)			
Syfy	Movie: Ghostbusters	★★ (2016) Four women battle mischievous ghosts in New York.							
TBS	(5:00) MLB Baseball		MLB Baseball	TBA at Tampa Bay Rays (Live)					
TCM	(6:30) Movie: Rebound	★★ (1931)	Movie: Libeled Lady	★★★★ (1936) An editor tries to get an heirress to drop a lawsuit.	Movie: I Love You Again	★★★ (1940)			
TLC	90 Day: Hunt		90 Day: Hunt for Love	(:05) 90 Day: Hunt	(:05) 90 Day: Hunt	(:05) Sister			
TNT	(5:45) Movie: The Equalizer 3 (2023)		Movie: Independence Day	★★★ (1996) A select group of survivors fight against an alien invasion.	Movie: I, Robot (2...				
Travel	(6:00) Mysteries- Unk.		Mysteries of the Unknown		Mysteries of the Unknown				
TruTV	(5:00) MLB Baseball		MLB Baseball	TBA at Tampa Bay Rays (Live)					
TV Land	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	(:10) King		
TV One	CosbySh..	CosbySh..	Fatal Attraction	Fatal Attraction	For My Man	For My M..			
USA Network	Law & Order: SVU		Law & Order: SVU	Law & Order: SVU	Law & Order: SVU	Pigeon			
VH1	Chris	Chris	Movie: Fist Fight	★★ (2017)	Movie: Taxi	★ (2004)			
WNCB	Paid Prog.	Paid Prog.	7News at..	Paid Prog.	National	WJLANe..	Paid Prog.	National	

LEGEND: **Bold** indicates new or live programs ♦ High Definition
Movie Ratings (from TMS) ★★ Excellent ★★ Good ★★ Fair ★ Poor No stars: not rated

HOROSCOPE

BIRTHDAY | OCTOBER 5: You are sensual, optimistic, admirable and fair. You're also charming and fun-loving. This is a year of learning and teaching. Take time for reflection. You might renew your spiritual beliefs.

Moon Alert: There are no restrictions to shopping or important decisions today. The Moon is in Leo.

ARIES
(March 21-April 19)
Social plans are unpredictable today. Likewise, sports events and playful activities with children are potentially accident-prone. Be vigilant! Nevertheless, this is a powerful day to make creative advances in the arts, financial speculation and the entertainment world.

TAURUS
(April 20-May 20)
Because your home routine might be interrupted today, get dressed and stock the fridge. Be patient with family members. Once the dust settles, a conversation with someone older (perhaps a parent) might give some structure and direction to things.

GEMINI
(May 21-June 20)
Pay attention to what you say and what you do today because this is a mildly accident-prone day for you. Keep your eyes open. On the upside, you might have some brilliant ideas because you can think outside the box. Later in the day, solid, practical solutions might occur to you.

CANCER
(June 21-July 22)
Keep an eye on your money and possessions today to protect them

from loss, theft or damage, because something unexpected might impact what you own. On the other hand (you have different rings), you might have some innovative moneymaking ideas that impress someone.

LEO
(July 23-Aug. 22)
This is a tricky day. The Moon is in your sign lined up with Mars, Uranus and Saturn, which means you'll feel ambitious, powerful, impulsive and yet ready to give things a sober, second thought. Quite a mixture! Go slowly, because this is also an accident-prone day. Expect some great moments!

VIRGO
(Aug. 23-Sept. 22)
Very likely, this is a restless day for you. It could be because of money and possessions, because these things are on your mind. However, someone in a position of authority – a parent, boss or the police – might catch you off guard today. Be alert.

LIBRA
(Sept. 23-Oct. 22)
A friend or a member of a group might surprise you today. Or, alternatively, you might surprise them. Travel plans and issues related to medicine, the law and publishing are unpredictable. Fortunately, a discussion with a partner or spouse might anchor things for you in a solid way.

SCORPIO
(Oct. 23-Nov. 21)
You're high-viz today. People notice you. Meanwhile, something unexpected might occur that calls attention to you. You might have a clever idea or something unexpected occurs. Stay light on your feet. You're ready to work hard.

SAGITTARIUS
(Nov. 22-Dec. 21)
Travel plans might be interrupted today, along with appointments related to medical, legal or educational issues. Give yourself extra time so you have wiggle room to deal with the unexpected. You might have an important discussion about something related to your kids, a vacation or an artistic project.

CAPRICORN
(Dec. 22-Jan. 19)
Keep an eye on banking issues and anything to do with shared property, inheritances, taxes, debt and anything you own jointly with someone else. This will be a focus today. Something unexpected could occur. A family member might help you solidify things.

AQUARIUS
(Jan. 20-Feb. 18)
Patience will be your best friend today, because important discussions with partners, close friends and spouses are tricky. You might have to deal with someone who is a bit aggressive, even unpredictable. Social plans might change. Be vigilant about your kids. Something looks "serious."

PISCES
(Feb. 19-March 20)
Your job routine might be interrupted today, especially if you work from home. You're motivated to be productive, definitely! You can use this energy to make some long-range, practical plans for the future. Meanwhile, someone older or more experienced might have advice for you, probably related to earnings or your possessions.

— Georgia Nicols

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BRIDGE

N-S VULNERABLE
NORTH
♠ A Q 4
♥ 4 2
♦ A 7 3 2
♣ A 6 4 2

WEST
♠ J 9
♥ Q J 10 6 5
♦ Q 8
♣ Q 10 8 5

EAST
♠ 10 8 5 3
♥ K 9 8 7
♦ 10 9 5
♣ 9 7

SOUTH (D)
♠ K 7 6 2
♥ A 3
♦ K J 6 4
♣ K J 3

The bidding:

SOUTH **WEST** **NORTH** **EAST**
1 NT Pass 3 NT All Pass
Opening lead — ♥ Q

“If at first you don’t succeed, rummage through the wastebasket in a desperate attempt to find the instructions.” — Cy the Cynic

The problem some players have as declarer is that if at first they don’t succeed, that’s the end of it all. Against today’s 3NT, West led the queen of hearts, and South took the ace and wanted the next eight tricks. He took the A-Q of spades and led a third spade to his king. A 3-3 break would have seen him home, but West pitched a club.

Declarer next led a club to dummy’s ace and a club to his jack. Alas, West produced the queen, and the defense took four hearts and the 10 of spades Down two.

South didn’t succeed at first — or at second. He should have tried playing third. After the spades fail to break, South should take the A-K of diamonds. (He has eight diamonds and seven clubs, so the queen of diamonds is more likely to fall.)

When West’s queen appears,

South makes an overtrick. If instead East-West played low, South would finesse in clubs.

DAILY QUESTION

You hold:
♠ A Q 4 ♥ 4 2
♦ A 7 3 2 ♣ A 6 4 2

You open one diamond, and your partner bids one spade. The opponents pass. What do you say?

ANSWER: To bid two clubs next would be a clear error. You would suggest a two-suited hand when your actual hand is balanced, and your partner would correctly return to two diamonds with a weak responding hand and 5-4-2-2 pattern. Raise to two spades. Like some players, I would have preferred to open one club.

— Frank Stewart

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SUDOKU

Complete the grid so that every row, column and 3x3 box contains every digit from 1 to 9 inclusively.

3		4	2	6				
		2		8	1	3		4
1	6	9		7		2		
8	7	3						
6				4				9
						5	3	2
		8		3		1	6	5
5	3		1	9	6		2	
				2	8	3		7

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★☆☆☆☆

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PREVIOUS SUDOKU SOLUTION

5	3	8	9	4	6	2	7	1
6	2	4	8	1	7	9	3	5
9	7	1	3	2	5	8	4	6
2	4	3	7	9	1	6	5	8
1	5	7	2	6	8	3	9	4
8	9	6	5	3	4	1	2	7
7	1	2	4	8	9	5	6	3
3	6	5	1	7	2	4	8	9
4	8	9	6	5	3	7	1	2

SCRABBLEGRAMS

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A1E1D2R1L1B3D2

RACK 1

E1O1Y4T1R1M3B3

RACK 2

A1A1E1Z1N1D2C3

RACK 3

E1I1U1S1C3F4F4

RACK 4

PAR SCORE 165-175
BEST SCORE 229

FOUR RACK TOTAL
TIME LIMIT: 20 MIN

DIRECTIONS: Make a 2- to 7-letter word from the letters in each row. Add points of each word, using scoring directions at right. Finally, 7-letter words get 50-point bonus. "Blanks" used as any letter have no point value. All the words are in the Official SCRABBLE® Players Dictionary, 5th Edition. SOLUTION TOMORROW

For more information on tournaments and clubs, email NASPA-NorthAmericanSCRABBLEPlayersAssociation@scrabbleplayers.org. Visit our website - www.scrabbleplayers.org. For puzzle inquiries contact scrgrams@gmail.com

10-05

JUMBLECROSSWORDS

by David L. Hoyt

10-5-26

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

CLUE

ACROSS

ANSWER

1. Show up

5. Home of Mumbai

6. Asian river

7. Bureau

EPPRAA
DINAI
NSDIU
EAYCGN

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

CLUE

DOWN

ANSWER

1. Creature

2. Creamy dessert

3. Desert

4. Upscale

AAIMLN
PGNUIDD
BNAOADN
SCYLAS

BONUS

CLUE: It was founded in 1821 on land selected for a new state capital.

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

11

12

How to play

Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.

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Send comments to D.L.Hoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com

LA TIMES CROSSWORD

By Amanda Cook

ACROSS

- Tiny trims
- “Tär” Oscar nominee Blanchett
- Jar topper
- Art studio stand
- Chocolate-flavored latte
- Fuss
- Playful back-and-forth
- Church seating
- Messy person
- Word with ocean or eye
- Skim through
- Wear away
- Sprawling property
- Workstation option since the 1980s
- Rainbow maker
- Attempted
- Bath rug
- Old hoops org.
- Genetic material
- Polo shirt, e.g.
- Power strip switch
- Not exactly, informally
- Ticket pickup location
- Battery terminals
- Punchiness
- See 58-Across
- Crown for a prom queen
- Wanes
- With 51-Across, dance accessory for Fred Astaire
- Time off that may coincide with a new calendar year, or what can be found in 16-, 26-, and 44-Across
- Connecticut Ivy Leagueur
- Derive
- Possibly dangerous
- Cozy burrow
- Composer Stravinsky
- River mammal

1	2	3	4	5		6	7	8	9		10	11	12
13						14					15		
16					17						18		
19					20				21				
				22	23			24	25				
26	27	28					29						
30						31							
32				33	34	35		36			37	38	39
				40				41		42	43		
44	45	46					47	48					
49						50							
51					52	53				54	55	56	57
58					59					60			
61					62				63				
64					65				66				

The Washington Post

SPORTS

MONDAY, OCTOBER 5, 2026

EZ SU

C

Titans	18	Patriots	29	Jets	12	Jaguars	22	Cardinals	24	Rams	24	Packers	17	Cowboys	34	Chiefs	30	Broncos	14	Chargers	23	Lions		Falcons	8:15 p.m.
Ravens	24	Bills	26	Bears	23	Bengals	17	Giants	36	Eagles	20	Bucs	14	Texans	30	Raiders	27	49ers	24	Seahawks	30	Panthers	late	Saints	ESPN



COLTS 30, COMMANDERS 13: Quarterback Marcus Mariota, filling in for Jayden Daniels, reaggravated an MCL injury in his right knee in Sunday's loss in London.

GEOFF BURKE/MAGN IMAGES

Jackson exits as Ravens hang on

RAVENS 24, TITANS 18

BY BRIAN WACKER
Baltimore Sun

Lamar Jackson slipped a high-top sneaker onto his right foot. His left one was bound for something more concerning: a walking boot.

The two-time NFL MVP hobbled out of M&T Bank Stadium late Sunday afternoon.

The Baltimore Ravens (3-1) won, holding on for a 24-18 victory over the listless Tennessee Titans (0-4), who, through four games, have fielded one of the NFL's worst offenses. They also lost their quarterback, with Jackson limping off the field near the end of the second quarter with an ankle injury and not returning following a sack by defensive lineman Jermaine Johnson II.

Coach Jesse Minter did not have an update afterward.

"We don't know enough about it right now," he said. "We'll have to see where that's at. I thought Snoop [Huntley] came in and ran the operation in a way that allowed us to get the win, and that's most important."

For the day, it was.

Baltimore's victory ended a four-game home losing streak that dated back to Nov. 23 of last year. It was also closer than it should have been against a winless Tennessee.

Like the gray clouds that hung over the field on a soggy afternoon, bigger worries loom.

In addition to losing Jackson, cornerback Marlon Humphrey (calf), tight end Durham Smythe (Achilles tendon) and right guard Andrew Vorhees (foot) were all injured. Left tackle Ronnie Stanley played but is dealing with a toe injury that has lingered since the first half of Week 1 and already cost him one game this season.

"It's very difficult, but it is what it is," Stanley said of the injuries. "Adversity hits, and you've got to trust the next guy who's available. That's the message that Coach Minter has given to us throughout the season. Everyone in that room that made the team, [practice] squad, everyone, has to be ready at any time."

"Unfortunately, those injuries happen throughout the season, but we expect those guys to pick

SEE RAVENS ON C5

Ravens at Falcons
Sunday, 8:20 p.m., NBC

London falling

Daniels will rejoin a Commanders team that's hurting. Can he succeed?

BY TASHAN REED

LONDON — Standing in front of a Washington Commanders backdrop at a fan event in a crowded British bar, owner Josh Harris called quarterback Jayden Daniels a "warrior" multiple times. The comparisons between the gridiron and the battlefield are overused, but it felt fitting given what Daniels has gone through — and what he has decided to endure.

No one would have blamed Daniels had he decided to undergo season-ending surgery after suffering the second dislocation of his left elbow Sept. 20. But after meeting with specialists, the third-year quarterback elected to forgo a procedure.

Then, just 10 days after his elbow bent the wrong way — for the second time in less than a year — Daniels was practicing. The bulky brace on his left arm looked straight out of "The Terminator." It drew a lot of jokes on social media, but it also drove home what he's willing to play through.

"He's an incredibly important part of our franchise moving forward," Harris said. "He was right back up and right back at it. He's a warrior."

Daniels didn't play in the Commanders' 30-13 loss to the Indianapolis Colts on Sunday at Tottenham Hotspur Stadium, but he's trending toward suiting up against the visiting New York Giants next weekend. Coach Dan Quinn

SEE DANIELS ON C6

Down to its third quarterback, Washington collapses in loss across the pond

BY TASHAN REED

LONDON — There are only so many injuries a team can incur at football's most important position. In their 30-13 loss to the Indianapolis Colts on Sunday, the Washington Commanders ran out of experienced quarterbacks.

In just four games, the Commanders (1-3) have turned to three players under center. They were already without starting quarterback Jayden Daniels because of a dislocated left elbow. Although Daniels returned to practice Wednesday, just 10 days after suffering the injury, he was ruled out Friday. That set up Marcus Mariota, who led Washington to an upset of the Seattle Seahawks last weekend, to start his second consecutive game.

ond consecutive game.

Mariota's appearance would be short-lived, however, as he suffered a right knee injury while being sacked midway through the first quarter at Tottenham Hotspur Stadium. He was ruled out for the rest of the contest against the Colts (2-2) at halftime.

Stepping in for Mariota, rookie Athan Kaliakmanis made his NFL debut. Washington was leading 6-0 when Mariota got injured, but it would fall behind by halftime and never lead again.

Without Mariota, the Commanders'

SEE COMMANDERS ON C6

Week 5: Giants at Commanders
Sunday, 1 p.m., Fox

PERSPECTIVE

Turns out it is 'Same Old Maryland'

Big Ten victory drought magnifies monotony for Locksley's Terrapins

BY MICHAEL HOWES
Baltimore Sun

It's been exactly one year since Maryland blew a 20-point lead against Washington in its Big Ten home opener and lost, 24-20. That defeat started an eight-game losing streak to end the season.

And after Saturday's 48-23 loss at Nebraska, the question is: What has changed since then?

Really, not much. At the time, the trials and tribulations of a young 2025 team with a freshman quarterback were understandable. Growing pains are natural. Then came

Nebraska at home the next week.

Maryland led by a touchdown in the fourth quarter and still lost, 34-31. Afterward, Coach Michael Locksley had the bravado to say this:

"Nobody can watch what we did today and feel like it's the 'Same Old Maryland.' I don't see that."

It's worth wondering what, exactly, he saw.

Flash forward one year later. Maryland went into Lincoln and lost to the Cornhuskers in worse fashion than it had a year before.

The Terps haven't won a Big Ten football game in 379 days. Since Locksley made those comments, Maryland has gone just 2-9, with its only two wins coming against non-Power Four opponents Hampton and Connecticut.

So, can people feel like it's the same old Maryland now?

Think so.

Locksley made a point at the beginning of the season that the Terps would "work more and talk a little less."

"Our work needs to be louder than our words," Locksley said at fall media day.

Makes sense. Maryland returned plenty of talent, including sophomore quarterback Malik Washington. Let the results do the talking. Locksley certainly exuded confidence entering the season, even if he wouldn't define what success would look like.

"I'll let you guys add it up at the end and answer those types of questions," he said Sept. 1.

Well, five games in, it's not the end. But it's a decent sample size. Let's add it up.

SEE MARYLAND ON C7

Maryland at Ohio State
Saturday, 4:15 p.m., BTN



STEVEN BRANSCOMBE/GETTY IMAGES

Terps QB Malik Washington has thrown six interceptions in two weeks with three returned for scores.

SPOTLIGHT: COLLEGE FOOTBALL

Victory over Florida lifts Missouri in AP rankings

BY ERIC OLSON

Missouri made a big jump to No. 14 in the Associated Press top 25 on Sunday following its rout of Florida, while the Gators dropped eight spots to No. 16 and were replaced by LSU in the top 10.

Texas will go into Saturday's Red River Rivalry game against Oklahoma as the No. 1 team for the fourth straight week. The rest of the top five stood pat, with Georgia, Notre Dame, Miami and Ohio State following the Longhorns.

Texas received 61 of the 70 first-place votes from the media voting panel, one fewer than last week. Georgia, whose 24-point win over Vanderbilt was its closest of the season, got six first-place votes. Miami, which beat Clemson by four touchdowns on the road, got two.

No. 6 Alabama and No. 7 Indiana flip-flopped, with the Hoosiers receiving the remaining first-place vote. BYU moved up two rungs to No. 8, Mississippi remained No. 9 and LSU went up one spot to No. 10.

Missouri's 11-spot promotion

from No. 25 was the second-biggest jump by a team this season following Florida's 13-spot rise last week. The Tigers sent the Gators plummeting with their 45-17 home win in Columbia and have their highest ranking since Oct. 5, 2025.

Iowa fell six spots to No. 20 after a 17-point home loss to Ohio State and SMU slipped three to No. 24 after an uninspired home win over Boston College.

Pittsburgh made its season debut in the poll at No. 25 and Kentucky, No. 24 last week, dropped out.

The Panthers are 5-0 for the second time in three seasons and ranked for the first time since last November after holding off Virginia Tech, 35-33, on Friday night. The bad news: Pittsburgh will go forward without quarterback Mason Heintschel, who tore his ACL against the Hokies and will miss the rest of the season.

Kentucky won, 35-34, in overtime at South Carolina after erasing a 17-0 deficit. The Wildcats are the unranked team receiving the most votes, two points behind Pittsburgh.

— Associated Press

A Paris repeat



Daryz, left, ridden by Mickael Barzalona, prevailed in the Prix de l'Arc de Triomphe on Sunday for the second consecutive year.



Jamal Roberts and the Tigers were Gator chomping throughout Saturday's home win, which moved them to No. 14 in the AP poll.

TELEVISION AND RADIO	
NFL	
8:15 p.m.	Atlanta at New Orleans • ESPN, WJFK (106.7 FM), WTEM (980 AM)
MLB PLAYOFFS — DIVISION ROUND	
5 p.m.	Game 2: Chicago White Sox at Cleveland • TBS
8 p.m.	Game 2: New York Yankees at Tampa Bay • TBS
NHL	
7 p.m.	Philadelphia at Tampa Bay • NHL Network
SOCCER	
Noon	UEFA Nations League, group stage: Latvia at Cyprus • Fox Sports 2
2:45 p.m.	UEFA Nations League, group stage: Turkey at Italy • Fox Sports 2
6 p.m.	Concacaf Nations League, group stage: El Salvador at Martinique • Fox Sports 2
8 p.m.	Concacaf Nations League, group stage: Suriname at Guatemala • Fox Sports 2
10 p.m.	Concacaf Nations League, group stage: Jamaica at Honduras • Fox Sports 2
TENNIS	
11 p.m.	ATP: China Open and Japan Open, finals; WTA: China Open, early rounds • Tennis Channel

The Washington Post

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SOCCER

Luvanga's first goal lifts Spirit in Houston

Clara Luvanga scored the winner in the 84th minute as the Washington Spirit took down the host Houston Dash on Sunday night.

It was Luvanga's first NWSL goal in just her second match. Tara Rudd and Sofia Cantore also scored for Washington, which is undefeated in its past six road games.

Miljana Ivanovic had a brace for Houston, which has lost five of seven.

The Spirit (15-8-4) has 49 points through 27 matches, good for third in the 16-team NWSL. First-place Gotham FC is at 55 points, while the San Diego Wave has 49. ...

Gonçalo Ramos is helping Portugal to forget all about Cristiano Ronaldo, while Greece took more points off Jürgen Klopp and Germany in the Nations League.

Ramos fired Portugal to a 2-1 win over Norway in Porto to keep the Portuguese perfect in Group A4 with four wins — enough to book their place in the quarterfinals.

Ronaldo was involved in Portugal's opening Nations League game, where he was replaced by Ramos in a 1-0 win over Wales, and hasn't played since. The veteran left the squad after watching the second game from the substitutes' bench, and Portugal has showed no ill effects from his departure.

Greece, which celebrated its first win over Germany last week, almost did it again. Ivan Jovanovic's team held Klopp's side to a scoreless draw in Thessaloniki.

Both teams wore black armbands as Ireland and Israel drew, 1-1, in a bad-tempered match in Backa Topola, Serbia.

TENNIS

Latest upset in Beijing sends Sabalenka home

Second-ranked Aryna Sabalenka was bundled out in the third round of the China Open in straight sets by the Czech Republic's Nikola Pietrangeli.

In the men's draw, Novak Djokovic maintained his perfect record at the Beijing tournament with a 4-6, 6-4, 6-4 victory over U.S. Open champion Alexander Zverev in the quarterfinals.

No. 34 Bartunkova defeated the four-time Grand Slam champion, 6-4, 6-3, in just over 90 minutes, leaving the tournament without its two top seeds in the first week. Newly crowned world No. 1 Elena Rybakina was ousted Saturday.

Sabalenka, who was denied a three-peat at the U.S. Open last month by Rybakina, squandered five break points in the first set as her historic struggles in Beijing continued. The Belarusian has never progressed past the quarterfinals at the event.

Bartunkova will next play 24-year-old Sinja Kraus of Austria, who earlier defeated Dayana Yastremska, 6-1, 6-4.

Fifth-ranked Mirra Andreeva eased into the fourth round with a 6-4, 6-1 victory over Polina Kudermetova.

This year's French Open winner fired six aces and took five of her seven break point opportunities to overwhelm her Uzbek opponent in just 68 minutes.

Djokovic is bidding to win his seventh China Open title and is now 32-0 in Beijing, eclipsing Rafael Nadal's 31-0 start at the French Open for the best start at a tour-level tournament in the Open era.

Djokovic will next face Daniil Medvedev in the semifinals.

Earlier, Hubert Hurkacz beat Karen Khachanov, 7-6 (7-2), 6-2, and will face Alex de Minaur, who beat Andrey Rublev, 1-6, 6-2, 6-3, in the other semi. ...

Top-seeded Carlos Alcaraz advanced to the semifinals of the Japan Open, continuing his strong return from a four-month wrist injury layoff.

Alcaraz moved into the final four in Tokyo after his opponent Denis Shapovalov was forced to retire with a hip injury during their quarterfinal match. The defending champion was leading 7-6 (7-4), 2-1 after 82 minutes when Shapovalov withdrew.

Alcaraz will play compatriot Jaume Munar in the semifinals after the qualifier beat Kyrian Jacquet of France, 6-4, 6-2.

AUTO RACING

Briscoe earns sweep in Cup race at Vegas

Chase Briscoe held off a last-lap charge from points leader Kyle Larson to win the NASCAR Cup Series race at Las Vegas Motor Speedway.

Briscoe swept all three stages on the 1.5-mile track to earn the maximum 75 playoff points. Larson lost control on the final stretch, hit the wall and collided with Tyler Reddick, who slid into the infield but still recovered to finish third.

It was Briscoe's first career Cup Series victory in Las Vegas, where he led a race-high 175 laps. Briscoe also moved up to sixth in The Chase standings.

Denny Hamlin, who entered second in the playoff standings, finished 16th and was shut out of stage points. Hamlin is still second but fell 40 points behind Larson.

Briscoe drove back from third place to pass Austin Cindric late in the second stage for the win. Cindric finished second in the stage, followed by Christopher Bell in third.

Briscoe won the opening stage ahead of Bell and Ryan Blaney. Briscoe elected not to pit for tires during a late green-flag pit cycle, holding off the field on the restart to secure the stage victory. ...

Max Verstappen's long wait for another Formula One race win is finally over. The title race might be over, too.

Verstappen took his first victory of an often-frustrating year for the four-time champion at the Bahrain Grand Prix in Malaysia. A retirement for George Russell handed a huge title boost to Kimi Antonelli.

The race was relocated because of the Iran war, becoming F1's first event at the Sepang circuit in Malaysia since 2017.

Verstappen was leading over Antonelli and Russell behind the safety car with five laps to go when Russell suddenly pulled over in his Mercedes.

The retirement allowed Antonelli to further stretch his lead over teammate Russell from 66 points to 84, with seven races remaining on the schedule, including those in Qatar and Abu Dhabi.

Antonelli finished second, and Ferrari's Lewis Hamilton passed Verstappen's Red Bull teammate Isack Hadjar for third.

GOLF

Dunhill title will keep Meronk on Euro tour

Adrian Meronk caught up quickly and pulled ahead on the mistakes of Casey Jarvis to win the Dunhill Links Championship with a 4-under-par 68, giving the 33-year-old from Poland a full card on the DP World Tour when he desperately needed it.

Meronk was the tour player of the year in 2023 when he was left off the Ryder Cup team in Rome, then defeated to LIV Golf the following year. He was among eight players who accepted a deal from the European tour earlier this year that allowed him to keep his membership.

The two-shot victory at St. Andrews in Scotland — his fifth title on the European tour and perhaps the most important — gives him a full European card for 2027. That's important with so much in doubt at LIV Golf as it goes through Chapter 11 bankruptcy.

Victory was not secure until Jarvis failed to hole out for eagle from the Valley of Sin on the 18th at the Old Course. He closed with a 72 and tied for second with Niklas Norgaard (68), whose amateur partner was outgoing PGA Tour commissioner Jay Monahan. ...

Austin Smotherman recovered from his lone blunder with two great shots and was able to cruise home to a 3-under 68 to win the Utah Championship, his first PGA Tour victory in his 100th career start.

Smotherman came into the week at No. 79 in the FedEx Cup — the top 100 keep full PGA Tour cards for 2027 — and picked up some immediate rewards. He now has a two-year exemption, which includes the lucrative "Championship Series" when the new competitive model starts in 2028.

A bogey-birdie finish put Smotherman at 26-under 258, easily breaking the 72-hole record at the Ivins tournament only in its third year. Along with the two-year exemption, he moves to No. 51 in the FedEx Fall.

Doug Ghim, also seeking his first PGA Tour victory, three-putted from 30 feet on the 13th and missed a six-foot par putt on the 15th, which hurt his chances. He birdied the final hole for a 69 that allowed him to finish alone in second,

moving him from 89th to 58th in the FedEx Cup.

HOCKEY

Shesterkin has assist as Rangers top Utah

Igor Shesterkin made 28 saves and had an assist on Eeli Tolvanen's empty-net goal with 1:15 remaining, and the New York Rangers beat the Utah Mammoth, 4-2, at home.

Three nights after becoming the first Rangers goalie to score, Shesterkin got his fourth career assist when he made a long pass to Will Cuyile before Tolvanen scored for the third straight game.

Gabe Perreault scored the tiebreaking goal 3:15 into the third and J.T. Miller scored with 7:13 remaining as the retooled Rangers won their third straight after opening with a loss. ...

Kyle Connor scored two of Winnipeg's three power-play goals and assisted on the third as the visiting Jets held off the Detroit Red Wings, 3-2.

Cole Perfetti scored the Jets' other goal and had two assists, while Josh Morrissey also had two assists. Stuart Skinner made 33 saves in Winnipeg's first victory.

COLLEGE BASKETBALL

Injunction lets Kansas bring in another player

Melvin Council Jr. returned to the Kansas men's team after he was granted a preliminary injunction in a New York state court allowing him to play a seventh season.

Coach Bill Self said in a statement posted on X that Council would begin practicing immediately, as Tre White did last week.

Council, 24, was the Jayhawks' starting point guard last season and averaged 12.7 points, five rebounds and 5.1 assists per game. ...

Lena Bilic will miss the upcoming season for the UCLA women because of an ACL tear.

The sophomore from Zagreb, Croatia, averaged 3.0 points and 1.4 rebounds in 33 games last season as the Bruins won the national championship.

PRO BASKETBALL

Spurs' Harris injures calf, could be on shelf

San Antonio Spurs forward Tobias Harris will miss the preseason and is questionable for the start of the NBA regular season after suffering a strained left calf during training camp.

Harris, who signed as a free agent July 6, did not participate in San Antonio's annual intrasquad Silver & Black scrimmage. The forward will be reevaluated following the team's five-game preseason schedule.

Harris signed a two-year contract with the Spurs after spending the past two seasons with the Detroit Pistons. He averaged 13.3 points, 5.1 rebounds and 2.5 assists in 27.7 minutes last season.

— From news services

WNBA PLAYOFF ROUNDUP

Golden State takes Game 1 of semis

VALKYRIES 71,
ACES 60

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Gabby Williams had 25 points, 11 rebounds and five assists, Kiah Stokes added 14 rebounds and three blocked shots, and the Golden State Valkyries took Game 1 of their WNBA semifinal series by beating the defending champion Las Vegas Aces, 71-60, in San Francisco on Sunday.

A’ja Wilson scored 24 points while Chelsea Gray contributed 16 points for Las Vegas, which lost guard Jewell Loyd to a left leg injury early in the third quarter and was held to its lowest point total of the season. The team said she was being evaluated, and Coach Becky Hammon didn’t have an immediate update afterward.

Playing to chants of “Gabby! Gabby!” from the sellout crowd at Chase Center, Williams scored 18 of her points on 6-for-10 shooting in the first half, including a three-pointer that put Golden State ahead 32-23 with 5:43 left before halftime.

That deafening “Ballhalla” home crowd turned the arena into a sea of violet-colored T-shirts and energy the Valkyries have so counted on in their first two seasons. Fans waved and cheered when the final buzzer sounded and confetti fell.

Game 2 in the best-of-five series is Wednesday night back at Chase Center.

“The goal here is to win our home games, so yes, we did well for the first game. But the Aces are championship-caliber — they know what it takes to win,” Stokes said. “I know in their locker room they’re not happy with how they played so their whole goal is to come to our house and still win games, so they still have the opportunity to do that. Going forward, we know that we need to come out on Wednesday and make sure we set the tone again.”

Valkyries Coach Natalie Nakase was well enough to coach after she went down on the sideline near Golden State’s bench



TONY AVELAR/AP

With the Chase Center crowd chanting her name, Gabby Williams, left, led the Valkyries in scoring in their series-opening victory.

with 1:40 remaining Friday night in a 77-73 comeback win to clinch the first-round series against Dallas. She was examined by a doctor during the day off Saturday.

• **DREAM 92, LIBERTY 82:** Jordin Canada scored 20 of her 25 points in the second half and had five steals to help host Atlanta beat New York in Game 1 of the best-of-five semifinals series.

DeWanna Bonner added 23 points and helped fill the void when Allisha Gray went down with a left hand injury in the second quarter. Atlanta once again played stellar defense, scoring 32 points off 21 forced turnovers, including 16 in a dominant third quarter. The 32 points off turnovers tied a WNBA playoff record.

“Everybody stepped up, and that’s what we need,” Canada said. “Next-man-up mentality. I just tried to do what I do best. I tried to be aggressive, find my shots and take my shots with confidence.”

Gray’s injury was the key moment of an even first half. Neither team led by more than six points in a period that had 14 lead changes. New York went into the locker room with a slim 40-37 advantage. But Atlanta outscored New York 32-15 in the

third quarter, seizing control with relentless defensive pressure.

“We knew we didn’t play our best in the first half,” Canada said. “We gave up a lot of defensive assignments, we weren’t playing up to our schemes, and we just weren’t being aggressive enough on the offensive end.”

Angel Reese and Canada had three steals apiece in the third, keying a 13-3 run to start the half, which gave Atlanta a lead it never surrendered. Seven different New York players recorded at least one third-quarter turnover, and the team shot just 4 for 14 from the floor in a stretch that created a margin too big to overcome.

New York trimmed a 16-point deficit down to five in the closing minutes, but a clutch three-pointer by Canada just before the shot clock expired followed by another transition layup off a stop stemmed the tide. Sabrina Ionescu led the Liberty with 27 points and Breanna Stewart added 19.

The win marked Atlanta’s first victory in the semifinal round since 2018 and left it as the only undefeated team remaining in the postseason. The Dream are also on an eight-game winning streak dating back to the regular season.

MLB PLAYOFF ROUNDUP

Chourio’s walk-off hit lifts Milwaukee

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Jackson Chourio says his knack for coming through in clutch situations stems from one instance when he failed to deliver during his rookie year.

Just about every Milwaukee Brewers opponent has been paying for that ever since, as baseball’s best closer now knows.

Chourio hit a two-run single off hard-throwing Mason Miller with two outs in the ninth inning as the Brewers rallied past the San Diego Padres for the second straight day, a 4-3 victory Sunday for a 2-0 National League Division Series lead.

“I think it’s probably in the top three of the special moments I’ve had in my career,” Chourio said through interpreter Daniel de Mondesert.

The fact Chourio didn’t automatically rank it atop the list speaks volumes about all the memorable moments the 22-year-old already has produced in his first three seasons. Chourio said his drive to deliver in these moments intensified after he struck out against Andrés Muñoz, ending a loss to Seattle early in his rookie year.

“At that point, everything turned for me,” Chourio said. “I told myself I was never going to make the last out. I’d dedicate myself to fighting and doing whatever I could for the team and not having that feeling again from that specific game.”

San Diego, which entered the postseason with 20 wins in its last 23 games, headed home for Game 3 of the best-of-five series on Tuesday following its first back-to-back losses since Sept. 1-2.

Milwaukee rallied from 2-0 deficits on consecutive days by beating the Padres’ bullpen. William Contreras hit a tie-breaking homer in the seventh inning against Adrian Morejon on Saturday.

Sale to start Tuesday

Chris Sale will start on extra rest for the Atlanta Braves in Game 3 of their NLDS against the Los Angeles Dodgers on Tuesday.

“At the end of the day, we



PATRICK MCDERMOTT/GETTY IMAGES

Jackson Chourio’s walk-off single with two outs in the ninth inning gave the Brewers a 2-0 advantage over the Padres in the NLDS.

want full-strength Chris Sale,” Braves Manager Walt Weiss said before Game 2. “I know him at 80 percent is really good, but that’s what it came down to.”

Sale will have five days of rest before Game 4 on Wednesday. The Braves used him to get the final four outs against the Phillies after just one day of rest. ...

Will Venable said before the start of the American League Division Series that it was possible the Chicago White Sox could use bullpen games during the first three contests against the Cleveland Guardians.

Venable isn’t deviating from that plan, so far.

Anthony Kay will be the opener for Game 2 on Monday at Progressive Field. It will be the 33rd time this season the White Sox have used an opener, including the third in the postseason.

Sean Burke is expected to throw most of the innings, but Venable said he will have many options available.

Gavin Williams will get the call for Cleveland. The right-hander went 14-8 with a 3.76 ERA and was second in the major leagues with 248 strikeouts. He held opposing hitters to a .213 batting average, tied for seventh best in the majors. ...

Milwaukee’s Dustin May will start Game 3 of the NLDS on Tuesday at San Diego despite struggling after he was acquired from St. Louis at the trade deadline.

San Diego plans to start Nick Pivetta in a matchup of right-handers.

May finished 7-9 with a 4.70 ERA, going 2-2 with a 5.65 ERA over 10 starts with Milwaukee after compiling a 5-7 record with a 4.38 ERA in 21 starts with St. Louis. In his last three appearances of the regular season, May allowed seven runs and three homers over 7 1/3 innings.

Pivetta (3-2, 2.86) spent much of this season on the injured list with an elbow issue that arose in April. He returned had a 1.45 ERA in four September appearances, then allowed one run over 3 1/3 innings in San Diego’s 4-1 Game 2 first-round series victory over the Chicago Cubs on Wednesday.

YANKEES: Slugger Aaron Judge, who was left off the roster while he tries to work his way back from a calf injury that has sidelined him since Sept. 16, resumed running on Sunday when the Yankees worked out at their spring training home — George Steinbrenner Field — across the bay in Tampa.

“He didn’t run yesterday. He was off from running, so I know he’s running again today,” Yankees Manager Aaron Boone said. “I think we’ll get some live in. So just another work day, trying to stack another good day and, obviously, continue to heal up.”

The three-time AL MVP was limited to 66 games this season after missing a few months with a fractured rib.



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NFL WEEK 4

Maye and New England bounce back

PATRIOTS 29, BILLS 26

BY JOHN WAWROW

ORCHARD PARK, N.Y. — Drake Maye didn't have to be perfect after his rough start to the season.

The New England Patriots quarterback understood he simply needed to be more consistent.

Maye delivered by shaking off two first-half turnovers to finish with three touchdown passes — including Efton Chism's one-handed catch with 1:50 remaining — in rallying New England to a 29-26 win over Josh Allen and the previously unbeaten Buffalo Bills on Sunday.

The three touchdowns were two more than Maye combined for as New England lost two of its first three games to open the season. The 29 offensive points scored against Buffalo matched the Patriots' total from their first three outings.

"It's relieving a little bit," said Maye, who was facing criticism after opening the season throwing six interceptions and losing a fumble. "I know I've got to play better and still left some stuff out there today. But we've got to build on it."

Patriots Coach Mike Vabel was far more enthusiastic about his third-year quarterback's performance in a game that improved the defending AFC East champions to 2-2.

"Gets us back in the race. Josh [Allen] was unbelievable," Vabel said. "Felt like Drake went toe to toe with him."

Indeed he did.

With New England trailing 26-21 following Allen's 34-yard touchdown pass to Keon Coleman, Maye led an eight-play, 73-yard drive, which he capped with the completion to Chism.

Facing third and five, Maye rolled to his right and lobbed a perfectly placed pass to the second-year wide receiver, who caught it with his right hand and maintained control falling to the ground.

"Shoot, when I'm out there and the ball is in the air, I kind of



JEFFREY T. BARNES/AP

Patriots QB Drake Maye threw for three touchdowns against the Bills after posting just one touchdown pass in his first three games.

black out," said Chism, who was getting extended playing time after Mack Hollins left with a calf injury. "Drake gave me an opportunity, and you have to come down with those opportunities."

Maye finished 22 for 37 for 269 yards. Romeo Doubs had touchdown catches of two and 14 yards, and Rhamondre Stevenson scored on a one-yard run.

Meanwhile, the Bills (3-1) frittered away a chance to widen their division lead, losing for the first time under Coach Joe Brady and the first time at their new Highmark Stadium.

"We're not going to make excuses. We're not going to let others make excuses for us," Brady said. "Let's just start with ourselves, and then we'll continue to clean it up and obviously start with myself."

Buffalo has much to clean up after committing two turnovers a week after a five-giveaway outing in a 24-16 win over the Los Angeles Chargers.

Wide receiver Khalil Shakir lost a fumble, and Allen's interception — his third of the season — essentially sealed the loss.

Despite having a minute left and the ball at the Buffalo 40, Allen turned overly aggressive. On second and six, he spun out of Dre'Mont Jones's sack attempt,

stepped up in the pocket and went deep, only to have his underthrown pass caught by safety Craig Woodson.

"Should have thrown that one out of bounds and live another day. That's what I should have done," Allen said. "It stinks. I feel like we hurt ourselves."

Allen finished 23 for 33 for 253 yards with a touchdown and also scored on a two-yard run. James Cook scored on an eight-yard run.

The offense also appeared to struggle after DJ Moore left with a shoulder injury late in the first half. Defensively, tackle Ed Oliver was sidelined by a knee injury, and the unit was already missing its top cornerback, Christian Benford (toe).

Maye put the finishing touches on the win after Allen's interception by rolling out to his right and lobbing a 12-yard pass to Hunter Henry in allowing the Patriots to run out the clock.

"I thought he just competed today, whether it was a bad snap, dropping the ball, whatever it may have been," Vabel said of Maye, whose turnover issues extended to the start of last season's playoffs. "I'm happy for him, I'm proud of him. He deserves all the credit."

— Associated Press

Kansas City ends Vegas' perfect start

CHIEFS 30, RAIDERS 27

BY MARK ANDERSON

LAS VEGAS — Patrick Mahomes said he loves playing in Allegiant Stadium, and it's no wonder, given his perfect record in one of the NFL's newer venues.

He's rarely been pushed as much as he was Sunday against a Raiders team out to show its quick start wasn't a fluke.

As he has so often, Mahomes came through, passing for 225 yards and two touchdowns. He got a big assist from Kenneth Walker III, who rushed for 177 yards and two touchdowns to lead the Kansas City Chiefs to a 30-27 victory over Las Vegas.

Walker's two-yard touchdown run with 3:21 left put the Chiefs (4-0) ahead for good at 23-19. It was set up by Tyquan Thornton's 55-yard reception on the previous play. Thornton, who had five catches for 111 yards and two touchdowns, suffered a gruesome-looking left ankle injury on the play and was carted off.

"I think you have to stay with it," Mahomes said, describing the back-and-forth game. "I keep saying it, but it's not always going to be pretty. That's a good football team, a good defense. It's not going to always be light it up and go out there and scoring 50 points or whatever. It's if you stay with the process, it's going to come."

Kirk Cousins passed for 365 yards and two touchdowns for the Raiders, ending his seven-game winning streak that included the final four games last season with the Atlanta Falcons. Brock Bowers, who played with an illness, caught six passes for 86 yards and a touchdown.

Las Vegas' running game produced just 72 yards, averaging 2.8 per carry.

"We've got to find that answer," Raiders Coach Klint Kubiak said of the struggles on the ground. "That will be a big factor in us being a better football team."

One of the NFL's early-season surprises, the Raiders put up a strong fight against their



DAVID BRYTUS/IMAGN IMAGES

Patrick Mahomes's touchdown pass to Tyquan Thornton was the first time all year the Raiders allowed points in the fourth quarter.

AFC West rivals, and Kubiak expressed confidence in his team at halftime.

"We're winning," Kubiak said on the CBS broadcast. "We're going to win the game."

Las Vegas certainly gave it a shot, taking a 13-10 advantage into the fourth quarter.

The lead didn't last long. Walker ended the third by busting free for a 76-yard run before he was chased down from behind by Raiders cornerback Taron Johnson at the 8-yard line. Walker ran 21.21 mph on that play, according to the NFL's Next Gen Stats.

"[Johnson] probably was going 23," Walker said. "I thought I was out of there until I started hearing breathing."

Two plays later, the Chiefs took their first lead as Mahomes connected with Thornton. It was the first time the Raiders' defense had been scored on in the fourth quarter this season.

Las Vegas came right back, with Matt Gay making field goals of 44 and 48 yards for a 19-17 lead with 4:53 left.

But it's hard to count out Mahomes in Las Vegas — or most places.

He led the go-ahead touchdown drive and then took advantage of a fumble on the en-

suing kickoff by handing the ball to Walker for another touchdown. Mahomes has won all six of his starts at Allegiant Stadium against the Raiders, plus the Super Bowl after the 2023 season.

"I trust him to do that," Chiefs Coach Andy Reid said. "I don't expect anything, but I do trust that he's going to do the right thing when the ball's in his hand."

Reid, amazingly, has the most wins of any coach at Allegiant Stadium with seven. He broke a tie with former Raiders coaches Josh McDaniels and Antonio Pierce. Reid is 7-1 at the stadium, which opened in 2020.

Backed by plenty of their red-clad fans, the Chiefs held off a frantic comeback attempt in the final minutes. Cousins hit Bowers for a 20-yard touchdown with 1:46 left, and the Raiders got the ball back, moving to mid-field before Cousins was intercepted.

Reid said left guard Kingsley Suamataia didn't start for disciplinary reasons. Mike Caliendo took his place.

"That's between Kingsley and I," Reid said. "We'll figure it out, and down the road, we'll be better as a team for it and Kingsley will be better for it."

— Associated Press

Bears 23, Jets 12

Kyle Monangai rushed for 146 yards and two touchdowns, and host Chicago stuffed New York.

Devin Bush, Austin Booker and Dayo Odeyingbo each had a sack as the Bears (3-1) limited the Jets (1-3) to seven first downs and 157 yards. Chicago has allowed a total of 28 points in three games since its wild 59-37 victory over the Carolina Panthers in its opener.

Geno Smith found Isaiah Williams for a 58-yard touchdown pass in the fourth quarter, trimming New York's deficit to 11 points with 9:16 left. It was Williams's first touchdown in his 27th NFL game.

But Jason Sanders missed the ensuing extra point, and Chicago ran out the clock with an 18-play, 77-yard drive.

Tyson Bagent threw for 268 yards while filling in for Caleb Williams, who missed his second straight game with a right hamstring injury. Case Keenum — who started last week — was behind center for Chicago's first play against New York, and Bagent was split out wide. Keenum pitched the ball to D'Andre Swift for a two-yard gain before Bagent took over.

Minkah Fitzpatrick stepped in front of Colston Loveland and snatched a pass by Bagent in the second quarter for New York's first interception since Ashtyn Davis had two in the 2024 season finale. But the Jets had three more picks taken off the board because of penalties in their third straight loss.

N.Y. JETS.....0 3 3 6 — 12
CHICAGO.....7 6 7 3 — 23

FIRST QUARTER
Chicago: Monangai 1 run (Santos kick), 2:3.

SECOND QUARTER
N.Y. Jets: FG Sanders 36, 8:15.
Chicago: FG Santos 30, 2:29.
Chicago: FG Santos 30, 3:0.

THIRD QUARTER
N.Y. Jets: FG Sanders 30, 7:00.
Chicago: Monangai 5 run (Santos kick), 2:26.

FOURTH QUARTER
Chicago: FG Santos 21, 10:01.
N.Y. Jets: I.Williams 58 pass from G.Smith (kick failed), 9:16.
At: 59, 70:2.

	NVJ	Chi
First downs.....	7	34
Total Net Yards.....	157	492
Rushes-yards.....	34-59	54-232
Passing.....	98	260
Punt Returns.....	0-0	2-16
Kickoff Returns.....	3-77	4-70
Interceptions Ret.....	1-27	0-0
Comp-Att-Int.....	8-15-0	25-34-1
Sacked-Yards Lost.....	3-21	1-8
Fumbles-Lost.....	5-52.6	0-0.0
Fumbles-Lost.....	0-0	1-1
Penalties-Yards.....	12-76	4-29
Time of Possession.....	17:15	42:45

RUSHING
N.Y. Jets: Allen 14-59. Chicago: Monangai 30-146, Swift 15-58, R.Johnson 4-16, Burden 1-11, Bagent 4-1.

PASSING
N.Y. Jets: G.Smith 8-15-0-119. Chicago: Bagent 25-34-1-268.

RECEIVING
N.Y. Jets: Wilson 3-27, Williams 2-73, Allen 2-8, Woods 1-11. Chicago: Oduze 6-94, Loveland 6-57, Burden 4-65, Swift 2-16, Kmet 2-13, Raymond 2-6, Roush 1-3, R.Johnson 1-7, Monangai 1-4.

Giants 36, Cardinals 24

Jameis Winston threw three touchdown passes to offset a pair of interceptions, Deonte Banks had a 98-yard pick-six in the final seconds, and New York secured another not-so-pretty win, defeating Arizona in East Rutherford, New Jersey.

Making his second start in place of injured franchise quarterback Jaxon Dart, Winston again did what he needed to do to engineer a victory with touchdown passes to Malachi Fields, Malik Nabers and Theo Johnson.

Winston's 12-yard toss to Fields with 4:30 left in the second quarter was the first touchdown for the Giants (3-1) since the opener, ending a drought that lasted nine-plus quarters. J.J. McCarthy was in uniform but didn't play, six days after New York acquired him in a trade.

Nabers, back from a serious knee injury, more than doubled his receiving yardage this season by gashing the Cardinals (1-3) for 112 yards on six catches.

The defense also made some big plays, sacking Jacoby Brissett twice and rebounding from allowing two long touchdown drives in the first 10 minutes. For a second game in a row, New York got an interception after its opponent reached the red zone, and Banks made up for his pass interference penalty a few plays earlier.

ARIZONA.....14 3 7 0 — 24
N.Y. GIANTS.....3 16 8 9 — 36

FIRST QUARTER
Arizona: Mar.Harrison 12 pass from Brissett (Ryland kick), 11:03.
N.Y. Giants: FG Zvada 39, 6:36.
Arizona: Algieier 22 run (Ryland kick), 3:04.

SECOND QUARTER
N.Y. Giants: FG Zvada 50, 14:55.
N.Y. Giants: Fields 12 pass from Winston (pass failed), 4:30.
N.Y. Giants: Nabers 25 pass from Winston (Zvada kick), 2:24.
Arizona: FG Ryland 60, 0:0.

THIRD QUARTER
Arizona: Higgins 2 pass from Brissett (Ryland kick), 7:20.
N.Y. Giants: Johnson 11 pass from Winston (N.Harris run), 1:44.

FOURTH QUARTER
N.Y. Giants: FG Zvada 52, 2:11.
N.Y. Giants: Banks 98 interception return, 0:0.

	Ari	NVG
First downs.....	19	17
Total Net Yards.....	270	319
Rushes-yards.....	26-123	28-87
Passing.....	147	232
Punt Returns.....	1-12	4-27
Kickoff Returns.....	7-196	4-124
Interceptions Ret.....	2-15	3-106
Comp-Att-Int.....	21-35-3	18-29-2
Sacked-Yards Lost.....	2-19	4-18
Fumbles-Lost.....	6-43.167	3-48.667
Fumbles-Lost.....	0-0	1-1
Penalties-Yards.....	7-55	6-44
Time of Possession.....	27:47	32:13

RUSHING
Arizona: Love 14-63, Algieier 8-42, Brissett 4-18. N.Y. Giants: Skatteebo 18-58, N.Harris 9-30, Tracy 1-(minus 1).

PASSING
Arizona: Brissett 21-35-3-166. N.Y. Giants: Winston 18-29-2-250.

RECEIVING
Arizona: Mi.Wilson 7-95, McBride 7-31, Higgins 2-19, Algieier 2-7, Harrison 1-12, Long 1-10, Love 1-(minus 8). N.Y. Giants: Lilely 7-66, Nabers 6-112, Fields 2-52, Johnson 1-11, Skatteebo 1-8, Ricard 1-1.

Packers 17, Buccaneers 14

Jordan Love threw two touchdown passes, and Green Bay overcame two fourth-quarter turnovers to beat Tampa Bay in Tampa.

Undrafted rookie Jalon Daniels threw two picks that led to 10 points in his first career start. Baker Mayfield missed a game for the first time in his three-plus seasons with the Bucs (0-4) because of a dislocated thumb.

The Packers (2-2) wasted two opportunities to extend a three-point lead in the fourth quarter, but the Buccaneers couldn't capitalize.

Tykee Smith forced Kaleb Johnson to fumble inside the Tampa Bay 5-yard line with just over nine minutes left in the game. A'Shawn Robinson recovered, but the ensuing drive went nowhere.

After getting the ball back when Jacob Parrish picked off Love inside the Tampa Bay 10, the Bucs drove to Green Bay territory, but Daniels threw incomplete on fourth down from the 47. Coach Todd Bowles passed up a 65-yard field-goal attempt by Chase McLaughlin, who made one from that distance last year.

Tampa Bay is off to its worst start since 2014, when it finished with the NFL's worst record. Only the 1992 San Diego Chargers overcame an 0-4 start to make the playoffs.

Packers linebacker Edgerrin Cooper was carted off in the third quarter with an Achilles tendon injury. Green Bay is still missing three-time all-pro edge rusher Micah Parsons.

GREEN BAY.....0 10 7 0 — 17
TAMPA BAY.....0 7 0 7 — 14

SECOND QUARTER
Green Bay: Golden 2 pass from Love (Smack kick), 12:54.
Tampa Bay: Tucker 2 run (McLaughlin kick), 5:13.
Green Bay: FG Smack 58, 0:0.

THIRD QUARTER
Green Bay: Kraft 2 pass from Love (Smack kick), 10:32.

FOURTH QUARTER
Tampa Bay: Gainwell 10 pass from Daniels (McLaughlin kick), 14:49.
At: 61,467.

	GB	TB
First downs.....	15	19
Total Net Yards.....	283	275
Rushes-yards.....	25-86	31-141
Passing.....	197	134
Punt Returns.....	2-19	1-13
Kickoff Returns.....	2-52	0-0
Interceptions Ret.....	2-18	1-8
Comp-Att-Int.....	22-30-1	19-27-2
Sacked-Yards Lost.....	0-0	3-18
Punts.....	4-45.0	4-40.0
Fumbles-Lost.....	2-61	4-17
Fumbles-Lost.....	10-68	4-17
Time of Possession.....	30:10	29:50

RUSHING
Green Bay: Johnson 8-42, C.Brooks 4-30, Lloyd 7-13, Golden 1-6, Kraft 1-3, Love 4-(minus 8). Tampa Bay: Irving 16-61, Daniels 8-55, J.Johnson 1-10, Tucker 3-10, Penalties-Yards.....

PASSING
Green Bay: Love 22-30-1-197. Tampa Bay: Daniels 19-27-2-148.

RECEIVING
Green Bay: Kraft 6-42, Lloyd 5-36, Watson 3-47, Golden 3-21, Redman 2-29, Smith 1-19, C.Brooks 1-5, Moore 1-(minus 2). Tampa Bay: Goldwin 6-31, Otton 4-37, Hurst 2-25, Gainwell 2-22, J.Johnson 2-17, Egbuka 2-13, K.Johnson 1-3.

Cowboys 34, Texans 30

CeeDee Lamb had a career-high 17 catches for 189 yards, and his 12-yard touchdown reception with 40 seconds left lifted Dallas to a win at Houston.

Javonte Williams rushed for a career-high three touchdowns — all in the second half — to help the Cowboys (2-2) to the victory.

Dallas took its first lead on the third score by Williams, a two-yard run that made it 27-23 with 11:17 remaining.

With under three minutes to go, the Texans (0-4) were staring down a third and 14 when they dialed up a hook-and-ladder play with a two-yard catch by Dalton Schultz and a 19-yard run by David Montgomery. That got them to the Dallas 6-yard line, and Woody Marks promptly ran it in to put Houston back in front.

Dak Prescott then orchestrated an 11-play, 74-yard drive that included a fourth-down conversion and capped it with the throw to Lamb to give the Cowboys the victory.

The Texans had one last chance after that, but C.J. Stroud's desperation pass fell incomplete.

Nico Collins had seven receptions for 118 yards and two touchdowns in his return after missing two games with a hamstring injury. But his big day wasn't enough to get the Texans in the win column.

DALLAS.....3 3 14 14 — 34
HOUSTON.....10 6 7 7 — 30

FIRST QUARTER
Houston: Collins 7 pass from Stroud (Fairbairn kick), 10:01.
Dallas: FG Aubrey 39, 5:10.
Houston: FG Fairbairn 51, 1:49.

SECOND QUARTER
Dallas: FG Aubrey 50, 12:30.
Houston: FG Fairbairn 39, 2:05.
Houston: FG Fairbairn 54, 0:0.

THIRD QUARTER
Dallas: J.Williams 8 run (Aubrey kick), 12:55.
Houston: Collins 22 pass from Stroud (Fairbairn kick), 10:50.
Dallas: J.Williams 1 run (Aubrey kick), 6:49.

FOURTH QUARTER
Dallas: J.Williams 2 run (Aubrey kick), 11:17.
Houston: Marks 6 run (Fairbairn kick), 2:23.
Dallas: Lamb 12 pass from Prescott (Aubrey kick), 40.

	Dal	Hou
First downs.....	28	16
Total Net Yards.....	399	397
Rushes-yards.....	25-75	19-42
Passing.....	224	335
Punt Returns.....	4-47	2-8
Kickoff Returns.....	5-147	7-161
Interceptions Ret.....	0-0	0-0
Comp-Att-Int.....	32-45-0	21-31-0
Sacked-Yards Lost.....	3-11	2-12
Punts.....	2-58.5	4-52.0
Fumbles-Lost.....	4-15	2-14
Punts.....	3-48.667	2-41.5
Fumbles-Lost.....	6-47	13-90
Time of Possession.....	33:27	26:26

RUSHING
Dallas: J.Williams 19-62, Goodson 3-12, Prescott 2-7, Lamb 1-(minus 6). Houston: Montgomery 10-24, Marks 6-22, Stroud 2-12, Noel 1-4.

PASSING
Dallas: Prescott 32-45-0-335. Houston: Stroud 21-31-0-347.

RECEIVING
Dallas: Lamb 17-189, J.Williams 5-21, Flourmoy 4-37, Ferguson 3-11, Pickens 2-75, Lueghe 1-2. Houston: Collins 7-118, Noel 3-85, Hutchinson 3-46, Boutte 3-36, Schultz 2-9, Stever 1-20, B.Jordan 1-13, Moreau 1-1.

MISSSED FIELD GOALS
Dallas: Aubrey 65, Aubrey 62.

Jaguars 22, Bengals 17

Trevor Lawrence passed for 227 yards and a touchdown, his defense forced two critical turnovers, and Jacksonville held off Cincinnati for a road win.

Joe Burrow passed for 428 yards for the Bengals (2-2), who lost all-pro wide receiver Ja'Marr Chase to a concussion in the second quarter.

Burrow also had two interceptions — one that the Jaguars converted into a touchdown and the other when the Bengals were in the red zone. It was the ninth straight game in which the Jaguars (3-1) have picked off a pass, a franchise record and the NFL's longest active streak. Coming out of the two-minute warning, Parker Washington appeared to put the game away for the Jaguars when he caught a screen pass and went 39 yards to the 16-yard line. But replays showed he stepped out of bounds at the Cincinnati 48.

That gave the Bengals a final chance to rally. They drove to the Jacksonville 21, but Chase Brown was stopped one yard short at the 12 after a catch on fourth and 10, allowing the Jaguars to go 3-1 for the second straight year.

On the other side, Cincinnati has dropped two straight after winning its first two for the second season in a row.

Lawrence beat the Bengals for the first time in four attempts. The sixth-year quarterback has at least one win over every AFC opponent.

JACKSONVILLE.....3 10 3 6 — 22
CINCINNATI.....0 3 7 7 — 17

FIRST QUARTER
Jacksonville: FG C.Little 55, 2:18.

SECOND QUARTER
Cincinnati: FG McPherson 29, 10:03.
Jacksonville: FG C.Little 28, 4:16.
Jacksonville: Bri.Thomas 7 pass from T.Lawrence (C.Little kick), 1:23.

THIRD QUARTER
Cincinnati: Gesicki 15 pass from Burrow (McPherson kick), 8:44.
Jacksonville: FG C.Little 54, 3:00.

FOURTH QUARTER
Jacksonville: Rodriguez 25 run (pass failed), 6:35.
Cincinnati: Burrow 1 run (McPherson kick), 3:28.

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NFL WEEK 4

PRO FOOTBALL												
NFC												
EAST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
N.Y. Giants	3	1	0	.750	82	79	3-0-0	0-1-0	1-0-0	2-1-0	1-0-0	
Philadelphia	2	2	0	.500	75	93	1-1-0	1-1-0	1-0-0	1-2-0	1-0-0	
Dallas	2	2	0	.500	122	112	1-0-0	1-1-0	1-1-0	1-1-0	1-1-0	
Washington	1	3	0	.250	88	122	1-0-0	0-2-0	0-1-0	1-2-0	0-2-0	
SOUTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
x-Carolina	1	2	0	.333	89	83	0-1-0	1-1-0	0-1-0	1-1-0	1-0-0	
New Orleans	1	2	0	.333	81	83	0-1-0	1-1-0	1-1-0	0-1-0	0-0-0	
Atlanta	1	2	0	.333	51	68	0-1-0	1-1-0	0-1-0	1-1-0	0-1-0	
Tampa Bay	0	4	0	.000	76	96	0-3-0	0-1-0	0-2-0	0-2-0	0-0-0	
NORTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
Minnesota	4	0	0	1.000	86	51	2-0-0	2-0-0	1-0-0	3-0-0	2-0-0	
Chicago	3	1	0	.750	112	65	2-1-0	1-0-0	1-0-0	2-1-0	0-1-0	
x-Detroit	2	1	0	.667	93	95	2-0-0	0-1-0	1-1-0	1-0-0	0-0-0	
Green Bay	2	2	0	.500	73	105	0-1-0	2-1-0	1-0-0	1-2-0	0-1-0	
WEST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
San Francisco	4	0	0	1.000	122	64	3-0-0	1-0-0	2-0-0	2-0-0	2-0-0	
Seattle	3	1	0	.750	105	73	2-0-0	1-1-0	2-0-0	1-1-0	1-0-0	
L.A. Rams	2	2	0	.500	85	83	1-1-0	1-1-0	0-1-0	2-1-0	0-1-0	
Arizona	1	3	0	.250	87	117	0-1-0	1-2-0	1-0-0	0-3-0	0-2-0	
AFC												
EAST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
Buffalo	3	1	0	.750	127	107	2-1-0	1-0-0	2-1-0	1-0-0	0-1-0	
New England	2	2	0	.500	65	77	1-0-0	1-2-0	2-1-0	0-1-0	1-0-0	
N.Y. Jets	1	3	0	.250	76	84	0-1-0	1-2-0	1-0-0	0-3-0	0-0-0	
Miami	0	4	0	.000	46	101	0-1-0	0-3-0	0-2-0	0-2-0	0-0-0	
SOUTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
Jacksonville	3	1	0	.750	104	53	2-0-0	1-1-0	3-1-0	0-0-0	0-0-0	
Indianapolis	2	2	0	.500	102	104	1-1-0	0-1-0	1-2-0	1-0-0	1-0-0	
Tennessee	0	4	0	.000	55	83	0-2-0	0-2-0	0-2-0	0-2-0	0-0-0	
Houston	0	4	0	.000	84	109	0-3-0	0-1-0	0-3-0	0-1-0	0-1-0	
NORTH	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
Cleveland	3	1	0	.750	81	95	2-0-0	1-1-0	1-1-0	2-0-0	1-0-0	
Baltimore	3	1	0	.750	116	96	1-1-0	1-0-0	2-0-0	1-1-0	0-0-0	
Pittsburgh	2	2	0	.500	77	87	2-0-0	0-2-0	1-2-0	1-0-0	1-1-0	
Cincinnati	2	2	0	.500	97	85	1-1-0	1-1-0	1-2-0	1-0-0	0-1-0	
WEST	W	L	T	PCT	PF	PA	HOME	AWAY	AFC	NFC	DIV	
Kansas City	4	0	0	1.000	118	77	2-0-0	2-0-0	4-0-0	0-0-0	2-0-0	
Las Vegas	3	1	0	.750	115	84	1-1-0	2-0-0	2-1-0	1-0-0	1-1-0	
Denver	2	2	0	.500	74	94	2-0-0	0-2-0	1-1-0	1-1-0	0-1-0	
L.A. Chargers	0	4	0	.000	67	106	0-2-0	0-2-0	0-2-0	0-2-0	0-1-0	

x-Late game

Thursday's result

at Cleveland 27, Pittsburgh 24

Sunday's results

Indianapolis 30, Washington 13, in London at Baltimore 24, Tennessee 18 at Chicago 23, N.Y. Jets 12 Dallas 34, at Houston 30 Green Bay 17, at Tampa Bay 14 Jacksonville 22, at Cincinnati 17 L.A. Rams 24, at Philadelphia 20 at N.Y. Giants 36, Arizona 24 New England 29, at Buffalo 26 at Minnesota 15, Miami 10 Kansas City 30, at Las Vegas 27 at San Francisco 24, Denver 14 at Seattle 30, L.A. Chargers 23 Detroit at Carolina, late

Monday's game

Atlanta at New Orleans, 8:15 p.m.

Thursday's game

Tampa Bay at Dallas, 8:15 p.m.

Sunday's games

Philadelphia vs Jacksonville at London, GBR, 9:30 a.m. Chicago at Green Bay, 1 p.m. Cincinnati at Miami, 1 p.m. Cleveland at N.Y. Jets, 1 p.m. Houston at Tennessee, 1 p.m. Indianapolis at Pittsburgh, 1 p.m. Las Vegas at New England, 1 p.m. Minnesota at New Orleans, 1 p.m. N.Y. Giants at Washington, 1 p.m. Denver at L.A. Chargers, 4:05 p.m. Detroit at Arizona, 4:25 p.m. San Francisco at Seattle, 4:25 p.m. Baltimore at Atlanta, 8:20 p.m. Open: Kansas City, Carolina

Monday, Oct. 12

Buffalo at L.A. Rams, 8:15 p.m.

Rams 24, Eagles 20

Kyren Williams ran for two touchdowns in the final four minutes as Matthew Stafford and Los Angeles rallied from a 10-point deficit to beat host Philadelphia.

The Rams (2-2) had struggled offensively all day, and a win seemed out of reach until late in the fourth quarter, when Eagles Coach Nick Sirianni decided against a chip-shot field goal and went for it on fourth and goal. An incompletion by Jalen Hurts gave Los Angeles new life.

Stafford and the Rams were aided by an unnecessary roughness call on a 98-yard drive, capped by Williams's one-yard run that made it 20-17.

The Eagles (2-2) — who failed to convert a third down on 12 tries — punted to set up Stafford again. He connected with Puka Nacua three times and had a clutch scramble on the 10-play, 79-yard march, which Williams finished off when he broke a few tackles to score from seven yards out.

The depleted Eagles came in down six starters. That number increased as star running back Saquon Barkley (hamstring), cornerback Quinyon Mitchell (knee) and linebacker Jonathan Greenard (ankle) all went down.

L.A. Rams	3	7	0	14	— 24
Philadelphia	3	17	0	0	— 20

FIRST QUARTER

Philadelphia: FG Elliott 29, 8:38. L.A. Rams: FG Mevis 40, 2:08.

SECOND QUARTER

Philadelphia: FG Elliott 56, 10:56. Philadelphia: Cooper 18 pass from Hurts (Elliott kick), 5:44. L.A. Rams: Nacua 2 run (Mevis kick), 1:55. Philadelphia: Cooper 10 pass from Hurts (Elliott kick), :03.

FOURTH QUARTER

L.A. Rams: Williams 1 run (Mevis kick), 3:59. L.A. Rams: Williams 7 run (Mevis kick), 1:10.

	LAR	Phi
First downs.....	26	12
Total Net Yards.....	414	172
Rushes-yards.....	25-106	27-104
Passing.....	308	68
Punt Returns.....	4-30	3-59
Kickoff Returns.....	4-49	3-65
Interceptions Ret.....	0-0	2-46
Comp-Att-Int.....	32-51-2	12-27-0
Sacked-Yards Lost.....	1-8	4-25
Punts.....	4-49-75	6-48-83
Fumbles-Lost.....	0-0	2-0
Penalties-Yards.....	8-100	10-58
Time of Possession.....	32:00	28:00

RUSHING

L.A. Rams: Williams 16-80, Corum 5-14, Stafford 3-10, Nacua 1-2. Philadelphia: Bigsby 14-55, Shipley 6-23, Hurts 5-16, Barkley 2-8.

PASSING

L.A. Rams: Stafford 32-51-2-316. Philadelphia: Hurts 12-27-0-93.

RECEIVING

L.A. Rams: Williams 10-66, Nacua 9-125, Higbee 5-67, Adams 4-32, Atwell 1-8, Corum 1-7, Mumphfield 1-7, Whittington 1-4. Philadelphia: Cooper 3-33, Lemon 3-27, Wicks 3-18, Ertz 2-13, Barkley 1-2.

MISSED FIELD GOALS

L.A. Rams: Mevis 48.

Vikings 15, Dolphins 10

Minnesota stayed undefeated with more dominance by its defense and five field goals from Will Reichard, sidestepping its early passing game problems to secure a victory over winless Miami in Minneapolis.

T.J. Hockenson tied a career high with 13 receptions on 13 targets from Kyler Murray, including the game-sealing eight-yard catch on third and five from the Dolphins' 10-yard line. Hockenson was wide open and could have coasted into the end zone, but he wisely slid in front of the goal line to drain the clock.

The Vikings moved to 4-0 for the second time in three years. The Dolphins, who are 0-4 for the first time since 2019 — their first season under Brian Flores, now Minnesota's defensive coordinator — were crushed by a combination of unforced errors and a bit of bad luck.

New Dolphins quarterback Malik Willis was just 9 for 17 for 85 yards, losing a fumble on one of Dallas Turner's two sacks. Willis thought he had escaped the relentless Vikings pass rush to float a 68-yard touchdown pass to Chris Bell early in the second quarter, but Bell was flagged for illegal touching after stepping out of bounds as he moved to get open.

MIAMI	0	0	10	0	— 10
MINNESOTA	3	6	3	3	— 15

FIRST QUARTER

Minnesota: FG Reichard 47, 7:54.

SECOND QUARTER

Minnesota: FG Reichard 50, 7:08. Minnesota: FG Reichard 33, :00.

THIRD QUARTER

Miami: FG Patterson 27, 11:56. Minnesota: FG Reichard 41, 6:35.

Miami: Gordon 12 run (Patterson kick), :11.

FOURTH QUARTER

Minnesota: FG Reichard 29, 6:41.

	Mia	Min
First downs.....	8	20
Total Net Yards.....	18-121	31-123
Rushes-yards.....	77	213
Punt Returns.....	1-0	3-51
Interceptions Ret.....	5-97	2-70
Kickoffs Ret.....	0-0	0-0
Comp-Att-Int.....	9-17-0	27-37-0
Sacked-Yards Lost.....	2-8	4-34
Punts.....	6-45-833	4-37-75
Fumbles-Lost.....	1-1	1-0
Penalties-Yards.....	9-55	11-85
Time of Possession.....	20:49	39:11

RUSHING

Minnesota: Gordon 9-100, Willis 2-11, Wright 5-7, M.Washington 2-13. Minnesota: A.Jones 20-94, Murray 6-16, Claiborne 3-12, Price 2-6, Addison 1 (-minus) 1.

PASSING

Miami: Willis 9-17-0-85. Minnesota: Murray 27-37-0-247.

RECEIVING

Miami: M.Washington 5-67, Gordon 2-0, Kacmarek 1-15, Coleman 1-3. Minnesota: Hockenson 13-119, Addison 4-52, A.Jones 4-34, Price 2-6, Felton 1-14, Dallas 1-10, Jennings 1-8, Bartholomew 1-4.

49ers 24, Broncos 14

Brock Purdy threw two touchdown passes, and Christian McCaffrey ran for a score to lead undefeated San Francisco over Denver in Santa Clara, California.

Both offenses struggled to move the ball on a hot day in the Bay Area, but the 49ers (4-0) took advantage of a fumbled punt return by Marvin Mims Jr. to set up a short touchdown drive in the third quarter that gave them the lead for good.

Purdy then engineered a 74-yard drive that McCaffrey finished with a one-yard run to extend the lead to 17-6 midway through the fourth after the Broncos (2-2) had settled for a field goal on fourth and two.

Bo Nix, who has thrived in late-game comeback situations, tried to mount another rally for Denver with his 13-yard touchdown pass to Jaylen Waddle, cutting San Francisco's lead to 17-14 with a two-point conversion with 4:05 to play.

But Purdy sealed the win with a 56-yard touchdown pass to George Kittle. Purdy avoided taking a sack for a fourth straight game and committed no turnovers.

DENVER	3	0	0	11	— 14
San Francisco	0	0	3	7	14 — 24

FIRST QUARTER

Denver: FG Lutz 52, 1:43.

SECOND QUARTER

San Francisco: FG Pineiro 24, 1:36.

THIRD QUARTER

San Francisco: Samuel 1 pass from Purdy (Pineiro kick), 4:15.

FOURTH QUARTER

Denver: FG Lutz 40, 14:08. San Francisco: McCaffrey 1 run (Pineiro kick), 8:52. Denver: Waddle 13 pass from Nix (Badie run), 4:05. San Francisco: Kittle 56 pass from Purdy (Pineiro kick), 2:15. A: 70,776.

	Den	SF
First downs.....	16	20
Total Net Yards.....	296	358
Rushes-yards.....	22-82	35-140
Passing.....	214	218
Punt Returns.....	1-0	0-0
Kickoff Returns.....	3-65	3-74
Interceptions Ret.....	0-0	0-0
Comp-Att-Int.....	25-42-0	19-30-0
Sacked-Yards Lost.....	0-0	0-0
Fumbles-Lost.....	5-49-2	4-52-0
Punts.....	3-1	1-0
Penalties-Yards.....	7-44	1-5
Time of Possession.....	30:53	29:07

RUSHING

Denver: Dobbins 11-40, R.Harvey 7-25, Nix 2-10, Badie 2-7. San Francisco: McCaffrey 15-52, Samuel 3-44, Purdy 10-29, Black 6-13, Cowing 1-2.

PASSING

Denver: Nix 25-42-0-214. San Francisco: Purdy 19-30-0-218.

RECEIVING

Denver: R.Harvey 10-68, Waddle 5-35, Bryant 3-47, Badie 2-32, Dobbins 2-12, Mims 1-10, Ingram 1-6, Sutton 1-4. San Francisco: Evans 5-76, Samuel 5-26, Kittle 4-70, McCaffrey 3-18, Juszczyk 2-28.

MISSED FIELD GOALS

Denver: Lutz 58. San Francisco: Pineiro 54.

Seahawks 30, Chargers 23

Emanuel Wilson caught a touchdown pass and ran for another score, and Seattle handed visiting Los Angeles a fourth straight loss to start the season.

Sam Darnold threw for 168 yards and two touchdowns for the defending Super Bowl champion Seahawks (3-1), who rebounded from last week's loss to the Washington Commanders.

Justin Herbert was limited to 189 passing yards with two interceptions and four sacks for the Chargers (0-4). The only team to reach the playoffs after a four-loss start is the 1992 Chargers.

Seattle won despite committing 14 penalties for a franchise-record 150 yards.

The game was chaotic at the start. The Seahawks' Drake Thomas intercepted Herbert's pass to Oronde Gadsden on the Chargers' opening play. Then Darnold's pass for Wilson was picked by Tuli Tuipulotu.

According to Sportradar, it was the first game since at least 1991 that both teams threw interceptions on their opening play from scrimmage.

L.A. CHARGERS	3	3	7	10	— 23
Seattle	7	13	10	0	— 30

FIRST QUARTER

L.A. Chargers: FG Dicker 40, 11:54. Seattle: Wilson 23 pass from Darnold (Myers kick), 9:53. A: 66,691.

SECOND QUARTER

Seattle: Shaheed 28 run (kick failed), 6:12. Seattle: Wilson 8 run (Myers kick), :43. L.A. Chargers: FG Dicker 39, :00.

THIRD QUARTER

Seattle: Horton 6 pass from Darnold (Myers kick), 10:23. L.A. Chargers: Vidal 9 pass from J.Herbert (Dicker kick), 4:53. Seattle: FG Myers 35, 1:19.

FOURTH QUARTER

L.A. Chargers: Hampton 2 run (Dicker kick), 7:49. L.A. Chargers: FG Dicker 36, 2:14. A: 66,691.

	LAC	Sea
First downs.....	20	19
Total Net Yards.....	301	286
Rushes-yards.....	32-147	33-138
Passing.....	154	148
Punt Returns.....	2-0	2-12
Kickoff Returns.....	5-140	3-83
Interceptions Ret.....	1-4	2-20
Comp-Att-Int.....	19-32-2	13-22-1
Sacked-Yards Lost.....	4-35	3-20
Punts.....	5-44.0	7-42.571
Fumbles-Lost.....	2-2	2-0
Penalties-Yards.....	16-130	14-150
Time of Possession.....	30:59	29:01

NFL WEEK 4

SEPT. 13	SEPT. 20	SEPT. 27	OCT. 4	OCT. 11	OCT. 19	WEEK 7	NOV. 1	NOV. 8	NOV. 12	NOV. 23	NOV. 29	DEC. 6	DEC. 13	DEC. 20	WEEK 16	WEEK 17	WEEK 18
L	L	W	L	11	19	BYE	1	8	12	23	29	6	13	20			
@ PHI	@ DAL	vs. SEA	vs. IND	vs. NYG	@ SF		vs. PHI	vs. LAR	@ NYG	vs. CIN	@ ARI	@ TEN	vs. HOU	vs. ATL	@ MIN	@ JAX	vs. DAL
24-22	37-20	33-31	30-13	1 p.m. Fox	8:15 p.m. ABC, ESPN		8:20 p.m. NBC	1 p.m. Fox	8:15 p.m. Prime Video	8:15 p.m. ESPN	4:25 p.m. Fox	1 p.m. CBS	1 p.m. CBS	1 p.m. Fox	TBD TBD	TBD TBD	TBD TBD

In a London loss, injuries keep haunting Commanders

COMMANDERS FROM C1

offense was largely inept. Kaliakmanis completed 15 of 33 passes for 186 yards with one touchdown and one interception. Not only was Washington held scoreless across Kaliakmanis's first five drives, but it managed just three first downs. "There's already things stuck in my mind from this game," Kaliakmanis said. "I told my coaches: 'I'm never making that mistake again. Never.' It's burned in my memory now. ... I think some of those times it cost us, and that falls on me as the quarterback. That stuff stings, but I got to learn from it."

The drought ended when wide receiver Treyton Burks shed Colts cornerback Sauce Gardner on a double move and hauled in a deep shot from Kaliakmanis for a 47-yard touchdown in the third quarter. That cut Indianapolis's lead to 17-13.

Following a Colts field goal, Kaliakmanis uncorked another pretty pass to wide receiver Dymai Brown for 48 yards. The Commanders would come up scoreless, though, after they failed to pick up a blitz and Kaliakmanis was sacked out of field goal range.

The Commanders nearly tied the game on their next drive, but the offense committed two penalties that negated what would've been an 87-yard catch and run by wide receiver Antonio Williams. Indianapolis promptly made the Commanders pay with a nine-play, 52-yard touchdown drive — capped by quarterback Daniel Jones's four-yard run — that put Washington down double digits for good.

"We say the same thing every week: 'We got to fix it,'" left tackle Brandon Coleman said. "But it's just [nonsense]. ... At the end of the day, it's on us as an offense."

Coach Dan Quinn said Mariota injured the same MCL he sprained in his right knee Aug. 14. Although Mariota went on to miss the rest of the preseason, he was healthy by Week 1. He will get an MRI exam once the team returns from London.

Kaliakmanis, 23, made the roster after beating out veteran Sam Hartman for the third-string quarterback job. Washington drafted Kaliakmanis in



The Commanders let Colts running back Jonathan Taylor rush for 95 yards and two touchdowns, though their secondary held up better.

the seventh round in April after he finished a five-year college career split between Minnesota and Rutgers.

"I thought he also showed a lot of confidence and some fearlessness," Quinn said. "He made some of the throws to highlight why he is where he is. As far as the full team, I didn't think we did enough around him."

For the second straight week, the Commanders' defense got off to an excellent start. On the second play of the game, outside linebacker Odafé Oweh pushed Indianapolis left tackle Bernhard Raimann back into Jones, which caused the quarterback to slip and lose the ball. Oweh recovered the fumble to give Washington possession deep in Indianapolis territory.

After the Commanders took an early lead on a field goal, their defense forced another quick stop on a three-and-out. That was when a lineup change from defensive coordinator Daronte Jones showed up: Cornerback Mike Sainristil was benched.

Amik Robertson started at outside cornerback alongside

Rasul Douglas, but Robertson moved inside whenever Washington used its nickel package. In that formation, Fabian Moreau replaced Robertson on the outside.

The switch-up in the secondary yielded results for the Commanders' pass defense. Daniel Jones completed just 56 percent of his passes for 143 yards and threw a brutal interception to Douglas.

Of course, it helped that Washington's pass rush got after Indianapolis's offensive line. It registered two sacks and six quarterback hits while generating plenty of pressure.

"I am pleased," Quinn said when asked about the defensive progress. "In the early stages, we had had some miscommunications that resulted in big plays. To see that process taking place to improve upon [that], I think that points to the players to say, 'This is where we can level up.'"

The defense's biggest blemish: It allowed Indianapolis running back Jonathan Taylor to rush for 95 yards and two touchdowns. But 17 of the Colts' points came on drives that start-

ed with the ball near midfield or in Washington territory, so the defense played better than the final score indicated.

"We lost, so it wasn't good enough," Douglas said. "You know what I mean? That's how we look at it."

The defense's efforts were wasted because the offense fell apart. Losing Mariota was the backbreaker, but there were other issues.

Washington made a lineup change in an attempt to assist its shorthanded offensive line. After shifting Nick Allegretti from center to right guard to fill in for Sam Cosmi (concussion) against the Seahawks, the Commanders stuck with Lucas Patrick at center Sunday. But in a surprise move, the Commanders benched Allegretti and started rookie Matt Gulbin at right guard in Cosmi's place.

Quinn said the decision was made partly because Allegretti was limited in practice with a hip injury this week. Asked whether Allegretti would be benched moving forward, he responded: "No, I don't see it that way."

That adjustment didn't do much for the Commanders' offensive line, which struggled mightily at both run blocking and protecting Kaliakmanis.

"We knew that's what they're going to do: They're going to dial him up," Gulbin said. "We've got to do a better job of communicating and protecting."

The pass catchers were solid without wide receiver Terry McLaurin, who was inactive after suffering a hamstring injury in practice Friday. But offensive coordinator David Blough's unit was plagued by costly procedural miscues and penalties for the second week in a row. That, combined with poor blocking and a lackluster run game, doomed Kaliakmanis and the offense.

The Commanders will return to Northwest Stadium to host the New York Giants next Sunday. Quinn said he expects Daniels to be a full practice participant throughout the week, which puts him on track to start.

"That's the goal for Jayden: To throw a full-on week," Quinn said. "This week, it'll be the plan for him to do all the reps."

Colts 30, Commanders 13

INDIANAPOLIS	0	10	7	10	30
WASHINGTON	6	0	7	0	13

FIRST QUARTER

Washington: FG Stevens 31, 12:57. Drive: 4 plays, 8 yards, 1:41. Key Play: Mariota 9 pass to Diggs on 3rd-and-11.

Washington: FG Stevens 29, 6:21. Drive: 8 plays, 70 yards, 4:18. Key Plays: Mariota 35 run; Mariota 35 pass to Crosby-Merritt on 3rd-and-6.

SECOND QUARTER

Indianapolis: Taylor 5 run (Shrader kick), 3:23. Drive: 9 plays, 46 yards, 5:07. Key Plays: Jones 12 pass to Warren on 3rd-and-2; Jones 5 pass to Downs on 3rd-and-14. Indianapolis: FG Shrader 48, 3:00. Drive: 3 plays, 51 yards, 1:09. Key Plays: Jones 23 pass to Dulin; Taylor 4 run on 3rd-and-10.

THIRD QUARTER

Indianapolis: Taylor 5 run (Shrader kick), 12:45. Drive: 4 plays, 20 yards, 1:24. Key Plays: Jones 12 pass to Warren return to Washington 20; Jones 11 pass to Treadwell on 3rd-and-6.

Washington: T.Burks 47 pass from Kaliakmanis (Stevens kick), 10:39. Drive: 6 plays, 70 yards, 2:06. Key Plays: Lane kick return to Washington 30; Kaliakmanis 11 pass to Ekeler.

Indianapolis: FG Shrader 52, 7:03. Drive: 8 plays, 32 yards, 3:36. Key Plays: McGowan kick return to Indianapolis 34; Taylor 10 run; Jones 13 pass to Warren; Jones 6 pass to O.Burks on 3rd-and-8.

FOURTH QUARTER

Indianapolis: Jones 4 run (Shrader kick), 11:38. Drive: 9 plays, 52 yards, 4:57. Key Plays: Jones 1 run on 3rd-and-1; Taylor 12 run; Taylor 12 run.

Indianapolis: FG Shrader 44, 5:48. Drive: 5 plays, 20 yards, 2:22. Key Plays: McGowan 11 run; Taylor 1 run on 3rd-and-2.

A: 60,907.

	Ind	Was
FIRST DOWNS	17	12
Rushing	10	4
Passing	6	7
Penalty	1	1
THIRD DOWN EFF	5-16	2-15
FOURTH DOWN EFF	1-1	1-4
TOTAL NET YARDS	257	317
Total Plays	64	61
Avg Gain	3.9	5.2
NET YARDS RUSHING	128	100
Rushes	30	22
Avg per rush	4.287	4.545
NET YARDS PASSING	129	217
Sacked-Yds lost	2-14	2-15
Gross-Yds passing	143	232
Completed-Att	19-34	18-37
Had Intercepted	1	1
Yards-Pass Play	3.583	5.564
KICKOFFS-EndZone-TB	6-0-0	4-1-0
PUNTS-Avg	4-53.25	5-37.8
Punts blocked	0	0
FGs-PATs blocked	0-0	0-0
TOTAL RETURN YARDAGE	109	182
Punt Returns	0-0	2-17
Kickoff Returns	4-102	6-162
Interceptions	1-7	1-3
PENALTIES-Yds	1-5	10-64
FUMBLES-Lost	1-1	0-0
TIME OF POSSESSION	30:40	29:20

RUSHING

Indianapolis: Taylor 20-95, McGowan 6-31, Jones 4-2. Washington: Mariota 1-35, Ekeler 4-29, Kaliakmanis 3-16, Crosby-Merritt 9-15, Reynolds 2-4, Allen 3-1.

PASSING

Indianapolis: Jones 19-34-1-143. Washington: Kaliakmanis 15-33-1-186, Mariota 3-4-46.

RECEIVING

Indianapolis: Treadwell 5-42, Warren 5-41, Dulin 3-29, Downs 3-16, McGowan 1-7, Burks 1-6, Taylor 1-2. Washington: Diggs 5-35, Brown 3-45, Williams 3-21, Crosby-Merritt 2-35, Okonkwo 2-5, Burks 1-47, Coleman 1-13, Ekeler 1-11.

PUNT RETURNS

Indianapolis: None. Washington: Lane 2-17.

KICKOFF RETURNS

Indianapolis: McGowan 4-102. Washington: Brown 3-82, Lane 3-80.

TACKLES-ASSISTS-SACKS

Indianapolis: Walley 3-3-1, Davis-Gaither 5-3-0, Carlies 3-2-0, Stewart 2-4-0, Buckner 2-2-0, Haulcy 2-1-0, Gardner 2-0-0, Tillery 1-4-0, Latu 1-2-5, Ajiake 1-0-0, Bynum 1-0-0, Ward 1-0-0, Boettcher 0-3-0, Curry 0-2-0, Kay 0-2-0, Tulimolao 0-2-0, Adebawore 0-1-5. Washington: Robertson 7-2-0, Douglas 5-1-0, Styles 4-4-0, Reeves 4-3-0, Martin 3-2-0, Payne 3-1-0, Kinlaw 3-0-0, Luvu 1-4-0, Oweh 1-0-1, Butler 1-0-0, Moreau 1-0-0, Chaisson 0-4-5, Settle 0-2-5, Medrano 0-1-0, Josephs 0-1-0.

INTERCEPTIONS

Indianapolis: Carlies 1-7. Washington: Douglas 1-3.

OFFICIALS

Referee Alan Ede; Ump Paul King, HL David Oliver, LJ Greg Bradley, EJ Fred Dimpfel, SJ Dale Shaw, BJ Grants Bell, Replay Joe Wollan.

When Daniels comes back, he will rejoin a decimated roster. Can he succeed?

DANIELS FROM C1

said he expects Daniels to be a full participant in practice this week. Barring a setback, that means he will play.

It goes without saying that Washington (1-3) is a much better team with Daniels on the field, but his return in itself won't be enough to right the course. Quarterback, after all, was far from the only issue against the Colts.

Beyond Daniels, Washington was decimated by injuries. Wide receiver Terry McLaurin was inactive after suffering a hamstring injury during practice Friday. Right guard Sam Cosmi (concussion) and safety Nick Cross (internal) didn't even make the trip to London.

The injuries continued to pile up after kickoff. Quarterback Marcus Mariota suffered a right knee injury when he was sacked midway through the first quarter and missed the rest of the game. Mariota, who aggravated the MCL he sprained during the Commanders' preseason opener Aug. 14, will undergo an MRI exam early this week to determine the severity.

Rookie Athan Kaliakmanis replaced Mariota. He connected on a couple of nice passes downfield but struggled overall in his NFL debut. If Mariota misses time, Kaliakmanis will probably serve as Daniels's backup.

Defensive end Charles Omenihu (groin), kick returner Jaylin Lane (ankle) and special teams ace Tyler Owens (hamstring) were also knocked out of the game. The players and coaches won't use the injuries as an excuse, but that's a lot to endure.

Perhaps the most affected unit is the offensive line. Without Cosmi and left tackle Laremy Tunsil (torn triceps), its play has been rough. Washing-



Commanders wide receiver and kick returner Jaylin Lane, center, injured his ankle against the Colts, joining a growing list of weary teammates traveling home from London.

ton averaged just 4.2 yards per carry on designed runs against the Colts and frequently allowed Mariota and Kaliakmanis to be pressured.

If Daniels is playing through an injury, an unreliable offensive line is a pressing concern.

Cosmi may return this week, which would give the big guys, up front a much-needed jolt.

"For us, having the run game is going to be a big deal," Quinn said. "... That's the sweet spot: Where you can balance both of them together. We don't have

to make it where [Daniels] is a drop-back player and it's, 'Hey, do all your magic every time.'"

The wide receiver group was productive without McLaurin, but it will still hurt Daniels's ability to make plays if his top target misses additional time.

"It was best to hold him out," Quinn said of McLaurin. "He desperately wanted to go."

The health of Cosmi and McLaurin notwithstanding, Daniels will be entering a standard situation the next time he takes the field. Although he

has shown the ability overcome such circumstances, he hasn't done so consistently since his rookie year.

It's not necessarily fair to Daniels, but that's the player the Commanders will need to salvage this season.



DYLAN WIDGER/IMAGN IMAGES

Under Coach Michael Locksley, the Terrapins haven't won a Big Ten game in almost 400 days.

PERSPECTIVE

For Terps the results sound very familiar

MARYLAND FROM C1

The inspection shows: Extremely unsuccessful!

So unsuccessful that whether Locksley even makes it to the end of the season has become a prevailing question.

It really has been the “Same Old Maryland.”

Not because every loss looks identical. Maryland was overwhelmed by UCLA in a 51-point blowout last Saturday. It spent all of the Virginia Tech game chasing from behind. Against Nebraska, it played well enough early to build a nine-point lead.

The mistakes change. The result usually doesn't.

Maryland nearly had a punt blocked on its opening possession Saturday, escaping as Nebraska was called for roughing the kicker. The warning changed nothing. The next time Bryce McPerson punted, Nebraska blocked it and scored a touchdown a play later.

A third and 27 that should have ended another Nebraska possession became a first down after a late penalty. On the Cornhuskers' final touchdown drive of the first half, Maryland was flagged four times. There's also the pick-six while the Terps were threatening to take a double-dig it lead, a 1-for-14 performance on third down and another fourth quarter that slipped away.

That's what becomes difficult to excuse in Year 8. These are no longer isolated mistakes.

Maryland is 2 for 29 on third down over the past two games. It hasn't won a fourth quarter in Big Ten play since Oct. 26, 2024. Washington, the centerpiece of the offense and one of the biggest reasons for optimism entering the season, has thrown six interceptions in two weeks, three returned for touchdowns.

The recurring blunders are the characteristics of Locksley's undisciplined program.

And then came the coach's postgame promises Saturday.

“We're going to keep getting up.”

“We just got to keep doubling down on the work.”

“I'm going to continue to show up and do the necessary work until the results catch up.”

Locksley's words feel empty. Effort still matters, and there's nothing wrong with preaching resilience. But the same promises keep arriving after the same kinds of losses. Locksley entered the season saying the Terps' work would speak for itself.

So far, it has. Just not in the way he intended. Ohio State is next. Rutgers follows, then a bye week. Maybe Maryland finds something before then, but it's not likely in Columbus.

Patience is getting harder to justify. And so is believing another promise that things will eventually look different.

Shop The Post Store



COLLEGE FOOTBALL

SATURDAY'S RESULTS EAST

Albany (N.Y.) 28, Delaware State 3
Bryant 31, North Carolina A&T 30
CSU 45, Wagner 14
Cornell 35, Georgetown 14
Dartmouth 14, Penn 10
Eastern Michigan 38, Massachusetts 14
Harvard 20, Colgate 17
Indiana 47, Rutgers 15
LIU Brooklyn 27, Mercyhurst 24
Lehigh 34, Fordham 10
Monmouth (N.J.) 41, Towson 40
Morgan State 38, Villanova 35
New Hampshire 30, Elon 23
Princeton 35, Columbia 13
Rhode Island 13, Brown 10
Richmond 40, Lafayette 31
Robert Morris 33, Norfolk State 31
Sacred Heart 24, Maine 16
Syracuse 42, Connecticut 41, (OT)
Western Michigan 20, Buffalo 17
Yale 41, Merrimack 24

SOUTH

Alabama 56, Mississippi State 23
Alabama Birmingham 33, Samford 14
Arkansas-Pine Bluff 41, Southern 10
Bethune 38, Alabama State 10
ETSU 14, Chattanooga 3
Florida Atlantic 66, Texas Southern 10
Florida State 38, Virginia 7
Georgetown 38, Vanderbilt 14
Georgia Southern 31, Coastal Carolina 24
Georgia State 42, Old Dominion 10
Grambling State 63, Alcorn State 59
Holy Cross 41, William & Mary 14
Howard 27, Hampton 13
Jackson State 31, Alabama A&M 28
James Madison 45, Marshall 17
Kentucky 35, South Carolina 34 (OT)
LSU 63, McNeese State 14
Louisiana Tech 31, Army 29
Louisiana-Lafayette 23, Arkansas State 20
MSU 26, Prairie View 27
Memphis 59, Charlotte 6
Mercer 54, VMI 3
Miami 41, Clemson 13
NC State 31, Louisville 28
North Alabama 20, Eastern Kentucky 16
Notre Dame 37, North Carolina 26
Presbyterian 55, St. Thomas (Minn.) 21
South Alabama 52, Louisiana-Monroe 35
Temple 17, South Florida 13
Tennessee 24, Auburn 14
The Citadel 34, SC State 31
Valparaiso 37, Morehead State 3
Western Carolina 44, Tennessee Tech 20
Wake Forest 57, Stanford 3
Wofford 32, Furman 25

MIDWEST

Bowling Green 24, Miami (Ohio) 20
Central Michigan 41, Akron 17
Drake 30, Dayton 22
Iowa State 45, West Virginia 42
Kansas 55, Middle Tennessee 0
Minnesota 20, Michigan 14
Missouri 45, Florida 17
North Dakota State 28, Wyoming 0
Nebraska 48, Montana 13
North Dakota 55, Murray State 28
Ohio 13, Kent State 10
Ohio State 31, Iowa 14
Purdue 24, Illinois 17
South Dakota State 31, Illinois State 14
South Dakota 44, Indiana State 14
Toledo 39, Ball State 24
Western Illinois 28, Tennessee State 21
Wisconsin 31, Michigan State 3
Youngstown State 28, Southern Illinois 16

SOUTHWEST

BYU 17, TCU 10
Houston 27, Central Florida 17
Houston Christian 16, Nicholls 2
SMU 25, Stephen College 16
Texas A&M 34, Arkansas 7
UTSA 16, Rice 14
Air Force 14, Navy 9
Arizona 34, Cincinnati 7
Baylor 35, Arizona State 19
Boise State 47, Utah State 18
Fresno State 26, Washington State 6
Montana 36, Northern Colorado 14
New Mexico 61, Texas-El Paso 7
Oregon State 56, Colorado State 26
Sacramento 34, Utah Tech 33
San Diego State 31, Texas State 29
San José State 20, Hawaii 16
USC 25, Washington 21
Texas Tech 29, Colorado 7
UC Davis 49, Eastern Washington 38
UNLV 39, California 31

WEST

Air Force 14, Navy 9
Arizona 34, Cincinnati 7
Baylor 35, Arizona State 19
Boise State 47, Utah State 18
Fresno State 26, Washington State 6
Montana 36, Northern Colorado 14
New Mexico 61, Texas-El Paso 7
Oregon State 56, Colorado State 26
Sacramento 34, Utah Tech 33
San Diego State 31, Texas State 29
San José State 20, Hawaii 16
USC 25, Washington 21
Texas Tech 29, Colorado 7
UC Davis 49, Eastern Washington 38
UNLV 39, California 31

No. 4 Miami 41, Clemson 13

Late Saturday

MIAMI10 7 7 17 — 41
CLEMSON3 3 0 7 — 13

FIRST QUARTER

MIA: Barkate 61 pass from Mensah (Weinberg kick), 13:05.

MIA: FG Weinberg 50, 3:11.

CLEM: FG Hauser 48, 4:04.

SECOND QUARTER

MIA: Mensah 34 run (Weinberg kick), 13:42.

CLEM: FG Hauser 29, 0:0.

THIRD QUARTER

MIA: Fletcher 2 run (Weinberg kick), 1:51.

FOURTH QUARTER

MIA: FG Weinberg 24, 14:48.

CLEM: Davidson 2 run (Hauser kick), 12:09.

MIA: Fletcher 1 run (Weinberg kick), 6:24.

MIA: Dunnigan 39 interception return (Weinberg kick), 1:49.

A: 80, 46:3.

CLEM

First downs25 22
Total Net Yards419 350
Rushes-yards35-192 31-55
Passing227 295
Punt Returns1-11 1-4
Kickoff Returns1-42 0-0
Interceptions Ret.1-39 0-0
Comp-Att-Int18-27-0 29-44-1
Sacked-Yards Lost-2-7 6-35
Punts1-4 1-1
Fumbles-Lost3-48, 6:67 5-35, 8
Penalties-Yards6-58 10-91
Time of Possession32:29 27:31

RUSHING

Miami: Fletcher 16-77, Mallory 14-63, Mensah 3-27, MaToney 1-19, Pringle 1-6. Clemson: CrJohnson 5-32, Davidson 7-25, Green 3-14, Pearman 1-6, Denson 1-0, Reynolds 14-63 (min 22).

PASSING

Miami: Mensah 18-27-0-227. Clemson: Reynolds 29-44-1-295.

RECEIVING

Miami: Barkate 5-98, MaToney 5-40, Upshaw 3-39, Lofton 3-34, Fletcher 2-16. Clemson: T.Brown 10-76, Moore 9-152, CrJohnson 1-10, Preston 1-7, Bentancur 1-5, Patt-Henry 1-5, Davidson 1-3, Sellars 1-1 (min 2).

No. 6 Indiana 47, Rutgers 15

Late Saturday

INDIANA10 13 14 10 — 47
RUTGERS0 0 7 8 — 15

FIRST QUARTER

IND: Becker 9 pass from Hoover (Radick kick), 8:24.

IND: FG Radick 39, 1:30.

SECOND QUARTER

IND: Chandler 2 pass from Hoover (kick failed), 9:30.

IND: Richard 14 run (Radick kick), 6:21.

THIRD QUARTER

IND: Marsh 12 pass from Hoover (Radick kick), 12:22.

IND: Becker 3 pass from Hoover (Radick kick), 5:36.

RUTG: Black 53 pass from Surace (Pizzaro kick), 3:52.

FOURTH QUARTER

RUTG: Thevenin 1 run (Carter run), 11:11.

IND: Beebe 13 (Radick kick), 7:43.

IND: FG Radick 48, 2:25.

IND

First downs26 9
Total Net Yards593 254
Rushes-yards39-229 35-59
Passing264 195
Punt Returns0-0 0-0
Kickoff Returns0-0 0-0
Interceptions Ret.0-0 0-0
Comp-Att-Int21-29-0 11-20-0
Sacked-Yards Lost-1-10 4-24
Punts2-38, 5 7-44, 71.4
Fumbles-Lost0-0 1-1
Penalties-Yards0-0 1-5
Time of Possession33:02 26:58

RUSHING

Indiana: Richard 13-204, Beebe 18-122, Campbell 2-7, Cuono 2-1, (Team) 1-(minus 2), Hoover 3-(minus 3). Rutgers: Thevenin 12-47, A.Raymond 11-31, Loneragan 1-0, Gibson 2-(minus 2), Ashenfeller 2-(minus 3), Surace 7-(minus 14).

PASSING

Indiana: Hoover 20-27-0-251, Wilson 1-2-0-13. Rutgers: Surace 6-10-0-128, Loneragan 5-10-0-67.

RECEIVING

Indiana: Becker 8-107, Marsh 7-120, Preston 2-24, Chandler 2-7, Richard 1-4, Morris 1-2. Rutgers: Duff 4-78, A.Raymond 2-7, Black 1-53, Carter 1-35, Houston 1-10, Thevenin 1-10, Coke 1-2.

No. 11 LSU 63, McNeese 14

Late Saturday

MCNEESE ST.0 0 14 0 — 14
LSU14 21 14 14 — 63

FIRST QUARTER

LSU: D.Jones 1 run (Starzyk kick), 9:23.

LSU: Mothershed 1 pass from Leavitt (Starzyk kick), 3:18.

SECOND QUARTER

LSU: Clark 3 run (Starzyk kick), 7:37.

LSU: Barber 6 pass from Leavitt (Starzyk kick), 4:01.

LSU: Barber 12 pass from Leavitt (Starzyk kick), 57.

THIRD QUARTER

LSU: Gerald 1 run (Starzyk kick), 11:34.

LSU: H.Berry 11 run (Starzyk kick), 8:22.

MCNS: Levi 43 pass from Barrier (De.Cannon kick), 4:48.

MCNS: Levi 64 run (De.Cannon kick), 3:32.

FOURTH QUARTER

LSU: Gage 46 run (Starzyk kick), 13:56.

LSU: Gage 39 run (Starzyk kick), 10:55.

A: 102, 32:1.

First downs6 39
Total Net Yards196 731
Rushes-yards30-102 53-367
Passing94 364
Punt Returns0-0 0-0
Kickoff Returns0-0 1-19
Interceptions Ret.1-7 1-21
Comp-Att-Int8-17-1 31-48-1
Sacked-Yards Lost-3-16 0-0
Punts10-43, 6 2-0 2-0
Fumbles-Lost1-0 2-0
Penalties-Yards4-32 3-11
Time of Possession22:47 37:13

RUSHING

McNeese St.: Levi 1-64, Wiggins 10-21, Swilley 5-18, Citizen 6-4, M.Davis 1-2, Barrier 3-0, Strong 4-(minus 7). LSU: Berry 15-125, Gage 6-110, D.Jones 16-79, Longstreet 4-32, Durham 5-13, Clark 3-11, Gerald 1-1, Gainey 2-0, (Team) 1-(minus 4).

PASSING

McNeese St.: Barrier 5-7-0-74, Strong 3-10-1-20. LSU: Leavitt 18-23-1-176, Clark 7-16-0-126, Longstreet 6-9-0-62.

RECEIVING

McNeese St.: Levi 2-46, So.Lewis 1-17, Deville 1-11, Sengal 1-7, Swilley 1-4, Haman 1-5, Citizen 1-2. LSU: Barber 7-53, Wilson 4-58, Jayc.Brown 4-52, Harris 4-27, T.Brown 3-50, Watkins 3-50, Mothershed 2-11, D.Jones 2-5, Elzy 1-25, Jo.Jackson 1-3.

No. 12 Texas Tech 29, Colorado 7

Late Saturday

TEXAS TECH7 0 9 17 — 29
COLORADO3 0 0 7 — 7

FIRST QUARTER

COLO: Jo.Williams 8 pass from L.Wilson (Arnold kick), 10:29.

TTU: FG Harrington 52, 7:05.

THIRD QUARTER

TTU: FG Harrington 27, 9:09.

TTU: T.Carter 11 pass from Hammond (pass failed), 3:01.

FOURTH QUARTER

TTU: FG Harrington 46, 13:42.

TTU: Curry 0 interception return (Harrington kick), 7:10.

TTU: Curry 30 run (Harrington kick), 3:06.

A: 50, 10:6.

First downs19 22
Total Net Yards315 375
Rushes-yards37-181 32-78
Passing234 297
Punt Returns1-9 0-0
Kickoff Returns0-0 0-0
Interceptions Ret.0-0 0-0
Comp-Att-Int17-26-0 28-48-4
Sacked-Yards Lost-2-14 1-2
Punts3-55, 6:67 4-0 0-0
Fumbles-Lost0-0 0-0
Penalties-Yards6-51 8-84
Time of Possession28:56 31:04

RUSHING

Texas Tech: J.Williams 17-88, Quinte-Joyner 10-43, Dick-ey 4-15, Rowden 1-8, Hammond 5-7, Colorado: Hick-ley 17-42, Henderson 3-19, Welch 2-5, R.Young 4-5, Mitchell 1-4, Taylor 1-2, J.Smith 4-1.

PASSING

Texas Tech: Hammond 17-26-0-134. Colorado: Wilson 26-44-3-290, Sweetweyne 1-2-0-7, J.Williams 1-2-1-0.

RECEIVING

Texas Tech: Taylor 8-67, J.Williams 3-26, Hudson 2-24, Eakin 1-12, Ke.Johnson 1-8, Carpenter 1-7, Lee 1-(minus 2). Colorado: J.Williams 10-93, Farrakhan 4-29, D.Moore 3-42, Welch 2-28, Wilson 2-7, Gibson 1-30, Henderson 1-30, Taylor 1-3, C.Williams 1-16, Clements 1-9, Campbell 1-3, Mitchell 1-3.

No. 18 USC 25, Washington 21

Late Saturday

WASHINGTON7 7 7 0 — 21
SOUTHERN CAL3 7 12 3 — 25

FIRST QUARTER

USC: FG Chittenden 26, 8:35.

WASH: Naone 5 pass from Ruebuck (Robles kick), 1:46.

SECOND QUARTER

USC: Jordan 8 run (Chittenden kick), 9:58.

WASH: Eldridge 1 run (Robles kick), 1:50.

THIRD QUARTER

WASH: DeGraaf 42 pass from D.Williams (Robles kick), 13:30.

USC: Hines 10 pass from Maiva (run failed), 6:30.

USC: Stewart 48 fumble return (run failed), 4:40.

FOURTH QUARTER

USC: FG Chittenden 39, 9:36.

A: 59, 13:6.

First downs15 21
Total Net Yards319 360
Rushes-yards33-116 35-115
Passing203 245
Punt Returns2-18 4-25
Kickoff Returns1-25 0-0
Interceptions Ret.0-0 0-0
Comp-Att-Int16-27-0 21-34-1
Sacked-Yards Lost-6-24 0-0
Punts5-49, 8 6-51, 6:67
Fumbles-Lost1-1 1-0
Penalties-Yards10-74 9-84
Time of Possession25:02 34:58

RUSHING

Washington: Bonner 19-89, D.Williams 13-26, Eldridge 1-1. Southern Cal: Ki-Miller 18-81, Jordan 11-36, Alston 1-8, (Team) 1-(minus 2), Maiva 3-(minus 3), Dixon-Wyatt 1-(minus 5).

PASSING

Washington: D.Williams 15-26-0-198, Ruebuck 1-1-0-5. Southern Cal: Maiva 21-34-1-245.

RECEIVING

Washington: Lawson 5-82, Ruebuck 5-30, Naone 3-40, DeGraaf 2-49, Bonner 1-2. Southern Cal: Hines 5-51, Pusey 54,089,385

WOMEN'S SINGLES — QUARTERFINALS

Hubert Hurkacz, Poland, def. Karan Khachanov, Russia, 7-6 (2), 6-2; Alex de Minaur (5), Australia, def. Andrey Rublev, Russia, 1-6, 6-2, 6-2; Daniil Medvedev (3), Russia, def. Francisco Cerundolo, Argentina, 4-6 (7-4), 6-3; Novak Djokovic (6), Serbia, def. Alexander Zverev (1), Germany, 4-6, 6-4, 6-4.

WOMEN'S SINGLES — ROUND OF 32

Sinja Kraus, Austria, def. Dayana Yastremska, Ukraine, 6-1, 6-4; Nikola Bartunkova (26), Czech Republic, def. Aryna Sabalenka (2), Belarus, 6-4, 6-3; Ekaterina Alexandrova (19), Russia, def. Diana Shnaider (11), Russia, 2-6, 6-4, 6-3; Mirra Andreeva (4), Russia, def. Polina Kukharenko, Russia, 6-4, 6-1; Linda Noskova (5), Czech Republic, def. Viktorija Golubic, Switzerland, 6-2, 6-1; Daria Shapovalov, Ukraine, def. Taylah Preston, Australia, 6-1, 6-0; Naomi Osaka (12), Japan, def. Sara Belkic (20), Croatia, 7-6 (7-4), 6-4; Karolina Muchova (7), Czech Republic, def. Liudmila Samsonova (29), Russia, 4-6, 6-4, 6-2.

ATP/WT



Richard Ables, director of Hall Brothers Funeral Home on Florida Avenue, in 2019 — the year it closed because of financial difficulties.

A beloved funeral director is ready for his own send-off

Richard Ables, who presided over the historic Hall Brothers Funeral Home, buried generations of Black Washingtonians

BY PAUL SCHWARTZMAN

As a funeral director, Richard Ables Sr. guided generations of Washingtonians through the wrenching ritual of burying loved ones, helping families choose cemetery plots and caskets, and dressing the dead for a last milestone. Ables, as it turns out, was no less meticulous about his own passing. After his death Sept. 13, at the age of 84, his children knew what their father wanted: to be dressed in a smoking jacket and silky pants as he lay in repose, with a band playing renditions of jazz greats like Thelonious Monk and Duke Ellington. The casket, too, had to be just so.

“He’d say, ‘Send me home in a mahogany casket,’” his daughter Geneita Russell said as she prepared for his funeral. “That was my dad. He wanted it classy.” For four decades, Ables presided at Hall Brothers Funeral Home on Florida Avenue, a business his uncles, Ocy and Macy Hall, founded in the early 1940s and that he eventually took over before shutting down seven years ago. Across from the Howard Theatre, Hall Brothers for generations was a fixture in D.C.’s Black community, a place that blue-collar and middle-class families relied on to orchestrate the most delicate of life’s rituals. By 2019, when it was the last of the Black-owned funeral parlors still on the U Street and

Florida Avenue corridor, Hall Brothers’ financial demise symbolized Washington’s demographic transformation. Chocolate City, as D.C. was once known, was no more. “They moved out or died out,” Ables told The Washington Post that year, referring to his vanishing customer base. “I’m sitting in here, dying with the business. It’s time to go.” The changes were not without benefits. After closing the Hall Brothers headquarters — an 1892 rowhouse for which his uncle had paid \$10,000 — Ables sold the property for nearly \$2 million. A developer turned the building into condominiums and named it — yes, really — “Washington.” SEE ABLES ON C11

Sentenced to death in 2001. Freed last week.

Plea deal marks end of decades-long legal battle in murder-for-hire case

BY DAN MORSE

A Virginia man once sentenced to death in a 2001 murder-for-hire case was released from prison after a plea deal finalized last Monday ended his decades-long legal battle, his attorneys said. Justin Michael Wolfe, whose case attracted national attention as an example of suburban youths dabbling in the worlds of drugs and death, pleaded guilty to two lesser charges of conspiracy to distribute marijuana and solicitation of robbery, according to court records. The latter disposition was made under an Alford plea, meaning a defendant doesn’t admit guilt but does admit that prosecutors have

enough evidence to potentially get a conviction. The order last week also finalized that all previous convictions in the case have been vacated and that charges related to them are dismissed, according to Wolfe’s attorneys. “After 25 years of rank injustice, Justin has achieved a measure of justice that long eluded him,” said one of Wolfe’s attorneys, Scott Abeles. “In clearing his murder conviction and securing his release, we’ve stood on the shoulders of the lawyers who preceded us. Today belongs to Justin and his close-knit family.” In an email, Wolfe’s mother noted that the order came from the same Prince William County Circuit Court where his sentence was first imposed. “In 2002, this court sentenced my son Justin Wolfe to die for murder-for-hire, a crime he did not commit. Today, after a 25-year battle for his life, my son finally gets to come home,” Teresa SEE WOLFE ON C10



Justin Michael Wolfe at his capital murder trial in Prince William County in 2002.

Boots on the school-ground

TENSIONS FLARE OVER TASK FORCE

National Guard, FBI, U.S. Marshals on campus

BY ANGIE ORELLANA HERNANDEZ, BEN CONARCK AND LIAM BOWMAN

Twice in the past few weeks, National Guard members have appeared in places where residents did not expect to see them: congregating outside D.C. public schools around student drop-off times. Jamais Burts-Parker said she encountered troops and FBI agents changing into tactical gear in the immediate vicinity of Bard High School Early College DC last Monday morning. Burts-Parker said she was rattled and left with concerns about whether a serious incident had happened over the weekend that merited a sizable response from federal law enforcement. “And then we found out, no, it’s just a part of this initiative,” said Burts-Parker, who is the president of the school’s parent-teacher organization. “It’s just alarming to drop your kid off, and your kid is seeing armed guards that are trained to be in the military outside of their high school where they’re coming to learn.”

Guard members and the FBI have remained around the school and the nearby Congress Heights Metro station since then, according to residents and to observations by a reporter.

The U.S. Marshals Service, which has spoken for the recently launched initiative, said the agencies are there to deter crime. But the timing of the appearances at the start of the school day has been questioned by community members and educators, who say they’re unsettling families while doing little to move the needle on crime.

The scope of the initiative, which has been reported in at least three neighborhoods, is unclear, and the Marshals Service declined to list all of the locations it has visited so far.

Brady McCarron, a Marshals Service spokesperson, said the team of troops and federal agents is serving warrants, checking on registered sex offenders, patrolling areas to deter crime, passing out fliers for wanted suspects and conducting “goodwill gestures,” which he described as asking residents “how things are going.”

The federal agency says it determines which areas to deploy the task force in by examining crime data, outstanding war- SEE NATIONAL GUARD ON C9

TODAY’S WEATHER

8 a.m.	Noon	4 p.m.	8 p.m.
60°	70°	71°	63°

High today at approx. 3 p.m.: 73°
Precip: 5% Wind: NW 8-16 mph
For weather news, go to C16

VIRGINIA

Neighbors rally behind couple after child gets rare diagnosis. C11

MARYLAND

In national first, the state now has an official shark — and it’s a big one. C16

OBITUARY

Harriet Hancock, LGBTQ activist in a conservative state, was 89. C12



D.C. residents unnerved by task force activity at schools

NATIONAL GUARD FROM C8

rants and the number of registered sex offenders living there.

“When a spike of calls is seen in a certain area of the city, that area will be the one that the team will go to,” McCarron said. “The goal is to see the trend of crime in an area and eliminate it as fast as possible.”

But Mayor Muriel E. Bowser’s office has pushed back, citing community concerns about National Guard troops and federal agents patrolling near D.C.’s schools, recreation centers and voting sites.

“The Bowser Administration has repeatedly requested that the federal taskforce and the National Guard refrain from patrolling near these locations and will continue to do so,” Lindsey Appiah, deputy mayor for public safety, said in a statement.

Overall, crime is down 15 percent in the District since Oct. 1, 2025, McCarron said. “But we want it down even more,” he said. “We want this operation to be *very* successful, not just successful.”

McCarron said the idea for the visits to D.C. schools was born out of discussions about how to reduce crime.

“Since the program has only had a few spots we have focused on over the last two months, we are still calculating to see if it is working,” he said.

There have been three studies so far that have attempted to determine whether the National Guard patrols in D.C. have brought down crime rates, though none of them are peer-reviewed. So far, none of the studies found that the patrols have had an effect on violent crime, though one of them found a “real but narrow improvement” in property crime during the first six months — about a 24 percent reduction that the study suggested could have been achieved in a less expensive manner by adjusting deployments of local police.

The Marshals Service confirmed that at least three operations, including last Monday’s appearance, have taken place as part of this new endeavor emerging from President Donald Trump’s D.C. Safe and Beautiful Task Force, which has sought, among other priorities, increased law enforcement patrols.

The first appearances took place on Aug. 7 and Aug. 8 at Saratoga and Potomac Gardens, McCarron said.

But the operation began to receive media attention around Sept. 17, when large groups of National Guard members and federal agents appeared outside Bruce-Monroe Elementary School in the Park View neighborhood of Northwest Washington as children arrived for the school day.

In interviews with The Washington Post, several parents and nearby residents said they were shocked by the presence of armed law enforcement.

A Park View father, who spoke on the condition of anonymity because of fear of repercussions due to his immigration status, said he observed a U.S. Park Police helicopter flying “really low in very close loops” around the school and the surrounding area. A Park Police spokesperson wrote that its helicopter was operating in the area that day in support of the Marshals Service, but that it was “unrelated to deployments to D.C. area schools.”

The father said an FBI agent approached him and offered a flier promoting cash rewards for tips, reading that “law enforcement is seeking information related to criminal activity.”

Bridget O’Brien, a Park View resident, said she noticed several groups of National Guard



LIAM BOWMAN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Members of the National Guard and FBI walk past a high school on Friday. Residents say the task force is unsettling families while doing little to move the needle on crime.

members and federal agents patrolling the neighborhood that morning. She said she approached one group and asked what they were doing there.

“They basically said, ‘We were asked to come to this neighborhood to engage and deter crime,’ and they asked if I had any requests for them,” O’Brien said. “I said I would like them to leave our neighborhood, and they said they understood and they would try to make it the least unpleasant they could.”

Several Park View residents said large groups of task force members have continued to patrol the neighborhood since Sept. 17.

“They’re trying to remind us that they can have a presence here,” said Vincent Cleveland, who said he is one of several residents following task force activity in the neighborhood. “I think it does put people a bit more on guard.”

A petition urging the city to do more to oppose the presence of task force members outside

schools garnered more than 300 signatures from parents and residents across the District.

“We know from talking to our children that having patrols of uniformed soldiers with military weapons and armed federal enforcement agents leads many of our kids to be fearful and distracted from learning,” the petitioners wrote in a letter to D.C. Council member Brooke Pinto (D-Ward 2), a copy of which was shared with The Post. “As parents and caregivers, we cannot accept this wasteful and unnecessary use of law enforcement resources that we know is creating more fear for our children and risk of violence in our communities instead of more safety.”

In a statement, Pinto said she met with parents from schools across the District “who have seen an alarming increased presence of armed National Guard troops outside their children’s schools.” She called the development “unacceptable.”

“Our kids deserve to go to school in safe, welcoming envi-

ronments, and being exposed to dozens of armed guards as they try to enter their school buildings is not productive, necessary, nor appropriate,” wrote Pinto, adding that she is calling on the guard not to congregate near schools and intends to hold a hearing on the topic on Nov. 5.

LaJoy Johnson-Law, the Ward 8 representative for D.C.’s State Board of Education, said residents, youth advocacy organizations and parents have led a counterresponse since last Monday at Bard DC to ensure that students feel safe arriving to school.

“We want them to know that there’s a community behind you and that there is a community that loves you,” Johnson-Law said. “And that’s what community is.”

Michael Scott, the director of the Center for Problem-Oriented Policing at Arizona State University, said the “fundamental problem” with the Marshals Service’s stated mission for the initiatives at schools is that it is doing the

work uninvited.

Scott, a former police chief, said that collaborative initiatives among local, state and federal law enforcement can work well, but only when they’re mutually agreed upon and primarily at the request of the local agency.

“It’s ludicrous to imagine that you can just throw a National Guardsman or a U.S. marshal into that local context and they could instantly — based on their training and body of knowledge — police in the same way that a properly trained local officer could do it,” he said.

Scott added that he felt it was unfair to ask federal agents to do that, and counterproductive.

“If they’re dealing with local policing in Washington, they’re not dealing with international drug dealers, international fugitives, higher-level federal law enforcement,” Scott said. “So they’re both unnecessary to what they are doing, and they’re depleting and distracting their attention from the things we expect them to do.”

MARYLAND

Illegal short-term rentals in Annapolis can now be fined up to \$5,000

BY BENJAMIN ROTHSTEIN
Capital Gazette

The Annapolis City Council has approved a resolution that raises the maximum violation for illegal short-term rentals to \$5,000, five times what it used to be.

“Most of the people who short-term rent play by the rules. They’re trying their best to follow through on the process that we set out,” said alderman Brooks Schandelmeyer, sponsor of the resolution, during last Monday’s City Council meeting. “There are a couple very loud, annoying schmucks who just don’t care, and I wanted to hit

them with a really big hammer.”

The introduction came after an explosion of short-term rentals within the city, as well as requests from residents for better enforcement of the rules. The city has cracked down on short-term rentals, only about 65 percent of which were estimated to be licensed as of February. The Department of Planning and Zoning hired a contractor specifically to handle short-term rentals. The city also established a lottery system for licenses that will go into effect in November of next year.

Annapolis Mayor Jared Littmann introduced the fine legislation. Alderwoman Karma

O’Neill co-sponsored the resolution alongside Schandelmeyer. The maximum fine before this resolution had been \$1,000.

In practice, the resolution sets the maximum fine for the property owner — matching the state limit for a fine — but the actual amount assessed is up to the discretion of code enforcement. Some people have voiced concerns about the justification for maximum fines. Alderman Harry Huntley voted in support of the resolution, with the caveat that the Department of Planning and Zoning should eventually present exactly how fine amounts are determined. The department will develop inter-

nal guidelines for fine amounts.

Two amendments were proposed to the resolution. The first, from Alderman Rob Savidge, attempted to set the initial offense to a fine of \$2,000.

“I used to be an enforcement officer with the city, and I just generally believe that we should have baked in our code a bit of an escalation of enforcement,” Savidge told the council. “I just think ... we’re setting ourselves up — and I think the public up, and staff up — for potential mistakes and issues where they might just be issuing fines that are way too high.”

Though Huntley was on board, other members ex-

pressed concerns about taking away freedom from the Department of Planning and Zoning, saying that however fines may be determined would ultimately be reasonable.

“I understand the concern about the person who rents for \$200 a night could get a \$5,000 fine. It chokes me up to hear that,” Alderman Frank Thorp said. “But I have a lot of faith — a lot more faith than that in our director of planning and zoning.”

Thorp added that, after 56 investigations into unlicensed short-term rentals conducted by planning and zoning, the goal needed to be deterrence.

Put to a vote, the amendment failed, with Savidge, Huntley and Alderwoman Janice Allsup-Johnson being the only members to vote to approve. The other amendment, which clarified the intention of the resolution in the “whereas” section, passed unanimously.

The resolution passed on the final vote, with only Savidge voting against.

“I am going to vote against this. I do want increased enforcement, and I want improved tools — but again, I think we’re setting ourselves up for failure,” Savidge said.



The Guide to Offers
The Washington Post

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Authorities alleged Wolfe enlisted partner in drug dealing to kill their supplier

WOLFE FROM C8

Steinberg wrote.

The plea “may not be what we had hoped,” she added, “but it does allow for Justin to maintain his innocence, finally be free and our family to begin to heal.”

Prince William County Commonwealth’s Attorney Amy Ashworth said last week’s resolution “is a just and appropriate outcome under the circumstances.”

The evidence regarding Wolfe’s role in the murder has long been complicated, Ashworth said. “There is evidence that Wolfe may have advised or assisted [Owen] Barber prior to the murder, depending upon which version of events is credited,” she said. “At the same time, the evidence does not allow us at this time, given the numerous versions of events since 2001, to definitively establish beyond a reasonable doubt every aspect of what occurred between Wolfe and Barber.”

Last week’s rulings end an odyssey for Wolfe that began in 2001, when authorities claimed that he instructed his alleged partner in drug sales, Owen M. Barber IV, who was 21 at the time, to kill their supplier, a former Chantilly High School classmate named Daniel R. Petrole Jr., also 21. At trial in 2002, Barber testified that Wolfe ordered the fatal shooting in a Bristow, Virginia, apartment parking lot and that Barber emptied a 9mm clip into Petrole’s car, fatally injuring him. Barber got 38 years; Wolfe was sentenced to death.

But the federal courts have repeatedly expressed outrage at the tactics of the Prince William police and prosecutors, who pressured Barber in 2001 to testify against Wolfe or face the death sentence. Barber later retracted his testimony that Wolfe had given the order to kill. But he said he continued to face the threat of a death sentence from Prince William, and he refused to testify on Wolfe’s behalf.

After a new trial was ordered



Justin Michael Wolfe, left, is led from the courtroom in Manassas by a sheriff’s deputy after being found guilty of capital murder on Jan. 22, 2002.

by the federal courts, Wolfe in 2016 wrote a four-page confession in which he said he and Barber had discussed robbing Petrole, but “if Danny [Petrole] fought back or pulled a gun, we agreed that Owen might have to kill Danny. Eventually we both agreed that it would be necessary to kill Danny because he was probably going to resist the robbery or figure out who did it and have to get revenge.”

That statement was part of

Wolfe’s guilty plea to murder and distribution of narcotics, and he received a 41-year sentence. But his lawyers have argued in recent years that the plea was coerced and the confession was false, a result of the unwillingness of Barber — the only witness to have tied Wolfe to the murder, according to Ables — to testify for Wolfe. The U.S. Supreme Court got involved about eight years ago, ordering Virginia courts to review wheth-

er Wolfe’s plea was involuntary, but the state courts rejected the claim.

“What happened to Danny was tragic,” Steinberg wrote. “The Petrole family lost a son. There was never any doubt that Owen Barber killed Danny.”

The way her son’s case was prosecuted, which was sharply criticized last summer by the U.S. Court of Appeals for the 4th Circuit, “only compounded the pain and suffering of all involved.”

In 2022, attorneys for Wolfe asked the U.S. District Court for the Eastern District of Virginia to vacate Wolfe’s conviction and grant his unconditional release, according to court records. Extensive legal filings followed, and the 4th Circuit weighed in last summer.

“The facts of this case span decades and deal with conduct by the Commonwealth of Virginia,” reads an opinion from three of the judges. “Twenty-four years

ago, the Commonwealth decided that Appellant [Wolfe] was a guilty man. From that moment, the Commonwealth has done everything in its power to ensure Appellant dies in prison, eschewing the Constitution, ethical strictures, and Appellant’s own repeated and consistent assertions of actual innocence.”

The opinion led to settlement negotiations that resulted in last week’s resolution, according to court filings.

VIRGINIA

Richmond investigators launch probe into proposed solar contracts

BY SAMUEL B. PARKER
Richmond Times-Dispatch

Richmond City Hall’s inspector general has opened an investigation into a proposed deal between the city and a power company that is seeking to install solar panels on city property.

Reached for comment last week, Inspector General Foster Curtiss said the investigation into the procurement process is “ongoing” and declined to comment on the details. During a City Council meeting last Monday, council member Sarah Abubaker made a veiled reference to “allegations of ethics violations” but did not clarify what part of the procurement process is under review.

A city spokesperson and a spokesperson for Staunton-based Secure Solar Futures both declined to comment.

The inquiry stems from a complex series of proposed leases that would see the company install solar panels on dozens of city buildings and then sell the energy produced back to the city. Mayor Danny Avula’s administration has said the deal would result in nearly \$20 million in energy savings over the 25-year contract term.

But in recent months, the process of approving those leases has hit major roadblocks as members of the City Council and members of Avula’s own administration have expressed concerns about potential risks.

The resulting delays have jeopardized the entire deal, portions of which are up against a tight deadline because of expiring federal solar tax credits the vendor is counting on to fund the project.

Members of City Council led by Abubaker and Kenya Gibson have repeatedly voiced concerns about multiple elements of the agreement, including how much the city would owe if officials decided to end the contract early and who would be responsible for removing and reinstalling the solar panels during routine roof repairs.

The council members aren’t alone.

In a July report, officials in City Hall’s risk management office advised the city to reject the deal in its original form, arguing that it exposed the city to financial risks. And the city’s insurance broker described the deal as “extremely one-sided” and “not in Richmond’s favor.”

In an August email, Chief Administrative Officer Odie Donald II said he was similarly worried about what would happen if “roofs and/or equipment fail or if our partners face fiscal challenges.”

Donald has since reversed course, citing concessions made by the vendor. Those concessions include structural analysis and roof-condition caveats that would allow officials to remove buildings from the list if they’re later deemed unsuitable to accommodate the solar panels, as

well as a five-year cap on the city’s termination-fee obligations.

City Attorney Laura Drewry, meanwhile, has also expressed misgivings, specifically over who would be on the hook if the solar panels created legal liability for the city.

Council kills plan, then tries — and fails — to resurrect it

Last Monday, the tense debate came to a head as City Council deliberated over the solar ordinances for nearly five hours, voted them down by a 5-4 margin — and then tried and failed to bring them back for a second vote.

The conflict centered on the compressed timeline of the proceedings. Multiple council members said they felt they needed more time to ask questions and get answers.

Abubaker said she had prepared her own contract amendments for consideration, and she proposed a special meeting to weigh them. And council member Ellen Robertson said she was trying to come around on the proposals and support the city’s sustainability and green energy goals, but noted that council members still had not received satisfactory follow-up on the risk management assessment.

“To push us to vote on this would force me to vote against something that I do not want to vote against,” Robertson said. Gibson echoed that sentiment.

But citing the federal deadline imposed by President Donald Trump’s tax credit phaseout, City Council President Cynthia Newbille and Vice President Katherine Jordan pressed ahead with a vote on the issue.

They were defeated. Gibson, Abubaker, Robertson, Reva Trammell and Nicole Jones all voted against the deal, while Andrew Breton, Jordan, Stephanie Lynch and Newbille voted in favor.

After the vote, the body deliberated over how to proceed. Several council members wanted to continue discussing the matter and even suggested entering into closed session to review it with city attorneys.

But questions as to whether they could lawfully deliberate over ordinances that had already been rejected created so much confusion that Newbille called a 10-minute recess to allow for the council members to regroup.

When they returned, Newbille noted that, under the City Council’s rules of procedure, the defeated ordinances could be resurrected if a council member from the “prevailing side” — the side that voted them down — made a motion to restore them to the agenda. Despite Newbille’s reiterating that possibility at least three times, no council member made such a motion.

In a statement after the vote, Avula said he was “disappointed in the outcome.”

“We had an extraordinary opportunity before us to reduce

the city’s long-term energy costs, increase the use of renewable energy, and advance Richmond’s commitment to a more sustainable and resilient built environment,” he said. “We listened to hours of testimony from both experienced subject matter experts and ordinary residents.

“It is extremely unfortunate that the majority of Council was not able to find a way to saying yes to this opportunity,” he said. “Actions have consequences, and City Council’s action tonight will make it harder to achieve the City’s sustainability goals.”

Avula added that he had been “inspired” by “climate and renewable energy advocates” who had pressed the City Council to approve the arrangement. Last Monday, dozens of public speakers gave comments urging the body to get the job done.

Mira Signer, a spokesperson for Avula, said the mayor’s office had received 55 emails of support as of Tuesday morning.

Throughout the proceedings, council members have asked pointed questions about the extent of the mayor’s involvement in the procurement process.

At one point, while questioning Sarah Carpenter — a former contracts attorney and a current policy analyst in the mayor’s office — Abubaker sought clarity on whether Carpenter was acting as legal counsel on the matter.

“You’re a policy analyst, not a legal adviser for this, right?” Abubaker asked Carpenter

during a Sept. 23 committee meeting, after Carpenter had pushed back on concerns from the insurance broker.

“No, no, no. I’m bringing my experience as a contract attorney, but I am not a practicing attorney at the moment,” Carpenter replied.

Carpenter’s role came up again later in the meeting. Speaking to Rene Almaraz, director of the procurement, Gibson questioned Avula’s and Carpenter’s relationships with procurement operations.

“Was the mayor’s office very close to this project?” Gibson asked. “And is that standard?”

“Ms. Carpenter worked with us on it; she supported us,” Almaraz replied. “She’s a former contracts attorney, so we’re trying to pull in all the forces available to work through the terms and conditions to make this a viable contract for the city.”

“It was a continual negotiation process between procurement, legal teams, sustainability and the mayor’s office negotiating with the contractor,” he said.

Almaraz characterized the contract process as a “competitive award” with a request for proposals and a “negotiation process.”

But that competitive award and negotiation process took place several years ago in Prince William County. Under state law on cooperative procurement, officials can adopt the same terms agreed to by another public entity — a practice called “riding.”

the **GUIDE** to the Lively Arts

SHOW NAME	DATES & TIMES	DESCRIPTION	DETAILS	PRICE	ADDITIONAL
MUSIC - CHAMBER					
 Marine Band Chamber Ensembles	Sunday, October 11 at 2 p.m.	Members of “The President’s Own” will present a program featuring the depth and versatility of the Marine Band’s clarinet section. This program features solo and ensemble works for clarinet in a variety of chamber settings.	St John’s Episcopal Church 9202 Frederick Rd Ellicott City, MD 21042	This event is free and open to the public.	Full details at: marineband.marines.mil/calendar

The Guide to the Lively Arts appears: • Sunday in Arts & Style. deadline: Tues., 12 noon

• Monday in Style. deadline: Friday, 12 noon • Tuesday in Style. deadline: Mon., 12 noon • Wednesday in Style. deadline: Tues., 12 noon

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Ables guided families through one of life’s most wrenching rituals

ABLES FROM C8

ton’s Farewell Address.”

Ables, though, may have had the last laugh. In retirement, he used the money to travel to Cuba, Italy, Spain and Monaco, and bought a Maserati to tool around D.C.

Elegant in an ever-present blazer, slacks and round tortoiseshell glasses, he liked to find humor in a business that could be dreary on the best days and crushing on the worst.

“Trying to stay on top of the ground,” he liked to joke when someone asked how he was faring.

“Dead,” he’d say when asked about business, his crescent smile framed by a gray beard.

Ables took his work seriously. He referred to burials as “cases” and to meetings with prospective clients as “conferences.” When someone died, he said they had “expired.” He spent hours alone with the dead, classical music playing in his embalming room, as he used tools to ensure that he “put that smile back on their face.”

“It’s an art, man,” Ables said. “We’re practicing an art.”

Derrick McArthur, who worked at Hall Brothers during the business’s last decade, said Ables saw himself as a source of comfort for mourners burying mothers, fathers, sisters, brothers, spouses, grandparents and, most painful of all, young children.

“He was that shoulder to cry on,” said McArthur, now the manager of Mount Olivet Cemetery in Northeast Washington.

Ables also saw himself as a repository of essential D.C. history. When his uncles owned Hall Brothers, they began recording every funeral they managed in thick ledger books, a handwritten log that included the name of the deceased, their occupation, the date of death and the cause.

Lawrence Monroe Ryles, as noted in one entry, died Sept. 13, 1947, after being “run over by a train.” Melvin Bailey, age 6, died that same year of meningitis. Sarah Lee Rush, 37, died in 1981 from a “gun shot wound to the chest.” Clyde Gossett died of complications from AIDS in 1989.

By the time Hall Brothers closed, Ables had 18 dusty volumes chronicling the deaths of thousands of Black Washingtonians. His inclination was to toss the books in the trash, but McArthur said he advised Ables that “they should be preserved for genealogical purposes.”

“There might be families that want to come back and do deep dives into their history,” McArthur said. “It didn’t make sense to throw away history if we were the history keepers.”

Ables agreed to offer the ledgers and other Hall Brothers ephemera to the D.C. Public Library, which made the records part of its People’s Archive collection.

In a sense, he was preserving his own family’s history as well.

The Hall brothers, after migrating to D.C. from Mississippi in the 1930s, went into the funeral business at a time when aspiring Black professionals, unable to enter fields like medicine, could find careers in the mortuary sciences.

From their rowhouse near Seventh Street and Florida Avenue NW, the brothers started their business, handing out business cards that read, “In the event of my death, please notify: Hall Bros. Funeral Home.”

When mourners assembled



PHOTOS BY MARVIN JOSEPH/THE WASHINGTON POST

After closing the Hall Brothers headquarters — an 1892 rowhouse for which his uncle had paid \$10,000 — Richard Ables sold the property for nearly \$2 million.



A developer has turned the building into condominiums, giving it the tongue-in-cheek name “Washington’s Farewell Address.”

for wakes, Hall Brothers distributed hand fans, one of them featuring the visage of gospel legend Mahalia Jackson and another that offered advice on “how to get along with people.” (“Keep skid chains on your tongue” was one recommendation; “Make promises sparingly and keep them faithfully” was

another.)

Ables, who grew up in D.C., spent many childhood hours at the funeral home, where one of his uncles lived upstairs. During hide-and-seek games, his cousins liked to tuck themselves into any one of the parlor’s array of caskets. The caskets were also useful on Halloween, when the

kids liked to jump out of them to greet trick-or-treaters.

In those years, and through the 1970s and ’80s, the neighborhood was a cultural hub for Black Washingtonians. The Howard Theatre drew stars like Smokey Robinson, James Brown and Aretha Franklin. Ables, who started helping out

at Hall Brothers in the late 1970s, would walk across the street after work to catch the acts.

“If we saw a White person, we’d ask, ‘What are you doing here?’” Ables told The Post in 2019. “Now it’s the opposite.”

In those years, the city’s Black-owned funeral homes

would gather for annual crab feasts and holiday celebrations. Everyone in the business knew each other, it seemed.

“It was a nice, lovely community,” said Jerome Austin, 82, a friend of Ables who still operates a body-removal business, Mortuary Transportation Services. “Everyone knew and liked Richard. He was always soft-spoken and always had that little smile on his face. He was just so gentle.”

Many of Ables’s contemporaries from the funeral world have died off. His wake on Friday night, at a funeral home in Maryland, drew old friends and family, everyone greeted by his daughters, Geneita and Ashley.

There was also a cousin, Macy Hall Jr., with whom Ables used to hide out in those caskets when they were kids, and Robert Smith, who worked at Hall Brothers for over 40 years. He tilted his head back and laughed at the idea that the old funeral parlor had been turned into condos.

“I don’t think I could live there knowing what I know,” he said.

Manny Moore, 78, a friend of 45 years who drove down from Baltimore, said Ables had been like a brother to him. “It’s hard to replace something that’s real,” he said. “He was real. We could trust each other. I could talk to him.”

The gathering had a low-key, wine-and-cheese vibe, the way Ables had wanted it, everyone chatting and laughing and pausing before his mahogany casket, where he lay, stylish as always, in a white ascot and matching white handkerchief tucked into the breast pocket of his blue smoking jacket.

VIRGINIA

‘The happiest little boy’: Family navigates son’s rare genetic disorder

BY ETHAN HUNT
Roanoke Times

ELLISTON, VA. — About two months ago, doctors diagnosed Brittany and Micah Gardner’s 19-month-old son, Daniel, with a rare genetic disorder that brings a host of health complications, including dwarfism and a significantly shortened lifespan.

Although the future is uncertain, the couple, both in their mid-20s, are focused on today while their community has rallied around them.

“We don’t know what symptoms are going to develop versus what’s not,” Brittany said. “So we’re just kind of taking it day by day and supporting him the best we can.”

Rhizomelic chondrodysplasia punctata, or RCDP, is a rare genetic disorder affecting about one in 100,000 children, according to the National Institutes of Health.

The disorder affects the development of many parts of the

body and leads to short stature and distinctive facial features. Individuals with RCDP often have limited or decreased movement of their joints. Other symptoms include intellectual impairment, cataracts, seizures, heart defects and respiratory concerns.

The severity of Daniel’s RCDP falls in the middle range, and the couple said they’re grateful his condition is milder than others. While Daniel does not currently experience all of the symptoms associated with RCDP, the couple said they have been told he could develop additional complications as he gets older.

Doctors have told Brittany and Micah that the lifespan of a child with RCDP is between 10 and 12 years, though some diagnosed with the condition have lived into their 30s.

But Micah, a school resource officer with the Christiansburg Police Department, said his son is the “happiest little boy in the world.”

“He loves watching people get active,” Micah said, describing bringing Daniel and his other son, 3-year-old James, with him to the gym where he does Brazilian jiu-jitsu. “He’s a boy’s boy.”

“He probably won’t ever be able to do any of the moves, but he just loves watching them and he laughs the entire time,” Brittany said.

For now, the couple’s goals for Daniel are short term.

Recently, he began opening his hands, and he works on stretches daily to help build core strength. Looking to the future, Brittany said she hopes he’ll be able to communicate more effectively, possibly by pressing buttons to say words.

“I really do think he wants to be able to communicate, but can’t, and so I’m hopeful,” she said. “We’re going to see a developmental pediatrician, and the genetics doctor mentioned that they could help with some auditory systems and things like that.”

Those doctor visits, which take place at University of Virginia Hospital about two hours away, are where the community has stepped in to help.

Micah’s coworkers at the Christiansburg Police Department organized a GoFundMe campaign with a goal of \$16,000. It had raised \$4,875 as of Monday.

The police department has also organized a raffle, with the proceeds going toward Daniel’s treatment. The fundraiser was promoted by Brad Williams, a comedian who has a form of dwarfism. Micah said his dad met Williams at one of his shows and asked if he would support his grandson.

The Brazilian jiu-jitsu gym Micah attends and the owner of the Christiansburg Dairy Queen also have offered to organize fundraisers.

Although the Gardners are thankful for the support, they said they didn’t ask for the help.

“I’m a very ‘figure it out,

dude,’” Micah said. “You get hurt, you get up and keep going. You don’t ask for help. It sounds cheesy when you say it, but we both are swallowing a lot of pride.”

He said they decided to accept the fundraising support after family members and doctors encouraged them.

So far, Daniel’s medical bills have totaled about \$62,000, though Brittany said insurance has covered a significant portion.

“One thing that I just feel guilty about is getting all of this and knowing that there are kids that are more severe and families are going through harder problems with their children,” Brittany said.

Brittany, who works full time as a continuous improvement engineer at Valcom, is 34 weeks pregnant with a third child, a girl named Penelope.

The couple did not receive Daniel’s diagnosis until well into Brittany’s current pregnancy,

and testing for RCDP on their unborn daughter carries a number of associated risks, which is why they don’t plan to test for it.

“Every kid that we have, there’s that potential, and of course we’ll support and love our child no matter what, but it’s hard because of the life-limiting aspect for them,” Brittany said.

For a child to be born with RCDP, both parents must be genetic carriers. The likelihood of that occurring is very low, which is why the disorder is so uncommon.

While their older son, James, does not have RCDP, the couple said he may be a genetic carrier. But that’s a concern to be addressed in the distant future, they said.

For now, Brittany has happy James plays with his younger brother, saying “he’s really good about involving him.”

“They love listening to music,” she said. “Him and his brother love AC/DC. They love rocking out.”



JEFF AMBERG

Harriet Hancock became a prominent activist in a conservative Southern state after her son came out as gay in the early 1980s.

HARRIET HANCOCK, 89

‘Mama’ to South Carolina’s gay community

Took on homophobia while organizing the state’s first Pride march

BY HARRISON SMITH

Harriet Hancock, who has died at 89, was a leading force for the gay rights movement in South Carolina, where she spent more than four decades fighting on behalf of equality and dignity for LGBTQ+ people like her son, Greg, who came out to her in the early 1980s.

“Is that all?” Ms. Hancock recalled saying, after he nervously told her he was gay. “I thought you wrecked the car or got caught smoking pot!”

At a time when gay men and lesbians faced widespread persecution, with many worried that coming out would threaten their jobs, families and safety, Ms. Hancock became an outspoken ally, emerging as a fixture of the LGBTQ+ community in her hometown of Columbia, the state capital.

“We always joke that my brother came out of the closet, but my mom kicked the door down,” her daughter Jennifer Tague told *The Washington Post*. “She came out fighting for his rights.”

In 1982, Ms. Hancock founded the state’s first chapter of PFLAG, a national organization then known as Parents and Friends of Lesbians and Gays. She had been listening to public radio as one of the organization’s New York co-founders, Amy Ashworth, was berated by listeners who called in to say that Ashworth and her family were “going to hell.”

Ms. Hancock, listening to the broadcast in the car, rushed home to call in herself, so that she could ask how to start her own branch of the organization in a conservative state known for hewing to tradition.

“People thought I was just a little bit crazy,” Ms. Hancock later told the Columbia newspaper the *State*. Initially, she said, she worried that “someone was going to burn a cross on my lawn.”

But aside from a few angry phone calls, the reaction was largely positive. Families, social workers and ministers sought her out for guidance, asking how they could support friends and loved ones who had recently come out.

Over the next decade, Ms. Hancock broadened her work by co-founding an HIV/AIDS support group in Columbia; speaking out against homophobia in lectures and interviews; and helping to organize South Carolina’s inaugural Pride march in 1990, which drew an estimated 2,000 people to the steps of the capitol.

In her early 50s, she also launched a new career as an attorney, taking on LGBTQ+ clients whom she sometimes advised and represented at no cost. Her efforts brought her a nickname: “Mama Harriet.”

“She was kind of a north star, for not only the LGBTQ+ community but also its allies,” said Matthew Butler, board president of the Harriet Hancock Center, which provides support and services for LGBTQ+ people in

Columbia. The center was established with help from Ms. Hancock in 1993 and renamed in her honor in 2005.

“Our kids aren’t broken, and they don’t need fixing,” Ms. Hancock said in 1990, speaking on behalf of other parents of LGBTQ+ children. “Society’s attitudes are broken, and they *do* need fixing.”

An early start

The second of four children, she was born Harriet Sybil Daniels in Columbia on Sept. 25, 1936. Her father worked for a tire company, and her mother was a hosiery buyer at a Belk’s department store.

Ms. Hancock was educated at segregated public schools, although she said her parents taught her that she was no better than anyone else. As a young girl, she found small ways to rebel against Jim Crow: drinking from the water fountain set aside for African Americans, sitting at the back of the bus instead of the front.

When it came to activism, “I started early on, I guess,” she said in an interview for the *South Carolina Progressive Network*.

Ms. Hancock briefly trained to become a nurse before dropping out in 1954 to get married at age 18. Her husband, Marion Hancock, was an electrical engineer whose career took the family to New Jersey, Florida and the Washington area, where he worked for the government while Ms. Hancock raised three children.

The marriage collapsed, she said, as her husband became an alcoholic. She left him in 1978, returning to South Carolina with her two younger children while the oldest was in college. Her husband died the next year.

“I had done all I could to help him,” she said. “I left and came back home to Columbia a broken person. I had to save myself and my kids.”

While looking for work, Ms. Hancock enrolled at a local technical college, thinking she might become a legal secretary. One of her professors suggested she

dream bigger: As she put it, “He thought that was the wrong side of the desk for me.”

Ms. Hancock went on to attend the University of South Carolina, where she received a bachelor’s degree in sociology in 1984 (at one point, she was attending the same classes as her son) and graduated from the university’s law school in 1988.

By then, she was active in the gay rights movement. She was in her first month of law school when she co-founded Palmeto to AIDS Life Support Services, now known simply as PALSS. The group grew out of visits Ms. Hancock and other volunteers made to local hospitals, to comfort men and women with AIDS who were scorned or stigmatized by their families and caretakers.

“The first thing I was determined to do when I walked in that room was to walk over and touch this person,” Ms. Hancock recalled in a 2019 oral history interview, noting how some hospital workers refused to touch patients without gloves and protective gear.

Ms. Hancock later took on AIDS patients as legal clients, including men who had lost their jobs and were denied insurance coverage as a result of their diagnosis. Long before same-sex marriage was legalized, other LGBTQ+ clients turned to her for help navigating cases involving wills, adoption, child custody and powers of attorney.

In 1989, Ms. Hancock began laying the groundwork for the state’s first Pride parade, at a time when gay men and lesbians in Columbia celebrated in private, gathering at an annual picnic on Dreher Island outside of town.

With prodding from a fellow activist, Jim Blanton, Ms. Hancock pushed for a more public event, taking down names on a clipboard to gauge support for a march. She ultimately joined fellow organizers in campaigning for nine demands as part of the parade, including equal opportunity in employment and the repeal of the state’s sodomy laws. The laws remain on the books, though they were invalidated by

a U.S. Supreme Court ruling in 2003.

“Sleepy little old Columbia didn’t think it had any gay people till it saw them in the streets,” Ms. Hancock later said in an interview for the *South Carolina Pride Movement*, a nonprofit organization that grew out of the event.

Some participants marched with oversize hats and sunglasses, or wore makeup — applied by one of Ms. Hancock’s sisters — to disguise their appearance. A post-parade party was held in private, the *State* later reported, “because the Ku Klux Klan had threatened to interfere with the pride celebration.”

Ms. Hancock credited the march with spurring changes to Columbia’s nondiscrimination employment policy, which was broadened to include sexual orientation. She continued to attend South Carolina Pride events late in life, riding along instead of marching, and often marveled at the progress that had been made, including through the legalization of same-sex marriage nationwide in 2015.

“She never thought she’d see it in her lifetime,” said Tague, her younger daughter. “She always said, ‘I figure marijuana will be legalized before gay marriage.’”

In 2024, she officiated her son’s wedding.

Ms. Hancock died Sept. 23 while in hospice in Lexington, a Columbia suburb. Survivors include her three children, Jennifer Tague, Greg Hancock and Karen Klocko; a brother and a sister; six grandchildren; and 11 great-grandchildren.

With the advent of marriage equality, Ms. Hancock’s focus shifted to advocacy on behalf of transgender people, whom she described as “the most maligned, most misunderstood group of people that I know of.” There was much work to be done, she said, but she hoped that her great-grandchildren would reflect on her LGBTQ+ activism and wonder why it had been necessary in the first place.

“I think they’re going to look back,” she told the *State* in 2005, “and think how bizarre that was.”



HARRIET HANCOCK CENTER

A crowd gathers on the State House steps in 1990, during the first Pride march in South Carolina.

DEATH NOTICE

BERMAN



HARVEY SANFORD BERMAN (Age 90)

Harvey earned a bachelor’s degree in Electrical Engineering from North Carolina State University and devoted most of his career to Underwriters Laboratories, where he led the quality department. He was a dedicated professional, an avid tennis player, and a man known for his tenacity and good sense of humor. Harvey was preceded in death by his beloved wife, Cynthia Berman, and his brother, Leonard Berman. He is survived by his daughter, Stacy Birnbach and her husband, Tom; his son, Gary Berman; and his grandchildren, Chloe, Ben, and Max. Harvey will be deeply missed and lovingly remembered by his family and friends. Graveside service will be held on Tuesday, October 6, 2026, 11 am at Garden of Remembrance Memorial Park, Clarksburg, MD. Services entrusted to Sagel Bloomfield Danzansky Goldberg Funeral Care. www.sagelbloomfield.com

When the need arises, let families find you in the Funeral Services Directory.

To be seen in the Funeral Services Directory, please call paid Death Notices at 202-334-4122.

The Washington Post



DEATH NOTICE

CARROLL



JAMES DOUGLAS CARROLL

“Jim” (Age 102)

Entered peacefully into eternal life on September 27, 2026. He was predeceased by the love of his life, Margaret Weiners Carroll (“Sis”) whom he married on September 20, 1947, in St. Mary’s Church in Alexandria, VA. After her passing in 2021, Jim longed to be reunited with her in eternal life. He was also predeceased in 2025 by his only son, Daniel Patrick Carroll, whom he missed greatly. His sister Wanda Carroll Davis (Stephen) also predeceased him. Jim leaves his loving daughter Theresa Carroll Daly, devoted son-in-law John Daly, and numerous family members and friends. He was born in Bluemont, VA, on November 1, 1923, to William Douglas Carroll and Sybil

Chappell Carroll. They moved the family to Alexandria during the early 1920s, and Jim became a lifelong resident of the city. After his enlisted service in the United States Coast Guard during World War II, Jim began a career with Southern Railway (now Norfolk Southern Corporation) and retired as Assistant to the President in 1985. During the early post-war years in Alexandria, he rowed for Old Dominion Boat Club and became a lifetime member of ODBC.

Jim always had a heart for the good, the true, the beautiful. He loved to use his hands to create things and applied his carpentry talents to every room of the family home. He enjoyed gardening, hunting, fishing, and the mountains of Virginia where he spent summers as a young boy with his grandfather. His greatest joy in life was being a loving husband and father who taught his children by example the importance of faith, humility, patience, hard work, generosity, and dedication to excellence. “If something is worth doing, it’s worth doing well,” he often said. Jim will be greatly missed by all who love him.

The family thanks the team of dedicated caregivers who helped care for him in the last years of his life. Family will receive visitors at Everly-Wheatley Funeral Home, 1500 W. Braddock Rd., on Monday, October 5, from 4:30 to 7 pm, with Rosary at 6 pm. A Funeral Mass will be celebrated at the Basilica of St. Mary, Alexandria, on Tuesday, October 6, at 10:30 am with interment in St. Mary’s Cemetery. The deceased requested that no flowers be sent. www.everlywheatley.com

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815 Legal Notices

ABC LICENSE: Gandhi Family LLC & Courtyard Management LLC trading as Courtyard Fairfax Fair Oaks 11220 Lee Jackson HWY Fairfax (Fairfax County) Virginia 22030. The above establishment is applying to the VIRGINIA ALCOHOLIC BEVERAGE CONTROL (ABC) AUTHORITY for a Mixed Beverage Hotel with Restaurant license to sell or manufacture alcoholic beverages. Ritesh Gandhi, Manager. **NOTE:** Objections to the issuance of this license must be submitted to ABC no later than 30 days from the date of the first of two required newspaper legal notices. Objections should be registered at www.abc.virginia.gov or (800) 552-5200.

850 Montgomery County

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR THE COUNTY OF MONTGOMERY, MARYLAND

WILLIAM M. SAVAGE, et al.
Trustee(s)
Plaintiff(s)

vs.

GUSTAVO J HERNANDEZ
Defendant(s)
Mortgagor(s)

CIVIL NO. C-15-CV-25-005582

NOTICE

NOTICE IS HEREBY GIVEN, this 29th day of September, 2026, by the Circuit Court for the County of Montgomery, Maryland and by the authority thereof, that the sale of the property mentioned in this proceedings and described as 12205 Academy Way Unit 9, Rockville, MD 20852, and reported in some daily newspaper printed in said County, once in each of three successive weeks before the 29th day of October, 2026, the report states the purchase price at the foreclosure sale to be \$161,100.00.

KAREN A. BUSHELL
CLERK OF THE CIRCUIT COURT
FOR COUNTY OF MONTGOMERY

Trustees File #: 25-299634

Oct 5, 12, 19, 2026 001252971

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

ANDREW J. BRENNER, et al.
6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
Substitute Trustee(s)/Plaintiffs,

vs.

KAREN HAMER
5415 Monroe Street
Silver Spring, MD 20910
Defendant(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-24-005362

NOTICE

Notice is hereby given this 15th day of September, 2026, by the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, Maryland, that the sale of the property mentioned in this proceedings and described as 4415 Monroe Street, Silver Spring, MD 20910 made and reported by the Substitute Trustee, will be RATIFIED AND CONFIRMED, unless cause to the contrary thereof be shown on or before the 15th day of October, 2026, provided a copy of this NOTICE be inserted in some daily newspaper printed in said County, once in each of three successive weeks before the 15th day of October, 2026. The report states the purchase price at the foreclosure sale to be \$542,000.00.

KAREN A. BUSHELL
CLERK, CIRCUIT COURT
FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

BWM#MD-372214

Sep 21,28,Oct 5, 2026 001252640

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

ANDREW J. BRENNER, et al.
6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
Substitute Trustee(s)/Plaintiffs,

vs.

MICHAEL WILLIAM KASZYNSKI (DECEASED)
18205 Cochrans Road
Germantown, MD 20874
Defendant(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-26-002668

NOTICE

Notice is hereby given this 29th day of September, 2026, by the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, Maryland, that the sale of the property mentioned in this proceedings and described as 18205 Cochrans Road, Germantown, MD 20874 made and reported by the Substitute Trustee, will be RATIFIED AND CONFIRMED, unless cause to the contrary thereof be shown on or before the 29th day of October, 2026, provided a copy of this NOTICE be inserted in some daily newspaper printed in said County, once in each of three successive weeks before the 29th day of October, 2026. The report states the purchase price at the foreclosure sale to be \$400,000.00.

KAREN A. BUSHELL
CLERK, CIRCUIT COURT
FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

BWM#MD-379262

Oct 5, 12, 19, 2026 001252955

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840 Trustees Sale - DC

Samuel I. White, P.C.
6100 EXECUTIVE BLVD. SUITE 400
ROCKVILLE, MARYLAND 20852

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE OF VALUABLE RESIDENTIAL DWELLING KNOWN AS:
1366 H STREET NE, WASHINGTON, DC 20002

By virtue of Deed of Trust recorded in the land records of the District of Columbia recorded on July 11, 2005, as Instrument Number 2005095498, and in accordance Judgment filed on August 27, 2026 in case 2024-CAB-002501 and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer to sell at public auction, within the office of

HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW, Suite 440
Washington, DC 20015-2034
On

October 13, 2026 at 12:00 PM

the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia and more particularly described in the above referenced Deed of Trust and as of the date hereof designated on the Records of the Assessor of the District of Columbia for assessment purposes as

1366 H Street NE, Washington, DC 20002
LOT 0152 AND SQUARE 1026

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, the ability of the purchaser to obtain title insurance or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to any assessments including assessment pursuant to D.C. Code Section 42-1903.13.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY BY certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note (9.5% per annum) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Trustees, payable in cash or certified funds within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. Adjustment of current years real property taxes are adjusted as of the date of sale, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All other public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, ground rent, whether incurred prior to or after the sale are to be paid by the purchaser. All costs of deed recordation including but not limited to title examination, conveyancing, city revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from date of sale. Time is of the essence for the Purchaser. If the Purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, Purchaser agrees that the property will be resold and the entire deposit retained by the Substitute Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for all correspondence including any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into and repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event or if the sale is not ratified, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit without interest.

KAREN A. BUSHELL
CLERK OF THE CIRCUIT COURT
FOR COUNTY OF MONTGOMERY

Trustees File #: 25-299634

Oct 5, 12, 19, 2026 001252971

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

ANDREW J. BRENNER, et al.
6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
Substitute Trustee(s)/Plaintiffs,

vs.

KAREN HAMER
5415 Monroe Street
Silver Spring, MD 20910
Defendant(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-24-005362

NOTICE

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KAREN A. BUSHELL
CLERK, CIRCUIT COURT
FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

BWM#MD-372214

Sep 21,28,Oct 5, 2026 001252640

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Defendant(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-26-002668

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KAREN A. BUSHELL
CLERK, CIRCUIT COURT
FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

BWM#MD-379262

Oct 5, 12, 19, 2026 001252955

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840 Trustees Sale - DC

Samuel I. White, P.C.
6100 EXECUTIVE BLVD. SUITE 400
ROCKVILLE, MARYLAND 20852
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE OF

VALUABLE RESIDENTIAL DWELLING KNOWN AS:
3122 SHERMAN AVENUE NW, WASHINGTON, DC 20010

By virtue of Deed of Trust recorded in the land records of the District of Columbia recorded on April 25, 2023, as Instrument Number 2023034046, and in accordance Judgment filed on March 24, 2026 in case 2025-CAB-003829 and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer to sell at public auction, within the office of

HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW, Suite 440
Washington, DC 20015-2034
on

October 13, 2026 at 12:00 PM

the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia and more particularly described in the above referenced Deed of Trust and as of the date hereof designated on the Records of the Assessor of the District of Columbia for assessment purposes as

515 Kenyon Street NW, Washington D.C. 20010,
35 T Street NE, Washington D.C. 20002 and
3122 Sherman Avenue NW, Washington, DC 20010
also known as

LOT 0105 AND SQUARE 2846
LOT 0044 AND SQUARE 3046
LOT 0114 AND SQUARE 3530

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, the ability of the purchaser to obtain title insurance or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to any assessments including assessment pursuant to D.C. Code Section 42-1903.13.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY BY certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note (2.5% per annum) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Trustees, payable in cash or certified funds within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. Adjustment of current year's real property taxes are adjusted as of the date of sale, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All other public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, ground rent, whether incurred prior to or after the sale are to be paid by the purchaser. All costs of deed recordation including but not limited to title examination, conveyancing, city revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from date of sale. Time is of the essence for the Purchaser. If the Purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, Purchaser agrees that the property will be resold and the entire deposit retained by the Substitute Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for all correspondence including any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into and repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event or if the sale is not ratified, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit without interest.

KAREN A. BUSHELL
CLERK OF THE CIRCUIT COURT
FOR COUNTY OF MONTGOMERY

Trustees File #: 25-299634

Oct 5, 12, 19, 2026 001252971

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

ANDREW J. BRENNER, et al.
6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
Substitute Trustee(s)/Plaintiffs,

vs.

KAREN HAMER
5415 Monroe Street
Silver Spring, MD 20910
Defendant(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-24-005362

NOTICE

Notice is hereby given this 15th day of September, 2026, by the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, Maryland, that the sale of the property mentioned in this proceedings and described as 4415 Monroe Street, Silver Spring, MD 20910 made and reported by the Substitute Trustee, will be RATIFIED AND CONFIRMED, unless cause to the contrary thereof be shown on or before the 15th day of October, 2026, provided a copy of this NOTICE be inserted in some daily newspaper printed in said County, once in each of three successive weeks before the 15th day of October, 2026. The report states the purchase price at the foreclosure sale to be \$542,000.00.

KAREN A. BUSHELL
CLERK, CIRCUIT COURT
FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

BWM#MD-372214

Sep 21,28,Oct 5, 2026 001252640

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

ANDREW J. BRENNER, et al.
6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
Substitute Trustee(s)/Plaintiffs,

vs.

KAREN HAMER
5415 Monroe Street
Silver Spring, MD 20910
Defendant(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-24-005362

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KAREN A. BUSHELL
CLERK, CIRCUIT COURT
FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

BWM#MD-372214

Sep 21,28,Oct 5, 2026 001252640

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

ANDREW J. BRENNER, et al.
6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
Rockville, MD 20852
Substitute Trustee(s)/Plaintiffs,

vs.

KAREN HAMER
5415 Monroe Street
Silver Spring, MD 20910
Defendant(s).

Case No. C-15-CV-24-005362

NOTICE

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KAREN A. BUSHELL
CLERK, CIRCUIT COURT
FOR MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND

BWM#MD-372214

Sep 21,28,Oct 5, 2026 001252640

840 Trustees Sale - DC

Samuel I. White, P.C.
6100 EXECUTIVE BLVD. SUITE 400
ROCKVILLE, MARYLAND 20852
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE OF

VALUABLE RESIDENTIAL DWELLING KNOWN AS:
3122 SHERMAN AVENUE NW, WASHINGTON, DC 20010

By virtue of Deed of Trust recorded in the land records of the District of Columbia recorded on April 25, 2023, as Instrument Number 2023034046, and in accordance Judgment filed on March 24, 2026 in case 2025-CAB-003829 and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer to sell at public auction, within the office of

HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW, Suite 440
Washington, DC 20015-2034
on

October 13, 2026 at 12:00 PM

the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia and more particularly described in the above referenced Deed of Trust and as of the date hereof designated on the Records of the Assessor of the District of Columbia for assessment purposes as

515 Kenyon Street NW, Washington D.C. 20010,
35 T Street NE, Washington D.C. 20002 and
3122 Sherman Avenue NW, Washington, DC 20010
also known as

LOT 0105 AND SQUARE 2846
LOT 0044 AND SQUARE 3046
LOT 0114 AND SQUARE 3530

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, the ability of the purchaser to obtain title insurance or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to any assessments including assessment pursuant to D.C. Code Section 42-1903.13.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY BY certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note (2.5% per annum) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Trustees, payable in cash or certified funds within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. Adjustment of current year's real property taxes are adjusted as of the date of sale, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All other public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, ground rent, whether incurred prior to or after the sale are to be paid by the purchaser. All costs of deed recordation including but not limited to title examination, conveyancing, city revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from date of sale. Time is of the essence for the Purchaser. If the Purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, Purchaser agrees that the property will be resold and the entire deposit retained by the Substitute Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to

Trustees Sale - DC **Trustees Sale - DC**

Samuel I. White, P.C.
6100 EXECUTIVE BLVD.
SUITE 400
ROCKVILLE, MARYLAND 20852

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE
OF VALUABLE RESIDENTIAL DWELLING**
KNOWN AS:
4515 TEXAS AVENUE SE, WASHINGTON, DC 20019

By virtue of Deed of Trust recorded in the land records of the District of Columbia recorded on July 24, 2019, as Instrument Number 2019077855, and in accordance Judgment filed on August 5, 2026 in case 2024-CAB-007496 and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer to sell at public auction, within the office of

HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW
Suite 440
Washington, DC 20015-2034
on
October 13, 2026 at 12:00 PM

the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia and more particularly described in the above referenced Deed of Trust and as of the date hereof designated on the Records of the Assessor of the District of Columbia for assessment purposes as

4515 Texas Avenue SE, Washington, DC 20019,
LOT 0802 AND SQUARE 5395

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, the ability of the purchaser to obtain title insurance or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to any assessments including assessment pursuant to D.C. Code Section 42-1903.13.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY BY certified funds shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note (5.125% per annum) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Trustees, payable in cash or certified funds within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. Adjustment of current years real property taxes are adjusted as of the date of sale, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All other public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, ground rent, whether incurred prior to or after the sale are to be paid by the purchaser. All costs of deed recordation including but not limited to title examination, conveying, city revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from date of sale. Time is of the essence for the Purchaser. If the Purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, Purchaser agrees that the property will be resold and the entire deposit retained by the Substitute Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for all correspondence including any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into and repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event or if the sale is not ratified, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit without interest.

Trustees File No. 82115
Daniel J. Pesachowitz, Esquire
Attorney for Trustees
Harvey West, Auctioneers
5335 Wisconsin Avenue, NW
Suite 440



Sep 14,21,28,Oct 5, 2026 001252443

872 Fairfax County

TRUSTEE'S SALE
Real property at
12229 Grays Pointe Road,
Apt C, Fairfax, VA 22033

In execution of a Commercial Deed of Trust in the original principal amount of \$750,000.00 dated December 20, 2022 recorded in the land records of the District of Columbia on August 12, 2024 as Instrument Number: 2023000246.001. Default having been made in the indebtedness secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at the front entrance to the Fairfax County Circuit Court, 4110 Chain Bridge Road, Fairfax, VA 22030, the above referenced property and fixtures or improvements thereon briefly described as: Parcel ID No. 045-2-08-2929C, and Condominium Unit Number 122929C, Phase Nine (9), GRAY'S POINTE.

October 13, 2026 at 12:45 PM

TERMS OF SALE: The property will be sold "AS IS," WITHOUT REPRESENTATION OR WARRANTY OF ANY KIND AND SUBJECT TO any environmental or other conditions, covenants, restrictions, reservations, easements, rights of way prior to the date of sale, and all other matters of record taking priority over the Deed of Trust, if any. Substitute Trustee shall have no obligation to deliver possession of the property, and any other obligation as to the premises.

A bidder's deposit of \$75,000.00 or 10% of the sale price, whichever is lower, will be required at the time of sale in the form of a certified check or cashier's check from the purchaser or the bid will be rejected. Successful bidder will be required to sign a memorandum of sale at the time of the sale and settle by bringing the balance of the purchase price within fourteen (14) days of sale. In the event of default of the successful bidder, the entire deposit shall be forfeited and applied to the costs and expenses of sale and Substitute Trustee's fee according to the Code of Virginia.

All other public charges or assessments, including water/sewer charges to be paid through date of sale, those incurred after the sale date, and all other costs incident to settlement to be paid by the purchaser. In the event of any other public charges have been advanced, a credit will be due to the seller, to be adjusted from the date of sale at the time of settlement. Sale is subject to post sale confirmation that the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale or whether other legal impediment to title exists. In any such event, the sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Additional terms may be announced at the time of sale.

FOR INFORMATION CONTACT:
Cohn Goldberg Deutsch, 410
256-2550 or www.cgd-law.com
or CGD # 465702. Cohn Goldberg Deutsch is a debt collector. Any information obtained will be used for that purpose.

BLUE RIDGE TRUSTEES LLC
Oct 5, 21, 28, 2026 001252718

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Trustees Sale - DC **Trustees Sale - DC**

4616 HAYES STREET NORTH EAST, WASHINGTON DC 20019

In execution of the Superior Court for the District of Columbia Decree of Sale in Case: 2023-CAB-003618 the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property known as 4616 HAYES STREET NORTH EAST, WASHINGTON DC 20019 at a public auction within the offices of, HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC., 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On **OCTOBER 13, 2026 AT 11:00 A.M.**, the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia, and designated as and being Lot 0012 and in Square 5150 and more particularly described in the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the District of Columbia, on OCTOBER 25, 2013 as Instrument Number: 2013121826 property will be sold by Trustee's Deed "as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$30,000.00 or 10% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in cash or certified funds. The deposit required to bid at the auction is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

If purchaser fails to settle within the aforesaid for thirty days (30) of the ratification, the purchaser agrees to pay the Trustees' reasonable attorney fees as ordered by the Court, plus all costs incurred, if the Trustees have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. Purchaser waives personal service of any paper filed with the Court in connection with such motion and any Show Cause Order issued by the Court and expressly agrees to accept service of any such paper or Order by certified mail and regular mail sent to the address provided by the purchaser and as recorded on the documents executed by the purchaser at the time of the sale. Service shall be deemed effective upon the purchaser 3 days after postmarked by the United States Post Office. It is expressly agreed by the purchaser that actual receipt of the certified mail is not required for service to be effective. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement the deposit shall be forfeited to the Trustees and all expenses of this sale (including attorney fees and full commission on the gross sales price of the sale) shall be charged against and paid from the forfeited deposit. In the event of resale the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the property regardless of any improvements made to the real property. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Trustees. In the event that the settlement is delayed for ANY REASON WHATSOEVER, there shall be no abatement of interest. Taxes, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the current year to date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for the costs of all transfer taxes, documentary stamps and all other costs incident to settlement. Purchaser shall be responsible for physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss from the date of sale forward. The sale is subject to post sale audit by the Mortgage holder to determine whether the borrower filed bankruptcy, entered into any repayment/forbearance agreement, reinstated or paid off prior to the sale. In any such event the Purchaser agrees that upon notification by the Trustees of such event the sale is null and void and of no legal effect and the deposit returned without interest. Trustees' File No. 21-001765

JAMES E. CLARKE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE

C/O ORLANDS PC
1602 Village Market Blvd SE, Suite 310
Leesburg, VA 20175

(703) 777-7101



Sep 14,21,28,Oct 5, 2026 0012525403

851 Prince Georges County **851 Prince Georges County**

ORLANDS LAW GROUP
1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD., SE, SUITE 310
LEESBURG, VA 20175
703-777-7101

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE
OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY**
11600 MARJORIE DRIVE
BOWIE, MD 20721

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from ALEXANDER WALLINGTON AND VICTORIA K. WALLINGTON, dated June 6, 2006 and recorded in Liber 25497, folio 311 among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No. C-16-CV-24-001112; Tax ID No. 13-1394527.) the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772, on

OCTOBER 7, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$40,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 23-005468)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
JOANNA FORONDA,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
JOHN ANSELL III,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES



Sep 21,28,Oct 5, 2026 0012525807

Trustees Sale - DC **Trustees Sale - DC**

5039 - 5043 A ST SE, WASHINGTON DC 20019

In execution of the Superior Court for the District of Columbia Decree of Sale in Case: 2024-CAB-000429 the undersigned Trustee(s) will offer for sale the property known as 5039 - 5043 A ST SE, WASHINGTON DC 20019 at a public auction within the offices of, HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC., 5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW Suite 440, Washington, DC 20015 202-463-4567 On **OCTOBER 13, 2026 AT 11:00 A.M.**, the land and premises situated in the District of Columbia, and designated as and being Lot 10, 11 & 12 and in Square 5327 and more particularly described in the Deed of Trust recorded in the Land Records of the District of Columbia, on SEPTEMBER 23, 2022 as Instrument Number: 2022097635 property will be sold by Trustee's Deed "as is" without any covenant, expressed or implied, in Fee Simple, subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, and all other recorded instruments superior to the Deed of Trust referenced above, and subject to ratification by the Court.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of the lesser of \$50,000.00 or 10% of the sale price will be required at time of sale in cash or certified funds. The deposit required to bid at the auction is waived for the Noteholder and any of its successors or assigns. The Noteholder may bid up to the credit and may submit a written bid to the Trustee which shall be announced at sale. The balance of the purchase price is to be paid in cash within 30 days of final ratification of the sale by the Court.

TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE.

If purchaser fails to settle within the aforesaid for thirty days (30) of the ratification, the purchaser agrees to pay the Trustees' reasonable attorney fees as ordered by the Court, plus all costs incurred, if the Trustees have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. Purchaser waives personal service of any paper filed with the Court in connection with such motion and any Show Cause Order issued by the Court and expressly agrees to accept service of any such paper or Order by certified mail and regular mail sent to the address provided by the purchaser and as recorded on the documents executed by the purchaser at the time of the sale. Service shall be deemed effective upon the purchaser 3 days after postmarked by the United States Post Office. It is expressly agreed by the purchaser that actual receipt of the certified mail is not required for service to be effective. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement the deposit shall be forfeited to the Trustees and all expenses of this sale (including attorney fees and full commission on the gross sales price of the sale) shall be charged against and paid from the forfeited deposit. In the event of resale the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds or profits resulting from any resale of the property regardless of any improvements made to the real property. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Trustees. In the event that the settlement is delayed for ANY REASON WHATSOEVER, there shall be no abatement of interest. Taxes, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, to be adjusted for the current year to date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for the costs of all transfer taxes, documentary stamps and all other costs incident to settlement. Purchaser shall be responsible for physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss from the date of sale forward. The sale is subject to post sale audit by the Mortgage holder to determine whether the borrower filed bankruptcy, entered into any repayment/forbearance agreement, reinstated or paid off prior to the sale. In any such event the Purchaser agrees that upon notification by the Trustees of such event the sale is null and void and of no legal effect and the deposit returned without interest. Trustees' File No. 23-006885

JAMES E. CLARKE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE

C/O ORLANDS PC
1602 Village Market Blvd SE, Suite 310
Leesburg, VA 20175
(703) 777-7101



Sep 14,21,28,Oct 5, 2026 0012525416

HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.
5335 WISCONSIN AVENUE, NW, SUITE 440
WASHINGTON, DC 20015
202-463-4567

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE OF
VALUABLE CONDOMINIUM UNIT KNOWN AS:
3287 SUTTON PLACE NW, #A, WASHINGTON DC 20016**

Pursuant to District of Columbia Condominium Act of 1976, Section 313 and Declaration of Condominium dated March 27, 1979, and recorded among the land records of the District of Columbia on April 6, 1979, as Instrument No. 7900011162, as may be amended from time to time, the Bylaws relating thereto dated March 27, 1979, and recorded among the land records of the District of Columbia on April 6, 1979, as Instrument No. 7900011162, as may be amended from time to time, and in accordance with Public Law 90-566 and D.C. Code Section 42-1903.13, as amended, notice filed September 4, 2026 and at the request of the Substitute Trustee for the Condominium, shall sell at public auction

ON October 6, 2026 AT 1:45 AM
within the office of
HARVEY WEST AUCTIONEERS, INC.,
5335 Wisconsin Avenue NW, Suite 440,
Washington, DC 20015,

Said condominium project is situated on parts of Lot 7 in Square numbered 1601 in a subdivision made by Grassland, Inc., as per plat recorded in Liber 167 at folio 127, in the Office of the Surveyor for the District of Columbia. While this information as to the nature and description or use of the Property has been obtained from sources deemed reliable and is believed to be accurate, no representations are made as to the presence, absence, development status or condition of improvements on or about the Property.

TERMS OF SALE: The Property will be sold in "AS IS" condition, without warranty, either express or implied, with respect to the nature and description of the improvements contained therein; and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any, and subject to existing mortgages or Deeds(s) of Trust in accordance with the District of Columbia Condominium Act, the outstanding balance of which will be announced at the time of sale if made available to the Trustees by such holders of prior mortgages or deeds of trusts and real estate taxes, if any; the purchase price above said trust(s) to be paid in cash. Also said subject to any other prior liens, encumbrances and municipal assessments, if any, further particulars of which may be announced at time of sale, if known. A deposit of \$5,000.00 will be required at time of sale, such deposit to be in cash, certified check or in such other form as the Substitute Trustee for the Condominium may require in his/her sole discretion. All conveyancing, recording, recodation tax, transfer, etc. at purchasers cost. The balance of the purchase price, together with interest at the rate of 6% per annum from date of sale to date of receipt of the balance of the purchase price, must be paid in cash or by cashier's certified check and all other term to be complied with within 30 days, otherwise deposit is forfeited and the property may be re-advertised and sold at the discretion of the Condominium and at the risk and cost of the defaulting purchaser. The Condominium shall convey a deed pursuant to D.C. Code Section 42-1903.13(c) (1) and (3) as amended and make no further representations of warranties as to title. Purchaser agrees to pay \$250.00 at settlement to the seller's attorney, for review and/or preparation of the settlement documents. The Condominium cannot guarantee clear title or the purchaser's ability to obtain title insurance. For this reason, the purchaser may not be able to obtain financing and therefore, must be able to pay the purchase balance in full within 30 days. The Condominium reserves the right in its sole discretion to rescind the sale at any time until conveyance of the deed. In the event of failure on the part of the Condominium to convey such deed, the purchaser's sole remedy shall be return of deposit.

The Trustees reserve the right to: (1) accept or reject any and all bids in their sole discretion; (2) withdraw the Property from the sale prior to acceptance of the final bid; and (3) postpone or cancel the sale.

Neither the Trustee nor any other party make any warranty or representation of any kind or nature regarding the physical or environmental condition of the description or of title to the Property.

Casey J. College, Substitute Trustees



Sep 21,28,Oct 5, 2026 0012526649

Montgomery County **Montgomery County**

Brock and Scott, PLLC
5431 Oleander Drive
Wilmington NC, 28403

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF
VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY**
KNOWN AS
1113 Kathryn Rd
Silver Spring, MD 20904

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to ROSENBERG AND ASSOCIATES, LLC, Trustee(s), dated June 24, 2022, and recorded among the Land Records of MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 66123, folio 98, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE MONTGOMERY COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 50 MARYLAND AVENUE, ROCKVILLE, MD 20850 ON,

OCTOBER 14, 2026 at 11:00 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MD, and more fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax ID# -05-00349010.

THE PROPERTY IS SUBJECT TO A PRIOR MORTGAGE.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$12,500.00 payable in certified check or by a cashier's check will be required from purchaser at time of sale, balance in immediately available funds upon final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court of MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND interest to be paid at the rate of 8.5% on unpaid purchase money from date of sale to date of settlement. The secured party herein, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit. Third party purchaser (excluding the secured party) will be required to complete full settlement of the purchase of the property within TEN (10) CALENDAR DAYS of the ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court otherwise the purchaser's deposit shall be forfeited and the property will be resold at the risk and expense, of the defaulting purchaser. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser.

Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public/private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent, and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recodation taxes hall be paid by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale.

Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. If the sale is rescinded or not ratified for any reason, including post sale lender audit, or a resale is to take place for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the aforementioned deposit. The Substitute Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if the ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the purchasers sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of their deposit, without interest.

The purchaser waives all rights and claims against the Substitute Trustees whether known or unknown. These provisions shall survive settlement Upon refund of the deposit, this sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. The sale is subject to post-sale review of the status of the loan and that if any agreement to cancel the sale was entered into by the lender and borrower prior to the sale then the sale is void and the purchaser's deposit shall be refunded without interest. Additional terms and conditions, if applicable, may be announced at the time and date of sale.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing. File No. (26-13512)

BRENNAN FERGUSON, JOHN C. HANRAHAN,
JEREMY B. WILKINS, AMANDA DRISCOLE,
ROBERT OLIVERI, PAUL HEINMULLER ,
Substitute Trustees



Sep 28,Oct 5,12, 2026 0012525765

874 Loudoun County

TRUSTEE'S SALE OF
Real property at
South Riding, VA 20152

In execution of a Deed of Trust in the original principal amount of \$358,000.00 dated October 15, 2020 recorded among the land records of the Circuit Court for Loudoun County, Virginia on August 21, 2024 as Instrument Number: 20241021-0045005, the undersigned appointed Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction, the Main entrance of the courthouse for the Circuit Court of Loudoun County, 18 E. Market Street, Leesburg, VA 20178 on **November 12, 2026 at 01:30 PM** the property described in said deed of trust, located at the above address and briefly described as:

Lot 81, Section 77, SOUTH RIDING, as the same is duly dedicated, platted and recorded as Instrument Number 20031029-0143309 and as Plat 20031029-0143310, among the Land Records of Loudoun County, Virginia. Tax ID: 165366167000.

TERMS OF SALE: A bidder's deposit of \$12,000.00 or 10% of the sale price, whichever is lower, will be required in the form of a certified or cashier's check. Cash will not be accepted as a deposit. Settlement within fifteen (15) days of sale otherwise cash must be provided. If the FinCEN reporting will be required of all successful purchasers, absent a lawful exemption. Additional terms to be announced at sale. This is a communication from a debt collector. This notice is an attempt to collect on a debt and any information obtained will be used for that purpose. Trustee # 26-007379

Substitute Trustee: ALG Trustee, LLC C/O Orlands Law Group PLLC PO Box 2548, Leesburg, VA 20177 (703) 777-7101 website: www.Orlands.com

Oct 5, 12, 19, 26, 2026 001252785

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Montgomery County **Montgomery County**

Brock and Scott, PLLC
5431 Oleander Drive
Wilmington NC, 28403

**SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF
VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY**
KNOWN AS
15320 Pine Orchard Dr 83-C1
Silver Spring, MD 20906

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to MICHAEL BAYNES, Trustee(s), dated December 8, 2023, and recorded among the Land Records of MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 67645, folio 255, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE MONTGOMERY COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 50 MARYLAND AVENUE, ROCKVILLE, MD 20850 ON,

OCTOBER 14, 2026 at 11:00 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MD, and more fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax ID# -13-01829596.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$19,500.00 payable in certified check or by a cashier's check will be required from purchaser at time of sale, balance in immediately available funds upon final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court of MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND interest to be paid at the rate of 6.624% on unpaid purchase money from date of sale to date of settlement. The secured party herein, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit. Third party purchaser (excluding the secured party) will be required to complete full settlement of the purchase of the property within TEN (10) CALENDAR DAYS of the ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court otherwise the purchaser's deposit shall be forfeited and the property will be resold at the risk and expense, of the defaulting purchaser. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser.

Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public/private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent, and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recodation taxes hall be paid by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale.

Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. If the sale is rescinded or not ratified for any reason, including post sale lender audit, or a resale is to take place for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the aforementioned deposit. The Substitute Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if the ratification of

850	Montgomery County	850	Montgomery County
Brock and Scott, PLLC 5431 Oleander Drive Wilmington NC, 28403			
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY KNOWN AS 18527 Tarragon Way Germantown, MD 20874			

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to DONALD J. ORDAKOWSKI JR. AND HENRY BIEGACZ, Trustee(s), dated June 9, 2006, and recorded among the Land Records of MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 32646 , folio 69 , the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE MONTGOMERY COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 50 MARYLAND AVENUE, ROCKVILLE, MD 20850 ON,

OCTOBER 14, 2026 at 11:00 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MD, and more fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax ID# - 09-01624075.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 payable in certified check or by a cashier's check will be required from purchaser at time of sale, balance in immediately available funds upon final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court of MONTGOMERY COUNTY, MARYLAND interest to be paid at the rate of 6% on unpaid purchase money from date of sale to date of settlement. The secured party herein, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit. Third party purchaser (excluding the secured party) will be required to complete full settlement of the purchase of the property within TEN (10) CALENDAR DAYS of the ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court otherwise the purchaser's deposit shall be forfeited and the property will be resold at the risk and expense, of the defaulting purchaser. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser.

Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public/private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent, and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes hall be paid by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale.

Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. If the sale is rescinded or not ratified for any reason, including post sale lender audit, or a resale is to take place for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the aforementioned deposit. The Substitute Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if the ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the purchasers sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of their deposit, without interest.

The purchaser waives all rights and claims against the Substitute Trustees whether known or unknown. These provisions shall survive settlement Upon refund of the deposit, this sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. The sale is subject to post-sale review of the status of the loan and that if any agreement to cancel the sale was entered into by the lender and borrower prior to the sale then the sale is void and the purchaser's deposit shall be refunded without interest. Additional terms and conditions, if applicable, may be announced at the time and date of sale.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing. File No. (24-12057)

BRENNAN FERGUSON, JOHN C. HANRAHAN,
JEREMY B. WILKINS, AMANDA DRISCOLE,
ROBERT OLIVERI, AND PAUL HEINMULLER,
Substitute Trustees



Sep 28,Oct 5,12, 2026

0012525447

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S0115-246

852	Anne Arundel County	852	Anne Arundel County
ORLANS LAW GROUP 1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310 LEESBURG, VA 20175 703-777-7101			
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY 224 ELIZABETH AVE BROOKLYN, MD 21225			

Under the Order for Decree of Sale entered AUGUST 6, 2026, i n Circuit Court Case Number C-02-CV-25-003021, MICHAEL RAY SCHUMAN, as to that real property described in a Deed of Trust dated December 29, 2021 and recorded in Liber 38205, folio 260 among the Land Records of ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, MD, and identified by Tax ID No. 05-624-15108900, default having occurred thereunder the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at 8 CHURCH CIR, ANNAPOLIS, MD 21401, on

OCTOBER 14, 2026 at 10:00 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$20,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 24-004952)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
JASON N. GREENBERG,
JOANNA FORONDA,
JOHN ANSELL III,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES

A181, A316, A311, A183, A425, A426, A461, A463, A508



Sep 28,Oct 5,12, 2026

0012525808

ORLANS LAW GROUP 1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310 LEESBURG, VA 20175 703-777-7101
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY 343 RAMBLING RIDGE COURT PASADENA, MD 21122

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from BRANDON J. KUHL, A SINGLE MAN, dated May 31, 2019 and recorded in Liber 33217, folio 363 among the Land Records of ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, MD, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No.C-02-CV-26-001072; Tax ID No.03-041-90044387) the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at 8 CHURCH CIR, ANNAPOLIS, MD 21401, on

OCTOBER 14, 2026 at 10:00 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$5,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 26-002318)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
JOANNA FORONDA,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
JASON N. GREENBERG,
JOHN ANSELL III,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES

A181, A316, A311, A183, A425, A426, A461, A463, A508



Sep 28,Oct 5,12, 2026

0012525642

852	Anne Arundel County	852	Anne Arundel County
ORLANS LAW GROUP 1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310 LEESBURG, VA 20175 703-777-7101			
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY 2704 THYME DRIVE EDGEWATER, MD 21037			

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from J. PENNY SMITH, dated March 16, 2009 and recorded in Liber 20863, folio 0060 among the Land Records of ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, MD, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No.C-02-CV-26-001048; Tax ID No.02-280-10817700) the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at 8 CHURCH CIR, ANNAPOLIS, MD 21401, on

OCTOBER 14, 2026 at 10:00 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$5,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 26-000814)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
JOANNA FORONDA,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
JASON N. GREENBERG,
JOHN ANSELL III,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES

A181, A316, A311, A183, A425, A426, A461, A463, A508



Sep 28,Oct 5,12, 2026

0012525111

855	Charles County	855	Charles County
ORLANS LAW GROUP 1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310 LEESBURG, VA 20175 703-777-7101			
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY 1005 Alward Drive Waldorf, MD 20602			

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from DARRIN MARTIN AND LAKEISHA JAMES, dated April 2, 2007 and recorded in Liber 05283, folio 0730 MODIFIED ON NOVEMBER 17, 2021 IN LIBER 12218 FOLIO 379; among the Land Records of CHARLES COUNTY, MD, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No.C-08-CV-26-00060; Tax ID No.06-069525) the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the CHARLES COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at 200 CHARLES STREET (IN THE BREEZEWAY BETWEEN CIRCUIT AND DISTRICT COURTS), LA PLATA, MD 20646, on

OCTOBER 7, 2026 at 12:30 pm

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in CHARLES COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$30,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for CHARLES COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 26-001160)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
JOANNA FORONDA,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
JASON N. GREENBERG,
JOHN ANSELL III,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES



Sep 21,28,Oct 5, 2026

0012524441

855	Charles County	855	Charles County
ORLANS LAW GROUP 1602 VILLAGE MARKET BLVD. SE, SUITE 310 LEESBURG, VA 20175 703-777-7101			
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY 4215 Drake Ct. Waldorf,, MD 20603			

Under a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from ZACHARY KINNEY, dated April 4, 2023 and recorded in Liber 12932, folio 504 among the Land Records of CHARLES COUNTY, MD, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No.C-08-CV-26-000422; Tax ID No.06-147852) the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the CHARLES COUNTY COURTHOUSE, located at 200 CHARLES STREET (IN THE BREEZEWAY BETWEEN CIRCUIT AND DISTRICT COURTS), LA PLATA, MD 20646, on

OCTOBER 7, 2026 at 12:30 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in CHARLES COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit \$30,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK. CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for CHARLES COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee(s) are unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 26-003158)

JAMES E. CLARKE,
JOANNA FORONDA,
MARY L. HURLEY,
PAUL J. MORAN,
JASON N. GREENBERG,
JOHN ANSELL III,
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES



Sep 21,28,Oct 5, 2026

0012524432

872	Fairfax County	872	Fairfax County
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TRUSTEES SALE OF 13001 Worlidge Drive, Herndon, VA 20170
In execution of a certain Deed of Trust dated April 4, 2014, in the original principal amount of \$65,000,000 recorded in the Clerk's Office for Fairfax County, Virginia in Book 23610 at Page 7. The undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction in the front of the Fairfax County Circuit Court building, located at 4110 Chain Bridge Road, Fairfax, VA 22030, on **October 26, 2026, at 9:00 AM**, the real and personal property described in said Deed of Trust, located at the above address, and more particularly described as follows:

ALL that certain land situate in the Town of Herndon, Fairfax County, Virginia, commonly known as 13001 Worlidge Drive, Herndon, VA 20170, identified for tax purposes by Tax ID No. 016-3-02-00018, and more particularly described as follows:

BEGINNING at the northwestern corner to the tract herein described, said point being a drill hole set on the southerly valve and bearing right-of-way line of Worlidge Drive and being a corner HMM Properties Inc.;

Thence departing said HMM Properties Inc. and running with said Worlidge Drive the following courses and distances:

South 52 degrees 23 minutes 06 second East 66.40 feet to an iron pipe found;

North 37 degrees 36 minutes 54 seconds East 9.00 feet to an iron pipe found;

South 52 degrees 22 minutes 03 seconds East 29.89 feet to an iron pipe set;

South 54 degrees 32 minutes 12 seconds East 17.94 feet to a drill hole found;

South 47 degrees 16 minutes 36 seconds East 103.70 feet to an iron pipe set;

180.19 feet along the arc of a curve to the right, said curve having a radius of 823.00 feet, a central angle of 12 degrees 32 minutes 41 seconds and a chord which bears South 45 degrees 17 minutes 42 seconds East 179.83 feet to an iron pipe found;

South 36 degrees 50 minutes 42 seconds East 179.19 feet to a drill hole set;

South 31 degrees 34 minutes 16 seconds East 126.22 feet;

to an iron pipe found, a corner to Parcel 2D, Worlidge Associates Property;

Thence departing said Worlidge Drive and running with said Parcel 2D, Worlidge Associates Property the following courses and distances:

South 61 degrees 42 minutes 41 seconds West 203.59 feet to a point;

South 16 degrees 42 minutes 41 seconds West 20.00 feet to a PK nail found;

North 73 degrees 17 minutes 19 seconds West 58.00 feet to a cross-pit found;

South 16 degrees 42 minutes 41 seconds West 155.75 feet to an iron pipe found;

North 66 degrees 16 minutes 26 seconds West 234.23 feet to an iron pipe found;

North 56 degrees 19 minutes 41 seconds West 294.19 feet to an iron pipe found;

North 58 degrees 09 minutes 16 seconds West 51.96 feet to an iron pipe found;

North 59 degrees 18 minutes 01 seconds West 1.86 feet to an iron pipe found on the line of the aforementioned HMM Properties Inc.;

Thence departing said Parcel 2D, Worlidge Associates Property and running with said HMM Properties Inc. the following courses and distances:

North 16 degrees 42 minutes 41 seconds East 128.59 feet to a point;

North 28 degrees 17 minutes 19 seconds West 36.81 feet to a point;

North 61 degrees 42 minutes 41 seconds East 1.58 feet to a point;

South 73 degrees 17 minutes 19 seconds East 16.91 feet to a point;

North 16 degrees 42 minutes 41 seconds East 24.90 feet to a point;

North 73 degrees 17 minutes 19 seconds West 19.42 feet to a point;

N 28 degrees 17 minutes 19 seconds West 2.83 feet to a point;

North 16 degrees 42 minutes 41 seconds East 31.35 feet to a point;

North 28 degrees 17 minutes 19 seconds West 35.82 feet to a point;

North 61 degrees 42 minutes 41 seconds East 8.60 feet to a point;

North 16 degrees 42 minutes 41 seconds East 19.17 feet to a point;

South 73 degrees 17 minutes 19 seconds East 9.67 feet to a point;

North 16 degrees 42 minutes 41 seconds East 8.25 feet to a point;

South 73 degrees 17 minutes 19 seconds East 206.30 feet to a point;

North 16 degrees 42 minutes 41 seconds East 270.51 feet to the point of beginning and containing 7.25775 acres more or less.

Together with all personal property identified in the Deed of Trust. Please see the aforesaid Deed of Trust for a complete description of the subject property.

<

THE WEATHER

WASHINGTONPOST.COM/WEATHER

Clouds flee after dreary weekend

Expect encroaching sunshine to gradually displace any clouds left over from the weekend, with temperatures rising to a comfortable 73 degrees. You might still want to bundle up, though — not because of rain, but because of wind from the northwest gusting to around 20 mph. In the evening, skies will clear and temperatures will drop to the high 40s.

AccuWeather FORECAST

Today
Partly sunny



73° 50°
REALFEEL®: 73°
CHANCE PRECIP: 5%
WIND: NW 8-16 mph
HUMIDITY: Moderate

Tuesday
Plenty of sun



66° 48°
REALFEEL®: 72°
CHANCE PRECIP: 0%
WIND: NNW 4-8 mph
HUMIDITY: Moderate

Wednesday
Sunny



75° 56°
REALFEEL®: 75°
CHANCE PRECIP: 0%
WIND: S 7-14 mph
HUMIDITY: Moderate

Thursday
Mostly sunny



80° 55°
REALFEEL®: 79°
CHANCE PRECIP: 10%
WIND: WNW 6-12 mph
HUMIDITY: Moderate

Friday
Pleasant with sunshine



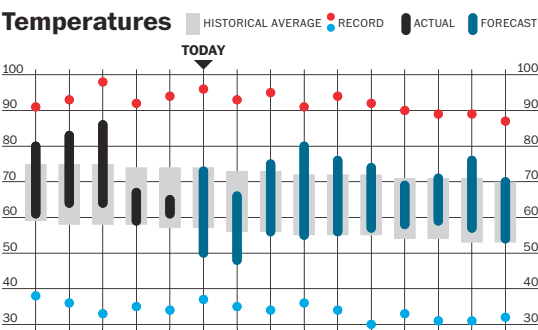
76° 56°
REALFEEL®: 78°
CHANCE PRECIP: 5%
WIND: WNW 6-12 mph
HUMIDITY: Low

Saturday
Partly sunny

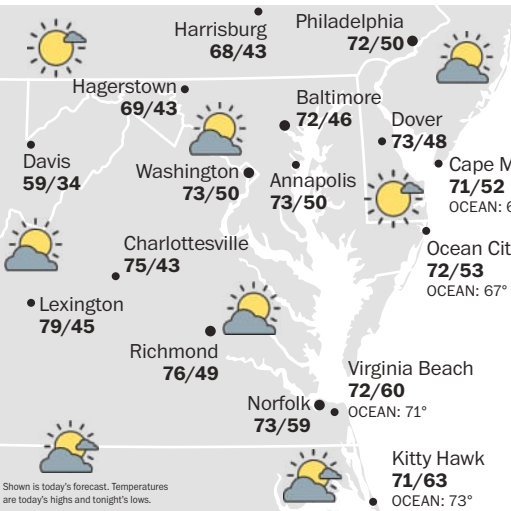


74° 57°
REALFEEL®: 76°
CHANCE PRECIP: 15%
WIND: ESE 4-8 mph
HUMIDITY: Moderate

OFFICIAL RECORD



REGION TODAY



Pollen: Moderate
Observed ratings on 10/2
Grass Low
Trees Moderate
Weeds Low
Mold Moderate

Air Quality: Good
Main pollutant: Particulates

UV: Moderate
4 out of 11*

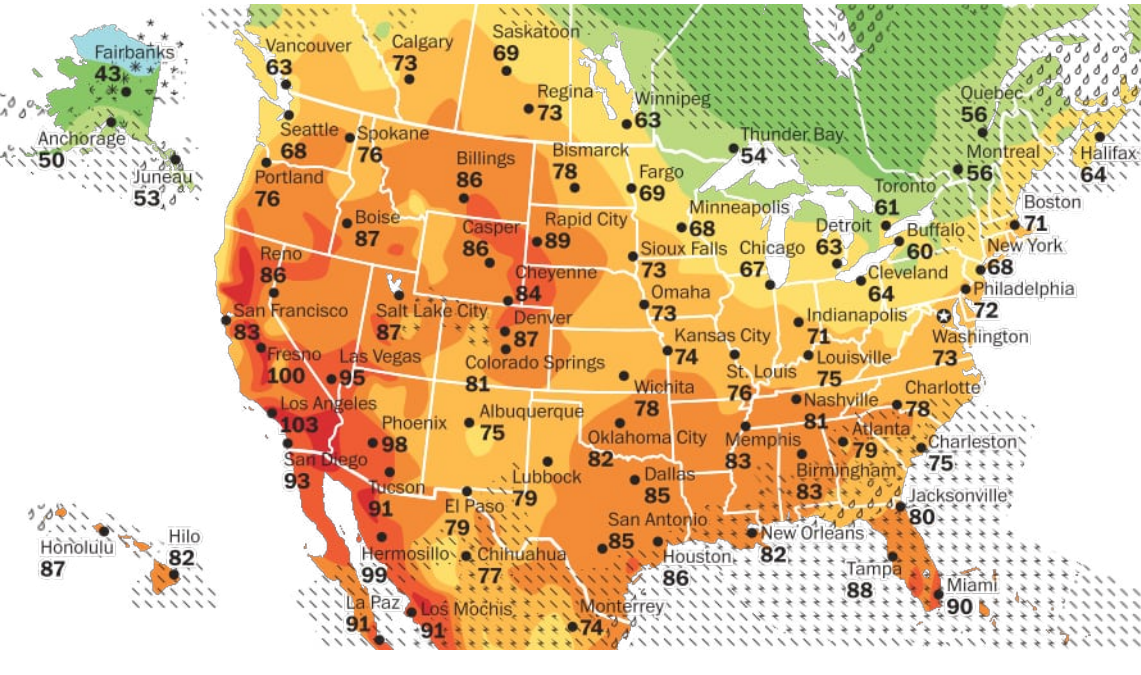
Blue Ridge: Shenandoah National Park: Today, mostly sunny; the start of an extended stretch of dry weather. High 71. Winds northwest 6-12 mph. Tonight, clear. Low 42. • **Great Smoky Mtns. National Park:** Today, sunny, not as warm; the start of an extended stretch of dry weather. High 65. Winds northeast 6-12 mph. Tonight, mainly clear.

Atlantic beaches: Ocean City, MD: Today, partly sunny, less humid. High 72. Winds northwest 7-14 mph. Tonight, clear. Low 53. Winds north-northwest 7-14 mph. • **Virginia Beach:** Today, mostly cloudy, less humid. High 72. Winds north-northwest 8-16 mph. Tonight, clear, a steady breeze. Low 60. Winds north 10-20 mph.

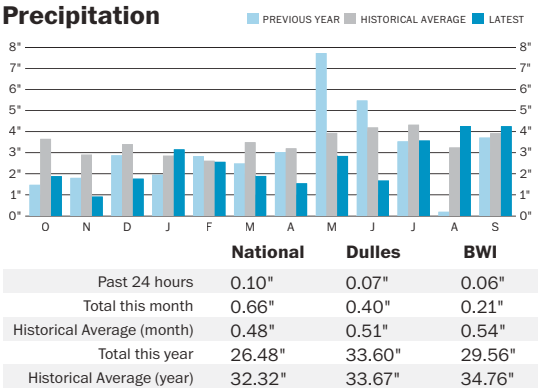
Waterways: Upper Potomac River: Today, partly sunny. Wind northwest 6-12 knots. Waves 2 feet or less. Visibility unrestricted. • **Lower Potomac and Chesapeake Bay:** Today, partly sunny. Wind northwest 7-14 knots. Waves 1-2 feet on the Lower Potomac; 2-4 feet on the Chesapeake Bay. • **River Stages:** The stage at Little Falls will be around 2.80 feet today, with no change of 2.80 Tuesday. Flood stage at Little Falls is 10 feet.

Today's tides (Shown are High tides in Bold and low tides.)				
Washington	3:30 a.m.	11:07 a.m.	4:26 p.m.	11:16 p.m.
Annapolis	1:24 a.m.	7:58 a.m.	1:07 p.m.	7:20 p.m.
Ocean City	3:18 a.m.	9:24 a.m.	4:00 p.m.	10:31 p.m.
Norfolk	5:25 a.m.	11:32 a.m.	6:02 p.m.	none
Point Lookout	4:20 a.m.	9:12 a.m.	3:29 p.m.	10:14 p.m.

NATION TODAY



NATIONAL		Today	Tomorrow	Des Moines		71/53/s	78/58/s	Oklahoma City		82/55/s	85/58/s	WORLD		Today	Tomorrow
Albany, NY	62/41/p	57/39/s		Detroit	63/41/s	65/50/s		Omaha	73/55/s	78/57/s	75/53/p	Addis Ababa	71/57/p	72/58/p	
Albuquerque	75/55/s	79/57/s		El Paso	79/61/p	84/62/s		Orlando	88/75/t	83/73/t		Amsterdam	69/58/p	70/55/p	
Anchorage	50/38/sh	47/39/r		Fairbanks, AK	43/31/c	40/30/c		Philadelphia	72/50/p	66/48/s		Johannesburg	68/51/c	72/51/p	
Austin	79/63/c	78/58/s		Fargo, ND	69/51/s	74/47/p		Phoenix	98/78/s	99/78/s		Kabul	84/60/p	78/58/p	
Baltimore	87/65/s	87/62/s		Hartford, CT	67/42/p	60/39/s		Pittsburgh	65/40/s	62/44/s		Kingston, Jam.	92/80/t	91/80/sh	
Billings, MT	72/46/p	65/45/s		Honolulu	87/73/r	87/73/sh		Portland, ME	67/40/p	59/35/s		Kolkata	93/77/p	89/77/p	
Birmingham	83/62/s	83/58/s		Houston	86/70/s	89/70/s		Portland, OR	76/55/s	75/50/p		Kyiv	65/49/p	66/51/p	
Boise	78/46/p	77/43/s		Indianapolis	71/46/s	71/53/s		Providence, RI	70/44/p	62/40/s		Lagos	84/76/r	85/76/r	
Boston	71/46/p	62/45/s		Jackson, MS	85/65/s	88/64/t		Raleigh, NC	76/53/p	73/48/s		Lima	80/71/s	80/71/s	
Buffalo	60/41/s	60/51/s		Jacksonville, FL	80/71/r	78/71/t		Reno, NV	86/52/s	88/53/s		Lisbon	78/64/t	74/62/p	
Burlington, VT	59/40/sh	56/41/s		Kansas City, MO	74/52/s	79/59/s		Richmond	76/49/c	68/47/s		London	72/53/p	71/56/p	
Charleston, SC	75/65/r	75/62/r		Las Vegas	95/74/s	97/75/s		Sacramento	100/60/s	101/62/s		Madrid	73/59/t	70/57/t	
Charleston, WV	70/41/s	71/45/s		Little Rock	83/55/s	83/56/s		St. Louis	76/52/s	78/58/s		Manila	95/79/sh	93/78/t	
Charlotte	78/55/c	75/51/s		Los Angeles	103/79/s	102/76/s		St. Thomas, VI	91/81/p	90/80/p		Mexico City	72/57/r	73/57/r	
Cincinnati	70/45/s	72/48/s		Louisville	75/48/s	75/51/s		Salt Lake City	87/61/p	83/58/s		Montreal	56/39/sh	55/43/p	
Cleveland	64/42/s	66/50/s		Memphis	83/57/s	84/59/s		San Diego	93/73/s	90/72/s		Moscow	55/47/c	55/46/r	
Dallas	85/61/s	83/61/s		Miami	90/78/t	90/78/t		San Francisco	83/60/s	84/61/s		Mumbai	95/79/s	93/81/s	
Denver	87/58/s	86/54/c		Milwaukee	62/49/s	70/56/s		San Juan, PR	91/78/r	90/79/p		Nairobi	83/62/p	81/62/r	
				Minneapolis	68/57/s	76/54/s		Seattle	68/52/p	67/52/p		New Delhi	97/75/s	97/75/s	
				Nashville	81/49/s	81/56/s		Spokane, WA	76/47/s	75/46/p		Oslo	65/47/p	62/40/s	
				New Orleans	82/74/t	82/74/c		Syracuse	60/38/sh	57/40/s		Ottawa	54/35/sh	53/40/s	
				New York City	68/49/p	62/48/s		Tampa	88/76/t	83/74/t		Paris	76/51/p	77/52/p	
				Norfolk	73/59/c	67/51/s		Wichita	78/54/s	83/59/s		Prague	69/44/s	70/45/s	



Moon Phases			Solar system		
Oct 10	New	Oct 18	First Quarter	Oct 25	Full
Nov 1	Quarter				
Sun	Rise	7:08 a.m.	Set	6:45 p.m.	
Moon	Rise	1:25 a.m.	Set	4:12 p.m.	
Venus	Rise	9:34 a.m.	Set	7:14 p.m.	
Mars	Rise	1:26 a.m.	Set	3:37 p.m.	
Jupiter	Rise	2:49 a.m.	Set	6:48 p.m.	
Saturn	Rise	6:48 p.m.	Set	7:07 a.m.	

Islamabad	93/74/p	85/68/t	Rio de Janeiro	80/71/r	79/72/sh
Istanbul	71/57/p	72/58/p	Riyadh	102/79/p	103/78/p
Jerusalem	76/61/p	75/58/sh	Rome	79/62/p	73/62/sh
Johannesburg	68/51/c	72/51/p	San Salvador	85/68/r	84/69/r
Kabul	84/60/p	78/58/p	Santiago	66/53/c	60/53/r
Kingston, Jam.	92/80/t	91/80/sh	Sarajevo	74/41/c	77/45/s
Kolkata	93/77/p	89/77/p	Seoul	69/48/s	73/48/s
Kyiv	65/49/p	66/51/p	Shanghai	74/57/p	77/59/p
Lagos	84/76/r	85/76/r	Singapore	92/81/sh	94/79/p
Lima	80/71/s	80/71/s	Stockholm	61/48/c	59/38/s
Lisbon	78/64/t	74/62/p	Sydney	72/61/p	80/59/s
London	72/53/p	71/56/p	Taipei City	83/71/t	76/70/p
Madrid	73/59/t	70/57/t	Tehran	79/66/p	81/68/p
Manila	95/79/sh	93/78/t	Tokyo	73/69/r	82/68/p
Mexico City	72/57/r	73/57/r	Toronto	61/39/s	62/50/s
Montreal	56/39/sh	55/43/p	Vienna	73/46/c	75/48/s
Moscow	55/47/c	55/46/r	Warsaw	65/50/p	69/48/p

Key: s=sunny, pc=partly cloudy, ec=cloudy, r=rain, sh=showers, t=thunderstorms, sf=snow flurries, sn=snow, f=fog
Sources: AccuWeather.com; US Army Centralized Allergen Extract Lab (pollen data); airmow.gov (air quality data); National Weather Service
* AccuWeather's RealFeel Temperature® combines over a dozen factors for an accurate measure of how the conditions really "feel."



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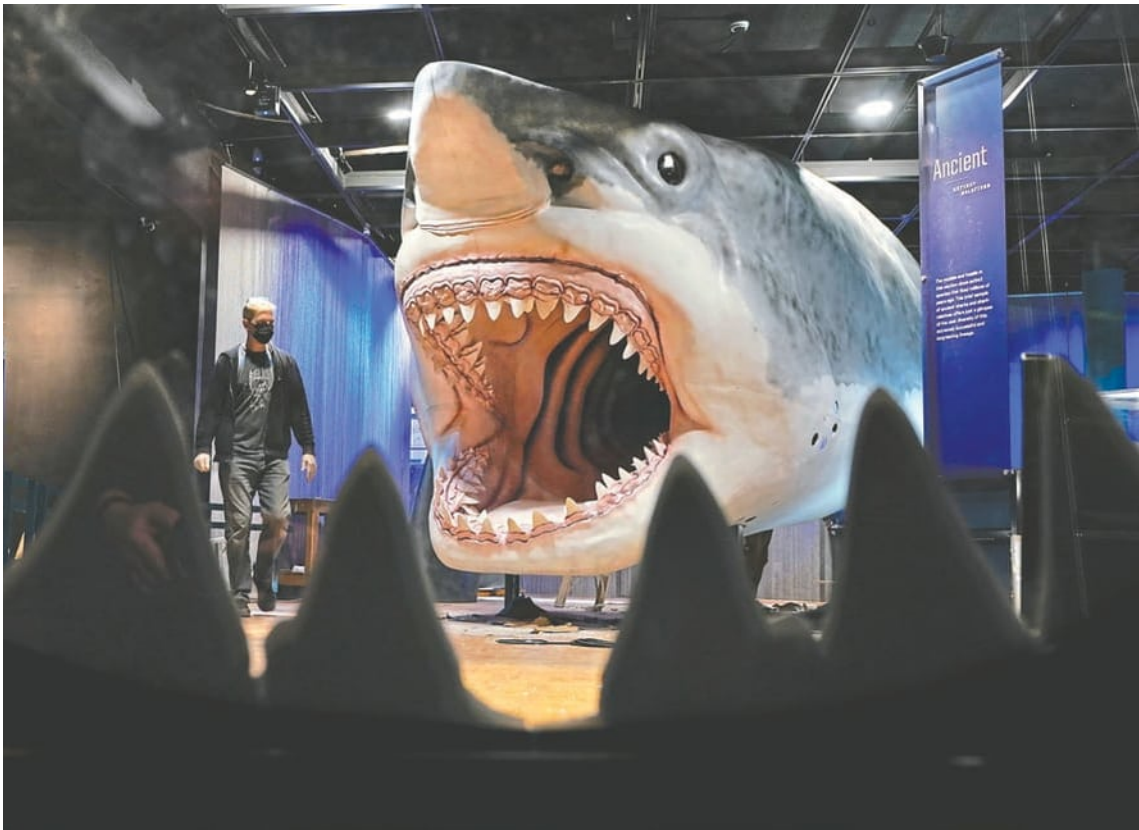


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RICHARD DREW/AP

A model of a megalodon, sometimes called the “T. rex of the seas,” at the American Museum of Natural History in New York. According to fossils, the prehistoric shark could have been about the size of this model: 27 feet long and 10 feet tall.

MARYLAND

Mighty megalodon becomes nation's first officially designated state shark

BY NICOLE PILSBURY
Baltimore Sun

Maryland is officially the first state in the nation to designate a state shark: The extinct megalodon became one of the state symbols Thursday as nearly 300 new laws took effect.

The megalodon was the largest predatory shark to ever live, according to a news release from the Calvert Marine Museum.

Its fossils, including highly coveted teeth, can be found throughout the Chesapeake Bay region, offering insight into prehistoric marine ecosystems, the release added.

“It’s one of the most famous prehistoric marine animals out there,” Del. Todd B. Morgan (R), a sponsor of the bill who represents Calvert and St. Mary’s counties, said at a hearing for the bill in March. “Megalodon roamed the Chesapeake Bay. Maybe he could have been a distant relative of Chessie, the

famous monster of the Chesapeake.”

Megalodon teeth can be found in seven Maryland counties: Anne Arundel, Calvert, Caroline, Charles, Dorchester, Prince George’s and St. Mary’s.

Despite being extinct, the megalodon represents the ecological importance of sharks in ocean systems and offers opportunities for education about marine life, conservation and the planet’s history, according to the release.

Although the original bill that designated the megalodon as Maryland’s state shark did not make it through the General Assembly’s legislative session this year, the designation was added to a bill about commemorative days and state designations sponsored by state Sen. Carl Jackson, a Democrat representing Baltimore County.

Stephen Godfrey, a curator of paleontology at the Calvert Marine Museum, was involved in creating the designation, work-

ing with lawmakers and testifying at hearings to champion the bill after pitching the idea.

A benefit of the megalodon being extinct is that it doesn’t carry a “fear factor,” but it can still be used to educate people, Godfrey said.

“We don’t want people to be afraid of sharks,” he said. “We want them to recognize that they’re a very important part of our marine ecosystem.”

Sharks play a large role in regulating species diversity and abundance, Godfrey added.

The megalodon’s designation as the state shark can serve as a way to educate people about other aspects of paleontology, such as what other fossils can be found in Maryland, he said.

“People love big predators,” Godfrey said. “We can use [the megalodon] as a hook to teach other things that we might not be able to get across as easily or [that might not] capture the imagination of children as does megalodon.”

BRAIN MATTERS

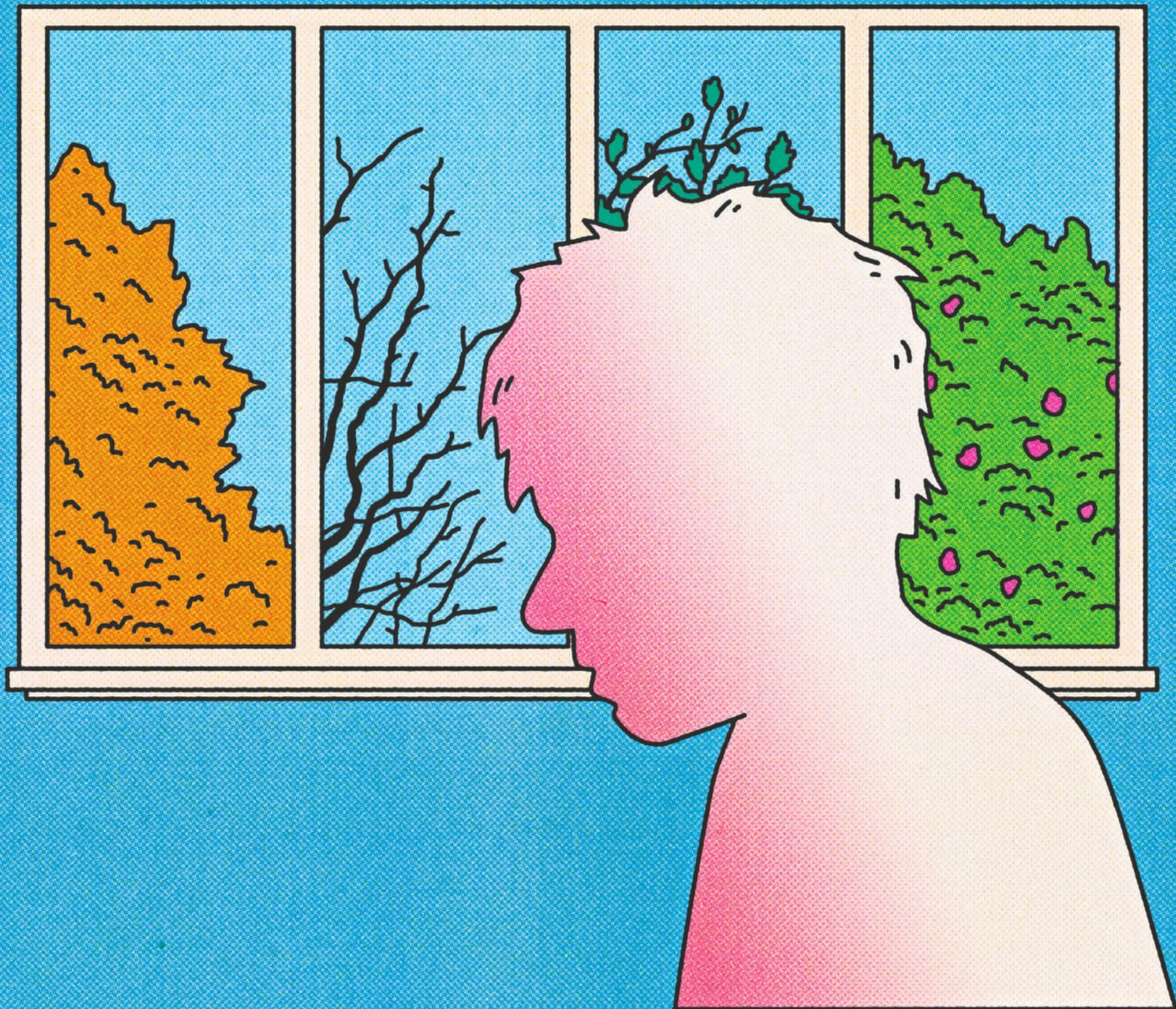


ILLUSTRATION BY GEORGE WYLESOL/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Stressed out? Place a hand on your heart for 20 seconds.

BY SYDNEY PAGE

In a moment of stress, there's a quick way that might help you calm yourself, researchers say: Place your hand on your heart for 20 seconds.

Most of us have probably had the experience of feeling comforted by a hug, but we don't always have that option if we're heading into a presentation at work or facing another potentially anxiety-producing situation.

Studies suggest that briefly placing a hand on your heart or abdomen can lower the stress hormone cortisol.

"The main finding was that before a stressful situation, doing 20 seconds of this gesture can lower the physiological stress response," said Aljoscha Dreisörner, a lecturer at the University of Graz Institute of Psychology in Austria and the lead author on a 2021 study that looked at the phenomenon.

In his study, 159 participants were told they would have just minutes to prepare for a presentation to a panel of strangers, where they would be asked to count backward from 2,043 in increments of 17.

They were assigned one of three stress-abatement "support measures" before their presentations, including self-soothing touch for 20 seconds, meaning placing one hand over their heart and one on their abdomen. Others received a 20-sec-

SEE CALM ON D6

Like long covid, flu can linger, too

Persistent symptoms may harm the lungs and other organs

BY RICHARD SIMA

Flu season is upon us, and millions will catch the virus. Last year, at least 32 million Americans got influenza, leading to almost 400,000 hospitalizations and at least 24,000 deaths. ¶ But a bout of flu doesn't always end after the coughing, fever and runny nose. Some people may develop "long flu," with persistent symptoms affecting not only the respiratory system, where the influenza virus first strikes, but other body organs, including the brain. ¶ A large 2024 study published in the journal the Lancet Infectious Diseases found that the long-lasting health consequences of flu eclipse by a large degree the symptoms when you first catch it, said Ziyad Al-Aly, a senior clinical epidemiologist at Washington University in St. Louis and co-author of the study. ¶ Before the pandemic and the rise of long covid, most people — including doctors like Al-Aly — believed that getting the flu meant being out of commission for a few weeks at most. ¶ But looking at what happens after the flu in their own data, it was eye-opening, Al-Aly said.

SEE FLU ON D4

MEDICINE

Prednisone can feel like a miracle drug, but it may come at a cost. D2



AGING

Do these five simple exercises every day to maintain mobility. D3

BILL OF THE MONTH

The hospital never treated her. She was still charged.

BY MICHELLE ANDREWS
KFF Health News

Autumn Daniels is no stranger to migraine headaches, which have troubled her since childhood.

The migraine tormenting the 32-year-old in April was even worse than usual. After a week of piercing head pain, she went to an urgent care center near her home in Champaign, Illinois, and received an injection of Toradol, a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug that usually helps with her symptoms. The doctor at the clinic told her that if the pain didn't improve, she should go to an emergency room the next day.

It didn't improve. So the next morning, Daniels's sister took her to a nearby ER, at Carle Foundation Hospital in Urbana. She said the ER didn't seem very busy when she registered at the front desk and was taken briefly to an exam room, where a staffer checked her vital signs and asked whether she had migraines frequently. Then they told her to sit in the waiting room until she was called.

She and her sister waited. And waited. By then, Daniels said, she was vomiting every 10 minutes, a not-uncommon occur-

SEE BILL ON D4

WELL+BEING

Treating these common conditions may help stop or reverse hair loss in women

BY LINDSEY BEVER

Hair loss in women can be caused by many things, including your genetics, illnesses, nutritional deficiencies, physiological stress and shifts in hormones. While hair thinning and shedding can be distressing, determining the underlying causes can help slow down, stop or even reverse certain types of hair loss.

We asked dermatologists about three common underlying conditions that can lead to hair loss, what signs to look for and what treatments are available. Here's what they said.

Thyroid disorders

Thyroid disorders, including both hyperthyroidism (when the thyroid is too active) and hypothyroidism (when it is not active enough), can lead to hair loss, research shows. And they're common, particularly among women — an estimated 1 in 8 women will develop some type of thyroid problem during their lifetime, data shows.

Thyroid disorders can disrupt the normal hair growth cycle, leading to a typically temporary but excessive form of hair shedding known as telogen effluvium, said Paradi Mirmirani, a dermatologist with Kaiser Permanente in Northern California.

The reason this happens is because the thyroid gland regulates our metabolism, controlling how fast it turns nutrients into energy. “Either the engine is running too hot or it's not running well enough. And the body's reaction is for the hair follicle to triage into a resting phase rather than a growth phase” to reallocate important resources, Mirmirani said.

Thyroid-related hair loss does not usually occur without other symptoms. For instance, hyperthyroidism can cause fatigue,



ISTOCK

Thyroid disorders, which affect an estimated 1 in 8 women, can lead to hair loss, research shows.

weight loss and a fast or irregular heartbeat, while hypothyroidism also can cause fatigue as well as weight gain and a slowed heart rate, among other symptoms. These conditions can be diagnosed with a blood test.

Hair loss may also result from autoimmune thyroid disease or thyroid removal, said Amy McMichael, professor of dermatology at Wake Forest University School of Medicine.

Thyroid-related hair loss can be resolved but requires treatment, time and patience. Once a physician addresses the underlying issue with hormone therapy, medications or surgery, for instance, and your thyroid levels normalize, it can take six to nine more months before excessive

shedding stops and your hair starts growing back more normally, Mirmirani said.

Iron deficiency

Iron deficiency is common, affecting about 1 in 3 Americans, and it can progress to iron deficiency anemia, which happens when your iron levels are too low for your body to make enough hemoglobin, the protein in red blood cells that carries oxygen through your blood. Low iron, which is more common in women, can stem from heavy menstrual bleeding, iron absorption problems, inadequate iron in the diet and other things. And it can lead to hair loss.

“Your body says, ‘I’m using all this energy to grow hair, but in

the current state, it is going to be more important for me to shift energy and deal with this anemia than it is for me to grow hair at the moment,” McMichael said.

Research suggests that low ferritin, a protein that stores iron inside your cells, is associated with different forms of hair loss, including telogen effluvium, in women. In fact, a 2025 study found that 28 percent of people with telogen effluvium had reduced ferritin levels, while no one in the control group had a deficiency.

The American Society of Hematology recently set new standards for diagnosing iron deficiency. If you have serum ferritin levels lower than 30 nanograms per milliliter, then you don’t have

enough iron in your body. For people with heavy menstrual cycles and those who are pregnant with anemia, the threshold is 50 ng/mL, and for those with certain inflammatory diseases and cancer, it's 100 ng/mL.

“I want ferritin above 30,” said Antonella Tosti, a professor of dermatology at the University of Miami. “Definitely when it's lower than 15 nanograms per milliliter, it's associated with excessive shedding.”

Women who have a restricted diet and may not get enough iron-rich foods, those who have absorption issues or those who have particularly heavy menstrual cycles may be more likely to have lower iron levels.

Once low iron is addressed — treatments may include oral supplementation or infusion — hair growth should start to normalize, though it can take months to see noticeable improvement. Your doctor may also recommend eating more iron-rich foods, such as red meat, poultry and fish, as well as legumes, leafy greens, seeds and nuts.

Hormonal conditions

Many women may notice hair loss with changes in hormones such as during pregnancy, menopause or even after starting or stopping birth control pills.

But hair loss is also a potential symptom of PMOS, which stands for polyendocrine metabolic ovarian syndrome, a common hormonal disorder that affects about 5 to 6 million women in the United States. People who have PMOS may experience an overgrowth of facial or body hair — such as dark coarse hair on the chest, abdomen, upper lip or chin — but at the same time, they may get thinning hair on the scalp.

PMOS, formerly known as polycystic ovarian syndrome (PCOS), doesn’t cause a lot of hair

shedding. Instead, excess testosterone is converted into dihydrotestosterone (DHT), which causes the hair follicles to become smaller and then the hair strands to become thinner. This is the thinning characteristic of female pattern hair loss, Mirmirani said.

In addition to hair-related changes, PMOS can cause acne, irregular periods, infertility, obesity and more.

One of the most common treatments for female pattern hair loss is minoxidil, sold under the brand name Rogaine. However, because it may cause hair growth in other places, such as the face or body, it's used with caution in people with PMOS.

Oral spironolactone, a hypertension drug, is often used off-label to block male hormone receptors, which can help with hair regrowth. Additionally, Mirmirani said she sometimes prescribes finasteride, an oral medication approved to treat androgenic alopecia in men, off-label for female pattern hair loss because it prevents the conversion of testosterone to DHT, which can prevent the shrinking of hair follicles.

However, because the Food and Drug Administration has warned about a potential for birth abnormalities, it is not recommended for women who are pregnant or who want to get pregnant.

While this miniaturization may not be completely reversed, with treatment to reduce androgens, you can see noticeable improvement, particularly when you intervene early.

“Think of it as a gradual progression of a big tree trunk to a finer, thinner branch,” Mirmirani said. “It’s much harder to enlarge the very fine miniaturized hair to the bigger, thicker, what we call ‘terminal hair,’ once it's far gone. If you do intervene earlier, you are more successful in the reversal.”

WELL+BEING

Prednisone can provide quick relief. It can also cause many side effects.

BY ERICA SLOAN

Almost since it hit the market in 1955, prednisone has been recognized as a double-edged sword, delivering both key benefits and significant risks. The drug mimics cortisol — a corticosteroid, or hormone produced by the adrenal glands, which are located on the top of the kidneys — dampening inflammation: the cause of pain, swelling and other symptoms of many chronic conditions and acute reactions.

For those living with inflammatory diseases such as rheumatoid arthritis, lupus, gout and ulcerative colitis, prednisone can feel like a miracle drug that offers swift pain relief — at least, at first. Short-term courses are also often prescribed to squash allergic reactions and flare-ups of asthma and chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, for instance triggered by a severe respiratory infection.

But because prednisone acts on receptors that are present in most cells, it can have myriad effects throughout the body, said Allison Hill, director of professional affairs at the American Pharmacists Association, many of which can be unpleasant or downright dangerous.

It's the reason the medical system has largely steered away from prednisone with the advent of targeted drugs to manage inflammatory conditions. Disease guidelines across medical organizations including the American College of Rheumatology and American College of Gastroenterology emphasize steroid-sparing strategies, which relegate prednisone and other corticosteroids to use mostly in brief durations and low doses, if at all.

Still, there are times when it's appropriate to use prednisone in the short term, and in rarer cases, for longer durations. (It's one of the top 40 most prescribed drugs in the United States, and roughly 10 million people are prescribed it every year.)

Below, experts break down how prednisone impacts different body systems and the possible side effects and risks that have earned it a mixed reputation.

Immune system

Prednisone's chief benefit comes from taming inflammation. *Some* degree of inflammation is good — it's how our immune system fights infection and repairs tissue after injury, said Jared Darveaux, an allergist-immunologist in Wisconsin and chair of the American College of Allergy, Asthma and Immunology Biologics and Pharmacology Committee. But sometimes, inflammation surges unnecessarily,

as in allergic reactions and autoimmune diseases, he explained. Prednisone helps shut that process down primarily by blocking the production of inflammatory chemicals in cells and limiting the function of certain immune cells.

Relief can come within a couple of days of starting prednisone. “People feel great because it treats whatever inflammatory condition [it was prescribed for] and also gets rid of other inflammation that we might not be thinking of, for instance in the joints,” Darveaux said.

But these benefits tend to be short-lived, said David Rubin, chief of gastroenterology, hepatology and nutrition, and director of the Inflammatory Bowel Disease Center at UChicago Medicine. Prednisone zaps inflammation without addressing the underlying cause.

Additionally, its reduction of immune activity keeps the body from ultimately being able to heal the tissue damaged by inflammation and can raise your risk of catching an infection, he said. (This immunosuppression is part of why, despite its potential to alleviate symptoms in the short term, prednisone is not recommended as treatment for the common cold or flu.)

Metabolic system

Because prednisone acts like cortisol, it sends your body into a version of fight-or-flight mode. This triggers metabolic changes to help move more sugar to your muscles, Darveaux explained — your liver releases stored glucose into your blood, and appetite spikes. Steroids can also reduce insulin sensitivity, preventing cells from using glucose as energy and raising blood sugar, said Carol Ramirez Rojas, an endocrinologist with Orlando Health Medical Group Endocrinology. All of the above can lead you to eat more and gain weight.

For those with diabetes or prediabetes, the blood-sugar surge can be especially dangerous. These people might need to begin insulin or raise their dose, Ramirez Rojas said.

With long-term use, generally for more than a month, steroids can also redistribute fat, shifting it around the midsection, Ramirez Rojas said. Some people develop a buildup of fat below the back of the neck, Rubin said. Fluid retention from prednisone can also contribute to weight gain and lead to facial swelling or what's known as “moon face,” he added.

Nervous system

Prednisone can “interfere with how the brain utilizes serotonin



ISTOCK

Prednisone, a corticosteroid often prescribed for short-term use to dampen inflammation, affects nearly every system in the body.

and norepinephrine,” Darveaux said, which are two chemicals important for mood and energy regulation. It's the reason mood changes and insomnia are among the more common side effects, even with short-term use.

Some people may feel down, while others can feel manic or hyperenergetic on prednisone, Rubin said. He recalled a colleague who took steroids for a week after surgery and said he'd “never been more productive.” It's rare, but a subset of people may develop steroid-induced psychosis and experience paranoia or delusions, he added, particularly at higher doses (e.g., 40 to 60 milligrams a day).

Musculoskeletal system

“Even a short course of corticosteroids, meaning a couple or three weeks, can reduce bone density,” Rubin said. (Longer and higher-dose courses pose an even greater threat.) The medication hinders the activity of bone-building cells and increases the functioning of bone-breakdown cells; all the while, it reduces absorption of bone-essential calcium. Petite and postmenopausal

women are especially at risk for corticosteroid-induced osteoporosis, Hill said.

Chronic use of prednisone (for a month or longer) can also increase your risk for steroid myopathy, or muscle weakness typically in the hips and thighs, Rubin said. “These people might have trouble getting out of a chair without using their arms.” It's generally reversible but can take weeks to months of strength-training after stopping the medication.

Gastrointestinal system

While prednisone has been used to treat inflammatory bowel diseases such as Crohn's and ulcerative colitis — though newer drugs, such as biologics and immunomodulators, are now considered the standard of care — the drug can also trigger GI effects, sometimes even with short-term use.

Steroids block the production of inflammatory chemicals called prostaglandins, which help maintain the stomach's mucus lining, or its layer of protection against harsh stomach acid, Rubin said. If that lining begins to disintegrate,

you may be at greater risk of stomach discomfort, heartburn and ulcers. However, Rubin noted that this risk is highest among those who combine prednisone with a nonsteroidal anti-inflammatory drug (NSAID) such as ibuprofen, which can also harm the stomach's mucosal shield.

Dermatologic system

In the past, dermatologists relied on oral corticosteroids to calm flare-ups of inflammatory skin conditions such as eczema or psoriasis — but only because there was nothing better available, said Emma Guttman-Yassky, chair of the department of dermatology at the Icahn School of Medicine at Mount Sinai and director of Mount Sinai's Laboratory for Inflammatory Skin Diseases.

Beyond its host of side effects, prednisone can trigger “rebound flares” of skin issues, where symptoms return “with a vengeance” after stopping the drug, Guttman-Yassky said. (Dermatologists now turn to safer long-term solutions — for instance, biologics or Janus kinase (JAK) inhibitors — to address certain inflammatory skin diseases, she added.)

Because prednisone lowers immune activity, it can also slow wound healing, and some people develop “steroid acne” — a smattering of uniform red bumps on the face, neck, back or chest — while on the drug, particularly at higher doses. Multiple courses or long-term use can also cause permanent skin thinning, fine lines or stretch marks, Guttman-Yassky said, because it limits synthesis of a skin protein called collagen.

Cardiovascular system

Several prednisone effects, taken together, can jeopardize heart health. It triggers fluid retention, which forces the heart to pump a greater volume and can raise blood pressure, particularly with prolonged use, Hill said. Prednisone can also cause changes in electrolyte balance that may alter heart rhythm. Coupled with the drug's blood-sugar impact, over time, these effects can increase risk of poor cardiovascular outcomes such as heart attack or stroke — even at lower daily doses.

Vision

Less commonly, prednisone can impede fluid drainage in the eyes, raising eye pressure and risk of glaucoma (which occurs when the optic nerve is damaged and can cause vision loss). In particularly sensitive people, this can happen within just days or weeks.

Chronic steroid use is also tied to cataracts, or cloudy spots in the

lens of the eye. A few factors might be in play, but one theory is that prednisone can bind to proteins in the eye lens, Darveaux said, altering its shape. Both eye conditions can be treated if caught early.

Getting off prednisone safely

Stopping prednisone can undo many of these side effects — such as changes in blood sugar and blood pressure, weight, appetite, mood and sleep — and mitigate the longer-term risks. But it's important to check with your doctor before discontinuing the medication.

A course of two weeks or shorter, for instance taken for an acute allergic reaction, can usually be stopped without issue, according to the experts we spoke with (though always check with your provider first).

Anything longer-term requires a slow taper, to avoid a rare but potentially life-threatening situation known as an adrenal crisis. With substantial time on prednisone, “the adrenal gland senses that there are enough steroids in the body and slows cortisol production,” Ramirez Rojas explained. “At the moment when the patient [stops the steroid], the gland can be nonfunctional.” Without cortisol, blood pressure can plummet, leading to dizziness or fainting, fatigue, nausea or muscle weakness. Gradually decreasing your dosage over a few weeks, instead of stopping cold turkey, can mitigate this risk.

But even if you feel great on prednisone and taper very slowly, stopping the medication typically brings back symptoms of an underlying inflammatory condition. “You can’t tiptoe away from steroids and fool your body into thinking it doesn’t have an immune problem anymore,” Rubin said. If you're taking prednisone to treat a chronic condition and not an acute illness, it's important to work with your doctor to ensure you begin a different, nonsteroidal medication as you taper, Guttman-Yassky said, to avoid winding up back on the drug again.

HEALTH & SCIENCE

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5 movements physical therapists say every adult over 50 should do every day

BY CHRISTA SGOBBA

It's the bane of busy folks everywhere: You know you *should* set aside time for regular exercise, but your packed schedule makes it tough. And as you reach your 50s and beyond, your body might start feeling the effects of that missed movement.

That's because as you get older, the bodily systems that work together to keep you mobile experience subtle changes, including losing muscle strength and mass and declining balance and proprioception, or your body's ability to sense where it is in space, said physical therapist Teresa Liu-Ambrose, director of the Aging, Mobility and Cognitive Health Lab at the University of British Columbia.

Movements that you once took for granted may eventually become difficult, and over time, a lack of mobility — the ability to move your joints through a comfortable range of motion — could make it more difficult to maintain independence.

This doesn't mean poor mobility is a given as you get older, said Annalisa Na, director of the Functional Aging and Mobility Research Laboratory at Drexel University. The best way to maintain it is to keep training it with exercises that mimic the movements of everyday life.

Below are five moves that Liu-Ambrose and Na recommend adding into your daily routine to improve mobility and maintain balance and proprioception.

Before getting started, consider having a friend nearby — especially if you already have difficulties with balance — to make sure you're tackling these moves safely. If you're unsure if you can do them properly but are interested in working on mobility, ask your health care provider for a referral to a physical therapist, who can be a great resource for getting moving in a way that's appropriate for your current physical activity level.

For demonstrations of these exercises, head to wapo.st/5movements.

Sit-to-stand

Even if getting up from your chair isn't an issue for you now, lots of older adults have difficulty

rising without pushing off from the armrests, said Liu-Ambrose. Working the sit-to-stand — one of the top moves both Liu-Ambrose and Na recommend to older clients and a good measure of overall fitness — into your daily routine can help preserve that functional motion.

The move strengthens your quads, hamstrings and glutes, and it trains the mobility of multiple joints, including your hips, knees and ankles, said Liu-Ambrose.

How to do it: Standing with your feet flat on the floor facing away from a sturdy chair, hinge forward at your hips to initiate a squatting motion. Lower until your butt hits the seat. Then, push evenly through your heels to stand up tall. That's one rep; aim to do 10.

The key is to take it slow and control your descent: "Pretend there's an egg on the chair," said Liu-Ambrose. "You want to sit down, but you don't want to squash it."

Make it easier by choosing a chair with a higher seat, said Na, or more difficult by picking a lower seat.

Dynamic pec stretch on wall

The pecs, or pectoral muscles, are what help you push objects (like a heavy door or furniture) and rotate your arms across your body (when you wash your opposite arm in the shower, for example). Spending a lot of time hunched over looking at your phone, laptop or tablet can make your pecs "quite tight," Liu-Ambrose said.

This dynamic stretch helps loosen the tight muscles in your chest. It also sets your body up for better posture, which is particularly important as you age because a hunched position can make your stance less steady, said Liu-Ambrose, potentially making falls more likely.

How to do it: Standing in front of a wall facing away from it, rest your butt, back and shoulders against the wall. Walk your feet forward a few inches and bend your knees slightly. With your arms in a goalpost position, try to touch the backs of your forearms to the wall. Reach your arms straight up, then bring them back down to goalpost position. That's one rep; aim for 10.



CHRISTIE HEMM KLOK/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

To do a heel raise, stand in front of a chair and rest your fingers on it for balance. Press your weight into the balls of your feet and raise your heels off the floor before lowering back down. That's one rep.

If your chest muscles are too tight for your arms to touch the wall, hold them a few inches out in front of the wall instead.

Heel raise

Your calf muscles' main job is to propel your body forward and help you accelerate and decelerate, said Na. As you get older, these muscles can weaken, resulting in less power in your stride when you walk or run, said Liu-Ambrose.

Weakness there can also lead to a shorter, more shuffling gait, which can make it difficult to steady yourself if you get knocked off balance. "It takes away a layer of defense that keeps you from falling," Na said.

The heel raise — one of the best exercises you can do for healthy aging — is effective at strengthening these muscles.

How to do it: Stand with your feet hip-width apart in front of a chair, counter, table or wall, and rest your fingers gently on the surface for balance. Then, press your weight into the balls of your feet to raise your heels as high as you can off the floor before lowering back down. That's one rep; aim for 10.

If these feel easy, you can add an extra power training element by raising your heels as quickly as possible, then slowly lowering down to the ground, said Liu-Ambrose. To further challenge your balance, try doing heel raises one leg at a time, she said.

Tandem stance/walk

When younger folks get knocked off balance, "the muscles around the ankle respond without them even thinking about it," said Na. As you get older, this doesn't happen as readily due to decreases in proprioception, as well as changes in ankle strength and stiffness.

While heel raises can help strengthen the muscles around the ankle joint, a simple tandem stance or walk, where you line your feet up heel-to-toe, also helps by honing your proprioception, Na said. By narrowing your base of support, it encourages the muscles in your ankle to make quick, tiny adjustments to keep you steady.

How to do it: Stand with one foot directly in front of the other,

the heel of your front foot touching the toes of your back. Try to hold this position while you're doing a task, like washing dishes or brushing your teeth, said Liu-Ambrose. If this position makes you too unsteady, do this in front of a counter, table or other surface that you can gently hold onto for support.

If this stance feels easy, try a tandem walk, which can further hone your balance. "Just be very deliberate so as you're walking, you're going heel-toe, heel-toe," said Liu-Ambrose. "Don't try to race through it."

Standing hip abduction

The hip abductors — a small group of muscles located on the outside of each hip that allow you to move your leg away from the midline of your body — tend to be weak for many folks, Liu-Ambrose said. Because they play a huge role in keeping your body stable in single-leg activities (walking, running or climbing stairs), weakness there can mess with your balance.

The standing hip abduction exercise helps strengthen these small-but-mighty muscles at home.

How to do it: Stand with your feet hip-width apart beside a sturdy chair or counter, lightly holding it with one hand for balance. Keeping your torso straight, lift your outside leg out to the side as far as is comfortable, feeling your outer hip and glute muscles engage, and lower it back down with control. That's one rep; aim for 10, then repeat on the other side.

"The key thing is that your toes should always be facing forward, not rotated sideways," said Liu-Ambrose. This targets the muscles you want to work on.

By adding a few simple moves into your day, you can help set yourself up for successful movement as you get older. Liu-Ambrose said to think of it like you do your retirement plan. "The advice has always been to start early and to invest a little bit throughout the years so that you can retire quite comfortably," she said. "By taking care of your body on a daily basis, the benefits accumulate," allowing you to maintain function for the long haul.

If your eyes have become persistently dry or you're seeing floaters, it may be a sign that something is wrong.



ISTOCK

The eye changes you shouldn't ignore

Here's what's normal as you age and what may signal a problem

BY KATHLEEN FELTON

James Byczek was out to dinner with his wife and a friend when he noticed what he thought was a fly buzzing around the room. "I asked them if they saw it, too, and they said no," he said. Later, at home, the floating spot had transformed into a thick, squiggly black line in his left eye. "I thought, *That's weird, I must have something in my eye*," Byczek, then 56, recalled. But he didn't see anything when he looked in the mirror.

Byczek, who lives in Elmhurst, Illinois, booked an appointment with an optometrist, who referred him to the emergency room. Three days later, he was in surgery for a retinal detachment.

Developing a detached retina — when the light-sensitive tissue lining the back of the eye pulls away from its normal position — is fairly uncommon. The average person's lifetime risk is less than 1 percent. However, if you are very nearsighted, have had a previous eye injury or have a family history of detachment, your chances of experiencing one are higher. Age increases that risk, too. "One of the main considerations with eye health is that age is a risk factor for nearly every eye disease," said Teri Geist, president of the Amer-

ican Optometric Association and an optometrist at Midwest Eye Care, P.C., in Omaha.

Suddenly seeing floaters, as Byczek did, can be a sign that something's wrong. But unfortunately, "so many eye diseases are quiet," noted Geist, which is why the American Academy of Ophthalmology recommends all adults over 40 receive an eye disease screening every five to 10 years.

Older adults might consider more regular exams, said Seenu Hariprasad, a surgical retina specialist and chair of the Department of Ophthalmology and Visual Science at UChicago Medicine. "I think it's wise that patients over the age of 55 have an eye exam every one to two years, and those over 65 every year, even in the absence of visual symptoms," he said. More frequent visits are especially important if you have a family history of eye disease or certain health conditions, like diabetes or high blood pressure, which can damage the retina, he added.

In addition to scheduling regular eye exams, alert your health care provider if you experience any of the following vision changes. While some can be a normal part of aging, others can be signs of an underlying eye condition.

It becomes harder to read things up close

Losing the ability to focus up close — meaning those tiny letters on a pill bottle or even on your phone become unreadable — is "one of the first things people

will notice as they get older," said Andrew Iwach, clinical spokesperson for the American Academy of Ophthalmology and an ophthalmologist at the Glaucoma Center in San Francisco.

When you're young, your eye's clear lens is softer and more easily alters its shape to focus light onto the retina. As that lens hardens with age, it becomes less able to focus on nearby objects, leading to a condition called presbyopia. Around age 40, many people suddenly realize they can't read as easily — books, menus and even texts or emails become impossible to decipher without stretching an arm out. "People in the presbyopic age range think they're rapidly losing vision, but this is a very normal change of the eye," Hariprasad said.

What to do: Even though "almost everyone" will experience presbyopia, Hariprasad said, book an eye exam if you notice it. Your doctor may recommend prescription lenses or over-the-counter reading glasses. "They're not expensive, and it's just like a breath of fresh air," he said.

Your eyes feel drier

Staring at a screen all day can leave your eyes feeling dry and scratchy at any age, but dry eye becomes more common later in life. "As we get older, we tend not to produce as many natural tears," Iwach explained. About 5 percent of adults may have diagnosed dry eye, a 2019 study found, and prevalence steadily increases with age.

SEE VISION ON D4

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Influenza’s impact can linger long after the coughing, fever and runny nose

FLU FROM D1

Long flu vs. long covid

In the study, Al-Aly and his colleagues analyzed medical records of over 80,000 people hospitalized for covid and over 10,000 people hospitalized for seasonal flu.

The researchers found that people in both groups still reported health problems up to 18 months after their infection. Long flu is particularly hard on the lungs compared with covid and was associated with a larger increase in risk of chest pain, rapid heart rate, cough, low blood oxygen, shortness of breath and Type 1 diabetes. (Viral infections like covid and the flu can increase the risk of autoimmune diseases like Type 1 diabetes in both adults and children.)

While not as severe on the other organ systems as long covid, the long-term effects of flu still outweighed its short-term harms on almost every organ system evaluated, including the brain, heart and kidney.

Like long covid, which is estimated to affect up to 1 in 6 people who get the coronavirus, long flu also had notable psychiatric and neurological impacts. Mental

health diagnoses affected 59 out of 100 people, while neurological symptoms, such as cognitive impairment, memory problems and sleepiness, affected more than half of people in the Lancet Infectious Diseases study. (For covid, 63 out of 100 people had mental health symptoms and 57 out of 100 people had neurological symptoms.)

We don’t know how prevalent long flu is because it’s an emerging area of research, though Al-Aly suspected about 3 to 5 percent of people who get the flu may develop long-term symptoms, given the data he’s collected.

But history shows that phenomena like long flu and long covid are not new.

There have been multiple flu pandemics that caused a wave of chronic illness and disability. During and after the 1918 flu pandemic, people complained of symptoms that sounded similar to the “brain fog” associated with long covid, including lethargy, forgetfulness and hazy thinking. Years after, there was a rise in Parkinson’s-like symptoms tied to the flu, as well as a coinciding epidemic of sleeping sickness, or encephalitis lethargica,

which could cause extreme sleepiness and movement difficulties and may have been linked to the flu.

Similar long-lasting symptoms, known as post-acute infection syndromes, followed in the wake of other illnesses, such as respiratory viruses SARS and Middle East respiratory syndrome (MERS), and Ebola, Lyme disease and dengue.

The more we understand what acute infections are doing, the more we understand their long-term consequences, Al-Aly said. “It sort of eats something. It may eat some functional reserve.”

How infections can affect the brain

Many influenza virus strains, including the common seasonal strains as well as the one behind the pandemic of 1918, don’t usually directly infect the nervous system or brain. But there is growing evidence that the immune response plays a role in the infection’s long-lasting effects.

Research shows that the immune system responds to infection by releasing inflammatory cytokines in the blood, which can permeate into the brain.

“These cytokines have a very big effect on the function of the other organs, especially the brain, because they can activate the immune cells in the brain and this can lead to some neuronal damage,” said Shirin Hosseini, a researcher in the Technical University of Braunschweig’s department of cellular neurobiology who studies the consequences of viral infections on the nervous system.

Hosseini and her colleagues had reported ways that influenza viruses can induce long-term neurological effects back in 2018, but it was only with the arrival of the coronavirus pandemic that the research got noticed.

“After long covid, the citation of my paper suddenly increased,” Hosseini said. “Because they say that, yes, these respiratory infections can lead to the long-term effects on the nervous system.”

In the study, which was published in the Journal of Neuroscience, Hosseini and her colleagues infected mice with influenza virus and examined their brains a month later. Even 30 days after infection, there were signs of neuroinflammation and changes to neurons in the hippocampus, a

crucial brain area for learning and memory.

“The hippocampus is a very sensitive area to these inflammatory responses,” Hosseini said.

The strain of the influenza virus also mattered. Virus strains are like dog breeds, Al-Aly said. “One could be a German shepherd and one could be a Chihuahua” and behave differently even if they are still both of the same species, he said.

In the mice, there were no signs of long-term effects with the milder H1N1 strain — a subtype of seasonal flu formerly known as the swine flu — after 30 days.

But with the more severe H3N2 strain — a subtype of the seasonal flu — and H7N7 (the avian flu), there was decreased neuroplasticity in the hippocampus neurons and impaired memory in the mice. (Neuroplasticity refers to the brain’s ability to change or reorganize its neural connections.)

By 120 days, however, it looked as though the brain had recovered to baseline in young adult mice. Hosseini is conducting further study on older mice and so far has seen their brains do not recover as well.

How to prevent long flu

When there’s potential for viruses to cause neuronal damage, then “we have to prevent getting infected as much as possible,” Hosseini said.

Thankfully, the flu vaccine helps prime your immune system to fight off the virus, reducing short- and long-term health consequences.

“Getting vaccinated is really the right thing to do here,” Al-Aly said, adding that it can help protect against a serious infection as well as reduce your risk for long flu.

It remains unclear how much vaccination protects against long flu. But research has shown that the flu vaccine is linked to a reduced heart disease risk — by 20 to 50 percent. It is also associated with lowered dementia risk.

The flu vaccine is recommended for adults and children older than six months. And according to the American Academy of Family Physicians, October is the best time to get it.

Do you have a question about human behavior or neuroscience? Email BrainMatters@washpost.com and we may answer it in a future column.



Autumn Daniels went to an ER for a serious migraine attack. After waiting four hours, she left to find faster treatment. Her bill was \$410.

Leaving ER before getting care may still result in bill

BILL FROM D1

rence during one of her serious migraine attacks.

After four hours, with no indication that Daniels would be seen anytime soon, her sister took her to another hospital. There, after a wait of about an hour and a half, Daniels was seen and treated, receiving more Toradol and anti-nausea medication among other drugs.

Having left Carle without getting treatment, Daniels didn’t expect to be charged.

Then the bill came.

The medical service

Daniels said a staffer checked her pulse, temperature and blood pressure when she arrived at Carle. She said she received no other services, nor was she seen by a doctor.

At one point while they sat in the waiting room, Daniels said, her sister asked for an ice pack for her head, but the staff wouldn’t provide one.

“ER triage is driven by risk of death or serious harm, not by level of suffering,” said Jennifer Robblee, a neurologist at the Barrow Neurological Institute in Phoenix and a board member at the Association of Migraine Disorders. “Migraine patients without red flags are unlikely to be prioritized, as they are not at immediate risk of dying.”

The bill

Four hundred and ten dollars for an “Emergency Room Level 1” visit. Daniels said she requested an itemized bill showing how the hospital arrived at that figure but never received one.

This is not the first time that a patient has complained to “Bill of the Month” about receiving a bill after leaving a Carle Health emergency room without being treated. In 2023, Maggi Wettstein took her toddler to a different Carle Health hospital and was billed \$445 for a nasal swab test for covid and influenza. They, too, left before getting treatment.

The billing problem: What counts as care

Though Daniels left the emergency room after a four-hour wait without being treated, the hospital billed her anyway. Her health plan, provided through her job as a state employee, paid for her treatment at the second hospital but denied the Carle claim, leaving her on the hook for the charges.

“Under the terms of her health plan, claims associated with a patient leaving the facility against medical advice are not eligible for coverage,” Leslie Porras, a spokesperson for HealthLink, which administers Daniels’s plan, said in a statement.

When Daniels asked about her bill, a Carle representative responded in an email: “Effective March 1, 2026, Emergency Department visits may result in charges even if you are not seen directly by a provider. When you arrive at the Emergency Department, your visit begins as soon as care is initiated.”

The email said “care” could mean registration and nursing assessment, in addition to diagnostic testing and treatment. It said that even if patients leave without being seen by a provider, they may still be charged, because the hospital is using resources to maintain its staff, space and equipment.

Carle Health declined to discuss Daniels’s bill or her care, even though Daniels signed a privacy waiver that authorized it to do so.

In a statement, Carle Health spokesperson Brittany Simon said, “Our Emergency Department has consistent billing practices for triage care,” referring to the process through which patients are evaluated to ensure the most critical cases are treated first.

“Carle Health takes patient concerns seriously and supports transparency in our billing processes,” she said.

Typically, an ER bill would include separate dollar amounts for physician charges and hospital charges, said Amber Padron, assistant director of case management

at the Patient Advocate Foundation, a nonprofit that assists patients with chronic or life-threatening conditions.

Daniels’s bill listed a single charge, for \$410. Under the description, it said “Emergency Room Level 1” and included the current procedural terminology code “99281.” CPT codes are used to bill for evaluation and management, or E/M, services provided by a medical professional. Level 1 is the lowest level of emergency care.

But there’s a catch: According to the American Medical Association’s CPT guide, “Triage alone is not an E/M service; therefore, it cannot be reported with an E/M code.”

It gets murkier. According to Robert Mills, a spokesperson for the AMA, the physician charge for an emergency visit under that CPT code would generally be significantly less than \$410.

“It is likely the hospital consolidated the provider-billed charge with a facility fee,” Mills said, referring to a fee that hospitals tack on to bills to cover their overhead costs, such as utilities.

Amid the billing uncertainty, Daniels is clear about one thing: The decision to charge ER patients who leave without getting treatment is recent.

In 2025, she went to the same emergency room with gastrointestinal problems. After waiting for several hours, she went elsewhere for care. She said that before leaving, her mother, who accompanied her that day, confirmed with the front desk that Daniels wouldn’t be charged if they left then. And she wasn’t.

“So when I went in for this visit in April, I had no idea I was going to be charged, because it was a very similar set of circumstances,” Daniels said.

The health system didn’t respond to a question about why it changed its policy.

The resolution

Carle didn’t budge. According to the health system’s email to

Daniels, “the charges have been determined to be accurate and fully supported by the medical record documentation.”

Daniels said she paid \$25 of the \$410 bill and has applied for financial assistance.

Meanwhile, according to HealthLink’s statement, Daniels can contest her health plan’s denial. “Ms. Daniels has the right to appeal the decision through the established appeals process.”

She’s considering it, but she remains outraged about what happened.

“How is it ethical or even legal for a hospital to essentially bill for occupying a waiting room?” she asked.

The takeaway

Don’t assume you won’t be billed if you leave a hospital before receiving medical care. You can check with the front desk about the facility’s policy, as well as ask your insurer whether it provides coverage for such bills.

If the hospital billing department isn’t giving you information about what services you’re being billed for, request your medical records, said Padron, of the Patient Advocate Foundation.

Furthermore, when your health plan processes a claim, you should receive an explanation of benefits informing you of that and explaining what you may owe. Keep an eye on your mail and your insurance portal.

When a claim is denied, filing an appeal with your health plan is always a smart idea, Padron said.

“It’s always going to be a no if you don’t appeal,” she said.

Bill of the Month is a crowdsourced investigation by KFF Health News and The Washington Post’s Well+Being that dissects and explains medical bills. Since 2018, this series has helped many patients and readers get their medical bills reduced, and it has been cited in statehouses, at the U.S. Capitol and at the White House. Do you have a confusing or outrageous medical bill you want to share? Tell us about it at wapo.st/medicalbills.

7 vision changes that may signal a problem

VISION FROM D3

What to do: Over-the-counter artificial tears can provide relief, but check with your eye doctor if dry eye is very bothersome. “If it’s persistent, you definitely want us to take a look with our microscope and make sure that there’s nothing more concerning,” Iwach said.

You have trouble seeing in low light

Picture this: You walk into a dark movie theater after being out in the sun, and it takes a minute for your eyes to adjust. As you get older, “that’s harder to do,” said Christine Curcio, professor emerita in the Department of Ophthalmology and Visual Sciences and director of the AMD Histopathology Lab at the University of Alabama at Birmingham Heersink School of Medicine. “People find it takes longer and longer to adjust after a bright light,” she said, and may also find it difficult to do everyday tasks in dim light.

This happens because rod-shaped photoreceptors in the eye degenerate with age, Curcio explained. These light-detecting cells convert light into signals the brain can understand.

What to do: Book an eye disease screening with an optometrist or ophthalmologist. Difficulty adjusting to low light can be associated with a greater risk of developing age-related macular degeneration (AMD), Curcio said. AMD is a common retinal disease and the leading cause of irreversible vision loss in people over age 50. Some forms are treatable, but intervention is important before the condition progresses.

Things don’t look as crisp

Vision that’s cloudy, blurry or “not as sharp as it used to be” is a common complaint among older adults, Hariprasad said, especially after age 60. This can be a symptom of cataracts, which develop gradually and can eventually cause blurry, distorted or double vision.

With cataracts, “the crystal clear lens that we’re born with becomes opacified, hard and turns into a whitish-brown color,” Hariprasad said. People with cataracts can also notice halos around lights: “When they look at a headlight, for instance, you get the light sort of speckling,” said Joan Miller, a professor of ophthalmology and former chair of the Department of Ophthalmology at Harvard Medical School, Massachusetts Eye and Ear/Massachusetts General Hospital and ophthalmologist-in-chief at Brigham and Women’s Hospital. Around two-thirds of U.S. adults over age 80 have cataracts.

What to do: It can feel scary to see your world become increasingly blurry and distorted. But unlike some eye conditions that develop with age, “here we can restore the vision,” Iwach said. In the early stages, prescription lenses may help improve vision, while surgery is an option as cataracts progress.

Straight lines look curvy or wavy

Sudden vision distortion — for example, when objects that should be straight appear wavy

or curved — is a more serious symptom of AMD. This distortion can occur when a blood vessel behind the eye’s photoreceptors bursts, creating a bump that alters vision, Curcio explained. Patients “may look out at a telephone pole and see that it looks wavy,” she said.

Wavy or curved lines can also occur with diabetic eye disease, said Hariprasad, or an epiretinal membrane, which is scar tissue that forms over the retina’s surface. Vision distortion should be considered “a warning symptom that something is going on in the retina,” Miller said.

What to do: “If you have lines that are supposed to be straight and all of a sudden there are wavy lines, that is absolutely something that you should have evaluated,” said Geist, especially if it’s only occurring in one eye.

You experience eye floaters, flashes or dark spots

Aging also affects the vitreous, a substance that fills the back of the eye and is gel-like at birth but becomes more liquid over time. “As the vitreous liquefies, you develop a mix of solids and liquids, and that’s where you perceive floaters,” Iwach said. They may look like dots, circles, lines, cobwebs or little specks.

Floaters may eventually fade on their own, but they can be a sign of posterior vitreous detachment, which occurs when the vitreous pulls away from the back of the eye; diabetic retinopathy, a diabetes complication that causes damage to the retina’s blood vessels; or retinal detachment, as Byczek experienced.

What to do: Always reach out to an eye specialist if you suddenly see many new floaters or flashes of light, Hariprasad said. Certain retinal detachments are medical emergencies; the longer a person goes without treatment, the greater their risk of permanent vision loss.

Your peripheral vision starts to narrow

Unlike macular degeneration, which usually affects the center of your vision, glaucoma typically starts at the edges. The disease damages the optic nerve, gradually creating blind spots and narrowing peripheral vision. Because these changes happen slowly and central vision often remains intact until the disease is advanced, many people don’t realize anything is wrong.

Glaucoma “is one of the scarier” eye conditions, Hariprasad said. “By the time patients come in, oftentimes, sadly, it’s so advanced,” he added. Without treatment, glaucoma can cause permanent vision loss or blindness.

What to do: Glaucoma is treatable, but because there are often no symptoms, about half of people with the disease don’t know they have it. This is a big reason the American Academy of Ophthalmology recommends those regular eye exams after age 40, “even if you think everything is fine,” Miller noted. Regular exams are “screening for a lot of different things, but the biggest one is glaucoma.”

WELL+BEING

As a sports medicine physician, here’s what I want you to know about peptides

Ask A Doctor
JORDAN D. METZL

Q: Should I be taking peptides to support my health and fitness goals?

A: A few weeks ago, a patient sat across from me and asked a question I am hearing more often these days: “Should I be taking peptides?”

He wasn’t asking about an injury. He wasn’t trying to qualify for the Olympics. He was simply looking for a way to feel better, recover faster and stay healthy as he got older. He had heard about peptides from friends, podcasts and social media. The promised benefits seemed almost endless. More muscle, less fat, faster recovery, better sleep, fewer aches and pains.

As a sports medicine doctor, I find myself in an increasingly uncomfortable position. For most of my career, I have told my patients that building a healthier body is remarkably unglamorous and requires consistency, with few shortcuts. Move more. Get stronger. Sleep. Eat well. Find exercise you enjoy enough to keep doing. Don’t wait until you are sick to start taking care of yourself.

But I also know that medicine has not always been very good at helping people do those things.

As a field, we’ve been very good at treating disease but less successful at preventing it. For most busy health care professionals, it is often easier to prescribe a medication to treat an existing medical problem than to coach patients on how to change the behavior that contributed to it.

The United States is investing far more than any other nation in disease treatment, to the tune of roughly \$5 trillion per year, but much less in disease prevention. That mismatch has created an opening. And peptides, increasingly promoted by the modern longevity movement, have rushed through it.



GETTY IMAGES

Peptides are short chains of amino acids, but the word now seems to carry an almost magical quality.

Some peptides are well-studied and have proven benefits

Peptides are short chains of amino acids — the molecules that serve as the building blocks of protein — but the word now seems to carry an almost magical quality. Not all peptides, however, are created equal. Some are medications like insulin, with decades of human research behind them. Others are experimental compounds that have produced intriguing results in mice or cells in a laboratory but have barely been studied in people.

Consider semaglutide, a GLP-1 receptor agonist. It is a peptide-based medication, and unlike many compounds now circulating through wellness clinics and the internet, it has been studied in large, randomized clinical trials.

In a 2024 study published in the New England Journal of Medicine, people with obesity and painful knee osteoarthritis took semaglutide or a placebo for 68 weeks. Those taking

semaglutide lost an average of 13.7 percent of their body weight, compared with 3.2 percent in the placebo group. They also had substantially greater reductions in knee pain and improvements in physical function.

The most interesting number in the study wasn’t even the number on the scale. It was what happened to people’s ability to move. Less weight meant less pain, which meant more movement.

For a sports medicine doctor, that is important. We’ve been encouraging people with knee arthritis to move more for decades, but it’s difficult to do that when your knees are sore. This GLP-1 study points to a new approach, using weight loss as part of the initial treatment, not an afterthought.

When it comes to peptides like GLP-1 — which is also found in tirzepatide, liraglutide and dulaglutide — these drugs may allow us to help patients in ways we previously could not.

But there is another side to the peptide craze.

Most peptides are understudied, and their long-term safety is unknown

Go online and you will find peptides promoted for almost everything. BPC-157 for tendon healing. TB-500 for rapid recovery. CJC-1295 and ipamorelin for muscle and growth hormone effects. Others are marketed for inflammation, aging, fat loss and athletic performance.

The science behind these compounds is not remotely equivalent to the science behind semaglutide.

For some of the most popular recovery peptides, the excitement comes largely from animal studies, laboratory experiments or very small human studies. What we don’t have is enough high-quality human evidence to know whether these treatments work, who should take them, what dose is appropriate and most important, what happens after years of use.

The Food and Drug Administration has raised

concerns about the limited safety information available for many of these compounds, driven by the lack of human exposure data. That uncertainty has previously led regulators to proceed cautiously with many peptide therapies.

However, the regulatory debate recently started moving in a different direction. The current administration has encouraged efforts to reconsider whether certain experimental peptides, including BPC-157 and TB-500, can be prepared by compounding pharmacies under applicable federal rules. Compounding pharmacies acquire the raw ingredients for a drug and prepare the final product themselves, rather than dispensing medications that have already been mass manufactured in standard, FDA-approved form. In essence, they circumvent the FDA.

Supporters argue that if people are already buying these substances through poorly regulated channels known as the “gray market,” physician-supervised access may be safer. The idea is to allow access while simultaneously studying the results in human subjects.

That is a reasonable suggestion. But allowing a pharmacy to compound a drug is not the same as the FDA approving it after years of clinical trials. Compounding does not establish that a peptide heals tendons, accelerates recovery or extends life. More important, compounds that have not undergone the FDA approval process do not have remotely the same body of rigorous safety and efficacy data as approved medications, nor are they produced under the strict manufacturing rules and inspections required for approved medications.

My bottom line

Here’s where I struggle: A peptide can work in a precise

manner. It can repair tissue in a mouse. It can make a cell behave differently in a laboratory dish. It can generate hundreds of testimonials online. None of that tells us what happens after five or 10 years of taking it. We don’t want to confuse biological plausibility with medical evidence.

That doesn’t mean we should stop studying these treatments. Quite the opposite: We should study them more. But the standard for liberalizing access to treatments like these shouldn’t be excitement.

It should be evidence. The peptide era may ultimately become one of the most important developments in preventive medicine. It may give us new ways to treat obesity, preserve muscle, reduce pain and help people stay active as they age.

We don’t know yet. And that is okay.

I tell my patients that I want to help them improve their health, mobility and fitness. I want them to move, lift weights and push themselves. But I also tell them that it’s dangerous to experiment with substances that haven’t been subjected to appropriate human trials or manufactured under strict safety guidelines.

My job isn’t to tell them that peptides are good or bad. My job is to help them make the smartest decision they can with the evidence we have today.

That is what being a sports medicine doctor means in the increasingly muddled peptide era.

Jordan D. Metz, MD, is a sports medicine physician at the Hospital for Special Surgery in New York and the founder of the Ironstrength fitness community. His newest book, “PUSH: Unlock the Science of Fitness Motivation to Embrace Health and Longevity,” examines the science of fitness motivation and muscle maintenance for health.

Wellness influencers say nicotine can enhance your cognition. Are they right?

BY HASMEENA KATHURIA
The Conversation

Across social media, podcasts, wellness communities and tech start-ups, prominent wellness influencers are now portraying nicotine as a misunderstood compound whose potential benefits have been overshadowed by its negative association with cigarette smoking. These advocates, many of whom support the Make America Healthy Again movement, are touting an addictive substance linked to tobacco use as a natural product that can be used for everything from improving focus to protecting against cognitive decline. This trend includes using nicotine alone in noncombustible products such as nicotine pouches or in combination with caffeine and nootropics, or “smart drugs” marketed to enhance cognition.

As a pulmonary physician-scientist who studies nicotine addiction and the health consequences of tobacco and nicotine products, I am concerned about claims that nicotine can enhance wellness, productivity and cognitive performance.

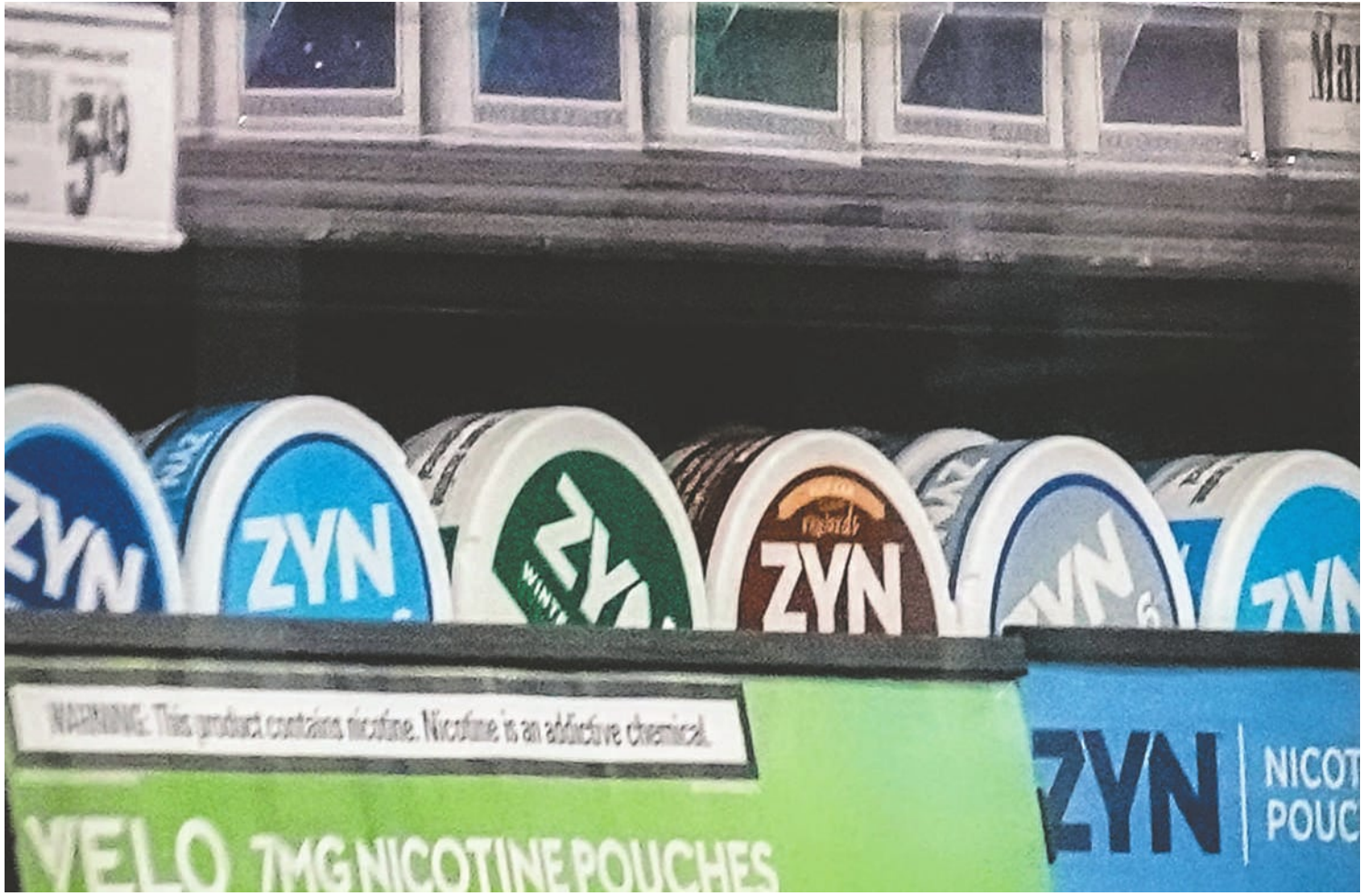
Nicotine’s impacts

Nicotine is the primary driver of tobacco addiction in the form of cigarettes, vapes, nicotine pouches, cigars, hookah tobacco, and smokeless tobacco products.

The greatest health risks arise when tobacco is burned, which generates thousands of toxic substances, including carcinogens, carbon monoxide, and fine particulate matter. Repeated exposure to these products can cause cancer, chronic obstructive pulmonary disease, cardiovascular disease and numerous other smoking-related illnesses.

While many smoking-related diseases result from exposure to combustion products, nicotine itself has well-known negative effects on the brain and body. Nicotine activates the sympathetic nervous system, the body’s “fight or flight” response, which increases heart rate and blood pressure and disrupts sleep. Repeated stimulation of this system can place additional strain on the heart.

Nicotine exposure is of particular concern during critical phases of development. Prenatal exposure to nicotine has been associated with adverse effects on fetal growth and development. Smok-



BEBETO MATTHEWS/AP

ing during adolescence can alter the neural systems involved in attention, learning and reward, increasing a teenager’s chances of becoming addicted.

Nicotine also leads to dependence by activating of brain reward pathways.

Acetylcholine is a key neurotransmitter — a chemical messenger in the brain — involved in attention, learning, memory and information processing. Nicotine acts on many of the same receptors that normally respond to acetylcholine, temporarily increasing alertness, attention and arousal. Activation of these receptors also influences the release of other neurotransmitters, including dopamine, which plays an important role in reward and reinforcement.

However, nicotine does not operate in the same way as acetylcholine. The effects of nicotine last much longer and alters activity throughout the brain. With repeated exposure, the brain adapts to nicotine’s presence. Receptors become less responsive to nicotine, and the brain compen-

Nicotine is the primary driver of tobacco addiction in the form of cigarettes, vapes, nicotine pouches (above), cigars, hookah tobacco and other products.

sates by increasing the number of nicotine receptors, contributing to dependence.

Focus and productivity

Wellness influencers argue that nicotine serves as a cognitive enhancer that improves focus and productivity.

Some of these claims stem from the observation that nicotine is a naturally occurring plant compound found primarily in tobacco and in nightshade vegetables such as tomatoes, potatoes and eggplant in trace amounts. Proponents of its use point to research also draw on studies suggesting that nicotine can affect certain aspects of cognition and brain function.

However, extending these findings to broad claims about productivity, brain health, longevity or wellness goes well beyond what has been shown in human studies.

Some studies indicate that nicotine may temporarily enhance attention, vigilance, reaction time and some aspects of working memory, but results are mixed. Research suggests that nicotine may benefit people with mild cognitive impairment, but it does not appear to enhance cognition in healthy individuals and may even worsen cognitive performance in higher-performing people.

In addition, many of these studies include some regular nicotine users who are dependent on nicotine. When they stop using nicotine, regular users commonly experience difficulty concentrating, irritability, anxiety, restlessness and impaired attention. Reintroducing nicotine often relieves these symptoms, making it difficult to determine whether observed improvements reflect true cognitive enhancement or simply

the reversal of withdrawal symptoms.

Managing stress

Wellness influencers also promote nicotine as a tool for managing stress and improving mood. For instance, influencer Dave Asprey said on YouTube that nicotine could “turn your mind back on without frying your nervous system.”

Nicotine activates reward pathways in the brain, which can create a temporary sense of pleasure and well-being. However, long-term nicotine use can interfere with the body’s stress-response system, which may make stress and anxiety harder to manage over time.

Among regular nicotine users, perceived improvements in mood and stress may partly reflect relief of withdrawal symptoms such as anxiety, irritability and restlessness. Research consistently shows that people who quit smoking experience reductions in anxiety, depression and stress, along with improvements in mood and overall quality of life. In fact,

long-term discontinuation of nicotine use is associated with better mental health and well-being.

Healthy aging and longevity

Some of the most ambitious claims emerging from the pro-nicotine wellness movement suggest that nicotine protects against dementia, Alzheimer’s disease, Parkinson’s disease and age-related cognitive decline.

These claims are based on findings suggesting that nicotine can influence neural pathways involved in memory and attention as well as animal and laboratory studies examining whether nicotine could modify disease processes associated with cognitive decline.

However, human studies have not demonstrated that nicotine can prevent dementia, slow the progression of Alzheimer’s disease, preserve long-term cognitive function, or improve outcomes in Parkinson’s disease.

Some wellness and longevity advocates claim that nicotine preserves cognitive function, slows biological aging or promotes longevity.

These claims are largely based on laboratory studies showing that nicotine can affect cellular pathways related to oxidative stress, which has been implicated in biological aging and in the progression of neurodegenerative diseases such as Alzheimer’s disease and Parkinson’s disease, and animal studies suggesting it can act as an anti-inflammatory in many cases. However, findings from laboratory and animal studies have not translated into evidence that nicotine promotes healthy aging, extends lifespan or prevents age-related disease in humans.

FDA-approved nicotine replacement therapies — including nicotine patches, gum and lozenges — can help people overcome nicotine dependence. But that sort of established therapeutic use should not be confused with these more recent, ambitious claims about nicotine’s benefits.

Hasmeena Kathuria is Professor of Medicine and Director of the Center for Tobacco Research and Intervention at the University of Wisconsin School of Medicine and Public Health.

This article was produced in collaboration with The Conversation, a nonprofit news organization.

The dementia that often strikes in midlife – and the signs people overlook

BY ERICA SLOAN

If you've heard of frontotemporal dementia (FTD), it may be because of Bruce Willis or Wendy Williams — two celebrities whose diagnoses in recent years have shed light on this infrequently discussed neurodegenerative disease. Though FTD is relatively rare, accounting for about 5 percent to 10 percent of all dementia cases and affecting an estimated 50,000 to 60,000 people in the United States, it's the most common form of early-onset dementia.

In fact, 60 percent of people who get diagnosed with it are ages 45 to 64, decades younger than the average person diagnosed with Alzheimer's disease (which causes most cases of dementia). And yet, experts believe this is a significant undercount because it's "rare enough that most medical providers, even specialists, don't have experience with it, and so they don't know what it looks like," said Brad Dickerson, neurologist at the Mass General Brigham Neuroscience Institute and director of the Frontotemporal Disorders Unit at Massachusetts General Hospital.

The initial symptoms of FTD also diverge sharply from those of the more common Alzheimer's disease because of the parts of the brain it attacks. FTD often starts "in the front of the brain, which is very important for behavior, regulation of social interactions, addiction, drive, organizing and planning," said Bruce Miller, a professor of neurology and director of the Edward and Pearl Fein Memory and Aging Center at the University of California at San Francisco.

So, FTD generally manifests first with behavior or mood changes — rather than the memory loss and thinking problems of Alzheimer's (which typically first affects the areas of the brain responsible for these tasks, including the hippocampus). It's the reason FTD is often misread as a psychiatric issue, Miller said. On average, it takes about three to four years for people to get a diagnosis of FTD, according to the Association for Frontotemporal Degeneration.

Below, experts explain why FTD tends to hit earlier in life than other dementias, the often-overlooked signs to know and what care for people with the condition looks like.

Why FTD starts earlier than other forms of dementia

Unlike Alzheimer's, most people with FTD are diagnosed before age 65. The question of why is still being studied — but experts think the answer has to do



Initial symptoms of frontotemporal dementia (FTD) are easy to miss, since they can look more like a psychiatric condition.

with the underlying cause.

Roughly 20 percent of cases are thought to be caused by any one of several genetic mutations. Two of them produce abnormal proteins with toxic effects on brain cells, and one of them leads to a deficiency in a protein that neurons need, Dickerson explained. These are readily passed down: You only need one bad copy of any of these genes to almost certainly develop FTD, he said, meaning that a child of a person with a mutation has a 50 percent chance of inheriting it.

Genetic mutations can "drive the biology" of FTD, starting early in life, Miller said. "By the time someone reaches the age of 40 or 50, there may have been many years [during which] that genetic cause has wreaked havoc in their brain."

Experts also think yet-to-be-discovered genes could play a role in some of the remaining 80 percent of cases. After all, as many as 40 percent of people with FTD have a family history.

One area of research is focused on genetic variants that, individually, are not disease-causing abnormalities, Dickerson said, but that could increase risk when they occur together. It's thought that if you inherit particular sets of these genes, you could be made

more vulnerable by other risk factors, perhaps environmental ones, than someone without a similar genetic pattern. (It's not clear what these environmental factors might be yet, but Dickerson made the comparison to the known association between air pollution and an increased likelihood of developing Alzheimer's and the fact that not everyone who lives in a polluted area will develop the disease.)

Ultimately, Miller said, the "number of FTD cases that have a genetic basis is likely quite high," which pushes down the age of onset. As for the cases where a genetic link isn't apparent, experts are still figuring out the contributors, though lifestyle is thought to be important. Research suggests that even those with a genetic mutation tied to FTD could delay symptoms if they are cognitively active and exercise regularly, Miller said. He added that head trauma is a risk factor that researchers are investigating, too.

Key early signs of FTD that are easy to miss

The symptoms of FTD depend on where exactly in the brain the condition starts. If it initially hits the temporal lobe, particularly on the left side, it'll affect language

skills, including the ability to speak and comprehend — causing a condition known as primary progressive aphasia. With this kind of FTD, people tend to get referred to a neurologist and diagnosed quickly, Dickerson said.

But as noted above, FTD most often begins in the frontal lobe and its earliest symptoms typically include behavior or personality changes — called behavioral-variant FTD. The most common ones are easily mistaken as signs of psychiatric conditions such as depression or bipolar disorder, or dismissed as the effects of stress, burnout or even a midlife crisis. They include:

- **Apathy.** "People lose interest in doing things, they move less and they are less interested in the stories of loved ones," Miller said.
- **Addictive behaviors.** They might turn to compulsive drinking, drugs, sex or several of the above, Miller pointed out.
- **Loss of empathy.** People with FTD tend to become alienated from their partners, children, friends and co-workers — and a big reason for that is losing the ability to feel what others are feeling, Miller said.
- **Difficulty with planning, organizing and managing money.** FTD often hinders executive function, which refers to high-

level cognitive skills including problem-solving, abstract thinking, regulating sensory input and decision-making. One way this could manifest: Dickerson said he's seen many patients who have fallen victim to scams that might have seemed obviously problematic to someone without FTD.

• **Disinhibition.** FTD can cause people to lose their filter or start acting in ways that are socially inappropriate, Dickerson said. He gave the example of someone urinating in a public bathroom without closing the door behind them.

Loved ones and friends often notice these changes first. A person with FTD will generally lack insight into their symptoms and might not think anything is wrong, Dickerson said. They might relay a different story to a doctor, which can further complicate diagnosis.

The stigma surrounding both dementia and psychiatric conditions can also lead people with FTD and their family members to avoid seeking care. If they do, they often wind up getting referred to a psychiatrist, Dickerson said, rather than a neurologist.

By the time a diagnosis arrives, the disease has often progressed. "FTD moves about twice as fast as the typical Alzheimer's disease,"

Miller said, with an average life expectancy around seven to 13 years. "As the disease progresses, the apathy becomes more profound, and people completely immobilize," he said. Some people develop motor problems, such as tremors; as many as 30 percent of those with FTD wind up with symptoms consistent with amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (ALS), a motor neuron disease that causes weakness, muscle wasting and difficulty swallowing.

It's the reason Miller said it's important to "think about the brain, and the frontal lobes in particular, in any case of dramatic change in behavior or personality."

A helpful point to remember: Dementia is often understood as a loss, for instance, of memory or reasoning skills, and there can certainly be a loss of organization with FTD. But many early symptoms of FTD also reflect "a gain of personality traits that were not there before," Dickerson said. Ones that register as inappropriate or out of character should especially prompt a visit to a neurologist. "We can help families manage it if we get in early," Miller said.

What treatment looks like for frontotemporal dementia

There is currently no cure for FTD. Care involves working with a team of experts — physicians, nurses, psychologists — to manage symptoms and behaviors, Miller said. "That often means thinking about, 'Which ones of these [symptoms] need to be managed, and which can we ignore?'" Some may be harmful to the person with FTD and those around them, while others may be minor enough to learn to accept and work around.

Some people with FTD may benefit from the antidepressants known as selective serotonin reuptake inhibitors (SSRIs), Miller noted. "They can decrease irritability and compulsive behaviors and improve mood." Those who have language deficits may also find speech therapy to be helpful, at least in early stages.

Both experts are hopeful, however, about the momentum they're seeing in treatment research, which has been supported by growing awareness. Dickerson pointed to clinical trials that aim to restore levels of the deficient protein in one form of FTD. Miller noted studies attempting to lower tau — one of the abnormal proteins that can drive FTD — and gene-editing efforts to "turn off or turn down the bad genes" in other types of dementia. These approaches are "not quite ready yet for frontotemporal dementia," but when they are, "it's going to be really exciting."

This simple hand gesture can bring calm in moments of stress, studies suggest

CALM FROM DI

ond hug, and the third group made paper airplanes.

Participants who practiced self-soothing touch or received a hug had lower levels of cortisol than those who made a paper airplane.

The researchers found no differences in participants' heart rates or how stressed they said they felt.

"For cortisol, it helped blunt the response," Dreisoerner said, noting that the hand-over-heart method brought a lower cortisol response in saliva tests than the group that received the hug, but the difference was not statistically significant.

Scientists are still examining why a hand on the heart seems to lessen cortisol. Dreisoerner hypothesized that it involves oxytocin, a hormone associated with promoting calm and reducing stress in the body.

"Some preliminary evidence shows that self-touch can elicit an oxytocin response," he said. Still, "it's hard to pinpoint because this literature is so young."

Dreisoerner said self-soothing touch is another name for self-compassionate touch, a simple gesture that is often accompanied by deep breaths.

"I view it as a comprehensive intervention that works from both angles. It has a physical component and a psychological component," he said. "Self-soothing touch is an embodied way to express self-compassion."

In another study, published this year, Dreisoerner and his colleagues randomly assigned 78 people they identified as "chronically stressed" to practice either self-soothing touch or a brief meditation for five minutes daily over two weeks. In both groups, all participants reported feeling less stressed, tired and lonely immediately afterward.

"There's a lot of research showing that one of the most basic

pathways to self-compassion is through the body," said Kristin Neff, a pioneering researcher in the field, and founder and president of the Self-Compassion Institute, an Austin-based company that offers workshops and coaching.

Self-compassion — staying attuned to your needs and avoiding harsh self-judgement — has been studied for decades, and has been linked to mental health benefits and overall improved well-being.

Neff, who was not involved in the studies, said the physical warmth and pressure of touch can signal safety to the nervous system.

"Touch is an expression of care," she said. "You start with the body, and it's easier for the mind to say: 'I'm here for you. I care about you.'"

Neff said putting a hand over your heart has become the most common mode of self-compassionate touch.

"The heart center, the chest center, is where we feel the emotion of love and care," she said. "The physical touch of the hand on the heart, the warmth of the hand on the heart, I think just naturally evokes those responses."

The body of research for self-compassionate touch is smaller than that of self-compassion more broadly.

Ashley Batts Allen, a self-compassion researcher and professor of psychology at the University of North Carolina at Pembroke, said the 2021 study is scientifically sound, but it's not clear whether physical contact alone accounted for the differences in cortisol levels.

Participants also took deep breaths and were instructed to focus on the warmth and pressure of their hands. The lowered cortisol could have come from the touch, the breathing, the warmth, the pressure or a combination.

"I would love to see more stud-



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ies that disentangle everything, so we can really nail down what exactly it is that's having the impact," she said.

Other studies have built on Dreisoerner's work by exploring whether self-compassionate touch can improve well-being when practiced regularly, and whether it outperforms other simple physical exercises, such as finger tapping.

Eli Susman, a psychologist and author of the forthcoming book "Micropractice," led a 2024 study at the University of California at Berkeley, in which 135 U.S. college students were assigned to do self-compassionate touch or a finger-tapping exercise, which involves tapping each finger to their thumb on the same hand. Participants were asked to practice their assigned exercises for 20 seconds at least once a day for

"All you need is 20 seconds. You are your own best scientist. That's how you're really going to see how this is going to work."

Kristin Neff, founder and president of the Self-Compassion Institute

Briefly placing a hand on your heart may lower the stress hormone cortisol. It can be a quick and inconspicuous way to calm down before, say, giving a presentation at work.

one month. They completed questionnaires at the beginning of the study and again a month later about their self-compassion, stress and mental health symptoms.

Of the 45 participants who practiced their assigned exercise nearly every day, those in the self-touch group reported greater mental health improvements than those in the finger-tapping group.

"The more you do it, the more you're going to benefit," Susman said.

In another study published last month in Scientific Reports, Susman and his colleagues asked nearly 500 people to perform an exercise where they placed one hand over the heart and the other over the abdomen. All the participants were encouraged to practice the exercise, or something

similar, daily for six months, and half were also given training on how to create and sustain habits.

The participants who were given habit-building tools practiced about two more times per week than those who were not given the tools. They also reported increased self-compassion after three and six months, and a greater reduction in negative mental health symptoms after six months.

"We did find that the stronger of a habit it became, the stronger of a reduction in stress they had," Susman said.

The biggest limitation of all the existing studies on self-compassionate touch is simple: There is not enough research to confirm what scientists believe to be true.

"We need more studies on this ... to see if the effect is robust," said Dreisoerner, adding that future research should involve larger, more diverse groups.

How to try it

The experts we talked to recommend placing one or both hands on your heart or abdomen, or one on each. Take a few deep breaths, and focus on the warmth and pressure for about 20 seconds.

Neff cautioned that this may not feel comforting to everyone. As an alternative, she suggested finding other forms of physical grounding, such as feeling the soles of your feet against the floor, or touching something soft.

"All you need is 20 seconds," Neff said. "You are your own best scientist. That's how you're really going to see how this is going to work."

While self-compassionate touch is not a proven treatment or substitute for professional care, in a moment of stress, it may be worth trying — and taking note of how it feels.

"The right way to practice self-compassion is what works for you," Neff said. "There's no one pathway in for everyone."